

THE
POLITICAL SONGS
OF ENGLAND,

FROM THE REIGN OF JOHN TO THAT OF EDWARD II.

EDITED AND TRANSLATED

BY THOMAS WRIGHT, Esq., M.A., F.S.A., &c.

OF TRINITY COLLEGE, CAMBRIDGE.



LONDON:

PRINTED FOR THE CAMDEN SOCIETY,

BY JOHN BOWYER NICHOLS AND SON, PARLIAMENT STREET.

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TRANSCRIBER'S NOTE

The yogh symbol is denoted by ȝ or ȝ; the eth symbol is denoted by ð; and the thorn symbol by þ or þ. The Tironian et is denoted by 7.

The translation of each song has been placed alongside the song, if the screen window is wide enough to allow it. If not, the translation will be found at the end of the song. The last song in the book 'POEM ON THE EVIL TIMES OF EDWARD II', at [page 323](#), is the only one without a translation.

'Various Readings' and 'Glossary' sections were inserted into each page of some of the songs in the original text. These have not been moved, because they contain references to specific line numbers of the song just above the inserted section.

There are no Footnotes in this book. The bracketed numbers in the text, for example [70], refer to the line number of the relevant song.

The bracketed number in the right margin is the page number for the original text.

Some minor changes to the text are noted at the [end of the book](#).

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OF
THE CAMDEN SOCIETY,

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P R E F A C E .

Few historical documents are more interesting or important than the contemporary songs in which the political partizan satirised his opponents and stirred up the courage of his friends, or in which the people exulted over victories gained abroad against their enemies or at home against their oppressors, or lamented over evil counsels and national calamities. Yet, though a few specimens have been published from time to time in collections of miscellaneous poetry, such as those of Percy and Ritson, and have never failed to attract attention, no book specially devoted to ancient Political Songs has yet appeared.

The quantity of such productions has generally varied with the character of the age. They were frequent from a very early period in other countries of Europe, as well as England. It would be easy to produce proofs that in our island they were very numerous in Saxon times,—a few specimens, indeed, have escaped that destruction which visits the monuments of popular and temporary feeling before all others; and for years after the Norman conquest the oppressed people continued to sing the songs of former days at their rustic festivals or amid their everyday labours. As the feelings which caused them to be remembered died away gradually before the weight of a new political system, a new class of songs also arose. From the Conquest to the end of the twelfth century, the political songs of the Anglo-Normans were in a great measure

confined, as far as we can judge from the few specimens that are left, to laudatory poems in Latin, or to funereal elegies on princes and great people. Yet we can hardly doubt that, with the turbulent barons of these troublous times, the harp of the minstrel must have resounded frequently to subjects of greater present excitement.

With the beginning of the thirteenth century opened a new scene of political contention. It is amid the civil commotions of the reign of John, that our manuscripts first present traces of the songs in which popular opinion sought and found a vent, at the same time that the commons of England began to assume a more active part on the stage of history. The following reign was a period of constant excitement. The weak government of Henry the Third permitted every party to give free utterance to their opinions and intentions, and the songs of this period are remarkably bold and pointed. These effusions are interesting in other points of view besides their connexion with historical events; they illustrate in a remarkable manner the history of our language; they show us how Latin, Anglo-Norman, and English were successively the favourite instruments by which the thoughts of our ancestors were expressed; and collaterally they show us how the clerk (or scholar) with his Latin, the courtier with his Anglo-Norman, and the people with their good old English, came forward in turns upon the scene. In our Songs we see that, during the earlier part of the reign of the third Henry, the satirical pieces which inveighed against the corruptions of the state and demanded so loudly their amendment, are all in Latin, which is as much as to say that they came from the scholastic part of the people, or those who had been bred in the universities, then no small or unimportant part of the community. They seem to have led the way as bold reformers; and the refectory of the monastery not less than the baronial hall rang frequently with the outbursts of popular feeling. The remarkable and highly

interesting declaration of the objects and sentiments of the Barons, which was published after the battle of Lewes, is written in Latin. Amid the Barons' wars was composed the first political song in English that has yet been found. It is remarkable that all the songs of this period which we know, whether in Latin, Anglo-Norman, or English, are on the popular side of the dispute—all with one accord agree in their praise and support of the great Simon de Montfort.

The circumstance of our finding no songs in English of an earlier date does not, however, prove that they did not exist. On the contrary, it is probable that they were equally abundant with the others; but the Latin songs belonged to that particular party who were most in the habit of committing their productions to writing, and whose manuscripts also were longest preserved. It is probable that a very small portion of the earlier English popular poetry was ever entered in books—it was preserved in people's memory until, gradually forgotten, it ceased entirely to exist except in a few instances, where, years after the period at which it was first composed, it was committed to writing by those who heard it recited. The English song on the battle of Lewes is found in a manuscript written in the reign of Edward II.; when, perhaps, the similar character of the time led people to give retrospective looks to the doings of Earl Simon and his confederate barons. They were sometimes written on small rolls of parchment, for the convenience of the minstrel, who thus carried them about with him from house to house, and chanted them at the will of his entertainers. From these rolls and loose scraps they were occasionally copied into books, long after they had ceased to possess any popular interest, by some "clerk" who loved to collect antiquities; for in those days, too, there were antiquaries. One of the Anglo-Norman songs printed in this collection is taken from the original roll; and the

Latin songs on the death of Peter de Gaveston were found in a manuscript written in the fifteenth century.

The constant wars of the reign of Edward I.—the patriotic hatred of Frenchman and Scot, which then ran at the highest—furnished the groundwork of many a national song during the latter years of the thirteenth century and the first years of the fourteenth. The English song becomes at this period much more frequent, though many were still written in Latin. Popular discontent continued to be expressed equally in Latin, Anglo-Norman (a language the influence of which was now fast declining), and English. In the “Song against the King’s Taxes,” composed towards the end of the thirteenth century, we have the first specimen of that kind of song wherein each line began in one language and ended in another; and which, generally written in hexameters, seems to have been extremely popular during the two centuries following. One song, in the reign of Edward II. presents in alternate succession all the three languages which were then in use. The political songs during this last-mentioned reign are not very numerous, but they are by no means devoid of interest.

It was the Editor’s original intention to continue the series of songs in the present volume to the deposition of Richard II. But, having adopted the suggestion of giving a translation, with the hope of making them more popular, and finding that in consequence the volume was likely to extend to a much greater length than was at first calculated upon, it has been thought advisable to close the present collection with another convenient historical period, the deposition of his grandfather Edward II.; and it is his intention at some future period to form a second volume, which will be continued to the fall of the house of York in the person of the crook-backed Richard III.

The wars of Edward III. produced many songs, both in Latin and in English, as did also the troubles which disturbed the reign of his successor. With the end of the reign of Edward II. however, we begin to lose sight of the Anglo-Norman language, which we shall not again meet with in these popular effusions. During the fifteenth century political songs are less numerous and also less spirited. With it we are introduced to a dark period of literature and science. It was the interval between the breaking up of the old system, and the formation of the new one which was to be built upon its ruins. When we come to the wars of the Roses, so fatal to the English nobility and gentry, the page even of history becomes less interesting, because it is less intellectual:—the great mental workings which had influenced so much the political movements of the thirteenth and fourteenth centuries, were replaced by the reckless and short-sighted bitterness of personal hatred, and the demoralizing agency of mere animal force. As it had required a long age of barbarism and ignorance to sweep away even the latest remnants of ancient pagan splendour, before the site was fit to build up the beautiful edifice of Christian civilization; so it seemed as though another, though a shorter and comparatively less profound, age of barbarism was required to turn men's minds from the defective learning of the schools, and the imperfect literature to which they had been habituated, and to break down old prejudices and privileges, which were but impediments in the way of the new system that came in with the Reformation.

The nature of the following collection of Songs requires little explanation. They have been brought together from scattered sources. It was the Editor's desire to make it as complete as possible; but further researches will probably bring to light other songs of no less interest, and these, if they become sufficiently numerous, he hopes will be collected together as a supplement to

the present volume. He has also omitted a few Anglo-Irish songs, because he expects they will, ere long, receive more justice than he is capable of doing them, at the hands of Mr. Crofton Croker. It is hoped that the texts will be found as correct as the manuscripts would allow. The translation is offered with diffidence, and requires many excuses; the variety of languages and dialects in which they are written, their dissimilarity in style of composition, the cramped constructions which were rendered necessary in the Latin Songs to allow the multiplicity of rhymes, the allusions which cannot now be easily explained, and above all, the numerous corruptions which have been introduced by the scribes from whose hands the different manuscripts came (for the greater part of these songs have been printed from unique copies), are the cause of so many difficulties, that in some instances little more has been done than to guess at the writer's meaning. The translation is in general as literal as possible—the Anglo-Norman, French, and English Songs are rendered line for line; but the Editor is almost inclined to regret that he did not give a freer version.

The Appendix consists of extracts from the inedited metrical chronicle of Peter Langtoft, which are here introduced, because they contain fragments in what was then termed "*ryme cowée*," or tailed rhyme, which are apparently taken from songs of the time. The text is printed from a transcript made by the Editor several years ago; and it contains many lines of the English songs which are not found in the manuscripts preserved at the British Museum. The Editor introduces these extracts the more willingly, as it is not very probable that the Chronicle itself will be published at present. As a monument of the Anglo-Norman language, it is far inferior to many others that remain still inedited; and, as a historical document, it is already well known through the English version of Robert de Brunne, which was printed by Thomas Hearne. The

collations have been made chiefly with a philological view; the comparison of the different manuscripts shows us how entirely the grammatical forms of the Anglo-Norman language were at this time neglected. To these extracts, the Editor has been enabled to add a very curious English poem from the Auchinleck MS. at Edinburgh, by the extreme kindness of David Laing, Esq., to whom the Camden Society owes the transcript and collation of the proofs of this poem.

It only remains for the Editor to fulfil the agreeable task of expressing his gratitude for the assistance which, in the course of the work, he has derived from the kindness of his friends: to Mons. d'Avezac, of Paris, so well known by his valuable contributions to geographical science, to whom he has had recourse in some of the greater difficulties in the French and Anglo-Norman songs, and who collated with the originals those which were taken from foreign manuscripts before they were sent to press; to Sir Frederick Madden, from whom he has derived much assistance in the English songs, and whose superior knowledge in everything connected with early literature and manuscripts has been of the greatest use to him; to James Orchard Halliwell, Esq., for many services, and for collating with the originals the songs taken from Cambridge Manuscripts; and to John Gough Nichols, Esq., for the great attention which he has paid to the proofs, and for various suggestions, which have freed this volume from very many errors that would otherwise have been overlooked.

THOMAS WRIGHT.

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THE
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P O L I T I C A L S O N G S .

KING JOHN. 1199–1216.

The thirteenth century opens amid the violence of party feelings, and the few political songs which we find during the reign of King John are full of keenness. Early in his reign the English Monarch suffered himself to be robbed of his possessions in Normandy, and the poetry of the Troubadours contains many expressions of regret at their separation from England, and bitter reflections on the King's cowardice and weakness. The following song seems to have been written when Thouars was in danger, during Philippe Auguste's incursions into Poitou, in 1206. Savary of Mauleon is famous in contemporary history, and was himself a poet of no small renown. He was a firm adherent to the English party.

SONG ON THE SIEGE OF THOUARS.

[Royal Library at Paris, MS. du fonds de St. Germain, No. 1989, fol. 111, v^o.
13th cent.]

Mors est li siècles briemant,
Se li rois Touwairs sormonte;
De ceu li vait malement
Ke li faillent li troi conte,
Et li vieillairs de Bouaing
I averait grant honte,
C'après la mort à vifconte
Morrait à si mauté.

Savaris de Maliéon,
Boens chiveliers à cintainne,
Se vos fals à ces besons,
Perdue avons nostre poinne;
Et vos, xanexals
Asi d'Anjow et dou Mainne,
Xanexal ont an Torainne
Atre ke vos mist.

Et vos, sire xanexals,
Vos et Dan Jehan dou Mainne,
Et Ugues, antre vos trois
Mandeis à roi d'Alemaigne,
Ke cist rois et cil Fransois
C'ameir ne nos d[a]ignent,
Cant por .j. mullet d'Espaigne
Laxait Bordelois.

Et vos, signors bacheleirs,
Ki ameis lois et proeses,
Cant vos souliez garreir
Touwairs iert vos forteresce.
Jà Deus ne vos doust porter
Ne mainche ne tresses,
Se Touwairt au teil tristesce
Laixiez oblieir.

TRANSLATION.—The world
will shortly come to nought,
—if the king overcome
Thouars.—On this account it
fares ill with it,—that the
three earls desert it,—and the
old man of Bouaing—would
have there great shame,—that
after the death of the viscount
—he should die in such evil
case.

Savary of Mauleon,—a
good knight at the quintain,—
if you fail us in this need,—
we have lost our labour;—and
you, Seneschal,—both of
Anjou and of Maine,—they
have placed a seneschal in
Touraine—other than you.

And you, Sir Seneschal,—
you and Sir John of Maine,—
and Hugh, between you three,
—send word to the King of
Almain,—that this king and
him of France,—deign not to
love us,—when for a mule of
Spain—he left the Bordelois.

And you, Sir bachelors,—
who love praise and prowess,
—when you were wont to war
—Thouars was your fortress.
—Now God hinder you from
hearing—sleeves or tresses —

beating sleeves of dresses,
if Thouars in such distress—
you allow to be forgotten.

John's own friends, disgusted with his weakness, began to desert him; and the following bitter song was addressed by the younger Bertrand de Born, to Savary de Mauleon, to persuade him to follow their example.

A SIRVENTE ON KING JOHN.

[Raynouard, Choix, tom. iv. p. 201.]

Quant vei lo temps renovellar,
 E pareis la fueill' e la flors,
 Mi dona ardimen amors
 E cor e saber de chantar;
 E doncs, pois res no m' en sofrainç,
 Farai un Sirvent escozen,
 Que trametrai lai par presen
 Al rei Joan que s n'a vergoing.

E deuria s' be'n vergoignar,
 Si l' membres de sos ancessors,
 Com laissa sai Peitieux e Tors
 Al rei Felip ses demandar;
 Per que tota Guiana plaing
 Lo rei Richard, qu' en deffenden
 En mes mant aur e mant argen;
 Mas aces no m' par 'n aia soing.

Mais ama l' bordir e l' cassar,
 E bracs e lebriers et austors,
 E sojorn; per que il faill honors,
 E s' laissa vius deseretar;
 Mal sembla d'ardimen Galvaing,
 Que sai lo viram plus soven;
 E pois autre cosseil non pren,
 Lais sa terra al seignor del Groign.

Miels saup Lozoics desliurar
 Guillelme, e l' fes ric secors
 Ad Aurenga, quan l' Almassors
 A Tibaut l'ac fait asetjar:
 Pretz et honor 'n ac ab gazaing;
 Jeu o dic per chastiamen
 Al rei Joan que pert sa gen,
 Que non lor secor pres ni loing.

TRANSLATION.—When I see
 the fair weather return,—and
 leaf and flower appear,—love
 gives me hardiesse—and
 heart and skill to sing;—then,
 since I do not want matter,—I
 will make a stinging sirvente,
 —which I will send yonder
 for a present,—to King John,
 to make him ashamed.

And well he ought to be
 ashamed,—if he remember
 his ancestors,—how he has
 left here Poitou and Touraine
 —to King Philip, without
 asking for them.—Wherefore
 all Guienne laments—King
 Richard, who in its defence—
 would have laid out much
 gold and much silver;—but
 this man does not appear to
 me to care much for it.

He loves better fishing and
 hunting,—pointers,
 greyhounds, and hawks,—and
 repose, wherefore he loses his
 property,—and his fief
 escapes out of his hands;—
 Galvaing seems ill-furnished
 with courage,—so that we
 beat him here most
 frequently;—and since he
 takes no other counsel,—let
 him leave his land to the lord

Baron, sai vir mon chastiar
A vos, cui blasme las follors
Que us vei far, e pren m'en dolors,
Car m'aven de vos a parlar,
Que pretz avetz tombat e' l' faing,
Et avetz apres un fol sen,
Que non doptas chastiamen,
Mas qui us ditz mal, aquel vos oing.

Domna, cui dezir e tenc car
E dopt e blan part las meillors,
Tant es vera vostra lauzors
Qu'ieu non la sai dir ni comtar;
C'aissi com aurs val mais d'estaing,
Valetz mais part las meillors cen,
Et ez plus leials vas joven
Non son a Dieu cill de Cadoing.

Savarics, reis cui cors sofraing
Greu fara bon envasimen,
E pois a flac cor recrezen,
Jamais nuls hom en el non poing.

him leave his land to the lord
of the Groing.

Louis knew better how to deliver—William, and gives him rich succour—at Orange, when the Almassor—had caused Tiebald to besiege him;—glory and honour he had with profit;—I say it for a lesson—to King John who loses his people,—because he succours them not near or far off.

Barons, on this side my lesson of correction aims—at you, whose delinquencies it blames—that I have seen you do, and I am grieved thereat,—for it falls to me to speak of you,—who have let your credit fall into the mud,—and afterwards have a foolish sentiment,—that you do not fear correction,—but he who told you ill, it is he who disgraces you.

Lady, whom I desire and hold dear,—and fear and flatter above the best,—so true is your praise,—that I know not how to say it or to relate it;—that, as gold is more worth than tin,—you are worth more than the best

hundred,—and you are better worth to a young man,—than are they (the monks) of Caen to God.

Savary, a king without a heart,—will hardly make a successful invasion,—and since he has a heart soft and cowardly,—let no man put his trust in him.

The dishonours which John suffered abroad, were, however, soon forgotten in the troubles which broke out at home. The following virulent libel on the three bishops of Norwich, Bath, and Winchester, who adhered to the King in his quarrel with the Pope about the presentation to the see of Canterbury, was no doubt the work of one of his ecclesiastical opponents.

SONG ON THE BISHOPS.

[Flacius Illyricus, p. 161.]

Planctus super Episcopis.

Complange tui, Anglia,
 Melos suspendens organi;
 Et maxime tu, Cantia,
 De mora tui Stephani.
 Thomam habes sed alterum,
 Secundum habes iterum
 Stephanum, qui trans hominem
 Induens fortitudinem
 Signa facit in populo.
 Dolos dolens metropolis
 Quos subdoli parturiunt,
 Orbata tuis incolis,
 Dolose quos ejiciunt,
 Largos emittis gemitus,
 Patre privata penitus.
 Sed cum habebis Stephanum,
 Assumes tibi tympanum,
 Chelym tangens sub modulo.

Ubi es, quæso, Moyses,
 Per quem cedat confractio?
 Ubi legem zelans Phinees,
 Per quem cesset quassatio?
 Quis natum David arguens?
 Quis Thaü signum statuens
 In limine et postibus,
 Ut sic confusis hostibus
 Liberetur Israel?
 Abraham, pater gentium
 Multarum, surge, domine,
 Agar expelle filium,
 Saræ ancillæ dominæ;
 Nam post subducet aliam.
 Jam adversus ecclesiam
 Prævalent portæ Tartari:

TRANSLATION.—Complain,
 O England! and suspend the
 melody of thine organ, and
 more especially thou, Kent,
 for the delay of thy Stephen.
 But thou hast another
 Thomas; thou hast again a
 second Stephen, who putting
 on a fortitude beyond that of
 man, performs signs among
 the people. O metropolis! who
 grieveest over the plots which
 the cunning people bring
 forth, bereaved of thine
 inhabitants, whom they
 treacherously have ejected,
 thou givest vent to heavy
 groans, being utterly deprived
 of thy father. But when thou
 shalt have Stephen, thou wilt
 take up the timbrel, and touch
 the harp to measure.

Where art thou, I ask, O
 Moses! through whom may
 the rupture cease? Where
 Phineas, zealous for the law,
 through whom the scourging
 may have an end? Who is
 there to accuse the son of
 David? Who is there that may
 set the sign of Thau on the
 threshold and the door-posts,
 that thus, her enemies being
 confused, Israel may be

Jam ludo ludunt impari
Isaac et Ismael.

Balthasar bibit iterum
De vasis templi Domini:
Vasa rapit vas scelerum
Dei dicata nomini.
Scribentem cerno digitum,
Et literis implicitum
Scriptis, "Mane, Tecchel, Phares;"
Quid sibi velit ea res,

Rei probabit exitus.
Jam patet in prætorio,
Et infimis et arduis,
Quod regni jam divisio
Et finis est in januis.
Crescit malorum cumulus,
Est sacerdos ut populus,
Currunt ad illicitum,
Uterque juxta libitum
Audax et imperterritus.

Plebs in Ægypti cophino
Servit, et sudat anxia
Sub Pharaone domino:
Edicta currunt varia:
Exactor opus exigit,
Israel lutum colligit.
Non est qui eum eruat,
Vel Pharaonis subruat
Equos cum ascensoribus.

Spargit Assur ac dejicit
Lapides Sanctuarii.
Quare? quia non objicit
Se lapis adjutorii.
Imo qui se objicere
Deherent et effundere

liberated? Abraham, father of many people, arise, lord, expel the son of Agar, the waiting-maid of her mistress Sarah; for after she shall deceive the other. Now the gates of Tartarus prevail against the Church: now Isaac and Ismael play at an unequal game.

Balthasar drinks again out of the vessels of the Lord's temple: the vessel of iniquities carries away the vessels dedicated to God's name. I perceive the hand, writing, and involved in the written letters, "Mane, Techel, Phares;" what this thing may mean, the event of the thing will prove. Now it appears in the court, both to the low and the high, that at present the division and end of the kingdom is at the gate. The mass of evils increases; the priest is as the people; they, bold and fearless, hasten to that which is unlawful, each according to his will.

The people serves in the coffer of Egypt, and anxiously sweats under the rule of Pharaoh: various edicts fly about: the collector exacts the

Debetent, et errant
Sanguinem pro iustitia,
Tractant de avaritia,
Quos his noto apicibus.

Si præsuli Bathoniæ
Fiat quandoque quæstio,
Quot marcæ bursæ regiæ
Accedant in scaccario:
Respondet voce libera,
Mille, centum, et cætera,
Ad bursam regis colligo,
Doctus in hoc decalogo,
Cæcus in forma canonis.

Tu, Norwicensis bestia,
Audi quid dicat veritas:
Qui non intrat per ostia
Fur est. An de hoc dubitas?
Heu! cecidisti gravius
Quam Cato quondam tertius:
Cum præsumpta electio
Justo ruat iudicio,
Empta per dolum Simonis.

Wintoniensis armiger
Præsidet ad Scaccarium,
Ad computandum impiger,
Piger ad Evangelium,
Regis revolvens rotulum;
Sic lucrum Lucam superat,
Marco marcam præponderat,
Et libræ librum subjicit.
Hi Belphegor prænunciant,
Et sedem Baal subjiciunt;
Ut melius proficiant,
Baal sibi præficiunt,
Complectuntur pro niveis

about. the collector exacts the
work, Israel collects clay.
There is no one who may
rescue him, or who may
overwhelm the horses of
Pharaoh with their riders.
Assur scatters and overthrows
the stones of the Sanctuary.
Why? because the Stone of
Help does not oppose itself.
Nay, they who ought to
oppose, and to shed their
blood for justice's sake, are
occupied with avarice, whom
I signalise by these marks.

If the question were
perchance asked of the bishop
of Bath, "How many marks
come in to the King's purse in
the Exchequer?" he would
answer readily, "A thousand, a
hundred, and so on, I collect
into the King's purse,"
learned as he is in this
decalogue, blind in the form
of the canon. Thou, beast of
Norwich! hear what the Truth
saith: "He who enters not by
the door is a thief." Dost thou
doubt of this? Alas! thou hast
fallen more heavily than once
the third Cato, since thy
presumed election falls by
just judgment, having been
bought by the craft of Simon.

Nigra, stercus pro croceis.
Hi tres insatiabiles,
Sanguisugis persimiles,
 “Affer,” dicunt, “non sufficit.”

Tres tribus his appositi
 Sunt, sed longe dissimiles,
Virtutum flore præditi,
 Morum vigore nobiles,
Noe, David, et Daniel,
Quos depingit Ezechiel.
Justitiam hi sitiunt,
Ob hæc sese objiciunt
 Murum pro domo Domini.
Joannes nostri temporis
 Surgit Decanus Angliæ,
Canus mente, vi roboris
 Stratam vadit justiciæ,
Canit laudum præconia
Qui jure de Ecclesia
Mariæ nomen accipit,
Dum conflictum hunc suscipit
 Sacrae devotus Virgini.

Heliensis progreditur,
 Huic datur discrimini,
Heli ut *ensis* dicitur,
 Parcens paucis, vel nemini.
Helia, ensem exere,
Et impios tres contere,
Ac Babylonis principem
Hujus doli participem
 Ictu prosterne simplici.
Tu, Wolstani subambule,
 Es in conflictu tertius,
Robustus insta sedit

The arm-bearer of
Winchester presides at the
Exchequer, diligent in
computing, sluggish at the
Gospel, turning over the
King’s roll; thus lucre
overcomes Luke; he makes a
marc weigh heavier than
Mark, and subjects the bible
to the scales. These are they
who fore-show Belphegor;
they subject the seat to Baal;
that they may profit better,
they make Baal their lord;
they embrace black for white,
dung instead of saffron. These
three are insatiable—very like
unto leeches; they cry, “Give!
there is not enough!”

There are three opposed to
these, but very unlike them,
endowed with the flower of
virtues, noble in the vigour of
good-breeding—Noah, David,
and Daniel, whom Ezechiel
paints. These thirst after
justice; for this they oppose
themselves as a wall for
God’s house. John arises the
dean of England of our time,
hoary in mind: with the might
of oak, he proceeds on the
way of justice; he sings the
proclamations of praises, who
rightly takes his name from

Triumphū verī conscius.
Hæres Wolstani diceris,
Si vere sit, tu videris:
Prius resigna baculum,
Et ephod et annulum,
Quam Baal velis subjici.

De Roffensi episcopo
Nil scio mali dicere.
Mentior et rem syncopo:
Hic est, et hic a latere
Est pauper Sarisburiaë,
Qui dormit usque hodie,
Ignem et aquam bajulat,
Nec causatur, nec ejulat
Pro desolata vinea.
I Romam, liber parvule,
Nec remeare differas,
Saluta quosque sedule,
Et Papæ salve differas.
Dic quid de tribus sentiam.
Ipse promat sententiam,
Utrum suo iudicio
Sint liberi a vitio;
Et michi detur venia.

the church of Mary, while he undertakes this conflict in devotion to the Holy Virgin.

He of Ely advances; he is given to this battle, as he is called the Sword of Hely, sparing few or none. Helias, draw forth the sword, and bruise the three impious ones, and lay prostrate the prince of Babylon, the participater in this plot, with a single blow. Thou, who walkest in the place of Wolstan, art the third in the conflict: robust as thou art, press on sedulously, certain of a true triumph. Thou art called the heir of Wolstan; if thou be truly so, thou art seen: sooner resign the staff, and the ephod, and the ring, than be willing to bow to Baal.

I know nothing ill to say of the bishop of Rochester. I lie, and cut the matter short; he is here, and here by his side the poor man of Salisbury also, who sleeps till to-day; he carries about fire and water, nor pleads for, nor bewails, the desolated vineyard. Go to Rome, little book, nor delay thy return; salute them all diligently and carry on

urgently, and carry a
salutation to the Pope: tell
what I think of the three: let
him give judgment, whether
in his opinion they be free
from vice; and let pardon be
granted to me.

It was during these religious dissensions that arose up, or at least became strong, that powerful spirit of opposition to the papal tyranny, which produced during the whole of this century so much satirical poetry; much of it attributed, perhaps with little reason, to Walter Mapes. The following song is supposed to have been written during the interdict. In the fourth line the lion is said to designate King John, and the asses the Bishops, and at the end the King is represented by Jupiter, whilst the Pope receives the contemptuous designation of Pluto.

SONG ON THE TIMES.

[MS. Harl. 978, fol. 108, r^o. Reign of Hen. III.]

Invectio contra avaritiam.

Utar contra vitia carmine rebelli;
Mel proponunt alii, fel supponunt melli,
Pectus subest ferreum deauratæ pelli,
Et leonis spoliū induunt aselli.

Disputat cum animo facies rebellis,
Mel ab ore defluit, mens est plena fellis;
Non est totum melleum quod est instar
mellis;

Facies est alia pectoris quam pellis.

Vitium est in opere, virtus est in ore,
Picem tegunt animi niveo colore:
Membra dolent singula capitis dolore,
Et radici consonat pomum in sapore.

Roma mundi caput est, sed nil capit
mundum:
Quod pendet a capite totum est
inmundum;
Transit enim vitium primum in
secundum,
Et de fundo redolet quod est iuxta
fundum.

Roma capit singulos et res singulorum;
Romanorum curia non est nisi forum.
Ibi sunt venalia jura senatorum,
Et solvit contraria copia nummorum.

Hic in consistorio si quis causam regat
Suam, vel alterius, hoc in primis legat,—
Nisi det pecuniam Roma totum negat,
Qui plus dat pecuniæ melius allegat.

Romani capitulum habent in decretis,
Ut petentes audiant manibus repletis:
Dabis, aut non dabitur, petunt quia petis;
Qua mensura seminas, et eadem metis.

Munus et petitio currunt passu pari,
Opereris munere si vis operari:

TRANSLATION.—I will use against
vices rebelling song; others put forward
honey, while under the honey they lay
on gall; the iron breast is concealed
under the gilt skin, and asses put on the
lion's spoil.—The rebelling face
disputes with the soul within; honey
flows from the mouth, the mind is full
of gall; it is not all sweet that looks like
honey; the breast has a different
countenance from the skin.—While vice
is in the work, virtue is in the face; they
cover the pitchy blackness of the mind
with a white colour; each of the
members suffers by the pain of the head,
and the flavour of the apple depends
upon the root from whence it springs.—
Rome is the head of the world; but it
receives nothing clean; all that depends
from the head is unclean; for the first
vice passes on into the second, and that
which is near the bottom smells of the
bottom.—Rome receives all, and the
goods of all; the court of the Romans is
but a market. There are offered for sale
the rights of the senators, and
abundance of money dissolves all
differences of opinion.—Here, in the
consistory, if any body plead a cause, be
it his own or another's, let him first read
this,—“Unless he give money, Rome
denies every thing; he who gives most
money will come off the best.”—The
Romans have a chapter in the decretals,
that they should listen to petitions from
those who come with their hands full;
thou shalt give, or nothing shall be
granted thee; they ask because thou
askest; by the same measure as you sow,
you shall reap.—A bribe and a petition
go side by side, and it is with a bribe
that you must work if you wish to
succeed: then you need have no fear,
even of Tully, were he pleading against
you; for money possesses a singular
eloquence.—There is nobody in this
court who does not look after money:
the cross on the coin pleases them; the

Tullium ne timeas si velit causari,
Nummus eloquentia gaudet singulari.

Nummis in hac curia non est qui non
vacet;

Crux placet, rotunditas, et albedo placet,
Et cum totum placeat, et Romanis placet,
Ubi nummus loquitur, et lex omnis tacet.

Si quo grandi munere bene pascas
manum,

Frustra quis objiciet vel Justinianum,
Vel sanctorum canones, quia tanquam
vanum

Transferunt has paleas, et inbursant
granum.

Solam avaritiam Roma novit parca,
Parcit danti munera, parco non est parca:
Nummus est pro numine, et pro Marco
marca,

Et est minus celebris ara, quam sit arca.

Cum ad papam veneris, habe pro
constanti,

Non est locus pauperi, soli favet danti;
Vel si munus præstitum non est aliquanti,
Respondet hic tibi sic, Non est michi
tanti.

Papa, si rem tangimus, nomen habet a
re,

Quicquid habent alii, solus vult papare;
Vel si verbum Gallicum vis apocopare,—
Paez, Paez, dit li mot, si vis impetrare.

Papa quærit, chartula quærit, bulla
quærit,

Porta quærit, cardinalis quærit, cursor
quærit,

Omnes quærunt: et si quod des uni deerit,
Totum jus falsum est, tota causa perit.

the cross on the coin pleases them, the roundness of it, and the whiteness thereof, pleases them; and since every part of it pleases, and it is the Romans whom it pleases, where money speaks, there all law is silent.—If you only feed the hand well with some goodly bribe, it will be in vain even to quote Justinian against you, or the canons of the saints, because they would throw them away as vanity and chaff, and pocket the grain.—Penurious Rome claims acquaintance with nothing but avarice; she spares to him who brings gifts, but she spares not to him who is penurious: money stands in the place of God, and a marc for Mark, and the altar is less attended than the coffer.—When you come to the Pope, take it as a rule, that there is no place for the poor, he favours only the giver; or if there is not a bribe of some value or another forthcoming, he answers you, “I am not able.”—The Pope, if we come to the truth of the matter, has his name from the fact, that, whatever others have, he alone will suck the pap; or if you like to apocopate a French word, “pay, pay,” saith the word, if you wish to obtain anything.—The Pope begs, the brief begs, the bull begs, the gate begs, the cardinal begs, the cursor begs,—all beg! and if you have not wherewith to bribe them all, your right is wrong, and the whole cause comes to nothing.—You give to these, you give to the others, you add gifts to those already given, and when you should have given enough, they seek as much more. O, you full purses, come to Rome! at Rome there is choice medicine for costive pockets.—They all prey upon the purse by little and little; great, greater, or greatest, gradually becomes a prey to them. Why should I go through all the particulars? I will put it in a few words; they all choke the purse, and it expires immediately.—Yet the purse imitates the liver of Tityus; the substance flies in order to return: dies

Das istis, das aliis, addis dona datis,
Et cum satis dederis, quærunt ultra satis.
O vos bursæ turgidæ, Romam veniatis;
Romæ viget physica bursis constipatis.
Prædantur marsupium singuli
paulatim;
Magna, major, maxima, præda fit
gradatim.
Quid irem per singula? colligam
summatim,—
Omnes bursam strangulant, et expirat
statim.

Bursa tamen Tityi jecur imitatur,
Fugit res, ut redeat, perit, ut nascatur,
Et hoc pacto loculum Roma deprædatur,
Ut cum totum dederit, totus impleatur.

Redeunt a curia capite cornuto:
Ima tenet Jupiter, cœlum tenet Pluto,
Et accedit dignitas animali bruto,
Tanquam gemma stercore et pictura luto.

Divites divitibus dant, ut sumant ibi,
Et occurrunt munera relative sibi:
Lex est ista celebris, quam fecerunt
scribi,
Si tu michi dederis, ego dabo tibi. *Finit.*

substance lies in order to return, dies that it may be born: and on this condition Rome preys upon the pocket, that when it has given all, it may all be filled again.—They return from the court with mitred heads; Jupiter is placed in the Infernal Regions, Pluto holds Heaven, and dignity is given to a brute animal, as a jewel to the dung and a picture to the mud.—The rich give to the rich, that they may receive again, and gifts mutually meet one another: that law is most in use, which they have caused to be written, “If you give to me, I will give to you.”

KING HENRY III. 1216–1272.

The death of King John offered an opportunity of putting an end to the distractions that had become so universal during the latter years of his reign, which most of the belligerents were glad to

embrace. The following short, but highly spirited poem, was probably written immediately after the pacification which followed the taking of Lincoln, apparently by a churchman, and certainly a partizan of King Henry. Some of the expressions in it, such as “the iron-girt bees of war,” and the like, remind us of the lofty metaphors of Saxon verse.

THE TAKING OF LINCOLN.

[From MS. Cotton. Vespas. B. XIII. fol. 130, v^o. in a hand of the beginning of the 14th Cent.]

¶ *Incipiunt versus de Guerra Regis
Johannis.*

Serpserat Angligenam rabies quadrangula
gentem.

In proprium jurata jugum, motuque
minaci

Gens sibi degenerans, ut libera serviat,
alta

Corruat, incolumis ægrotet, tuta pavescat,
Vendicat antiquas inimico consule leges;

Non legis libra, non juris luce, nec igne

Sacri consilii, sed nec lima rationis,

Fulgurat in vetitum sprete ratione
voluntas.

¶ Prima fuit rabies proprio concepta
tumore;

Altera belligeras Francorum traxerat alas;

Conduxit nigras Scottorum tertia turmas;

Flexit quarta leves tenui sub veste
Galenses.

¶ Fœdera rumpuntur pacis, tonitrusque
minaces;

Serpserat in attonitas corrupta licentia
turre,

In quibus ægra fides latuit, medicumque
salutis

Expectata diu, tandem de munere Christi

Convaluit, traxitque suas in bella
cohortes.

¶ Hæc rabies patiente Deo permissa
parumper

Non concessa fuit, ut molles fulmina
mentes

Comburant, nec ut ira Dei confundat
inermes

TRANSLATION.—A four-fold rage had crept upon the English nation. Conspiring against its own government, and threatening rebellion, the degenerate nation,—that it may change freedom for slavery,—that it may fall from its high position, from health to sickness, from safety to danger,—lays claim to ancient laws under a hostile governor; not governed by the balance of the law, not by the light of justice, nor by the fire of holy counsel, nor yet by the file of reason, the will, in despite of reason, darts like lightning into what is forbidden. ¶ The first rage was conceived by its own pride; the second drew hither the warlike legions of the French; the third conducted the black troops of the Scots; the fourth bent the inconstant Welsh under their light garment. ¶ The leagues of peace are broken, and the threatening thunders follow; corrupt licence has crept into the astonished towers, in which Faith lay hid and sick, and long waiting a physician of health, at length by the generosity of Christ she recovered, and drew out her bands to the wars. ¶ This rage, by the sufferance of God, was permitted for a while, but not allowed that the lightnings should burn the effeminate minds, or that the anger of God should confound the defenceless. But the Searcher of hearts recalled by his own love the sheep which sought the desert and were long wandering, that he might correct the deserving faults with a healing lash, and reconciling his divine threats with paternal mercy, softened the corrections of a father with the love of a mother. ¶ The honour of the English bowed, and the comeliness of the Kingdom; its bending head had felt the anger of the divine judge, and feared to serve the proud tyrant. The balanced

memmes.

Sed cordis scrutator oves deserta petentes
Errantesque diu proprio revocavit amore,
Vapulet ut meritas medicato verbere
culpas,

Divinasque minas clementia patris
amicans

Ubere materno lenivit verbera patris.

¶ Anglorum nutabat honor, regnique
venustas,

Inclinata caput divini judicis iram
Senserat, et tumido timuit servire
tyranno.

Pendula palma, diu dubio protracta
favore,

Nunc risit Gallis, nunc risum contulit
Anglis,

Verius applaudens istis, fallacius illis.

¶ Non tulit ulterius regem regnare furentem
Vindicis ira Dei; cecidit percussus ab illo
Cujus templa, domos, combusserat igne
minaci.

A face fax oritur fati, flammæque
furorem

Dum furit in regem febris vindicta
fugavit.

Summus honos mors illa fuit, culmenque
decoris

Attulit, in nullo quod erat superatus ab
hoste,

Et tot erant hostes; victus victore
superno,

Invictusque suos hostes moriendo
momordit.

¶ Desinat ira tumens; discat servire potestas
Curvarique Deo, cui subdens colla

resurgat.

serve the proud tyrant. The balanced palm, long held out with dubious favour, now smiled on the French, now turned its smile to the English, applauding with more truth these latter, more deceitful to the others. ¶ The anger of an avenging God allowed no longer the furious king to reign; he fell, struck by him whose temples and houses he had burnt with threatening fire. From this torch arises the torch of fate, and the avenging fever, while it raged against the king, drove away the rage of the flame. That death was the highest honour, and was accompanied with the highest glory, that he was in nothing overcome by the enemy, amidst so many enemies; vanquished by the conqueror who is above, and unconquered, he bit his own enemies even in his death. ¶ Let proud anger cease; let power learn to serve and to bow to God, in submitting the neck to whom she elevates herself; in rising she falls: short is the power of man; and let it learn that the end approaches in a few days. ¶ The widowed state had mourned the death of John, and, fearing to bow the neck to a degenerate husband, the tear of the English calls up the strength of England; the heavier the grief, the nearer is its cure. ¶ Meanwhile had shone forth the minute spark of most small beauty, the royal offspring, sole hope of the torn Kingdom, a star, as it were, lit by God, it had divested itself of the cloud that obscured its father, shining forth a new light, and the candle of the child called back the stars which had been scared by the father's thunder. ¶ O precious piety of God! who masters things that are great, confounds those that are strong, raises such as are infirm, strikes ferocity with lightning, breaks the haughty, who himself having come a child out of the virgin's womb, thus took a child to nourish, gave it to the bosom of the Church, which the gentle parent receives in a mother's arms.

resurget,
 In surgendo cadet: brevis est humana
 potestas,
 Et brevibus discat finem properare
 diebus.
 ¶ Planxerat extinctum regio viduata
 Johannem,
 Degenerique timens sua subdere colla
 marito
 Invocat Angligenas Anglorum lacrima
 vires;
 Quo gravior dolor est, propior medicina
 doloris.
 ¶ Fulserat interea minimæ scintillula
 formæ,
 Regia progenies, laceri spes unica regni,
 Stella quasi succensa Deo, nubemque
 paternam
 Exuit, irradians nova lux, stellasque
 fugatas
 Fulmine de patrio pueri candela vocavit.
 ¶ O Pietas preciosa Dei! qui magna
 magistrat,
 Fortia confundit, infirma levat, feritates
 Fulminat, inflatos frangit, qui virginis
 alvo
 Parvulus egressus, parvum suscepit
 alendum,
 Ecclesiæque dedit gremio, quem matris
 in ulnas
 Blanda parens recipit, nato blandita
 parentis
 Obsequio, teneram capiti positura
 coronam.
 Consilium cœleste fuit, quod consona
 sacri
 Unio concilii regi parere puella

parent receives in a mother's arms,
 rendered gentle by the obedience now
 newly born, and about to place on its
 head a tender crown. It was heavenly
 ordinance, that the consonant union of
 holy counsel feared not to obey a boy
 king, and feared more to serve a tyrant.
 ¶ Sacred union matures the new king to
 lofty things; utility, and piety, and faith,
 swear together to concur with the fates,
 and to sign them all with the seal of the
 Cross; they had raised together the
 standard of the Cross and had ranged
 themselves round the new King, and the
 white cross decorating the bearers of the
 Cross fixed the unstable troops in the
 foundation of faith. ¶ O famous legation
 of a man! file of blessed council! star of
 right! mirror of reason! helmet of the
 worship of God! crested with the plume
 of care! England hath grasped her
 conquering swords by impulse of God;
 her castles pour forth for the common
 good the standard-bearing troops, fierce
 in war, and threatening the enemy. ¶
 What time the Earth had begun to
 bloom with new fruitfulness, and had
 spread out her fresh grass in locks,
 redolent of flowers had painted the
 young fleece of the fields, and, whilst
 the new verdure curled the renascent
 woods, recalled innumerable tongues of
 birds to the song; then the Gallic fury
 had resolved to join the English of the
 north, the band having conspired to pass
 through the midst of the English, having
 issued from their London, the army of
 Louis deserted the long shades, and the
 proud earls have the shame of going the
 way that is open to them, and they carry
 fierce aid to Mountsorrel; for as a
 greater victory attends it, so has the
 anger of God ordained that it should not
 undergo a greater ruin. But with more
 caution retires thence the nobility of
 earls, the flower of the faith, the royal
 strength, the shield of Chester, until
 with roaring tumult the rage of the
 others had passed the famous castle on

Unio consilii regi parere puero
Non timuit, timuitque magis servire
tyranno.

¶ Unio sacra novum maturat ad ardua
regem;

Utilitas, pietasque, fides, concurrere fatis
Conjurant, cunctos[que] crucis signare
sigillo;

Constiterant vexilla crucis, regemque
novellum

Ambierant, bajulosque crucis crux alba
decorans

Instabiles statuit fidei fundamine turmas.

¶ O famosa viri legatio, lima beati
Consilii, sidus recti, speculum rationis,
Gala dei cultor, curæ cristata galero!
Anglia victrices strinxit divinitus enses,
In commune bonum fundunt castella
catervas
Signiferas, belloque truces, hostique
minaces.

¶ Tempus erat quo terra novo pubescere
partu

Cœperat, et teneras in crines solverat
herbas,

Vellera pratorum redolens infantia florum
Pinxerat, et, renovas crispans coma
primula silvas,

Innumeras avium revocavit ad organa
linguas,

Gallica tum rabies aquilonis adhæserat
Anglis,

Conjurata manus medios transire per
Anglos,

Londoniis egressa suis, longasque
latebras

Deseruit, Ledæique cohærens comitesque

Others had passed the famous castle on the heights (Nottingham), and the bank of Trent, and the pride of long war had flown to the besieged citadel of the noble matron (Lincoln). ¶ Hither when the fates have turned the fierce troops with a murmuring noise, Fame flies, and calls the earls, and the Cestresian companions of the earls, and the shielded harvest of men increases. The royal standards glitter, and the conspiring bands follow, when clear faith at last draws out their faces, the bright signs of the Cross paint the excelling breasts of the youth, a common will strengthens their hearts; there was one sole hope of conquering; victory was already stamped on all their faces; and with a shout, ominous of good, they put forth their associated hands to the accordant battle. ¶ The sabbath was at hand in which the festival of the high God is performed, and the eve celebrates the triune honour of the deity; the sun was touching the earth with his first light, when the trumpet with its terrible song had given the flourish; the leaders move iron war; many were the standards you might see with tremulous flight above the nodding helms, many the shields changing their ensigns with various colours. The beauty of the sun shone upon the armed troops; the coward became feverish; the brave strengthened their hearts. When the constancy of war came to the astonished town, the youth encircled the walls with a fearful wreath, and seek new approaches; nor do the leaders immediately attack the city; a legation is sent in to summon the sacrilegious men to the league of peace. Yet no peace satisfied these fierce men; they utter insults, despise the messengers, and add threatening words. ¶ When the messengers bring back the angry message, the leaders order their bold followers to the attack; then the horror of war reared, the trumpets thundered, a

Deserunt Ludovica comites, comitesque
 superbos
 Concessa pudet ire via, Montique Sorello
 Subsidium feralē ferunt, nam quo magis
 illum
 Major palma colit, graviores ferre
 ruinas
 Præcavet ira Dei; sed cautior inde recessit
 Nobilitas comitum, fidei flos, regia
 virtus,
 Cestrensis clipeus, donec frendente
 tumultu
 Transierat rabies notum super ardua
 castrum,
 Trigintæque latus, longique superbia belli
 Fluxit ad obsessam matronæ nobilis
 arcem.
 ¶ Huc ubi fata feras fremitu flexere
 phalangas,
 Fama volat, comitesque vocat,
 comitumque sodales
 Cestrenses, crescitque seges clipeata
 virorum.
 Regia signa micant, et conjurata
 sequuntur
 Agmina, clara fides cum denique
 protrahit ora,
 Candida signa crucis juvenum præstantia
 pingunt
 Pectora, consolidat communis corda
 voluntas;
 Vincendi spes una fuit, victoria cunctas
 In facies præmissa patet, plausuque
 secundo
 Permittunt socias in consona prælia
 dextras.
 ¶ Instabat sabbatum, quo festa peracta

of war roared, the trumpets thundered, a
 fearful noise rose into the air, and in the
 resounding tumult the clouds might
 wonder at earthly thunders. They leap
 over the fosses, mount over the walls,
 break the gates, force the passages, and
 join battle. And they made way with
 their swords; a merited confusion strikes
 the sacrilegious men; the hives of Christ
 send forth the iron-girt bees of war, and
 with fearful stings they penetrate the
 hostile shirts, and cut the scaly textures
 of iron, and draw Sauls to the chains of
 Paul, and the holy conversion turned
 hares into lions. ¶ Here stood Moses in
 the Mount; here Josua had fixed the
 station of the sun; there the sling and
 stone of David overcome the great
 Goliath; the honour of Lincoln sees the
 venerable wonder; the rage of the sea
 sees the imperial trophy of God; the
 four-fold plague sees the standards rise
 again against it with conquering palm. It
 saw, and was astonished; and the pride
 of war felt that God fought for the boy;
 nor was it quiet by its own will, but it
 burst, and received the feet of peace on
 its neck. ¶ O famous day, to be
 venerated through our age! in which the
 rage of war hid itself,—in which the
 peace-bringing sword subdued our
 pestiferous divisions,—in which the
 grace of Christ washed out the
 dishonour that had been brought forth,
 and, with the font of faith, cleansed
 from the averted brow the disgrace
 which had been inscribed on it.

¶ Instabat sabbatum quo testa peracta
superni
Flaminis, et trinum celebrat deitatis
honorem
Vespera; sol prima lambebat lampade
terras,
Cum tuba terribili dederat præludia
cantu;
Bella movent ferrata duces, tot signa
videres
Nutantes tremulo galeas superare volatu,
Tot clipeos vario mutantes signa colore.
Fulsit in armatas solaris gratia turmas,
Febricitabat iners, validabant corda
feroces.
Venit ut attonitam constantia Martis ad
urbem,
Terribili juvenes muros cinxere corona,
Rimanturque novos aditus; nec protinus
urbem
Invasere duces; legatio mittitur intus
Sacrilegos revocare viros ad fœdera
pacis.
Nec placuit pax ulla feris, convitia
fundunt,
Legatos spernunt, adduntque minacia
verba.
¶ Irrita legati postquam mandata reportant,
Magnanimos monet ire duces; tum
bellicus horror
Infremuit, tonuere tubæ, mugitus in auras
Horridus insurgit, et, constrepitante
tumultu,
Mirari poterant terrena tonitrua nubes.
Transiliunt fossas, transcendunt mœnia,
portas
Confringunt aditus, rumpunt, et prælia

Coniungunt, autus rumpunt, et præna
miscent.

Et gladiis fecere viam; confusio digna
Sacrilegos sternit, fundunt examina
Christi

Ferrigeras Mavortis apes, stimulisque
timendis

Hostiles penetrant tunicas, squamosaque
ferri

Texta secant, Saulosque trahunt ad
vincula Pauli,

Reddidit et lepores conversio sacra
leones.

¶ Hic Moyses in Monte stetit, Josue
stationem

Fixerat hic solis, magnum premit inde
Goliam

Funda lapisque David; vidit venerabile
mirum

Lincolniensis honor, vidit maris ira
trophæum

Imperiale Dei, vidit quadrangula pestis

In se victrici vexilla resurgere palma.

Vidit, et obstupuit, sensitque superbia
belli

Pro puero pugnare Deum; nec sponte
quievit,

Sed crepuit, pacisque pedes in colla
recepit.

¶ O famosa dies, nostrum veneranda per
ævum!

Bellica qua rabies latuit, qua pacifer ensis
Pestiferas domuit partes, qua gratia
Christi

Dedecus extersit natum, fideique lavacro
Proluit inscriptum versa de fronte
audacem

puddorem.

*Expliciunt versus de Guerra regis
Johannis.*

All authorities agree in describing the great pride and avarice and luxury of the nobles in general, but particularly of the Romish prelates, at the beginning of the thirteenth century. The following song is a fair specimen of the unsparing satire which was universally directed against them by their contemporaries.

SONG ON THE CORRUPTIONS OF THE TIME.

[MS. Harl. No. 978. fol. 105, v^o. reign of Hen. III.]

Contra avaros.

Quam sit lata scelerum et quam longa
tela
Sub qua latent pectora vitiis anhela,
Musa vultu lugubri refer et revela,
Si curas cor spectantis tetigisse querela.
Pensant vota miseræ gentis et
prophanæ
Non virtutis pretium, set lini vel lanæ;
Vespere quod agitur est infectum mane,
O curas hominum, o quantum est [in]
rebus inane!
Est ad jura quilibet oculus obtusus;
Omnis ad injurias animus diffusus;
Ad fortunæ prodeunt aleas et usus
Mille hominum spes et rerum discolor
usus.
Cum Sabinæ conferant saltum
meretrici,
Pauperizent Arabes sub toga mendici,
Suo neget Tydeus fidem Polynici,
Spectatum admissi, risum teneatis, amici?
Singulos per singula si nosse labores,
Qui cultores otii, qui doli structores,
Qui ministri Mammonæ, qui Dei
spretores,
Ætatis cujusque notandi sunt mores.
Puer pede certior, odit fores, foras
Fugit, minus minimis colit res, honoras,
Et iram post gaudia, breves rumpens
moras,
Colligit et ponit, temere mutatur in horas.
A custode juvenis evolat et seris,
Gaudet equis, canibus, aleis, et meris,
Venator libidinis, aucupator mulieris

TRANSLATION.—How wide and how long is the web of crimes with which our breasts, choked with vices, are enveloped, tell, and reveal, O muse, with a mournful countenance, if you care to touch the heart of the spectator with your lament.—The wretched and profane people seem to form their wishes in consideration, not of the price of virtue, but of flax or wool: what is done in the evening is unwrought in the morning. O cares of men! O how much emptiness there is in things!—Every eye is blind to justice; every mind is large to injustice; a thousand hopes of men and the differing aspects of things depend on the dice and uses of fortune.—When chaste maidens join in dance with the strumpet, when the Arabs play the pauper under the robe of a beggar, when Tydeus denies his faith to his Polynices, then, if you are admitted to the spectacle, my friends, can you restrain your laughter?—If you are anxious to know all men by their several failings, who practise sloth, who are the plotters of treason, who the servants of Mammon, who the despisers of God, we must observe the manners of every age of life.—The boy, as he learns the use of feet, hates the doors, flies abroad; he respects things and honours less than the least; anger and joy succeed each other with short intervals, for his changes are sudden.—The youth flies from his tutor and confinement; he delights in horses, dogs, dice, and wine, a hunter of his pleasures, whose occupation is with women, a slow provider of useful things, prodigal of money.—When arrived at manhood, that he may rule the citizens and dictate to the prætor, that he may extend his possessions with a longer cable, and fill his bags with greater treasure, he seeks riches and

venator invidius, auceps muneris,
Utilium tardus provisor, prodigus æris.

Vir ut præsit civibus, imperet prætori,
Ut extendat prædia fune longiori,
Et impregnet scrinia censu pleniori;
Quærit opes et amicitias, inservit honori.

Multa circumveniunt senem casus duri,
Vel quod eget, abstinens, census perituri,
Vel quod tractat gelide res, ut prosint furi,
Dilator, spe longus, iners, avidusque futuri.

Sic ætates variat temporum respectus,
Transit ætas tenera cordis in affectus,
Vir in alta, sed ei quem torquet senectus,
Fervet avaritia miseraque cupidine pectus.

Omnis ad hoc hominum animus
senescit,
Qui dum quærit extra se res, quærens se
nescit,
Non rebus crescentibus ambitus quiescit;
Crescit amor nummi quantum ipsa
pecunia crescit.

Sed hoc uno veniam vitium meretur,
Quod cum rerum dominis semper
dominetur;
Tanto mens conspectius quæ nil reveretur
Crimen habet, quanto qui peccat major
habetur.

Roma, turpitudinis jacens in profundis,
Virtutes præposterat opibus inmundis,
Vacillantis animi fluctuans sub undis,
Diruit, ædificat, mutat quadrata rotundis.

Vultus blandos asperat, quibus nunc
arrisit;
Sinu foveat placido quos prius elisit;
Dum monetam recipit, tractat, et periclitatur

greater treasure, he seeks riches and friendships, and is a slave to honours.—Many serious troubles surround the old man, either that, from stinginess, he spares his perishing wealth, or that he handles his riches with fear, lest they should fall to the thief; he is one who delays long, depending on hope, inactive, and greedy of the future.—Thus difference of time causes variety of ages; the tender age is occupied on the affections of the heart, the man on lofty things, but he whom old age bends, his breast glows with avarice and miserable cupidity.—In this respect the whole mind of men grows old, which, while it seeks things external, is ignorant of itself in the pursuit; ambition is not quieted by success: the love of money increases as fast as the money itself increases.—But in this point alone may vice claim some credit, that it is always prevalent among the great; yet that disposition which respects no control is the more conspicuously criminal, in proportion as the sinner occupies a higher station.—Rome, lying in the depths of turpitude, ranks virtues beneath filthy lucre; fluctuating under the waves of a vacillating mind, she overthrows, builds, and changes square things for round.—She despises the bland countenances at which but now she smiled; she cherishes in her placid breast those whom before she rolled down; while she receives money, she treats and revises: what she sought she despises, and seeks again what lately she let go.—If she does not perceive rightly a thing in any manner whatever, and has not forgotten the custom which she first learnt, she smells of the custom of the cask, which will keep very long the odour with which it was once endued while fresh.—Before the cardinals and before the patriarch, a pound overcomes the Bible, money the accused, and a marc Mark, the law sparing to him who is not sparing, gives

Dum monetam recipit, tractat, et revisit,
Quod petiit, spernit, repetit quod nuper
omisit.

Si non recte percipit quocumque modo
rem,

Et quem primo didicit non oblita morem,
Morem testæ redolet, quæ diutiorem
Quo semel est inbuta recens servabit
odorem.

Coram cardinalibus, coram patriarcha,
Libra libros, reos res, Marcum vincit
marca,

Tantumque dat gratiæ lex non parco
parca,

Quantum quisque sua nummorum servat
in arca.

Si stateram iudicum quæris, quæras
ære,

Cum ab ære pendeat gratia stateræ;
Non quæras inducias, sed quod quærunt
quære,

Unde habeas quærit nemo, sed oportet
habere.

Commissus notario munera suffunde;
Statim causæ subtrahet, quando, cur, et
unde,

Et formæ subjiciet canones rotundæ,
Quem res plus nimio delectavere
secundæ.

Roma cunctos erudit ut ad opus
transvolent,

Plus quam Deo Mammonæ cor et manus
inmolent,

Sic nimirum palmites mala stirpe
redolent,

Cui caput infirmum cetera membra
dolent

sparring to him who is not sparing, gives only as much grace as each has money in his purse.—If you seek the balance of the judges, you should seek it with copper, since the favour of the balance hangs from copper; you should not ask respite, but ask what they ask; whence you obtain it nobody will inquire, but you needs must have it.—When you are turned over to the notary, pour out your bribes; he will at once extricate you from your cause, when, why, or whence it may arise, and will subject the canons to the form that is round (i. e. the coin), whom prosperity delights not a little.—Rome teaches all that they should fly over to expediency, that they should offer heart and hand to Mammon rather than to God; thus it happens that the branches smell of a bad root; where the head is infirm, the other members are in pain.—The archbishops tread under foot the necks of the clergy, and extort tears in order that they may be dried by gifts; nor, if the poor wretches bring few or not good ones, do they take them in good part, or acknowledge them with favour.—If any one begins to complain of an injury, they immediately stretch their ear to the cause, their hand to the gift; if they once receive a thing of the plural number, to-morrow the same basenesses may be done as yesterday.—The bishop loves a cheerful giver, and dares either right or wrong after the smell of a bribe, unable to resume, after he has thrown shame aside, the blush once rejected from his worn brow.—Nor is there less baseness in the archdeacon; whom he has once taken up, whether in earnest or in joke, he holds; nor has he mercy for the needy or the naked; the leech which will not let go the skin till he is filled with blood.—The dean, born to everlasting wiles, that he may explore the creed (symbolum) and the things which succeed, changing the tune of his tongue and yesterday's garments, migrates with humble speech to the

uolent.
 Calcant archipræsules colla cleri
 prona,
 Et extorquent lacrimas ut emungant dona;
 Nec, si ferunt miseri pauca, vel non bona,
 Æquis accipient animis, donantve corona.
 Si de contumelia cæperit quis
 conqueri,
 Statim causæ porrigunt aurem, manum
 muneri;
 Si semel acceperint rem pluralis numeri,
 Cras poterunt fieri turpia sicut heri.
 Diligit episcopus hilarem datorem,
 Fas et nefas ausus post muneris odorem,
 Nescius resumere, post lapsum pudorem,
 Ejectum semel attrita de fronte ruborem.
 Nec archidiacono minor turpitudine,
 Quem semel arripuit serio vel ludo
 Tenet, nec misertus est inopi vel nudo;
 Non missura cutem nisi plena cruoris
 hirudo.
 Decanus insidias natus ad æternas,
 Ut exploret symbolum et res subalternas,
 Mutans linguæ modulum et vestes
 hesternas,
 Migrat in obscuras humili sermone
 tabernas.
 Presbiter quæ mortui quæ dant vivi,
 quæque
 Refert ad focariam, cui dat sua seque;
 Ille sacri nominis, ille mentis æquæ,
 Legem qui Domini meditatur nocte
 dieque.
 Fulti verbis laici cleri delinquentis,
 Non tam verbis inhiant quam famæ
 docentis:
 Nec consuecis flectere minis aut

migrates with humble speech to the
 obscure taverns.—The priest, whatever
 either the dead or the living give, carries
 all to his fireside-woman, to whom he
 gives himself and what he has; he of the
 holy name and the equal mind, who
 meditates the law of the Lord by day
 and by night.—The laymen resting on
 the words of the clergy who depart from
 them, pay less attention to the words
 than to the character of the teacher: nor
 can laws subdue the senses of men by
 threats and torments, so much as the
 example of the ruler.—The luxurious
 princes stir kingdoms and states, that
 they may lead armies, inflicting the
 punishment of a tax on the rustic and the
 miserable citizen; for whenever the
 kings run wild, the Greeks pay the piper.
 —They who are occupied with the cares
 of the kingdom or of the court, detract
 while they smile, and when they flatter
 they are plotting damage or disgrace;
 there is neither faith nor honesty in
 those who follow camps.—If a citizen
 perceive you, he caresses that he may
 burn you; if you lay down ten, he puts
 the payment of his stake to another
 time; he cheats you out of your own;
 look to it, while it lasts; he may perish
 behind the wine and the dice, who
 leaves care till to-morrow.—If any one
 going to the houses of the lawyers,
 carries his money openly, he also is a
 simpleton; for when he sleeps in his bed
 weary and full, people live by rapine,
 the guest is not safe from his host.—
 Thus rapine, snares, treachery, and
 strife, lead people into error, misery, and
 folly; thus ambition and luxury, and the
 revered possession of riches, allure the
 foolish minds of all men.—But what
 availeth luxury and power to those
 miserable people who, despising virtues,
 esteem only things that produce evil,
 such as gold, gems, and heaps of
 wealth? when our labour is expended on
 what is injurious to us, the misery of
 mortals is on the increase. What avails

NEC SENSUS SIC NECELE MINIS AUT
tormentis

Humanos edicta valent, quam vita
regentis.

Regna movent principes statusque
lascivi,

Ut ducant exercitus, pœnam donativi

Infligentes rustico miseroque civi;

Quicquid delirant reges plectuntur
Achivi.

Qui regni vel curiæ curis accinguntur,
Dum arrident detrahunt, et dum
blandiuntur

Jacturam vel dedecus semper moliuntur;

Nulla fides pietasve viris qui castra
sequuntur.

Si te civis percipit, demollit ut urat,
Si dena contuleris mutuum futurat,
Te de tuo submovet, percipe, dum durat;
Pone merum et talos pereat, qui crastina
curat.

Si quis ad forensium domos devolutus
Censum palam deferat, et minus astutus,
Nam cum cubans dormiet fessus et
imbutus,

Vivitur ex rapto, non hospes ab hospite
tutus.

Sic raptus, insidiæ, dolus, et simultas
Reddunt gentes devias, miseras, et
stultas;

Sic inescant omnium mentes inconsultas
Ambitus, et luxus, et opum metuenda
facultas.

Sed quid confert miseris luxus aut
potestas

Qui spretis virtutibus colunt res funestas,

Aurum, gemmas, purpuream, et opes

MORTALS IS ON THE INCREASE.—What avails
it to talk of purple, gems, gold, land?
With riches we have feuds, losses, pleas,
fastings, fears, and justly sleepless cares
come in a long train.—The poor man
reigns more safely than he that amasses
wealth, who, while the informer
deprives the lord of his favour, or the
lurking spoiler spoils him who is laden,
he, an empty traveller, will sing before
the thief.—They who are destitute often
live more pleasantly under a slight hut
of brick or mud, than those who are
delicately clothed in the palaces of
kings; he will be ever a slave who
knows not how to use moderation.—But
if you seek abundance of true property,
reject superfluity, seek what is enough,
strip yourself of riches, and die naked;
delay not this, for those who are
prepared are ever injured by delay.—If
while you are on your road to what is
more useful, fear dissuade hope, or
delay endanger success; change not
your mind, nor slacken your reins; the
grateful hour will arrive when least
expected.—Treasure up that which you
cannot abuse, having a care of the
needy, the blind, the lame, and the
dumb; serve your soul, and not your
mind or your skin; you owe little to
pleasure, but more to your salvation.—
No one is safe on a king's throne, or in a
sanctuary, since it can be expressed
neither by tongue nor pen by how
slender a thread the destinies of men
hang under the imminent approach of
death.—While you navigate
prosperously the far side of the sea,
weigh not the present but the future, and
considering the poop more than the
prow or the oar, act as though you
thought every day your last.

Aurum, gemmas, purpuram, et opes
congestas?

Cum labor in dampno est, crescit mortalis
egestas.

Quid ad rem, de purpura, gemmis,
auro, rure?

Assunt cum divitiis odia, jacturæ,
Placita, jejunia, metus, et de jure
Insompnes longo veniunt ex agmine
curæ.

Regnat pauper tutius quam rerum
collator,

Qui, dum rapit domini gratiam delator,
Vel onustum spoliat prudens spoliator;
Cantabit vacuus coram latrone viator.

Sæpe vivunt gratius rebus destituti,
Sub exili tegete lateris aut luti,
Quam in regum domibus mollibus induti;
Serviet æternum qui parvo nesciet uti.

Sed si quæris copiam veræ facultatis,
Rejice superflua, cole quod est satis,
Exue divitias, nudus cede fati;
Tolle moram, nocuit semper differre
paratis.

Si dum iter arripis ad utiliora,
Spem metus dissuadeat, vel successus
mora,
Animum ne revoces, nec reflectas lora,
Grata superveniet quæ non sperabitur
hora.

Thesaurizes illud quo non potes abuti,
Curam gerens inopis, cæci, claudi, muti;
Animæ, non animo servias vel cuti,
Pauca voluptati debentur, plura saluti.

Nemo regis solio tutus, vel asylo,
Cum nec lingua nequeat exprimi vel stilo
Quam sub fato pendula vicinoque pile

Quam sub lato pendulo vicinoque pio,
Omina sunt hominum tenui pendentia
 filo.

 Prosperè dum navigas æquoris
 extremum,
Pensa non præsentia, sed futura demum,
Et puppim considerans, non proram vel
 remum,
Omnem crede diem tibi diluxisse
 supremum.

The foreign policy of Henry III. was even less manly than that of his father. Among the many songs of the Normans and Poitevins, reclaiming the assistance of their ancient sovereign, we may give as an example the *Sirvente* of Bernard de Rovenac, addressed to Henry and his contemporary James I. King of Aragon, from whom Louis IX. had taken Languedoc to give it as a portion to his brother Alphonsus. There is internal evidence that it was written about 1229, the year in which Henry III. made his ill-conducted expedition into Brittany.

A SIRVENTE AGAINST KING HENRY.

[Raynouard, *Choix*, tom. iv. p. 203.]

Ja no vuelh do ni esmenda
 Ni grat retener
 Dels ricx ab lur falz saber,
 Qu'en cor ay que los reprene
 Dels vils fatz mal yssemitz;
 E no vuelh sia grazitz
 Mos sirventes entr' els flacx nualhos,
 Paupres de cor et d' aver poderos.

Rey Engles prec que entenda,
 Quar fa dechazar
 Son pauc pretz per trop temer,
 Quar no'l play qu' els sieus defenda,
 Qu'ans es tan flacx e marritz
 Que par sia adurmitz,
 Qu'el reys frances li tolh en plas perdos
 Tors et Angieus e Normans e Bretos.

Rey d'Arago, ses contenda,
 Deu ben nom aver
 Jacme, quar trop vol jazer;
 E qui que sa terra s prenda,
 El es tan flacx e chausitz
 Que sol res no y contraditz;
 E car ven lay als Sarrazis fellos
 L'anta e'l dan que pren say vas Lymos.

Ja tró son payre car venda
 No pot trop valer,
 Ni s cug qu' ieu li diga plazer,
 Tró foc n'abraz e n'essenda
 E n' sian grans colps feritz;
 Pueys er de bon pretz complitz,
 S'al rey frances merma sos tenezos,
 Quar el sieu fieu vol heretar N Anfos.

TRANSLATION.—I wish neither for the gifts and favours—nor to obtain the good-will—of the rich, with their false wisdom;—but I have in my heart the intention to reproach them—with their vile deeds ill-conceived;—and I don't wish to be agreeable—my Sirventes among the cowardly idlers,—poor in heart and heavy in riches.

The English King, I pray him to hear it,—for he causes to fall—his little glory by too much timidity,—for it does not please him to defend his own people,—and thus he is so cowardly and so vile,—that he seems to be asleep,—while the French King takes from him with impunity—Tours, and Angiers, and Normans, and Bretons.

The King of Aragon, without any doubt,—ought really to have the name—of James; for he is too willing to lie down;—and whoever it be that takes his land,—he is so cowardly and caitiff,—that he does not even contradict it;—and he revenges on that side

Coms de Toloza, la renda
Que soletz tener
De Belcaire us deu dolar,
S'al deman faitz lonj' atenda
Vos e 'l reys que us es plevitz;
L'enprendemen n'er aunitz,
S'ar no vezem tendas e pabalhos,
E murs fondre, e cazer autas tors.

Ricx homes, mal yssernitz,
En vey hom vostres malz ditz,
E laissera us, s'ie us vis arditz ni pros,
Mas no us tem tan que ja m'en lays per
vos.

and he revenges on that side
against the felon Saracens
——the shame and damage
which he receives on this side
towards Limoux.

Until he have revenged his
father,—he cannot have much
esteem,—nor let him imagine
that I will speak to please
him,—unless he ravage and
put in flames,—and unless
great blows be struck.—For
there will have been
accomplished great honour,—
if he narrows the domains of
the French King,—for Don
Alfonse desires to inherit his
fief.

Earl of Toulouse, the rent—
which you used to hold—
from Beaucaire, you ought to
regret,—if you make long
delay to demand it,—you, and
that King, because you are in
league;—that undertaking
will not be disgraced,—if we
now see tents and pavilions,
—and walls fall and high
towers break.

Rich men, ill-advised,—
one sees your evil sayings,—I
would let you alone, if I saw
you hardy and courageous,—
but I do not fear you so much

as to leave it on your account.

The following Sirvente, by the same author, is also directed against Henry and James, and was written about the year 1250. It repeats the same articles of accusation, and its object was to persuade those kings to invade the dominions of Louis, while he was himself absent on his crusade.

A SIRVENTE AGAINST KING HENRY.

[Raynouard, tom. iv. p. 205.]

D'un sirventes m'es grans volontatz
 preza,
 Ricx homes flacx, e non sai que us disses,
 Quar ja lauzor no y auria ben meza,
 Ni us aus blasmar, e val pauc sirventes
 Que laza quan blasmar deuria;
 Pero si tot vos par folia,
 A me platz mais que us blasme dizen ver,
 Que si menten vos dizia plazer.

Amdos los reys an una cauz' empressa,
 Selh d'Arago et aisselh dels Engles,
 Que no sia per elhs terra defeza
 Ni fasson mal ad home qu'el lur fes,
 E fan merces e cortezia,
 Quar al rey que conquer Suria
 Laisson en patz lur fieus del tot tener;
 Nostre Senher lur en deu grat saber.

Vergonha m pren, quant una gens
 conquenza
 Nos ten aissi totz vencutz e conques,
 E degr' esser aitals vergonha prezza,
 Quom a me pren, al rey Aragones
 E al rey que pert Normandia,
 Mas prez an aital companhia
 Que ja nulh temps no fasson lur dever,
 Et anc non vitz autre tan ben tener.

E pus no pren en la leuda torneza
 Qu'a Monpeslier li tollon siey borzes,
 Ni no y s venja de l'anta que y a preza,
 Ja no 'lh sia mais retragz Carcasses,
 Pos als sieus eys no s defendria,
 Assatz fa sol qu'en patz estia;
 Patz non a ses senher ah gran noder

TRANSLATION.—I am seized by a great desire of writing a sirvente,—O rich yet cowardly men! and I know not what I shall say to you,—for there will be little room for praise;—nor dare I blame you, and a sirvente is worth little—which praises when it ought to blame:—but though it may seem all folly to you,—yet it pleases me more to blame you by telling the truth,—than if I spoke falsehood to please you.

Both the kings have resolved on one thing,—he of Aragon and he of the English,—that by them the land shall not be defended,—and that they will do ill to no one who does ill to them;—they are merciful and courteous;—for they let the King who is conquering Syria—retain their fiefs altogether in peace;—our Lord ought to be very thankful to them for it.

Shame seizes on me, when a vanquished people—holds us thus all subdued and conquered,—and such shame ought to seize—the King of Aragon, as seizes me,—and the King who loses Normandy,—but they take such company—that now they never perform their duty,—and I never saw another hold so well.

And afterwards he does not receive the tax,—which at Montpellier his burgesses take from him,—neither does he revenge himself of the disgrace he received there,—now Carcasson may no more be recovered by him;—for he would not defend his own eyes,—his only endeavour is that he may be in peace;—a noble lord with great power has no peace,—when he turns his ways to nonchalance.

To praise people too much, when valour is ill esteemed,—I do not call it peace, for it is bad war;—nor shall it now be understood by me for peace,—it ought rather to have the name of pages'

Patz non a ges semer ab gran poder,
Quan sas antas torna a non chaler.

Ges trop lauzar, quan valors es mal
meza,
Non apel patz, quar mala guerra es;
Ni ja per me non er per patz enteza,
Mielhs deuria aver nom gauch de pages,
E dels ricx que perdon tot dia
Pretz, e ja fort greu no lur sia,
Quar pauc perdon e pauc lur deu doler,
Quar ges de pauc non pot hom trop
mover.

Lo reys n Anfos a laissat cobezeza
Als autres reys, qu'a sos ops non vol ges,
Et a sa part elh a preza largueza,
Mal a partit qui reptar l'en volgues;
E dic vos que m par vilania
Qui partis e qui 'l mielhs s' atria,
Mas ges pertant non a fag non dever,
Quar a pres so qu'elhs no volon aver.

Ricx malastrucx, s'ieu vos sabia
Lauzor, volontiers la us diria;
Mas no us pessetz menten mi alezer,
Que vostre grat no vuelh ni vostr' aver.

play,—and of the rich who lose every day—honour, and yet it grieves them not much,—for they lose little and need not grieve much,—for we cannot be moved much by a little thing.

The king Don Alfonso has left covetousness—to the other kings, because he will not make use of it,—and he has taken for his share largess,—he has an ill share who wishes to recover this from him;—and I tell you that it appears to me villany,—when one shares and takes the best to himself;—yet no one has done otherwise than right,—when he has taken that which others will not have.

Rich men ill-advised, if I knew any thing in you—worthy of praise, I would willingly tell you of it;—but think not to take up my leisure,—for I desire neither your thanks nor your goods.

Henry's embarrassments at home were now becoming every day more numerous and more complicated. Scarcely any part of the nation, clergy, barons, or people, were any longer his friends. The following song (made in 1256) was evidently written by one belonging to the former of these classes, indignant at the taxes

which the King, with the consent of the Pope, had levied on the clergy, in the vain hope of placing one of his sons on the throne of Sicily, and afterwards to pay the debt which he had contracted towards the supreme pontiff. The King of France, quoted as an example, was the saintly Louis IX.

THE SONG OF THE CHURCH.

[MS. Cotton. Jul. D. vii. fol. 133, v^o. of 13th century.]

*Istud canticum factum fuit anno gratiæ m^occ^olvi^o supra
desolatione Ecclesiæ Anglicanæ.*

Or est acumpli à men acient
 La plainte Jeremie, ke oï avez suvent;
 ke dit cument set sule
 cité pleine de fule
 Plurant amerement,
 ore est sanz mariage
 e mis en tailage,
 La dame de la gent.
 Cest est seint eglise trestut apertement,
 Ke est ja hunie e tut mis a vent:
 E si est maumise, nus veum cument.
 Ele gent e plure,
 n'a ad nul ke sucure
 De sun marement.

Jà fu cleregie
 franche e à desus,
 Amée e cherie,
 nule ren pot plus.
 Ore est enservie,
 E trop envilie,
 e abatu jus;
 Par iceus est hunie,
 Dunt dut aver aïe;
 jo n'os dire plus.

Li rois ne l'apostoile ne pensent
 altrement,
 Mès coment au clers tolent lur or e lur
 argent.
 Co est tute la summe,
 ke la pape de Rume
 Al rei trop consent,
 pur aider sa curune
 la dime de clers li dune,
 De ce en fet sun talent

TRANSLATION.—Now is
 accomplished as I conceive—
 the plaint of Jeremiah, which
 you have often heard,—who
 tells how this sole—city full
 of people—bemoaning bitterly,
 —is now without marriage—
 and put in contribution,—the
 Lady of the people.—That is
 holy church very evidently,—
 who is now disgraced and all
 put to sale;—and truly is she
 in ill case, we see how.—She
 laments and weeps,—there is
 none who helps her—out of
 her desolation.

Formerly clergy was—free
 and uppermost,—loved and
 cherished,—nothing could be
 more so.—Now it is enslaved,
 —and too much debased,—
 and trodden down.—By those
 is it disgraced,—from whom
 it ought to have help;—I dare
 not say more.

The king and the pope
 think of nothing else,—but
 how they may take from the
 clergy their gold and their
 silver.—This is the whole
 affair,—that the pope of
 Rome—yields too much to
 the king,—to help his crown,
 the tenth of the clergy's

De ço en fet sun talent.

Jo ne quid pas ke li rois face sagement,
Ke il vit de roberie ke il de la clergie
 prent.

 Jà ne fra bone prise,
 pur rober seinte eglise;
Il la say verament.
 Ke vot aver semblance,
 regarde le rois de France
E sun achievement.

—the tenth of the clergy's
goods he gives him,—and
with that he does his will.

I do not think that the King
acts wisely,—that he lives of
robbery which he commits
upon the clergy.—He will
never be a gainer,—by
robbing holy church;—he
knows it truly.—He who
seeks an example,—let him
regard the King of France—
and his achievement.

The next Song, directed against the avarice of the Bishops,
appears to be of about the same date. In the manuscript it is written,
like the foregoing, as prose.

A SONG AGAINST THE BISHOPS.

[From the same folio of the same MS.]

Licet æger cum ægrotis,
Et ignotus cum ignotis,
Fungar tamen vice totis,
Jus usurpans sacerdotis;
 flete, Syon filiæ,
 præsides ecclesiæ
 imitantur hodie
Christum a remotis.

Jacet ordo clericalis
In respectu laicalis,
Sponsa Christi fit venalis,
Generosa generalis;
 veneunt altaria,
 venit eucharistia,
 cum sit nugatoria
Gratia venalis.

Donum Dei non donatur
Nisi gratis conferatur;
Quod qui vendit vel mercatur,
Lepra Syri vulneratur;
 quem sic ambit ambitus,
 ydolorum servitus
 templo sancti spiritus
Non compaginatur.

In diebus juventutis
Timent annos senectutis,
Ne fortuna destitutis
Desit eis splendor cutis.
 Sed dum quærunt medium,
 vertunt in contrarium,
 fallit enim vitium
Specie virtutis.

TRANSLATION.—Although
sick with those who are sick,
and unknown with those who
are unknown, yet I will
assume all characters in turn,
usurping the right of the
priest: weep, ye daughters of
Sion, the bishops of the
church at the present day are
but remote imitators of
Christ!

The clerical order is
debased in respect of the laity;
the spouse of Christ is made
venal,—she that is noble,
common; the altars are for
sale; the eucharist is for sale,
although venal grace is vain
and frivolous.

God's gift is not given if it
be not conferred gratis; and he
who sells and makes
merchandise of it, is, in so
doing, struck with the leprosy
of Syrus; the service of idols,
at which his ambition thus
aims, may not be engrafted on
the temple of the Holy Spirit.

In their days of youth, they
look forwards to old age with
fear, lest, deserted by fortune,
they possess no longer their
sleek skin But while they

Tu qui tenes hunc tenorem,
Frustra dicis te pastorem;
Nec te regis ut rectorem,
Rerum mersus in ardorem:

Hæc est alia
sanguisugæ filia,
quam venalis curia
Duxit in uxorem.

seek him. But while they
seek the mean, they turn into
the contrary extreme; for vice
deceives them in the guise of
virtue.

Thou who holdest this
course, vainly thou callest
thyself a pastor; neither dost
thou govern thyself like a
ruler, immersed in the heat of
temporary affairs; she is
another—daughter of the
leech, whom the venal court
has taken to wife.

The following is another bitter satire on the vices of the great, during the reign of Henry III. Who were the four brothers against whom the song is more particularly directed, would not be easily ascertained without other particulars besides those here furnished.

A SONG ON THE TIMES.

[MS. Harl. No. 978. fol. 123, v^o. of the 13th cent.]

Mundi libet vitia cunctis exarare;
 Nam in mundo video multos nunc errare,
 Spernere quod bonum est, quod malum
 est amare,
 Et ad mala sæpius sponte declinare.
 Mundus quia malus est, male scit
 nocere;
 Mala novit facere, nescit pœnitere;
 Caro quicquid appetit pro posse vult
 habere,
 Sed quod Deus præcipit nequit
 adimplere.
 Jam nil valet aliquis ni sciat litigare,
 Nisi sciat cautius causis cavillare,
 Nisi sciat simplices dolis impugnare,
 Nisi sciat plenius nummos adunare.
 Mundi status hodie multum variatur,
 Semper in deterius misere mutatur;
 Nam qui parcit nemini, quique plus
 lucratur,
 Ille plus dilectus est et plus
 commendatur.
 Rex et regni procures satis sunt amari;
 Omnes fere divites nimis sunt avari;
 Pauper pauca possidens debet depilari,
 Et ut ditet divitem rebus spoliari,
 Bona per superflua dives excæcatur;
 Circa temporalia tota mens versatur:
 Et in vanis quoniam nimis delectatur,
 Bona differt facere, malum non vitatur.
 Ex prælatis plurimum Deum non
 timentes
 Sunt sub boni specie mala facientes,
 Hiique plus quam laici sæpe sunt
 nocentes,

TRANSLATION.—Everybody has a right to satirize the world's vices; for now I see many in the world err, despise what is good, love what is bad, and most frequently turning off spontaneously to evil.—Because the world is depraved, it knows how to do injury; it knows how to act ill, but not how to repent; the flesh will do all it can to possess whatever it desires, but is unable to fulfill God's commandments.—Now nobody is esteemed unless he knows how to litigate; unless he can cavil cunningly in law-suits; unless he can overreach the simple; unless he know how to amass abundance of money.—The state of the world is at the present day constantly changing; it is always becoming miserably worse; for he who spares nobody, and who is bent most on gain, is most beloved and most commended.—The King and his nobles are sufficiently bitter; almost all the rich men are too avaricious; the poor man, who possesses little, must be robbed and spoiled of his property to enrich the wealthy.—The rich man is blinded by superfluous wealth; his whole mind is occupied with temporal matters; and, since he is too much pleased with vanities, he puts off the doing of good, but avoids not the evil.—Of the prelates, there are very many who, having no fear of God, do evil under the mask of good, and they often do more injury than the laymen; they take great care of the body, but feed ill the mind.—Now impiety reigns, piety is driven away, and noble liberality is sent into far exile; for narrow stinginess is the companion of many, and thus in many charity is become cold.—Right and wrong march nearly on an equal footing; there is now scarcely one who is ashamed of doing what is unlawful; the man is held dear who knows how to flatter, and he enjoys a singular privilege.—Lucre is a thing too much sought after; whoever has an

Bene curant corpora, male pascunt
mentes,

Regnat nunc impietas, pietas fugatur,
Nobilisque largitas procul relegatur;
Stricta nam tenacitas multos comitatur,
Et in multis caritas sic refrigeratur.

Fas et nefas ambulant pene casu pari,
Vix est jam quem pudeat nefas operari;
Carus hic acceptus est qui scit adulari,
Hicque privilegio gaudet singulari.

Quod ad lucrum pertinet nimis
affectatur;
Lucra quisquis prospicit, cautus
judicatur;

Res qui servat strictius, sapiens vocatur;
Sua qui dat largius, stultus reputatur.

Dolus avaritiæ comes copulatur;
Fidei perfidia jam parificatur;
Nam qui scit decipere, prudens
prædicatur;

Qui plus mali perpetrat plus appetiatur.

Quatuor sunt maxime qui sic
operantur,
Et cum malefecerint pejus meditantur,
Quorum infra scelera satis declarantur,
Et eorum nomina sic intitulantur.

Hii sunt fratres quatuor, Robertus, et
Ricardus,
Gilebertus postea, vir valde Wandelardus,
Quartus inter alios frater est bastardus,
Galfridus, qui piger est, et ad bona tardus.

Cuique satis proprie nomen adaptatur,
Per quod quæ proprietas cujusque sit
notatur;

Nam qui recte nominum vim
interpretatur,

too much sought after, whoever has an eye to it, is considered prudent; he who keeps very close what he has, is called a wise man; he who gives liberally, is set down for a fool.—Treachery accompanies avarice; perfidy is now put on equality with honesty; for he who knows how to deceive, is proclaimed a prudent man; and he who does most ill is most prized.—There are four persons in particular who work thus; who, even while doing ill, are meditating to do worse, whose crimes are sufficiently declared below, and whose names are as follows:—They are four brothers, Robert, and Richard; next Gilbert, a true Wandelard; the fourth is a bastard brother, Geoffrey, who is a sluggard, and slow to do anything good.—Each of them has a very appropriate name, by which his own character is described; for if any one interpret rightly the names, he may know most accurately what each signifies.—By *Robert*, is very sufficiently indicated *a robber*; and by Richard, with much fitness, a *rich hard* man; *Gilbert* is not without reason called a *guiler*; and *Geoffrey* is, if we come to the point, changed into *jo frai* (i. e. I will do it).—By these people's names, which are thus described, are denoted the habit, and fraud, and works, of many men; and in order that these may be made more manifest to all, they are here published better and more fully —Robert fleeces, extorts, and threatens; and Richard keeps all he gains; Gilbert deceives, and afterwards boasts of it; Geoffrey procrastinates, and does nothing.—I will follow up the truth now in full cry: every ravenous man is the companion of Robert; a false and miserly man is similar to Gilbert; a slow and listless man is, without doubt, a Geoffrey.—The latter idly protracts the time, behindhand at whatever hour is appointed, he neglects to do what is good, and by putting off the good he falls into that which is evil, and he is

Scire potest certius quid significatur.

Competenter per *Robert, robbur*
designatur;

Et per *Richard, riche hard* congrue
notatur;

Gilebert non sine re *gilur* appellatur;

Gefrei, si rem tangimus, in *jo frai*
commutatur.

Per istorum nomina, quæ sic
figurantur,

Modus, fraus, et opera multorum
denotantur;

Et ut cunctis clarius hæc aperiantur,

Melius et plenius hic notificantur.

Robertus excoriat, extorquet, et
minatur;

Et Ricardus retinet totum quod lucratur;

Gilebertus decipit, et inde gloriatur;

Galfridus se procrastinat, et nil operatur.

Veritatem prosequar ore nunc aperto:

Vir quicumque rabidus consors est
Roberto;

Vir fallax et cupidus par fit Gileberto;

Vir piger et tepidus Galfridus est pro
certo.

Tempus piger protrahit omni tardus
hora;

Operari negligit quæ sunt meliora;

Bona nimis differens ruit in pejora;

Et ut bene faciat semper est in mora.

Hic promittit quodlibet, sed nil vult
implere;

Semper dicit “faciam,” nunquam facit
vere;

Sed cum mors est proxima, tunc incipit
dolere;

falls into that which is evil, and he is always backward in acting well:—he promises anything, but will perform nothing; he always says, “I will do,” but never does; but when death is at hand, he begins to lament: there is great danger in repenting so late.—Let every one take care that he is not himself deceived; let him try to repent before his end, that he may merit well while he is in health, lest by putting it off, he chance to die before it is done.—The Lord, who is the fountain and author of the highest degree of piety, give us here the inclination so to mourn for our faults, and to be penitent spontaneously while we are in health, that in the next world we may be in joy with the saints!

Magnum est periculum tam sero
pœnitere.

Quisque sibi caveat ne decipiatur;
Pœnitere studeat antequam labatur;
Dum est compos corporis bene mereatur,
Ne dum differt interim forte moriatur.

Fons et auctor, Dominus, summæ
pietatis
Nobis hic sic annuat flere pro peccatis,
Et dum sumus validi pœnitere gratis,
Ut possimus alibi gaudere cum beatis!
AMEN.

A perpetual subject of popular outcry against the great, during this and the following centuries, was afforded by the foreign and extravagant fashions in dress, which were prevalent. A glance at the illuminations in contemporary manuscripts will show us that these complaints were not without foundation. We, even at the present day, can with difficulty conceive the immense sums which were in former days expended on the toilet. This profusion was frequently and severely commented upon in the prose writings of the clergy, and was not uncommonly the subject of popular satire. The following song upon the tailors is very playful.

SONG UPON THE TAILORS.

[MS. Harl. 978. fol. 99, v^o. reign of Hen. III.]

*In nova fert animus mutatas
dicere formas Corpora, Dii
cæptis, nam vos mutastis et illas,
Aspirate meis.*

Ego dixi, dii estis;
Quæ dicenda sunt in festis
 Quare prætermitterem?
Dii, revera, qui potestis
In figuram novæ vestis
 Transmutare veterem.

Pannus recens et novellus
Fit vel capa vel mantellus,
 Sed secundum tempora
Primum capa, post pusillum
Transmutatur hæc in illum;
 Sic mutatis corpora.

Antiquata decollatur,
Decollata mantellatur,
 Sic in modum Proteos
Demutantur vestimenta;
Nec recenter est inventa
 Lex metamorphoseos.

Cum figura sexum mutant;
Prius ruptam clam reclutant
 Primates ecclesiæ;
Nec donatur, res est certa,
Nisi prius sit experta
 Fortunam Tiresiæ.

Bruma tandem revertente,
Tost unt sur la chape enté
 Plerique capucium;

TRANSLATION.—I have said, ye are gods; why should I omit the service which should be said on festival days? Gods certainly ye are, who can transform an old garment into the shape of a new one.—The cloth, while fresh and new, is made either a cape or mantle; but, in order of time, first it is a cape, after a little space this is transformed into the other; thus ye “change bodies.”—When it becomes old, the collar is cut off; when deprived of the collar, it is made a mantle: thus, in the manner of Proteus, are garments changed; nor is the law of metamorphosis a new discovery.—With their shape they change their sex; the primates of the church privately close up again what was before torn; nor is it given, assuredly, till it has first undergone the fortune of Tiresias.—When, at length, winter returns, many engraft immediately upon the cape a capuce; then it is squared; after being squared it is rounded; and so it becomes an aumuce.—If there remain any morsels of the cloth or skin

Alioquin dequadratur,
De quadrato retundatur,
Transit in almucium.

Si quid restat de morsellis
Cæsi panni sive pellis,
Non vacat officio:
Ex hiis fiunt manuthecæ,
Manutheca quidem Græcè
Manuum positio.

Sic ex veste vestem formant,
Engleis, Tyeis, Franceis, Normant,
Omnes generaliter;
Ut vix nullus excludatur.
Ita capa declinatur,
Sed mantellus aliter.

Adhuc primo recens anno,
Nova pelle, novo panno,
In arca reconditur;
Recedente tandem pilo,
Juncturarum rupto filo,
Pellis circumciditur.

Sic mantellus fit apella;
Ci git li drap, e la pel là,
Post primum divortium;
A priore separata
Cum secundo reparata
Transit in consortium.

Quod delictum dices majus?
Istud palam est contra jus:
Nam si nupsit alteri,
Conjugium est violatum,
Dum fit novo copulatum

which is cut, it does not want a use: of these are made gloves; a glove is called in Greek “the placing of the hands.”—This is the general manner they all make one robe out of another, English, Germans, French, and Normans, with scarcely an exception. Thus *cape* is declined; but *mantle* otherwise.—In the first year, while it is still fresh, the skin and the cloth being both new, it is laid up in a box; when, however, the fur begins to be worn off, and the thread of the seams broken, the skin is circumcised.—Thus the mantle is made a Jew; here lays the cloth, there the skin, after the first divorce: being separated from its former husband, after separation it passes in reparation to marriage with a second husband.—But what will you say is a greater crime? this is clearly against right; for if she have married a second, the marriage is broken, when a new conjunction is made in spite of the reclamations of the old partner.—It is neither canonic nor wise to marry two cloths to one fur, and so we

Reclamante veteri.

N'est de concille, ne de sene,
Deus dras espuser à une pene,
E si nus le juggium;
Permittunt hoc decreta? non:
Sed reclamat omnis canon
Non esse conjugium.

Pannus primum circumcisis,
Viduatus et divisus
A sua pellicula,
Jam expertus Judaismum,
Emundatur per baptismum
A quacumque macula.

Circumcisis mundatusque,
Est adeptus utriusque
Legis testimonium;
Quem baptismus emundavit,
Cum secunda secundavit
Pelle matrimonium.

Pilis experts, usu fractus,
Ex Esaü Jacob factus,
Quant li peil en est chaü,
Inversatur vice versa,
Rursus idem ex conversa
Ex Jacob fit Esaü.

Pars pilosa foris paret,
Sed introrsus pilis caret
Vetustas abscondita;
Datur tamen, k'il n'i eit perte,
Servienti, pur deserte,
Mantellus hypocrita.

judge it. Do the decretals permit this? No: on the contrary, every canon declares, that it is no marriage.—The cloth having been first circumcised, then widowed and separated from its skin, now having experienced Judaism, is cleansed by baptism, from every stain (*i. e.* it is dyed).—Being circumcised and cleaned, and having obtained the testimony of both laws, he whom baptism has cleansed, contracts a new marriage with a second skin.—Being devoid of hair, and worn by use, from Esau having become Jacob, when the hair is fallen from it, the process is inverted, and again conversely from Jacob it becomes Esau.—The hairy part is turned out, but the old part, concealed inwardly, is bare of hairs. Now the hypocritical mantle, in order that there may be nothing lost, is given to the servant for his wages.

Trucidare Saxones soliti Cambrenses
Ad cognatos Britones et Cornubienses;
Requirunt ut veniant per acutos enses,
Ad debellandos inimicos Saxonienses.

Venite jam strenue loricis armati;
Sunt pars magna Saxonum mutuo necati,
Erit pars residua per nos trucidati:—
Nunc documenta date qua sitis origine
nati.

Mellinus veredicus nunquam dixit
vanum;
Expellendum populum prædixit
vexanum.

Et vos hoc consilium non servatis sanum;
Cernite fallaces quorum genus omne
profanum.

Prædecessor validus rex noster Arturus
Si vixisset hodie, fuisset securus
Nullus ei Saxonum restitisset murus;
Esset ei[s] sicut meruerunt in prece
durus.

Procuret omnipotens sibi successorem
Saltem sibi similem, nollem meliorem,
Qui tollat Britonibus antiquum dolorem,
Et sibi restituat patriam patriæque
decorem.

Hoc Arturi patruus velit impetrare,
Sanctus [qui]dam maximus, Anglum ultra
mare;
Scimus festum Martis kalendis instare,—
Ad natale solum Britones studeat
revocare.

Virtuosos filii patres imitantur;
Sic Arturum Britones virtute sequantur:
Quam probo, quam strenuo monstrant

TRANSLATION.—The Cambrians, who are used to slay the Saxons, salute their relations the Britons and Cornish-men: they require them to come with their sharp swords to conquer their Saxon enemies.—Come now, vigorously, armed with coats of mail; a great part of the Saxons are fallen in mutual slaughter, the remainder shall be slain by us: now is the time for you to show of what blood you are sprung.—The soothsayer Merlin never said a thing that was vain; he foretold that the mad people should be expelled. And you do not keep this wise counsel; observe deceitful people of whom the whole race is accursed.—If our valiant predecessor, King Arthur, had been now alive, I am sure not one of the Saxon walls would have resisted him; he would have been hard to them, spite of their prayers, as they have deserved.—May the Omnipotent procure him a successor only similar to him, I would not desire a better, who may deliver the Britons from their old grievance, and restore to them their country and their country's glory.—May it please the uncle of Arthur to obtain this for us, a certain very great saint, [to send] the Englishman over the sea; we know that his festival is approaching on the kalends of March (St. David's day), may he make it his study to recall the Britons to their native land.—Sons imitate their virtuous fathers, so let the Britons take Arthur for their example in valour; they show from what a good and brave man they are descended; as Arthur was, so let them be, conquerors!—The Roman power reigned at Paris, the bold giant Frollo, with the bearish mind; him Arthur slew: every person of good faith believes it: witness the tent and the Parisian island.—He is a madman who kills the noble Britons: it seems that he holds them thus hated; for he invidiously proclaims them hateful

procreantur;
Ut fuit Arturus sic victores habeantur!
Regnabat Parisius potestas Romana,
Frollo gygas strenuus, cujus mens ursana;
Hunc Arthurus perimit, credit fides sana,
Testis tentorium sit et insula Parisiana.
Insanit qui Britones necat generosos;
Videtur quod habeat sic eos exosos,
Namque per invidiam clamat odiosos
Semper et assidue, quos audit victoriosos.
Ex hac gente ⁱⁱⁱ^{or} sunt imperatores,
Arthurus, Broinsius, fortes bellatores,
Constantinus, Brennius, fere fortiores.
Hii monarchiam tenuerunt ut probiores.
Solum suum Karolum Francia
præjectat;
Et Ricardum Anglia probitate jactat;
Paucitatem numerus major labefactat,
Virtutem regis quia quadrupla gloria
mactat.
Istis suis finibus contigit regnare;
Illis duces, præsides, reges triumphare,
Quibus nullo merito se possint æquare;
Est quam regnare longe plus induperare.

invidiously proclaims them hateful
always and incessantly, who he hears
are victorious.—Of this nation there
have been four great commanders,
Arthur and Broinsius, powerful
warriors; Constantine and Brennius,
more powerful, if it were possible; these
held the monarchy by reason of their
being the best.—France can only boast
of her Charlemaine; and England glories
in the valour of King Richard; a larger
number overcomes a smaller, because a
four-fold glory increases the valour of
the King.—To these latter it was granted
to reign within their own bounds; to the
others, to triumph, over commanders,
governors, and kings, with whom they
can in no respect claim equality: it is a
far greater thing to command, than to
reign.

The following fragment of what appears once to have been a long ballad, made to be sung in the halls of the Barons, seems to have been written soon after the disturbances in London in 1263, though there is not enough preserved to enable us to determine the precise occasion on which it was composed. Several nobles are here joined together, who afterwards took different sides.

THE SONG OF THE BARONS.

[A roll of parchment, of the 13th cent. in a private library.]

* * * *

Mès de Warenne ly bon quens,
Que tant ad richesses et biens,
 Si ad apris de guere,
En Norfolk en cel pens[is]
Vint conquerrant ses enemis,
 Mès ore ne ad que fere.

Sire Jon Giffard deit bien nommé,
Que n'out gueres un pem ... é
 En cele chivauchée;
E si fu touz jors à devant,
Prus e sages et pernant,
 E de grant renommée.

Et Sire Jon D'Ayvile,
Que onques ni aima treyson ne gile,
 Fu en lur conpanie;
Et sire Peres de Montfort,
Si tint bien à lur acord,
 Si out grant seignurie.

Et de Clifford ly bon Roger
Se contint cum noble ber,
 Si fu de grant justice;
Ne suffri pas petit ne grant,
Ne arère ne par devant,
 Fere nul mesprise.

Et Sire Roger de Leyburne,
Que sà et là sovent se torne,
 Mout ala conquerrant;
Assez mist paine de gainer,
Pur ses pertes restorer,
 Que Sire Edward le fist avant.

TRANSLATION.—But the good Earl of Warenne,—who has so much riches and property,—and has skill in war,—in Norfolk in this thought—he came conquering his enemies,—but now he has nothing to do.

Sir John Gifford ought well to be named,—who had scarcely a ...—in this riding-bout;—and he was always forward,—valiant and wise, and active,—and of great renown.

And Sir John Dayville,—who never loved treason or guile,—was in their company;—and Sir Peter de Montfort,—he held firm to their agreement,—and had great signory.

And the good Roger de Clifford—behaved like a noble baron,—and exercised great justice;—he suffered neither little nor great,—neither behind or before,—to do any wrong.

And Sir Roger de Leyburne,—who often turns

Mout furent bons les barons;
Mès touz ne sai nomer lur nons,
Tant est grant la some:
Pur ce revenk al quens Simon,
Pur dire interpretison,
Coment hom le nome.

Il est apelé de Monfort,
Il est el mond et si est fort,
Si ad grant chevalerie;
Ce voir, et je m'acort,
Il eime dreit, et het le tort,
Si avera la mestrie.

El mond est veréement;
Là ou la comun à ly concent,
De la terre loée;
C'est ly quens de Leycestre,
Que baut et joius se puet estre
De cele renomée.

Ly eveske de Herefort
Sout bien que ly quens fu fort,
Kant il prist l'affère:
Devant ce esteit mult fer,
Les Engleis quida touz manger,
Mès ore ne set que fere.

Et ly pastors de Norwis,
Qui devoure ses berbis,
Assez sout de ce conte;
Mout en perdi de ses biens,
Mal ert que ly lessa riens,
Ke trop en saveit de honte.

Et Sire Jon de Langelé,
Soune chose fu gainé,

him on this side and on that,
—made great progress
conquering;—he laboured
much to gain,—to restore his
losses,—which Sir Edward
had caused him before.

Right good men were the
barons;—but I cannot tell all
their names,—the number is
so great:—therefore I return
to Earl Simon,—to give the
interpretation,—what is his
name.

He is called de Montfort;—
he is in the world (*monde*),
and he is strong (*fort*);—and
he has great chivalry:—this is
true, and I agree to it,—he
loves right and hates wrong,
—and he shall have the
mastery.

He is truly in the world,—
there where the commons are
in accord with him—which
are praised of the land;—it is
the Count of Leicester,—who
may be glad and joyous—of
this renown.

The Bishop of Hereford—
knew well that the Earl was
strong,—when he took the
matter in hand;—before that
he (the bishop) was very

Deheiz eit que l'en pleine!
Tot le soen en fist porter
De Clifford mi Sire Roger,
Ne vout que rien remeine.

Ne à Sire Mathi de Besile
Ne lesserent une bile,
En champ u en vile.
Tot le soen fu besilé,
E cointement fu detrussé
Par un treget sanz gile.

Mès mi Sire Jon de Gray
Vint à Lundres, si ne sai quoi,
Que must une destance
Par entre Lundres et ly,
Que tot son hernois en perdi,
Ce fu sa meschance.

Et Sire Willem le Latimer
Vint à Lundres pur juer,
* * * *

he (the bishop) was very
fierce;—he thought to eat up
all the English;—but now he
does not know what to do.

And the pastor of Norwich,
—who devours his own
sheep,—knows enough of this
story;—he lost much of his
goods;—it is pity they left
him anything,—who was too
much acquainted with shame.

And Sir John de Langley,—
his property was gained,—
cursed be he who complains
of it;—all he had my lord
Roger de Clifford—caused to
be carried away;—he would
let nothing remain.

Neither to Sir Matthew de
Besile—did they leave one
farthing,—in country or in
town.—All his property was
ravaged,—and neatly was he
stripped—by a 'treget'
without guile.

But Sir John de Gray—
came to London, and some
thing or other—made a
quarrel—between London
and him,—that he lost all his
harness;—that was his
mischance.

And Sir William le Latimer
—came to London to play, * *
*

The following satirical song seems to have been written on the occasion of the intermediation of Louis IX. of France, between the contending parties in England, in the beginning of the year 1264. Much of its point consists in a rather gross play upon words which cannot always be translated; it is written in a very broad dialect; and the numerous instances of bad French, which are observed in it, were, no doubt, committed intentionally, to increase the hilarity of the listeners, at the expense of the English and their King.

SONG OF THE PEACE WITH ENGLAND.

[From a MS. of the thirteenth century, in the Bibl. du Roi, at Paris, No. 7218,
fol. 220, v^o.]

Or vint la tens de May, que ce ros panirra,
Que ce tens serra beles, roxinol chanterra,
Ces prez il serra verdes, ces gardons
florirra;
J'ai trova à ma cul .j. chos que je dirra.

De ma ray d'Ingleters qui fu à bon
naviaus,
Chivaler vaelant, hardouin, et léaus,
Et d'Adouart sa filz qui fi blont sa
chaviaus,
Mai covint que je faites .j. dit troute
noviaus.

Et de ce rai de Frans, cestui longue baron,
Qui tenez Normandi à tort par mal
choison;
Lonc tens fout-il croupier sor Parris son
maison,
Qu'il onc for por .i. gaire ne chauça
d'asperon.

Sinor, tendez à mai; ne devez pas rier:
Ce navel que je port doit tout le mont
crier.

L'autr'ier je fi à Londres une grosse
concier;
Là ne movra baron la meilleur ne la pier,

Que tout ne fout venez à ce grand
plaidement.

Là arra fet tel chos, je craie vraiment,
Qu' 'i farra rois François .i. grant
poentement

De ce terres qu'il tient contre le Glaise
gent.

TRANSLATION.—Now comes the time of May, when the rose will open,—when the seasons will be fair, and the nightingale sing,—the fields will be green, and the gardens will bloom;—I have found behind me a thing which I will relate.

Of my King of England, who is in a good ship,—a valiant knight, hardy, and loyal,—and of Edward his son, who hath flaxen hair,—it pleases me to make a saying which is quite new.

And of that King of France, that long baron,—who held Normandy wrongfully by ill event;—long time did he settle his house upon Paris,—that he never but for a war alone put on his spur.

Lords, attend to me; you must not laugh:—all the world ought to cry this news which I bring.—The other day there was at London a great assembly;—there no baron, from the best to the worst, would move,

But they would all come to this great debating.—There would have been done such a thing, I believe truly,—that it would have caused the French King a great fright—concerning the lands which he holds against the English people.

Lords, it is a long time since Merlin prophecied—that Philip of France, a lord who was formerly,—should conquer all the land, such as it is, on this side;—but, at all events, I say it, the English will still have it.

Now is come the time that the English would make an inroad,—if he should find the French inclined to grumble,—who would appear frightened by swords and by greyhounds(?),—that he would have no courage to grumble against the English.

The good King of England drew

Sinor, lonc tens fout-il que Mellins
 profita
 Que Philippes de Frans, .i. sinor qui fi jà,
 Conquerra tout ce ters quanqu'il fout par
 deçà,
 Mès toute vois, dit je l', qu'encore Glais
 l'arra.

Or sont-il vint le tans que Glais voura
 vauchier;
 S'il trovez la François qui la voura
 groncier,
 Qui parra si froirrous d'espé ou de
 levrier,
 Qu'il n'arra talant por gondre Glais
 grondier.

Le bon rai d'Ingleteer se traina à .i. part,
 Li et Trichart sa frer irrous comme lipart.
 Il suspire de cul, si se claima à l'art,—
 “Hui Diex! com puis-je voir de Normandi
 ma part?”

“Ne vous maie mi,” dit la conte à
 Clocestre,
 “Vous porra bien encors; tel chos poistron
 bien estre,
 Se Diex salva ma cul, ma pié, et ma
 poing destre,
 Tu sarra sus Parris encore troute mestre.”

La cont Vincestre dit au buer rai
 d'Ingletiere,
 “Rai, rai, veus-tu sivier? Festes mouvoir
 ton guere,
 Et ie te conduira trestout ton gent à foire.”

The good King of England drew
 himself on one side,—he and Richard
 his brother, as angry as leopards.—He
 sighs from behind, and so cries with
 alacrity,—“O God! how may I have my
 part of Normandy?”

“Do not disturb yourself at all,” said
 the Earl of Gloucester,—“you may still
 do it; such things may still easily be,—if
 God preserve my backside, my foot, and
 my right fist,—thou shalt still be entire
 master over Paris.”

The Earl of Winchester said to the
 noble King of England,—“King, King,
 wilt thou follow? Set agoing the war,—
 and I will conduct thee all thy people in
 abundance:—at this juncture thou wilt
 be able to conquer Normandy.”

“If I can constrain the King of France
 to a battle,—and I can strike him with
 my lance behind,—I think that I shall
 make him fall so hard—that he will
 break his head, or my tail will be
 broken.”

“I will take good right, if I can, with
 God's will,—when I shall have in my
 hand Normandy and Poitou,—I will
 make my English people approach to
 Paris,—and then I will go to take France
 in spite of the Earl of Anjou.”

“By the five wounds of God! the
 French are in bad case;—if I can lay
 hold upon them, truly they shall be
 punished.—When the English go there,
 there will be a great disturbance;—
 God's death! I think they will all fly
 away.”

Sir Simon de Montfort heard this
 speech,—then he leaped on his feet; he
 did not look very handsome.—Says he
 to the English King, “By the body of the
 holy Lamb!—now let this thing alone;
 the Frenchman is not a lamb.”

“If you attack them, they will defend
 themselves:—he will burn all thy tents
 to ashes.—There is no man so valiant

Et je te conduira destout ton gent a l'ore.
Tu porras Normandi à ce pointes
conquerre.”

“Se je pois rai François à bataille contrier,
Et je porrai mon lance desus son cul
poier,
Je crai que je ferra si dourrement chier
Qu’il se brisa son test, ou ma cul fu
rompier.

Je prendrez bien droitur, se je puis, à
Diex poise,
Quant j’arra en mon main Normandi et
Pontoise;
Je ferra soz Parris achier mon gent
Gloise,
Puis vondrai prender Frans, maugré conte
d’Angoise.

Par la .v. plais à Diex, François maubali
sont;
Si g’i la puis grapier, certes il chateront.
Quant Inglais irront là, mult bahot i
serront;
Par la mort Dieu! je crai que toutes
s’enfuiront.”

Sir Symon à Montfort atendi ce navel,
Doncques sailli à piez; il ne fout mie bel.
A dit à rai Inglais, “Par le cors saint Anel!
Lessiez or cesti chos:—François n’est mi
anel.

Se vous aler seur leus, il se voudra
dafandre:
Toute ta paveillons metra feu à la cendre.
Il n’a si vaillant qui l’ose mi attendre.

to come. There is no man so vain
who dare wait for him;—they will be in
ill case whom the Frenchman can
catch.”

“What is that you say, Simon?”
replied Roger Bigot;—“do you take the
King for a simpleton and a fool?—if
you are so bold as to say another word,
—you will not serve yourself with your
best coat.”

“Sir Roger,” said the King, “for
God’s sake! dont be in a heat;—I am not
so angry against this scamp.—I dont
care half a farthing for all the French
that are;—I will do as I like, let the
matter go as it will.

“I will easily take Paris, I am quite
certain;—I will set fire to the river
which is called Seine;—I will burn the
mill; this will be a very grievous thing,
—if they eat no bread all the week.

“By the five wounds of God! Paris is
a very great city!—There is a chapel, of
which I am desirous;—I will cause it to
be carried in a rolling cart,—straight to
Saint Amont in London, just as it stands.

“When I have led all my ships to
Paris,—I will cause the Chancellor in
the monastery of St. Denis—to crown
Edward on his flaxen hair.—There I will
kill for you cows and pigs.

“I believe that you will see there a
great feast,—when France shall have
crowned Edward’s head. He has well
deserved it, my son; he is no fool;—he
is a good knight, brave, and courteous.”

“Sir King,” said Roger, “for God’s
sake, listen to me;—thou hast pierced
me behind, so much has pity overcome
me;—Now may God Almighty ordain
by his commandment,—that thou
perform this thing very gloriously!”

Il n'a si vaerant qui n'ose m'attendre,
Mult sarra maubali qui le François puet
prendre.”

“Qoi dites-vous, Symon?” pona Rogier
Bigot;
“Bien tenez-vous la rai por binart et por
sot?
Fout insi hardouin que vous sone plus
mot,
Ne te pot besoner por vostre mileur cot!”

“Sir Rogier,” dit la rai, “por Dieu, ne
vous chaele!
Ne sai mi si irrous contre ce merdaele.
Je ne dout mi François tout qui sont une
mele;
Je farra ma talent comment la chos aeale.

Je pandra bien Parris, je suis toute
certaine;
Je bouterra le fu en cele eve qui [fu]
Saine;
La moulins arderra; ce fi chos mult
gravaine
Se n'i menja de pain de troute la semaine.

[P]ar la .v. plais à Diex, Parris fout vil
mult grant
Il i a .i. chapel dont je fi coetant;
Je le ferra portier, à .i. charrier rollant,
A Saint Amont à Londres toute droit en
estant.

Quant j'arra soz Parris mené tout me
naviaus,
Je ferra le moustier Saint Dinis la

Chanciaus
Corronier d'Adouart soz sa blonde
chaviaus.
La voudra vous toer de vaches à porciaus.

Je crai que vous verra là endret grosse
fest,
Quant d'Adouart arra corroné France test.
Il l'a bien asservi, ma fil; il n'est pas best;
Il fout buen chivaler, hardouin, et
honest."

"Sir rai," ce dit Rogier, "por Dieu à mai
entent;
Tu m'as percé la cul, tel la pitié m'a
prent.
Or doint Godelamit, par son
culmandement,
Que tu fais cestui chos bien
gloriouslyment!"

Explicit la pais aus Englois.

The decisive battle of Lewes, in 1264, was the subject of great exultation amongst the adherents of Simon de Montfort. The following song, in English, is directed against the king's brother, Richard Earl of Cornwall, who had become very unpopular by his foreign schemes of ambition. He took shelter at a windmill, after he saw the king's party defeated.

SONG AGAINST THE KING OF ALMAIGNE.

[MS. Harl. No. 2253, fol. 58 v^o, of the reign of Edw. II.]

Sitteth alle stille ant herkneth to me:
The Kyn of Alemaigne, bi mi leauté,
Thritti thousent pound askede he
For te make the pees in the countré,
ant so he dude more.

Richard, thah thou be ever trichard,
trichen shalt thou never
more.

Richard of Alemaigne, whil that he wes
kyng,

He spende al is tresour opon swyvyng;
Haveth he nout of Walingford o ferlyng:

Let him habbe, ase he brew, bale to
dryng,

maugre Wyndesore.

Richard, thah thou be ever, etc.

The Kyng of Alemaigne wende do ful
wel,

He saisede the mulne for a castel,

With hare sharpe swerdes he grounde the
stel,

He wende that the sayles were mangonel
to helpe Wyndesore.

Richard, etc.

The Kyng of Alemaigne gederede ys
host,

Makede him a castel of a mulne post,

Wende with is prude ant is muchele bost,
Brohte from Alemayne mony sori gost

to store Wyndesore.

Richard, etc.

TRANSLATION.—Sit all still and listen to me:—the King of Almaine, by my loyalty,—thirty thousand pound he asked—to make peace in the country,—and so he did more.—Richard, though thou art ever a traitor,—thou shalt never more deceive.

Richard of Almaine, while he was king,—he spent all his treasure upon luxury;—have he not of Wallingford one furlong:—let him have, as he brews, evil to drink,—in spite of Windsor.

The King of Almaine thought to do full well,—they seized the mill for a castle;—with their sharp swords they ground the steel,—they thought the sails had been mangonels—to help Windsor.

The King of Almaine gathered his host,—he made him a castle of a mill-post,—he went with his pride and his great boast,—brought from Almaine many a wretched soul—to garrison Windsor.

By God, that is above us,
he did great sin,—who let the

By God, that is aboven ous, he dude
 much synne,
That lette passen over see the Erl of
 Warynne:
He hath robbed Engeland, the mores, ant
 th[e] fenne,
The gold, ant the selver, ant y-boren
 henne,
 for love of Wyndesore.
Richard, etc.

Sire Simond de Mountfort hath swore bi
 ys chyn,
Hevede he nou here the Erl of Waryn,
Shulde he never more come to is yn,
Ne with sheld, ne with spere, ne with
 other gyn,
 to help of Wyndesore.
Richard, etc.

Sire Simond de Montfort hath suore bi ys
 cop,
Hevede he nou here Sire Hue de Bigot,
Al he shulde quite here twelfmoneth scot,
Shulde he never more with his fot pot
 to helpe Wyndesore.
Richard, etc.

Be the luef, be the loht, sire Edward,
Thou shalt ride sporeles o thy lyard
Al the ryhte way to Dover ward;
Shalt thou never more breke fore-ward,
 ant that reweth sore:
 Edward, thou duest ase a sheward,
 forsoke thyn emes lore.
Richard, etc.

Earl of Warenne pass over
sea:—he hath robbed England
both the moor and the fen,—
of the gold and the silver, and
carried them hence,—for love
of Windsor.

Sir Simon de Montfort hath
sworn by his chin,—had he
now here the Earl of Warenne,
—he should never more come
to his lodging,—neither with
shield, nor with spear, nor
with other contrivance,—to
help Windsor.

Sir Simon de Montfort hath
sworn by his head,—had he
now here Sir Hugh de Bigot,
—he should pay here a
twelvemonth's scot,—he
should never more tramp on
his feet,—to help Windsor.

Be it agreeable to thee, or
disagreeable, Sir Edward,—
thou shalt ride spurless on thy
hack—all the straight road
towards Dover;—thou shalt
never more break covenant;—
and that sore rueth thee;—
Edward, thou didst like a
shrew,—forsookest thine
uncle's teaching.

The following long, but singularly interesting, poem may be considered as the popular declaration of the principles with which the barons entered into the war, and the objects which they had in view. It bears internal proofs of having been written immediately after the decisive battle of Lewes; and the moderate and deeply moral and religious feeling which the reforming party here shows, even in the moment of triumph, is extremely remarkable, and is closely connected with the complaints against the licentiousness of the other party in the satirical songs which precede. We might almost suppose ourselves transported to the days of Wickliffe or Cromwell.

THE BATTLE OF LEWES.

[MS. Harl. 978. fol. 128, r^o. of the middle of the 13th cent.]

Calamus velociter scribe sic scribentis,
 Lingua laudabiliter te benedicentis,
 Dei patris dextera, domine virtutum,
 Qui das tuis prospera quando vis ad
 nutum;
 In te jam confidere discant universi,
 Quos volebant perdere qui nunc sunt
 dispersi.
 Quorum caput capitur, membra
 captivantur;
 Gens elata labitur, fideles lætantur.
 Jam respirat Anglia, sperans libertatem;
 Cui Dei gratia det prosperitatem!
 Comparati canibus Angli 10
 viluerunt,
 Sed nunc victis hostibus caput extulerunt.
 Gratiae millesimo ducentesimoque
 Anno sexagesimo quarto, quarta quoque
 Feria Pancratii post sollempnitatem,
 Valde gravis prelii tulit tempestatem
 Anglorum turbatio, castroque Lewensi;
 Nam furori ratio, vita cessit ensi.
 Pridie qui Maii Idus confluxerunt,
 Horrendi discidii bellum commiserunt;
 Quod fuit Sussexiæ factum 20
 comitatu,
 Fuit et Cicestriæ in episcopatu.
 Gladius invaluit, multi ceciderunt,
 Veritas prævaluit, falsique fugerunt.
 Nam perjuris restitit dominus virtutum,
 Atque puris præstitit veritatis scutum.
 Hos vastavit gladius foris, intus pavor;
 Confortavit plenius istos cœli favor.
 Victoris sollempnia sanctæque coronæ
 Reddunt testimonia super hoc agone;

TRANSLATION.—Write quickly, O pen
 of one who, writing such things as
 follow, blesses and praises with his
 tongue, thee, O right hand of God the
 Father, Lord of virtues, who givest
 prosperity at thy nod to thine own,
 whenever it is thy will; let all those
 people now learn to put their trust in
 thee, whom they, who are now
 scattered, wished to destroy—they of
 whom the head is now taken, and the
 members are in captivity; the proud
 people is fallen; the faithful are filled
 with joy. Now England breathes in the
 hope of liberty; [10] to which (England)
 may the grace of God give prosperity!
 The English were despised like dogs;
 but now they have raised their head over
 their vanquished enemies.

In the year of grace one thousand two
 hundred and sixty-four, and on the
 Wednesday after the festival of St.
 Pancras, the army of the English bore
 the brunt of a great battle at the castle of
 Lewes: for reasoning yielded to rage,
 and life to the sword. They met on the
 fourteenth of May, [20] and began the
 battle of this terrible strife; which was
 fought in the county of Sussex, and in
 the bishopric of Chichester. The sword
 was powerful; many fell; truth
 prevailed; and the false men fled. For
 the Lord of valour resisted the perjured
 men, and defended those who were pure
 with the shield of truth. The sword
 without, and fear within, routed the
 former; the favour of heaven comforted
 very fully the latter. The solemnities of
 the victor, and the sacred crowns, [30]
 give testimony on this contest; since the
 Church honoured the said persons as
 saints, and victory crowned the true
 soldiers. The wisdom of God, which
 rules the whole world, performed
 miracles and made a joyful war; caused
 the strong to fly, and the valorous men
 to shut themselves up in a cloister, and

Cum dictos ecclesia sanctos 30
 honoravit,
 Milites victoria veros coronavit.
 Dei sapientia, regens totum mundum,
 Fecit mirabilia bellumque jocundum;
 Fortes fecit fugere, virosque virtutis
 In claustro se claudere, locis quoque tutis.
 Non armis sed gratia christianitatis,
 Id est in ecclesia, excommunicatis
 Unicum refugium restabat, relictis
 Equis, hoc consilium occurrebat victis.
 Et quam non timuerant prius 40
 prophanare,
 Quam more debuerant matris honorare,
 Ad ipsam refugiunt, licet minus digni,
 Amplexus se muniunt salutaris ligni.
 Quos matrem contempnere prospera
 fecerunt,
 Vulnera cognoscere matrem compulerunt.
 Apud Northamptoniam dolo prosperati,
 Spreverunt ecclesiam infideles nati;
 Sanctæ matris viscera ferro turbaverunt,
 Prosperis non prospera bella meruerunt.
 Mater tunc injuriam tulit 50
 patienter,
 Quasi per incuriam, sed nec affluenter:
 Punit hanc et alias quas post addiderunt,
 Nam multas ecclesias insani læserunt;
 Namque monasterium, quod Bellum
 vocatur,
 Turba sævientium, quæ nunc conturbatur,
 Inmisericorditer bonis spoliavit,
 Atque sibi taliter bellum præparavit.
 Monachi Cystercii de Ponte-Roberti
 A furore gladii non fuissent certi,
 Si quingentas principi 60

in places of safety. Not in arms, but in the grace of Christianity, that is in the Church, remained the only refuge for those who were excommunicated; after deserting their horses [40] this counsel alone occurred to the vanquished. And her whom previously they had not hesitated to profane, her whom they ought to have honoured in the place of a mother—in her they seek refuge, though little worthy of it, and seek their defence in embracing the wood of salvation. Those whom prosperity caused to despise their mother, their wounds compelled to know their mother. When at Northampton they succeeded by treachery, the faithless children despised the church; with the sword they disturbed the bowels of the holy mother, and in their prosperity [50] did not merit a successful war. The mother then bore the injury patiently, as though heedless of it, but not letting it pass unmarked: she punishes this and other injuries which were afterwards added, for the madmen ravaged many churches; and the band of enraged men, which has now been thrown into confusion, mercilessly spoiled the monastery which is called Battle, of its goods, and thus they prepared a *battle* for themselves. The Cistercian monks of Robertsbridge [60] would not have been safe from the fury of the sword, unless they had given five hundred marks to the prince, which Edward ordered to be received, or they had perished. By these, and similar deeds, they merited to give way and succumb before their enemies. May the Lord bless Simon de Montfort! and also his sons and his army! who, exposing themselves magnanimously to death, fought valiantly, condoling the lamentable lot of the English who, trodden under foot in a manner scarcely to be described, [70] and almost deprived of all their liberties, nay, of their lives, had languished under hard

marcas non dedissent.
Quas Edwardus accipi jussit, vel
perissent.

Hiis atque similibus factis meruerunt
Quod cesserunt hostibus et succubuerunt.
Benedicat dominus .S. de Monte-Forti!
Suis nichilominus natis et cohorti!
Qui se magnanimiter exponentes morti,
Pugnaverunt fortiter, condolentes sorti
Anglicorum flebili, qui subpeditati
Modo vix narrabili, peneque privati
Cunctis libertatibus, immo 70
sua vita,

Sub duris principibus langüerunt ita,
Ut Israelitica plebs sub Pharaone,
Gemens sub tyrannica devastatione.
Sed hanc videns populi Deus agoniam,
Dat in fine seculi novum Mathathiam,
Et cum suis filiis zelans zelum legis,
Nec cedit injuriis nec furori regis.

Seductorem nominant .S. atque
fallacem;
Facta sed examinant probantque
veracem. 80

Dolosi deficiunt in necessitate;
Qui mortem non fugiunt, sunt in veritate.
Sed nunc dicit æmulus, et insidiator,
Cujus nequam oculus pacis perturbator:
“Si laudas constantiam, si fidelitatem,
Quæ mortis instantiam vel pœnalitatem
Non fugit, æqualiter dicentur constantes
Qui concurrunt pariter invicem
pugnantes,

Pariter discrimini semet exponentes,
Duroque cognomini se subjicientes.”
Sed in nostro prelio cui nunc 90

rulers, like the people of Israel under Pharaoh, groaning under a tyrannical devastation. But God, seeing this suffering of the people, gives at last a new Matathias, and he with his sons, zealous after the zeal of the law, yields neither to the insults nor to the fury of the king.

They call Simon a seductor and a traitor; [80] but his deeds lay him open and prove him to be a true man. Traitors fall off in time of need; they who do not fly death, are those who stand for the truth. But says his insidious enemy now, whose evil eye is the disturber of peace, “If you praise the constancy and the fidelity, which does not fly the approach of death or punishment, they shall equally be called constant who, in the same manner, go to the combat fighting on the opposite side, in the same manner exposing themselves to the chance of war, [90] and subjecting themselves to a hard appellation.” But in our war in which we are now engaged, let us see what is the state of the case.

The earl had few men used to arms; the royal party was numerous, having assembled the disciplined and greatest warriors in England, such as were called the flower of the army of the kingdom; those who were prepared with arms from among the Londoners, were three hundred set before several thousands; whence they were contemptible to those, [100] and were detested by those who were experienced. Much of the earl’s army was raw; fresh in arms, they knew little of war. The tender youth, only now girt with a sword, stands in the morning in battle accustoming himself to arms; what wonder if such an unpractised tyro fear, and if the powerless lamb dread the wolf? Thus those who fight for England are inferior in military discipline, and they are much fewer than the strong men, who boasted

instamus,
Qualis sit discretio rei videamus.
Comes paucos habuit armorum
expertos
Pars regis intumuit, bellatores certos
Et majores Angliæ habens congregatos,
Floremque militiæ regni nominatos;
Qui Londoniensibus armis comparati,
Essent multis milibus trecenti prælati;
Unde contemptibiles illis extiterunt,
Et abhominabiles expertis fuerunt.
Comitis militia plurima 100
tenella;
In armis novitia, parum novit bella.
Nunc accinctus gladio tener adolescens
Mane stat in prelio armis assuescens;
Quid mirum si timeat tyro tam novellus,
Et si lupum caveat impotens agnellus?
Sic ergo militia sunt inferiores
Qui pugnant pro Anglia, sunt et pauciores
Multo viris fortibus, de sua virtute
Satis glorientibus, ut putarent tute,
Et sine periculo, velut 110
absorbere
Quotquot adminiculo Comiti fuere.
Nam et quos adduxerat Comes ad
certamen,
De quibus speraverat non parvum
juvamen,
Plurimi perterriti mox se subtraxerunt,
Et velut attoniti fugæ se dederunt;
Et de tribus partibus tertia recessit.
Comes cum fidelibus paucis nunquam
cessit.
Gedeonis prelium nostro comparemus,
In quibus fidelium vincere videmus

in their own valour, [110] because they thought safely, and without danger, to swallow up, as it were, all whom the earl had to help him. Moreover, of those whom the earl had brought to the battle, and from whom he hoped for no little help, many soon withdrew from fear, and took to flight as though they were amazed; and of three parts, one deserted. The earl with a few faithful men never yielded. We may compare our battle with that of Gideon; [120] in both of which we see a few of the faithful conquer a great number who have no faith, and who trust in themselves like Lucifer did. God said, "If I should give the victory to the many, the fools will not give the glory to me, but to fools." So if God had made the strong to conquer, the common people would have given the credit of it to the men, and not to God.

From these considerations it may be concluded that the warlike men did not fear God, wherefore they did nothing to prove their constancy or fidelity, [130] but they showed on the contrary their pride and cruelty; and wishing to confound those whom they despised, issuing forth boldly, they perished quickly. Exaltation of the heart brings on ruin, and humility merits to receive the divine grace; for he who does not trust in God, God overthrows his pride. We may bring forward as examples Aman and Mardocheus; we read that the former was arrogant, the latter a true Israelite; the gallows which Aman had prepared for Mardocheus, [140] in the morning the wretch bore it himself in order to be hanged upon it. The queen's banquet blinded Aman, which he reputed as an extraordinary privilege; but his vain expectation is turned into confusion, when after the feast he is dragged to the gallows. Thus sorrow followed close upon joy, when it coupled death with the end of the feast.

Paucos multos numero fidem 120
 non habentes,
 Similes Lucifero de se confidentes.
 “Si darem victoriam,” dicit Deus,
 “multis,
 Stulti michi gloriam non darent, sed
 stultis.”
 Sic si Deus fortibus vincere dedisset,
 Vulgus laudem talibus non Deo dedisset.
 Ex hiis potest elici quod non timuerunt
 Deum viri bellici, unde nil fecerunt
 Quod suam constantiam vel fidelitatem
 Probet, sed superbiam et crudelitatem;
 Volentes confundere partem 130
 quam spreverunt,
 Exeuntes temere cito corruerunt.
 Cordis exaltatio præparat ruinam,
 Et humiliatio meretur divinam
 Dari sibi gratiam; nam qui non confidit
 De Deo, superbiam Deus hanc elidit.
 Aman introducimus atque Mardocheum;
 Hunc superbum legimus, hunc verum
 Judæum;
 Lignum quod paraverat Aman
 Mardocheo,
 Mane miser tollerat suspensus in eo.
 Reginæ convivium Aman 140
 excœcavit,
 Quod ut privilegium magnum reputavit;
 Sed spes vana vertitur in confusionem,
 Cum post mensam trahitur ad
 suspensionem.
 Sic extrema gaudii luctus occupavit,
 Cum finem convivii morti sociavit.
 Longe dissimiliter accidit Judæo,
 Honorat sublimiter quem rex, dante Deo.

Very differently, it happens, to the Israelite, whom, by God's will, the king honours. Goliath is overthrown by the stroke of a little stone; [150] nothing profits him whom God pursues. Add to the various reasons already mentioned, that the stinking bawds collected with them so many strumpets, amounting to seven hundred, which they ought to have known to be fraudulent persons, disciples of Satan to deceive men's souls, and matches to set them on fire, treacherous scissars to cut the hairs of Samson, inflicting the stains of base action on the wretches who are not strong in heart, [160] nor made firm by the grace of the divine gift, but animals dedicated to the lust of the flesh, by the uncleanness of which, reduced to the level of brutes, they ought not to be worthy of victory, who grovelled in the foul luxury of the flesh; they diminish their strength in the stews which they had made, therefore they were unworthy of the attributes of knights. A knight is girt on the thigh with a sword, that it may not be ungirt, and that vile deeds should be eschewed; the body of a new knight is accustomed to be bathed, [170] in order that he may learn to be clean from unlawful deeds. They who had newly married lawful wives, were not fit for the Lord's warfare, as the battle of Gideon witnesseth, much less those whom the furnace of luxury hath injured with its fire. Why then should God help adulterers, and not rather strengthen clean children? Let them be clean who desire to conquer in fighting; they who vanquish their faults are in the way to triumph; first let them conquer their vices, [180] who wish with justice to have the victory over sinners. If the just man seems sometimes to be vanquished by the impious man, on the contrary he should be reputed the conqueror; for neither can the just man be vanquished, nor the unjust man conquer while he is

Golias prosternitur projectu lapilli;
Quem Deus persequitur, nichil prodest
illi. 150

Ad prædictas varias adde rationes,
Quod tot fornicarias fætidæ lenones
Ad se convocaverant, usque septingentas,
Quas scire debuerant esse fraudulentas,
Sathanæ discipulas ad decipiendas
Animas, et faculas ad has incendendas,
Dolosas novaculas ad crines Samsonis
Radendos, et maculas turpis actionis
Inferentes miseris qui non sunt cordati,
Nec divini muneris gratia firmati,
Carnis desideriis animales 160
dati,

Cujus immunditiis, brutis comparati,
Esse ne victoria digni debuerunt,
Qui carnis luxuria fœda sorduerunt:
Factis lupanaribus robur minuerunt,
Unde militaribus indigni fuerunt.
Accingitur gladio super femur miles,
Absit dissolutio, absint actus viles;
Corpus novi militis solet balneari,
Ut a factis vetitis discat emundari.
Qui de novo duxerant uxores 170
legales,

Domini non fuerant apti bello tales,
Gedeonis prelio teste, multo minus
Quos luxur incendio læserat caminus.
Igitur adulteros cur Deus juvaret,
Et non magis pueros mundos roboraret?
Mudentur qui cupiunt vincere
pugnando;
Qui culpas subjiunt sunt in
triumphando;
Primo vincant vitia, qui volunt victores

the enemy of the law.

Listen to the equity of Earl Simon: when the royal party would be satisfied only with his head and his life, nor would allow his head to be redeemed, but would have it cut off, by whose confusion they hoped the body of the people should be confounded, [190] and the greatest part of the state brought into danger, so that the most grievous ruin would immediately follow;—may it be very long before this happen!—Stephen, by divine grace, bishop of Chichester, groaning deeply for the immense evils which were then impending, (without exaggeration,) the two parties being persuaded to treat of a peace, received this answer from the Earl: “Choose the best men, who have a lively faith, [200] who have read the decretals, or who have taught, in a becoming manner, theology and sacred wisdom, and who know how to rule the Christian faith, whatever they may resolve by sound doctrine, or whatever they may have the courage to decree, they shall find us ready to agree to what they shall dictate, in such a manner as that we may escape the stigma of perjury, and keep the league as children of God.” Hence it may easily be understood by those who swear, and show little reluctance to despise what they swear, receding quickly from it although they swear to what is right, [210] and not rendering whole what they have promised to God, with how much care they ought to keep their oath, when they see a man neither avoiding torment nor death on account of his oath, which was made not inconsiderately, but for the reformation of the fallen state of the English nation, which the fraud of an inveterate enemy had violated. Behold Simon, obedient, despises the loss of property, submitting himself to punishment, rather than desert the truth, proclaiming to all men openly by his deeds more than by his

Esse cum justitia super peccatores.
 Si justus ab impio 180
 quandoque videtur
 Victus, e contrario victor reputetur;
 Nam nec justus poterit vinci, nec iniquus
 Vincere dum fuerit juris inimicus.
 Æquitatem comitis Symonis audite:
 Cum pars regis capitis ipsius et vitæ
 Solam pœnam quæreret, nec
 redemptionem
 Capitis admitteret, sed abscisionem,
 Quo confuso plurima plebs
 confunderetur,
 Et pars regni maxima periclitaretur,
 Ruina gravissima statim 190
 sequeretur;
 Quæ mora longissima non repareretur!
 .S. divina gratia præsul Cycestrensis,
 Alta dans suspiria pro malis immensis
 Jam tunc imminentibus, sine fictione,
 Persüasis partibus de formatione
 Pacis, hoc a Comite responsum audivit:
 “Optimos eligite, quorum fides vivit,
 Qui decreta legerint, vel theologiam
 Decenter docuerint sacramque sophiam,
 Et qui sciant regere fidem 200
 Christianam;
 Quicquidque consulere per doctrinam
 sanam
 Quicquidve discernere tales non
 timebunt,
 Quod dicent, suscipere promptos nos
 habebunt;
 Ita quod perjurii notam nesciamus,
 Sed ut Dei filii fidem teneamus.”
 Hinc possunt perpendere facile jurantes,

openly by his deeds more than by his words, [220] that truth has nothing in common with falsehood. Woe to the perjured wretches who fear not God! denying him for the prospect of an earthly reward, or for fear of imprisonment or light punishment; the new leader of the journey teaches to bear all that the world may inflict on account of truth, for it is this which can give perfect liberty. For the Earl had first pledged his oath that whatever the zeal of the wise had provided for the reformation of the King's honour, [230] and for the repression of wandering error, at Oxford, he would steadfastly keep it, and would not change the law then ordained, knowing that such canonical constitutions, and such catholic ordinances for the pacific conservation of the kingdom, on account of which he had before sustained no slight persecution, were not to be despised; and because he had sworn to hold them firmly, unless the most perfect doctors of the faith should say, [240] that the jurators might be absolved, who had before taken such oath, and that no further account was to be made of what they had sworn. Which, when the said bishop recited to the king, and perhaps the artificer of fraud was standing by, the voice of the crowd of arrogant courtiers was raised high, “See now the soldier is to give way to the sayings of clerks! The military order subjected to clerks is debased!” Thus the wisdom of the Earl was despised; and Edward is said to have answered thus: [250] “They shall have no peace unless they all put halters about their necks, and deliver themselves up to us to be hanged, or to be drawn.” What wonder if the Earl's heart was then moved, when nothing but the pain of the stake was prepared for him? He offered what he ought to do, but he was not listened to; the king rejected measure, forgetting what was

Et quod jurant spernere parum dubitantes,
 Quamvis jurent licita, cito recedentes,
 Deoque pollicita sana non reddentes,
 Quanta cura debeant suum 210
 juramentum
 Servare, cum videant virum nec
 tormentum
 Neque mortem fugere propter
 jusjurandum,
 Præstitum non temere, sed ad
 reformandum
 Statum qui deciderat Anglicanæ gentis,
 Quem fraus violaverat hostis invidentis.
 En Symon obediens spernit dampna
 rerum,
 Pœnis se subjiciens, ne dimittat verum,
 Cunctis palam prædicans factis plus
 quam dictis,
 Quod non est communicans veritas cum
 fictis. 220
 Væ perjuris miseris, qui non timent
 Deum!
 Spe terreni muneris abnegantes eum,
 Vel timore carceris, sive pœnæ levis;
 Novus dux itineris docet ferre quævis
 Quæ mundus intulerit propter veritatem,
 Quæ perfectam poterit dare libertatem.
 Nam Comes præstiterat prius
 juramentum,
 Quod quicquid providerat zelus
 sapientum
 Ad honoris regii reformationem,
 Et erroris devii declinationem,
 Partibus Oxoniæ, firmiter 230
 servaret,
 Hujusque sententiæ legem non mutaret;

rejected measure, forgetting what was good for him. But, as the event of the matter next day taught him, the measure which he then refused, afterwards was not to be had. In the evening was derided the Earl's devotion, [260] the shock of which, next day, was found to be victorious. This stone, long rejected from the doorway, was afterwards fitted to the two walls. The division of England was on the verge of desolation, but the corner-stone was there as a help to the division, the truly singular religion of Simon. The faith and fidelity of Simon alone becomes the security of the peace of all England; he humbles the rebellious, raises those who were in despair, [270] reconciling the kingdom, repressing the proud. And how does he repress them? certainly not by praising them; but he presses out the red juice in the hard conflict; for truth obliges him to fight, or to desert the truth, and prudently he chooses rather to devote his right hand to the truth, and by the rough way, which is joined to probity, by the harder and shorter way which is unpleasant to the proud, to obtain the reward which is given to those who use force, than to displease God by shrinking, [280] and to promote the designs of bad men by flight. For some men had studied to erase the name of the English, whom they had already begun to regard with hatred, against whom God opposed a medicine, since he did not desire their sudden ruin.

Hence let the English learn to call in strangers, if they wish to be exiled by strangers. For these when they wish to enlarge their own glory, and wish their own memory to stand always, study to associate with themselves very many of their own nation, [290] and by degrees to make them the principal nobles; and thus grows the confusion of the natives, with indignation and bitterness of heart, when the chief men of the kingdom feel

Sciens tam canonicas constitutiones
 Atque tam catholicas ordinationes
 Ad regni pacificam conservationem,
 Propter quas non modicam
 persecutionem
 Prius sustinuerat, non esse spernandas;
 Et quia juraverat fortiter tenendas,
 Nisi perfectissimi fidei doctores
 Dicerent, quod eximi possent juratores,
 Qui tale præstiterant prius 240
 jusjurandum,
 Et id quod juraverant non esse curandum.
 Quod cum dictus pontifex regi recitaret,
 Atque fraudis artifex forsitan astartet,
 Vox in altum tollitur turbæ tumidorum,
 “En jam miles subitur dictis clericorum!
 Viluit militia clericis subjecta!”
 Sic est sapientia Comitis despecta;
 Edwardusque dicitur ita respondisse,
 “Pax illis præcluditur, nisi laqueis se
 Collis omnes alligent, et ad 250
 suspendendum
 Semet nobis obligent, vel ad
 detrahendum.”
 Quid mirum si Comitibus cor tunc
 moveretur,
 Cum non nisi stipitis pœna pareretur?
 Optulit quod debuit, sed non est auditus;
 Rex mensuram respuit, salutis oblitus.
 Sed ut rei docuit crastinus eventus,
 Modus quem tunc noluit post non est
 inventus.
 Comitibus devotio sero deridetur,
 Cujus cras congressio victrix sentietur.
 Lapis hic ab hostibus diu 260
 reprobatus,

themselves to be beaten down by those who make themselves their equals, taking from them the things which ought to appertain to them, growing by the things by which they used to grow. The King ought to honour with escheats and wards his own people, who can help him in various ways, who, by as much as they are more powerful by their own strength, [300] are so much the more secure in all cases. But those who have brought nothing, if they are enriched by his goods, if they are made great who were of no account, such men, when they begin to grow, always go on climbing till they have supplanted the natives; they study to avert the prince's heart from his own people, that they may strip of glory those whose ruin they are seeking. And who could bear such things patiently? Therefore let England learn prudently to have a care, lest such a perplexity should happen any more, [310] lest such an adversity should fall upon the English. The Earl studied to obviate this, because it had gained too much head, like a great sea, that could not be dried by a small effort, but must be forded by a great assistance from God. Let strangers come to return quickly, like men of a moment, but not to remain. One of the two hands aids the other, neither of them bearing more really the grace which belongs to both; let it help, and not injure, by retaining its place. [320] Each thing would avail its own possessor if they come so; the Frenchman by doing good to the Englishman, and not seducing by a flattering face, nor the one withdrawing the goods of the other; but rather by sustaining his own portion of the burden. If his own interest had moved the Earl, he would neither have had any other zeal, nor would he have sought with all his power for the reformation of the kingdom, but he would have aimed at power, he would have sought his own

Post est parietibus duobus aptatus.
 Angliæ divisio desolationis
 Fuit in confinio, sed divisionis
 Affuit præsidio lapis angularis,
 Symonis religio sane singularis.
 Fides et fidelitas Symonis solius
 Fit pacis integritas Angliæ totius;
 Rebelles humiliat, levat desperatos,
 Regnum reconsilians, reprimens elatos.
 Quos quo modo reprimat? 270
 certe non laudando,
 Sed rubrum jus exprimit dure
 confligendo;
 Ipsum nam conflare veritas coegit,
 Vel verum deserere, sed prudens elegit
 Magis dare dexteram suam veritati,
 Viamque per asperam junctam probitati,
 Per grave compendium tumidis ingratum,
 Optinere bravium violentis datum,
 Quam per subterfugium Deo displicere,
 Pravorumque studium fuga promovere.
 Nam quidam studuerant 280
 Anglorum delere
 Nomen, quos jam cæperant exosos
 habere,
 Contra quos opposuit Deus medicinam,
 Ipsorum cum noluit subitam ruinam.
 Hinc alienigenas discant advocare
 Angli, si per advenas volunt exulare.
 Nam qui suam gloriam volunt ampliare,
 Suamque memoriam vellent semper
 stare,
 Suæ gentis plurimos sibi sociari,
 Et mox inter maximos student collocare;
 Itaque confusio crescit 290
 incolarum,

promotion only, and made his first object the promotion of his friends, [330] and would have aimed at enriching his children, and would have neglected the weal of the community, and would have covered the poison of falsehood with the cloak of duplicity, and would thus have deserted the faith of Christianity, and would have subjected himself to the retribution of fearful punishment, nor would he have escaped the weight of the tempest, And who can believe that he would give himself to death, that he would sacrifice his friends, in order that he might thus raise himself high? If those who hunt after honour cover their object cunningly; [340] always meditating at the same time how they may avoid death; none love more the present life, none choose more eagerly a position devoid of danger. They who thirst after honours dissimulate their aim, they make themselves cautiously the reputation which they seek. Not so the venerable Simon de Montfort, who, like Christ, offers himself a sacrifice for many; Isaac does not die, although he is ready for death; it is the ram which is given to death, and Isaac receives honour. Neither fraud nor falsehood promoted the Earl, [350] but the Divine grace which knew those whom it would help. If you consider the time and the place of the conflict, you will find that they promised him a defeat rather than victory; but God provided that he should not succumb. He does not take them on a sudden by creeping stealthily by night; but he fights openly when day is come. So also the place was favourable to his enemies, that thus it might appear plainly to all to be the gift of God, that victory departed from him who put his trust in himself. [360] Hence let the military order, which praises the practice of the tournament, that so it may be made expert at fighting, learn

Crescit indignatio, crescit cor amarum,
Cum se premi sentiunt regni principales
Ab hiis qui se faciunt sibi coæquales,
Quæ sua debuerant esse subtrahentes,
Quibus consüeverant crescere,
crescentes.

Eschaetis et gardiis suos honorare
Debet rex, qui variis modis se juvare
Possunt, qui quo viribus sunt valentiores,
Eo cunctis casibus sunt securiores.
Sed qui nil attulerant, si suis 300
ditantur,
Qui nullius fuerant, si magnificantur,
Crescere cum ceperint, semper scandunt
tales

Donec supplantaverint viros naturales;
Principis avertere cor a suis student,
Ut quos volunt cadere gloria denudent.
Et quis posset talia ferre patienter?
Ergo discat Anglia cavere prudenter,
Ne talis perplexitas amplius contingat,
Ne talis adversitas Anglicos inpingat.
Hüic malo studuit comes 310
obviare,

Quod nimis invaluit quasi magnum mare,
Quod parvo conamine nequibat siccari,
Sed magno juvamine Dei transvadari.
Veniant extranei cito recessuri,
Quasi momentanei, sed non permansuri.
Una juvat aliam manuum duarum,
Neutra tollens gratiam verius earum;
Juvet et non noceat locum retinendo.
Quæque suum valeat ita veniendo;
Gallicus ad Anglicum 320
benefaciendo.

Et non per sophisticum vultum

how the party of the strong and skilful was here bruised by the arms of those who were feeble and unpractised: that he may confound the strong, God promotes the weak, comforts the feeble, lays prostrate the firm. Thus let no one now presume to trust in himself; but if he know how to place his hope in God, he may take up arms with constancy, nothing doubting, [370] since God is a help for those who are on the side of justice. Thus it was right that God should help the Earl, for without God he could not overcome the enemy. Of whom should I call him the enemy?—of the Earl alone? or should I recognise him as the enemy of the English and of the whole kingdom?—perhaps also of the Church, and therefore of God? And if so, how much grace ought he to have? He failed to deserve grace who trusted in himself, and he did not merit to be helped who did not fear God. Thus falls the boast of personal valour, [380] and so for evermore praised be the Lord God of vengeance! who gives aid to those who are destitute of force, to a few against many, crushing fools by the valour of the faithful; who sits on a throne in heaven above, and by his own strength treads upon the necks of the proud, bowing the great under the feet of the less. He has subdued two kings and the heirs of kings, whom he has made captives, because they were transgressors of the laws; and he has turned to shame the pomp of knighthood with its numerous retinue; [390] for the barons employed on the sons of pride the arms, which, in their zeal for justice, they had taken up in the cause of the kingdom, until victory was given them from heaven, with a great glory that was not expected. For the bow of the strong was then overcome, and the troop of the weak was established with strength; and we have said that it was done by heaven, lest any one should boast of it;

seducendo,
 Nec alter alterius bona subtrahendo;
 Immo suum potius onus sustinendo.
 Commodum si proprium comitem
 movisset,
 Nec haberet alium zelum, nec quæsisset
 Toto suo studio reformationi
 Regni, sed intentio dominationi,
 Solam suam quæreret, et promotionem
 Suorum proponerat, ad ditationem
 Filiorum tenderet, et 330
 communitatis
 Salutem negligeret, ac duplicitatis
 Palli[o] supponeret virus falsitatis;
 Sic fidem relinqueret Christianitatis,
 Et horrendæ subderet se pœnalitatis
 Legi, nec effugeret pondus tempestatis.
 Et quis potest credere quod se morti
 daret,
 Suos vellet perdere, ut sic exaltaret?
 Callide si palliant honorem venantes;
 Et quod mortem fugiant semper
 meditantes; 340
 Nulli magis diligunt vitam temporalem,
 Nulli magis eligunt statum non mortalem.
 Honores qui sitiunt simulate tendunt,
 Caute sibi faciunt nomen quod intendunt;
 Non sic venerabilis .S. de Monte-forti,
 Qui se Christo similis dat pro multis
 morti;
 Ysaac non moritur cum sit promptus
 mori;
 Vervex morti traditur, Ysaac honori.
 Nec fraus nec fallacia Comitem
 promovit,
 Sed divina gratia, quæ quos juvet novit.

let all the honour, on the contrary, be
 given to Christ, in whom we believe!
 For Christ at once commands, conquers,
 reigns! [400] Christ delivers his own, to
 whom he has given his promise. We
 pray God to grant that the minds of the
 conquerors may not attribute their
 success to themselves, and let what Paul
 says be observed by them, "He who
 would be joyful, let him be joyful in
 God." If any one of us indulge in vain
 glory, may God be indulgent to him, and
 not angry! and may he make our party
 cautious in future; lest deeds be
 wanting, may they make themselves a
 wall! May the power of the Almighty
 perfect what it has begun, [410] and
 restore to its vigour the kingdom of the
 English people! that glory may be to
 himself, and peace to his elect, until
 they be in the country where he shall
 lead them. O Englishmen! read this
 concerning the battle of Lewes! by the
 influence of which you are saved from
 destruction: for if victory had gone over
 to those who are now vanquished, the
 memory of the English would have lain
 in disgrace.

To whom shall the noble Edward be
 compared? Perhaps he will be rightly
 called a leopard. If we divide the name,
 it becomes a lion and a pard:—[420] a
 lion, for we have seen that he was not
 slow to meet the strongest; fearing the
 attack of none; making a charge in the
 thick of the battle with the most
 unflinching bravery, and as though at
 his will, and wherever he went, as if,
 like Alexander, he would soon subdue
 the whole world, if the mutable wheel of
 Fortune would but stand still; in which,
 although he stand at the top, let him
 know that his fall is near at hand, and
 that he who reigns like a lord will not
 reign long. Which, in fact, has happened
 to the noble Edward, [430] who has
 manifestly fallen from his unstable
 position. He is a lion by his pride and by

Horam si vocaveris locum 350
 que conflictus,
 Invenire poteris quod ut esset victus
 Potius quam vinceret illi conferebat;
 Sed ut non succumberet Deus providebat.
 Non de nocte subito surripit latenter;
 Immo die redito pugnat evidenter.
 Sic et locus hostibus fuit oportunus,
 Ut hinc constet omnibus esse Dei munus,
 Quod cessit victoria de se confidenti.
 Hinc discat militia, quæ torneamenti
 Laudat exercitium, ut sic 360
 expedita
 Reddatur ad prælium, qualiter contrita
 Fuit hic pars fortium exercitatorum,
 Armis imbecillium et inexpertorum:
 Ut confundet fortia, promovet infirmos,
 Confortat debilia Deus, sternit firmos.
 Sic nemo confidere de se jam præsumat;
 Sed in Deum ponere spem si sciat, sumat
 Arma cum constantia, nichil dubitando,
 Cum sit pro justitia Deus adjuvando.
 Sicque Deum decuit 370
 Comitem juvare,
 Sine quo non potuit hostem superare.
 Cujus hostem dixerim? Comitibus solius?
 Vel Anglorum sciverim regni que totius?
 Forsan et ecclesiæ, igitur et Dei?
 Quod si sic, quid gratiæ; conveniret ei?
 Gratiam demeruit in se confidendo,
 Nec juvari debuit Deum non timendo.
 Cadit ergo gloria propriæ virtutis;
 Et sic in memoria, qui dat destitutis
 Viribus auxilium, paucis 380
 contra multos,
 Virtute fidelium conterendo stultos,

position. He is a lion by his pride and by his ferocity; by his inconstancy and changeableness he is a pard, not holding steadily his word or his promise, and excusing himself with fair words. When he is in a difficulty, he promises just what you will; but as soon as he has escaped the danger, he forgets his promise. Witness Gloucester, where, as soon as he was out of the difficulty, he revoked immediately what he had sworn. The treachery or falseness by which he gains his ends [440] he calls prudence; the way by which he arrives at his object, be it ever so crooked, is reputed to be straight; when wrong serves his purpose, it is called right; he calls lawful whatever he wills, and thinks himself absolved from the law, as though he were greater than a king: for every king is ruled by the laws which he enacts. King Saul was deposed, because he brake the laws; and we read that David was punished, as soon as he did contrary to the law; hence, therefore, let him who reads know, that he cannot reign who does not keep the law; [450] nor ought they, whose province it is to do so, to elect such a man for their king. O Edward! thou desirest to be made a king without law; they would be truly miserable who were ruled by such a king! For what is more just than law, by which all things are ruled? and what more true than justice, by which all things are administered? If thou wouldest have a kingdom, reverence the laws; they are but rough roads, which are opposed to law, rough and crooked roads which will not lead thee to thy journey's end; but if thou keepest the laws, they shine like a lamp. Therefore avoid and detest treachery; [460] labour after truth and hate falsehood. Although treachery may flourish, it cannot bear fruit; the Psalm may teach thee this; God says to the faithful of the earth, "They are my eyes, and it is my will that they shall sit with me at the end of

Benedictus dominus Deus ultionum!
 Qui in cœlis eminens sedet super thronum,
 Et virtute propria colla superbiorum
 Calcat, subdens grandia pedibus
 minorum.
 Duos reges subdidit et hæredes regum,
 Quos captivos reddidit transgressores
 legum,
 Pompamque militiæ cum magna sequela
 Dedit ignominia; nam barones tela
 Quæ zelo justitiæ pro regno 390
 sumpserunt,
 Filiis superbiæ communicaverunt,
 Usque dum victoria de cœlo dabatur,
 Cum ingenti gloria quæ non sperabatur,
 Arcus namque fortium tunc est superatus,
 Cœtus inbecillum robore firmatus;
 Et de cœlo diximus, ne quis glorietur;
 Sed Christo quem credimus omnis honor
 detur!
 Christus enim imperat, vincit, regnat
 idem;
 Christus suos liberat, quibus dedit fidem.
 Ne victorum animus manus 400
 osculetur
 Suas, Deum petimus quod illis præstetur;
 Et quod Paulus suggerit ab ipsis servetur,
 "Qui lætatus fuerit, in Deo lætetur."
 Si quis nostrum gaudeat vane gloriatus,
 Dominus indulgeat, et non sit iratus!
 Et cautos efficiat nostros in futurum;
 Ne factum deficiat, faciant se murum!
 Quod cæpit perficiat vis omnipotentis,
 Regnumque reficiat Anglicanæ gentis!
 Ut sit sibi gloria, suis pax 410
 electis,

they shall sit with me at the end of time." Observe how little thou hast gained by thy treachery at Northampton; the heat of deceit does not warm like fire. If you will compare treachery to fire, feed studiously such fire with straw, which ceases to glow as soon as it is burnt up, [470] and is consumed almost as soon as kindled. So passeth away vanity which hath no roots; rooted truth is not subject to vicissitudes: therefore let that alone be permitted thee which is lawful, and let not what the double man shall say please thee. A prince shall project things which are worthy of a prince: therefore take the law under thy protection, which will make thee worthy to govern many, worthy of the principality, of the aid of many, and of a numerous retinue. And why lovest thou not those of whom thou desirest to be king? [480] Thou chooseth not to profit them, but only to govern. He who seeks only his own glory, everything that he governs is ruined by his pride. Thus recently the whole which thou governest has been ruined; the glory which alone thou soughtest is past.

Lo! we are touching the root of the perturbation of the kingdom of which we are speaking, and of the dissension of the parties who fought the said battle. The objects at which these two parties aimed were different. The king, with his, wished thus to be free: [490] and so [it was urged on his side] he ought to be; and he must cease to be king, deprived of the rights of a king, unless he could do whatever he pleased; it was no part of the duty of the magnates of the kingdom to determine whom he should prefer to his earldoms, or on whom he should confer the custody of castles, or whom he would have to administer justice to the people, and to be chancellor and treasurer of the kingdom. He would have every one at his own

Donec sint in patria se duce provectis.
Hæc Angli de prælio legite Lewensi,
Cujus patrocínio vivitis defensi;
Quia si victoria jam victis cessisset,
Anglorum memoria victa viluisset.

Cui comparabitur nobilis Edwardus?
Forte nominabitur recte leopardus.
Si nomen dividimus, leo fit et pardus:
Leo, quia vidimus quod non fuit tardus
Aggredi fortissima, nullius 420
occursum

Timens, audacissima virtute discursum
Inter castra faciens, et velut ad votum
Ubi et proficiens, ac si mundum totum
Alexandro similis cito subjugaret
Si fortunæ mobilis rota semper staret;
In qua summus protinus sciat se casurum,
Qui regnat ut dominus parum
regnaturum.

Quod Edwardo nobili liquet accidisse,
Quem gradu non stabili constat cecidisse.
Leo per superbiam, per 430
ferocitatem;

Est per inconstantiam et varietatem
Pardus, verbum varians et promissionem,
Per placentem pallians se locutionem.
Cum in arcto fuerit quicquid vis
promittit;

Sed mox ut evaserit, promissum dimittit.
Testis sit Glovernia, ubi quod juravit
Liber ab angustia statim revocavit.
Dolum seu fallaciam quibus expeditur
Nominat prudentiam; via qua venit
Quo vult quamvis devia recta 440
reputatur;

Nefas det placentia, fasque nominatur;

will, and counsellors from whatever nation he chose, [500] and all ministers at his own discretion; while the barons of England are not to interfere with the king's actions, the command of the prince having the force of law, and what he may dictate binding upon every body at his pleasure. For every earl also is thus his own master, giving to every one of his own men both as much as he will, and to whom he will; he commits castles, lands, revenues, to whom he will; and although he be a subject, the king permits it all. Which, if he do well, is profitable to the doer; [510] if not, he must himself see to it; the king will not hinder him from injuring himself. Why is the prince worse in condition, when the affairs of the baron, the knight, and the freeman, are thus managed? Therefore they aim at making the king a slave, who wish to diminish his power, to take away his dignity of prince; they wish by sedition to reduce captive into guardianship and subjection the royal power, and to disinherit the king, [520] that he shall be unable to reign so fully as hitherto have done the kings who preceded him, who were in no respect subjected to their people, but administered their own affairs at their will, and conferred what they had to confer according to their own pleasure. This is the King's argument, which has an appearance of fairness, and this is alleged in defence of the right of the kingdom.

But now let my pen turn to the other side:—let me describe the object at which the barons aim; and when both sides have been heard, let the arguments be compared, [530] and then let us come to a final judgment, so that it may be clear which side is the truest. The people is more prone to obey the truer party. Let therefore the party of the barons speak for itself, and proclaim in order by what zeal it is led. Which party

Quicquid libet licitum dicit, et a lege
Se putat explicitum, quasi major rege.
Nam rex omnis regitur legibus quas legit;
Rex Saül repellitur, quia leges fregit;
Et punitus legitur David mox ut egit
Contra legem; igitur hinc sciat qui legit,
Quod non potest regere qui non servat
legem;

Nec hunc debent facere ad quos spectat
regem. 450

O Edwarde! fieri vis rex, sine lege;
Vere forent miseri recti tali rege!
Nam quid lege rectius qua cuncta
reguntur,

Et quid jure verius quo res discernuntur?
Si regnum desideras, leges venerare;
Vias dabit asperas leges impugnare,
Asperas et invias quæ te non perducent;
Leges si custodias ut lucerna lucent.
Ergo dolum caveas et abomineris;
Veritati studeas, falsum detesteris.

Quamvis dolus floreat, 460
fructus nequit ferre;

Hoc te psalmus doceat; ad fideles terræ
Dicit Deus, "Oculi mei sunt, sedere
Quos in fine seculi mecum volo vere."
Dolus Northamptoniæ vide quid nunc
valet;

Nec fervor fallaciæ velut ignis calet.
Si dolum volueris igni comparare,
Paleas studueris igni tali dare,
Quæ mox, ut exarserint, desistunt ardere,
Et cum vix inceperint terminum tenere.
Ita transit vanitas non habens 470
radices;

Radicata veritas non mutat per vices.

in the first place protests openly, that it has no designs against the kingly honour; nay, it seeks the contrary, and studies to reform and magnify the kingly condition; just as if the kingdom were ravaged by enemies, [540] then it would not be reformed without the barons, who would be the capable and proper persons for this purpose; and should any one then hang back, the law would punish him as one guilty of perjury, a traitor to the king, who owes to his lord, when he is in danger, all the aid he can give to support the king's honour, when the kingdom is as it were nigh its end by devastation.

The adversaries of the king are enemies who make war upon him, and counsellors who flatter the king, who seduce their prince with deceitful words, [550] and who lead him into error by their double tongues: these are adversaries worse than those who are perverse; it is these who pretend to be good whilst they are seducers, and procurers of their own advancement; they deceive the incautious, whom they render less on their guard by means of things that please them, whereby they are not provided against, but are considered as prudent advisers. Such men can deceive more than those who act openly, as they are able to make an outward appearance of being not hostile. What if such wretches, and such liars, [560] should haunt the prince, capable of all malice, of fraud, of falsehood, excited by the spurs of envy, should seek to do that extreme wickedness, by which they should sacrifice the privileges of the kingdom to their own ostentation, that they should contrive all kinds of hard reasons, which by degrees should confound the commonalty, should bruise and impoverish the mass of the people, and should subvert and infatuate the kingdom, so that no one

Ergo tibi libeat id solum quod licet,
Et non tibi placeat quod vir duplex dicet.
Princeps quæ sunt principe digna
cogitabit:

Ergo legem suscipe, quæ te dignum dabit
Multorum regimine, dignum principatu,
Multorum juvamine, multo comitatu.

Et quare non diligis quorum rex vis esse?
Prodesse non eligis, sed tantum præesse.

Qui nullius gloriam nisi 480
suam quærit,

Ejus per superbiam quicquid regit, perit.
Ita totum periit nuper quod regebas;

Gloria præteriit quam solam quærebas;

En radicem tangimus perturbationis
Regni de quo scribimus, et dissentionis
Partium quæ prælium dictum
commiserunt.

Ad diversa studium suum converterunt.

Rex cum suis voluit ita liber esse;

Et sic esse debuit, fuitque necesse

Aut esse desineret rex, 490
privatus jure

Regis, nisi faceret quicquid vellet; curæ
Non esse magnatibus regni, quos
præferret

Suis comitatibus, vel quibus conferret
Castrorum custodiam, vel quem exhibere

Populo justitiam vellet, et habere

Regni cancellarium thesaurariumque.

Suum ad arbitrium voluit quemcumque,

Et consiliarios de quacumque gente,

Et ministros varios se præcipiente,

Non intromittentibus se de 500
factis regis

Angliæ baronibus, vim habente legis

could obtain justice, [570] except ne who would encourage the pride of such men as these by large supplies of money; who could submit to the establishment of such an injury? And if such, by their conduct, should change the state of the kingdom; if they should banish justice to put injustice in its place; if they should call in strangers and trample upon the natives; and if they should subdue the kingdom to foreigners; if they should not care for the magnates and nobles of the land, and should place contemptible persons over them; and if they should overthrow and humiliate the great; [580] if they should pervert and turn upside-down the order of things; if they should leave the measures that are best, to advance those which are worst;—do not those who act thus devastate the kingdom? although they do not make war upon it with arms from abroad, yet they fight with diabolical arms, and they violate, in a lamentable manner, the constitution of the kingdom; although not in the same manner [as a foreign enemy], yet they do no less damage. Whether the king, seduced to give his consent, not perceiving the design, should approve measures so destructive to the kingdom; [590] or whether the king should follow such an injurious course with an ill design of setting his own power above the laws, abusing his strength to please his own will; if thus or otherwise the kingdom be wasted, or the kingdom be finally left destitute, then the magnates of the kingdom are bound to look to it, that the land be purged of all errors. To whom if such a purgation of errors belongs, if such a provision belongs to them to regulate customs, how can it otherwise than appertain to them [600] to look out that no evil may happen which would be injurious? Which, after it has happened, they ought to remove, lest by a sudden occurrence it give those

Principis imperio, et quod imperaret
 Suomet arbitrio singulos ligaret.
 Nam et comes quilibet sic est compos sui,
 Dans suorum quidlibet quantum vult et
 cui
 Castra, terras, redditus, cui vult
 committit,
 Et quamvis sit subditus, rex totum
 permittit.
 Quod si bene fecerit, prodest facienti;
 Si non, ipse viderit, sibimet nocenti
 Rex non adversabitur. Cur 510
 conditionis
 Pejoris efficitur princeps, si baronis,
 Militis, et liberi res ita tractantur?
 Quare regem fieri servum machinantur,
 Qui suam minuere volunt potestatem,
 Principis adimere suam dignitatem,
 Volunt in custodiam et subjectionem
 Regiam potentiam per seditionem
 Captivam retrudere, et exhæredare
 Regem, ne tam ubere valeat regnare
 Sicut reges hactenus qui se 520
 præcesserunt,
 Qui suis nullatenus subjecti fuerunt,
 Sed suas ad libitum res distribuerunt,
 Et ad suum placitum sua contulerunt.
 Hæc est regis ratio, quæ vera videtur,
 Et hæc allegatio jus regni tuetur.

Sed nunc ad oppositum calamus
 vertatur:—

Baronum propositum dictis subjungatur;
 Et auditis partibus dicta conferantur,
 Atque certis finibus collata claudantur,
 Ut quæ pars sit verior valeat 530
 liquere.

who do not provide against it cause to
 grieve. Thus, in order that no one of the
 aforesaid things may happen, which
 may hinder the form of peace and good
 customs, but that the zeal of the
 experienced men may find what is most
 expedient for the utility of the many,
 why is a reform not admitted, with
 which no corruption shall be mixed? For
 the king's clemency and the king's
 majesty [610] ought to approve the
 endeavours, which so amend grievous
 laws that they be milder, and that they
 be, while less onerous, more pleasing to
 God. For the oppression of the
 commons pleaseth not God, but rather
 the commiseration whereby the
 commons may have time to think upon
 God. Pharaoh, who so afflicted the
 people of God, that they could with
 difficulty repair to the oracle which he
 had appointed to Moses, was afterwards
 so punished, that he was obliged to
 dismiss Israel against his will; and when
 he thought to catch them after they were
 dismissed, [620] he was drowned whilst
 he thought to run through the deep.
 Solomon was unwilling to bruise Israel,
 nor would he reduce to servitude any
 one of the race; because he knew that it
 was God's people over whom he
 reigned; and he feared to hurt the
 imprint of God; and he praises mercy
 more than judgment, and the peace of a
 true father more than execution.

Since it is clear that the barons have a
 right of doing all this, it remains to
 answer the king's arguments. The king
 wishes to be free by the removal of his
 guardians, [630] and he will not be
 subject to his inferiors, but be placed
 over them; he will command his
 subjects and not be commanded; he will
 be humiliated neither to himself nor to
 those who are his officers. For the
 officers are not set over the king; but on
 the contrary they are rather the noble
 men who support the law. Otherwise

Veriori promor populus parere.
 Baronum pars igitur jam pro se loquatur,
 Et quo zelo ducitur rite prosequatur.
 Quæ pars in principio palam protestatur,
 Quod honori regio nichil machinatur;
 Vel quærit contrarium, immo reformare
 Studet statum regium et magnificare;
 Sicut si ab hostibus regnum vastaretur,
 Non sine baronibus tune reformaretur,
 Quibus hoc competeret atque 540
 conveniret;
 Et qui tunc se fingeret, ipsum lex puniret
 Ut reum perjurii, regis proditorem,
 Qui quicquid auxilii regis ad honorem
 Potest, debet domino cum periclitatur,
 Cum velut in termino regnum deformatur.
 Regis adversarii sunt hostes bellantes,
 Et consilarii regi adulantes,
 Qui verbis fallacibus principem seducunt,
 Linguisque duplicibus in errorem ducunt:
 Hii sunt adversarii perversis 550
 peiores;
 Hii se bonos faciunt cum sint seductores,
 Et honoris proprii sunt procuratores;
 Incautos decipiunt, quos securiores
 Reddunt per placentia, unde non
 caventur,
 Sed velut utilia dicentes censentur.
 Hii possunt decipere plusquam manifesti,
 Qui se sciunt fingere velut non infesti.
 Quid si tales miseri, talesque mendaces,
 Adhærerent lateri principis, capaces
 Totius malitiæ, fraudis, 560
 falsitatis,
 Stimulis invidiæ puncti, pravitatis
 Facinus exquirere, per quod regni jura

there would not be one king of one state, (?) but they would reign equally to whom the king was subject. Yet this inconvenience also, though it seem so great, with the assistance of God, is easily solved: for we believe that God wills truth, [640] through whom we dissolve this doubt as follows. He is said to be, and is in truth, one king alone, by whom the universe is ruled in pure majesty; who neither wants help whereby he may reign, nor even counsel, in as much as he cannot err. Therefore, all-powerful and all-knowing, he excels in infinite glory all those to whom he has given to rule and, as it were, to reign under him over his people, who may fail, and who may err, and who cannot avail by their own independent strength, [650] and vanquish their enemies by their own valour, nor govern kingdoms by their own wisdom, but in an evil manner wander in the track of error. They want help which should assist them, and counsel which should set them right. Says the king, "I agree to thy reasoning; but the choice of these must be left to my option; I will associate with myself whom I will, by whose support I will govern all things; and if my ministers should be insufficient, [660] if they want sense or power, or if they harbour evil designs, or are not faithful, but are perhaps traitors, I desire that you will explain, why I ought to be confined to certain persons, when I might succeed in obtaining better assistance?" The reason of this is quickly declared, if it be considered what the constraint of the king is: all constraint does not deprive of liberty, nor does every restriction take away power. Princes desire free power; [670] those who reign decline miserable servitude. To what will a free law bind kings?—to prevent them from being stained by an adulterated law. And this constraint is not one of slavery, but is

Ad suas inflecterent pompas, quæque
dura

Argumenta fingerent, quæ communitatem
Paulatim confunderent, universitatem
Populi contererent et depauperarent,
Regnumque subverterent et infatuarent,
Quod nullus justitiam posset optinere,
Nisi qui superbiam talium fovere
Vellet, per pecuniam largiter 570
collatam;

Quis tantam injuriam sustineret ratam?
Et si tales studiis suis immutarent
Regnum, ut injuriis jura supplantarent;
Calcatis indigenis advenas vocarent;
Et alienigenis regnum subjugarent:
Magnates et nobiles terne non curarent,
Atque contemptibiles in summo locarent;
Et magnos dejicerent et humiliarent;
Ordinem perverterent et præposterarent;
Optima relinquerent, 580
pessimis instarent;

Nonne qui sic facerent regnum
devastarent?

Quamvis armis bellicis foris non
pugnarent,

Tamen diabolicis armis dimicarent,
Et regni flebiliter statum violarent;

Quamvis dissimiliter, non minus
dampnarent.

Sive rex consentiens per seductionem,
Talem non percipiens circumventionem,
Approbaret talia regni destructiva;
Seu rex ex malitia faceret nociva,
Proponendo legibus suam 590
potestatem,

Abutendo viribus propter facultatem;

rather an enlarging of the kingly faculty. Thus the king's child is kept from being hurt; yet he is not made a slave when he is thus restricted. Nay, the very angels are restricted in this manner, who are confirmed from becoming apostates. For, that the Author of all things cannot err, [680] that He who is the beginning of all things cannot sin, is not impotence, but it is the highest degree of power, the great glory of God and his great majesty. Thus, he who may fall, if he be kept from falling, so that he may live free from danger, he reaps advantage from such keeping, nor is such a support slavery, but it is the safeguard of virtue. Therefore that there be permitted to a king all that is good, but that he dare not do evil,—this is God's gift. They who keep the king from sinning when he is tempted, [690] they serve the king, to whom he should be grateful, that they deliver him from being made a slave; so that those by whom he is led do not overcome him. But he who should be in truth a king, he is truly free if he rule rightly himself and the kingdom; let him know that all things are permitted him which are in ruling convenient to the kingdom, but not such as destroy it. It is one thing to rule according to a king's duty, and another to destroy by resisting the law. The law receives its name from binding (*a ligando*), [700] which is so perfectly said of liberty, whereby it is served gratefully. (?)

Let every king bear in mind that he is a servant of God; let him love that only which is pleasing to Him; and let him seek His glory in reigning, not his own pride in despising his peers. A king who wishes his subject kingdom to yield obedience to him, let him render his duty to God in other things truly; let him know that obedience is not owing to him who denies the service in which he is bound to God. Again, let him know

Quia Dei populum scivit quem regebat,
Et Dei signaculum lædere timebat;
Et plusquam iudicium laudat misereri,
Et plusquam supplicium pacem patri[s]
veri.

Cum constat baronibus hæc cuncta
licere,
Restat rationibus regis respondere.
Amotis custodibus vult rex liber esse,
Subdique minoribus non vult sed
præesse; 630
Imperare subditis et non imperari;
Sibi nec præpositis vult humiliari.
Non enim præpositi regi præponuntur;
Immo magis incliti qui jus supponuntur.
Unius rex aliter unicus non esset,
Sed regnarent pariter quibus rex subesset.
Et hoc inconueniens quod tantum videtur,
Sit Deus subueniens, facile solvetur.
Deum namque credimus velle veritatem,
Per quem sic dissolvimus hanc
dubietatem. 640

Unus solus dicitur et est rex revera,
Per quem mundus regitur maiestate mera;
Non egens auxilio quo possit regnare,
Sed neque consilio qui nequit errare.
Ergo potens omnia sciensque præcedit
Infinita gloria omnes quibus dedit
Sub se suos regere quasique regnare,
Qui possunt deficere, possunt et errare,
Et qui suis viribus nequeunt præstare,
Suisque virtutibus hostes expugnare,
Neque sensu proprio regna 650
gubernare,
Sed erroris invio male deviare.
Indigent auxilio sibi suffragante,

presumption, but it be truly so, then his instruction will visit the true hearts of his subjects with light, and will instruct his people with moderation.

We instance Moses, David, Samuel—each of whom we know to have been a faithful prince; who suffered many things from their subjects, [750] and yet for their deserts they did not cast them off, nor set strangers over them, but governed by means of those who were their own people. “I will place thee over a greater people; and I will slay this people” saith God. “I had rather die, than this people should perish,” answered kind Moses, who was worthy to govern. And thus a wise prince will never reject his people, but an unwise one will disturb the kingdom. Wherefore, if a king is less wise than he ought to be, [760] what advantage will the kingdom gain by his reign? Is he to seek by his own opinion on whom he should depend to have his failing supplied? If he alone choose, he will be easily deceived, who is not capable of knowing who will be useful. Therefore let the community of the kingdom advise; and let it be known what the generality thinks, to whom their own laws are best known. Nor are all those of the country so uninstructed, as not to know better than strangers the customs of their own kingdom, [770] which have been bequeathed from father to son. They who are ruled by the laws, know those laws best; they who experience them are best acquainted with them; and since it is their own affairs which are at stake, they will take more care, and will act with an eye to their own peace. They who want experience can know little; they will profit little the kingdom who are not stedfast. Hence it may be collected, that it concerns the community to see what sort of men ought justly to be chosen for the utility of the kingdom; they who are willing

Ne cadat, quod libere vivat, adjuvatur
 A tali custodia, nec est servitutis
 Talis sustinentia, sed tutrix virtutis.
 Ergo regi libeat omne quod est bonum,
 Sed malum non audeat; hoc est Dei
 donum.
 Qui regem custodiunt ne peccet
 temptatus,
 Ipsi regi serviunt, quibus esse gratus
 Sit, quod ipsum liberant ne 690
 sit servus factus,
 Quod ipsum non superant a quibus est
 tractus.
 Sed quis vere fuerit rex, est liber vere
 Si se recte rexerit regnumque; licere
 Sibi sciat omnia quæ regno regendo
 Sunt convenientia, sed non destruendo.
 Aliud est regere quod incumbit regi;
 Aliud destruere resistendo legi.
 A ligando dicitur lex, quæ libertatis
 Tam perfecte legitur qua servitur gratis.
 Omnis rex intelligat quod 700
 est servus Dei:
 Illud tantum diligat quod est placens ei;
 Et illius gloriam quærat in regendo,
 Non suam superbiam pares
 contempnendo.
 Rex qui regnum subditum sibi vult
 parere,
 Reddat Deo debitum alioquin vere;
 Sciat quod obsequium sibi non debetur,
 Qui negat servitium quo Deo tenetur.
 Rursum sciat populum non suum sed Dei,
 Et ut adminiculum suum prosit ei:
 Et qui parvo tempore populo 710
 præfertur,

unskilful people guide it; if any one of
 the passengers belonging to it who is
 placed in the ship abuse the rudder, it
 matters not whether the ship be
 governed prosperously or not. So those
 who ought to rule the kingdom, let the
 care be given to them, if any one of the
 kingdom does not govern himself
 rightly; he goes on a wrong path which
 perhaps he has himself chosen. The
 affairs of the generality are best
 managed [820] if the kingdom is
 directed in the way of truth. And,
 moreover, if the subjects labour to
 dissipate their property, those who are
 set over them may restrain their folly
 and temerity, lest by the presumption
 and imbecility of fools, the power of the
 kingdom be weakened, and courage be
 given to enemies against the kingdom.
 For whatever member of the body be
 destroyed, the strength of the body is
 diminished thereby. So if it be allowed
 even that men may abuse what belongs
 to themselves, [830] when it be
 injurious to the kingdom, many
 immediately after following also the
 injurious liberty, will so multiply the
 wildness of error, that they will ruin the
 whole. Nor ought it properly to be
 named liberty, which permits fools to
 govern unwisely; but liberty is limited
 by the bounds of the law; and when
 those bounds are despised, it should be
 reputed as error. Otherwise you will call
 a raving madman free, although he be at
 enmity with everything like prosperity.
 Therefore the king's argument
 concerning his subjects, [840] who are
 ruled at their own choice by whom they
 will, is by this sufficiently answered and
 overthrown; since every one who is
 subject, is ruled by one who is greater.
 Because we say that no man is
 permitted all that he will, but that every
 one has a lord who may correct him
 when erring, and aid him when doing
 well, and sometimes raises him up when

Cito clausus marmore terræ subinfertur.
 In illos se faciat ut unum ex illis;
 Saltantem respiciat David cum ancillis.
 Regi David similis utinam succedat,
 Vir prudens et humilis qui suos non
 lædat;
 Certe qui non læderet populum
 subjectum,
 Sed illis impenderet amoris affectum,
 Et ipsius quæreret salutis profectum,
 Ipsum non permetteret plebs pati
 defectum. 720
 Durum est diligere se non diligentem;
 Durum non despiciere se despicientem;
 Durum non resistere se destituenti;
 Convenit applaudere se suscipienti.
 Principis conterere non est, sed tueri;
 Principis obprimere non est, sed mereri
 Multis beneficiis suorum favorem,
 Sicut Christus gratiis omnium amorem.
 Si princeps amaverit, debet reamari;
 Si recte regnaverit, debet honorari;
 Si princeps erraverit, debet 730
 revocari
 Ab hiis quos gravaverit injuste negari,
 Nisi velit corrigi; si vult emendari,
 Debet ab hiis erigi simul et juvari.
 Istam princeps teneat regulam regnandi,
 Ut opus non habeat non suos vocandi:
 Qui confundunt subditos principes ignari,
 Sentient indomitos sic nolle domari.
 Si princeps putaverit universitate
 Quod solus habuerit plus de veritate,
 Et plus de scientia, plus 740
 cognitionis,
 Plus abundet gratia, plusque Dei donis:

he is falling. We give the first place to the community: we say also that the law rules over the king's dignity; for we believe that the law is the light, [850] without which we conclude that he who rules will wander from the right path. The law whereby is ruled the world and the kingdoms of the world, is described as being of fire; which contains a mystery of deep meaning: it shines, burns, warms; shining, it hinders the wanderer from quitting his right path; it avails against the cold; it purges and burns to cinders some things; it softens what is hard, and what had been raw the fire cooks; it takes away numbness, and it does many other good things. The sacred law is equally serviceable to the king. Solomon asked for this wisdom; [860] its friendship he sought with all his might. If the king want this law, he will wander from the right track; if he does not hold it, he will err foully; its presence gives the power of reigning rightly, and its absence overturns the kingdom. This law speaks thus, "Kings reign through me; through me justice is shown to those who make laws." No king shall alter this firm law; but by it he shall make himself stable when he is variable. If he conform to this law, he will stand; [870] and if he disagree with it, he will waver. It is said commonly, "As the king wills, so goes the law:" but the truth is otherwise, for the law stands, but the king falls. Truth and charity and the zeal of salvation, this is the integrity of the law, the regimen of virtue; truth, light, charity, warmth, zeal burns; (?) this variety of the law takes away all crime. Whatever the king may ordain, let it be consonant to these; for if it be otherwise, the commonalty will be made sorrowful; the people will be confounded, if either the king's eye want truth, [880] or the prince's heart want charity, or he do not always moderately fulfil his zeal with severity.

Si non sit præsumptio, immo sit revera,
Sua tune instructio suorum sincera
Subditorum lumine corda perlustrabit;
Et cum moderamine suos informabit.

Moysen proponimus, David,
Samuelem,
Quorum quemque novimus principem
fidelem;

Qui a suis subditis multa pertulerunt,
Nec tamen pro meritis illos abjecerunt,
Nec illis extraneos 750
superposuerunt,

Sed rexerunt per eos qui sui fuerunt.
“Ego te præficiam populo majori,
Et hunc interficiam;” dicit Deus.—“Mori
Malo, quam hic pereat populus,”
benignus

Moyses respondeat, principatu dignus.
Sicque princeps sapiens nunquam
reprobabit

Suos, sed insipiens regnum conturbabit.
Unde si rex sapiat minus quam deberet;
Quid regno conveniat regendo? num
quæret 760

Suo sensu proprio quibus fulciatur,
Quibus diminutio sua suppleatur?
Si solus elegerit, facile falletur,
Utilis qui fuerit a quo nescietur.
Igitur communitas regni consulatur;
Et quid universitas sentiat, sciatur,
Cui leges propriæ maxime sunt notæ.
Nec cuncti provinciæ sic sunt idiotæ,
Quin sciant plus cæteris regni sui mores,
Quos relinquunt posteris hii qui sunt
prios. 770

Qui reguntur legibus magis ipsas sciunt;

These three things being supposed, whatever pleases the king may be done; but by their opposites the king resists the law. However, kicking against it does not hurt the prick; thus the instruction which was sent from heaven to Paul teaches us. Thus the king is deprived of no inherited right, if there be made a provision in concordance with just law. For dissimulation shall not change the law, [890] whose stable reason will stand without end. Wherefore if anything that is useful has been long put off, it is not to be reprehended when adopted late. And let the king never set his private interest before that of the community; as if the salvation of all yields to him alone. For he is not set over them in order to live for himself; but that his people who is subject to him may be in safety. You must know that the name of king is relative; you should know also that the name is protective; wherefore he cannot live for himself alone [900] who ought by his life to protect many. He who will live for himself, ought not to be set over others, but to live separately from them that he may be alone. It is the glory of a prince to save very many; to inconvenience himself in order to raise many up. Let him not therefore allege his own profit, but have regard to his subjects in whom he is trusted. (?) If he work the salvation of the kingdom, he acts the part of a king; whatever he does contrary to this, he fails in that point. The true province of a king is sufficiently clear from these arguments; [910] that he is ignorant of the condition of a king who is occupied only with his own affairs. For true charity is as it were contrary to self-interest, and an indissoluble league to the community, melting like fire everything that is near, as is done with wood which they subject to the active fire to increase it, and then in return it is taken away to decrease it.

Quorum sunt in usibus plus periti fiunt;
Et quia res agitur sua, plus curabunt,
Et quo pax acquiritur sibi procurabunt.
Pauca scire poterunt qui non sunt experti;
Parum regno proderunt, nisi qui sunt
certi.

Ex hiis potest colligi quod communitatem
Tangit quales eligi ad utilitatem
Regni recte debeant; qui velint et sciant
Et prodesse valeant, tales regis fiant
Et consilarii et coadjutores; 780
Quibus noti varii patriæ sunt mores;
Qui se lædi sentiunt, si regnum lædatur;
Regnumque custodiunt, ne, si noceatur
Toti, partes doleant simul patientes;
Gaudenti congaudeant, si sint diligentes.
Nobile iudicium regis Salomonis
Ponamus in medium; quæ divisionis
Parvuli non horruit inhumanitatem,
Quia non condoluit atque pietatem
Maternam non habuit, quod 790
mater non erat

Teste rege docuit; ergo tales quærat
Princeps, qui condoleant universitati,
Qui materne timeant regnum dura pati.
Sed si quem non moveat ruina multorum;
Si solus optineat quæ vult placitorum;
Multorum regimini non est coaptatus,
Suo cum sit omnium soli totus datus.
Communis conveniens est communitati;
Sed vir incompatiens cordis indurati
Non curat si veniant multis 800
casus duri;

Casibus non obviant tales modo muri.
Igitur eligere si rex per se nescit
Qui sibi consulere sciant, hinc patescit

Therefore if the prince will be warm
with charity as much as possible
towards the community, if he shall be
solicitous to govern it well, [920] and
shall never be rejoiced at its destruction;
wherefore if the king will love the
magnates of the kingdom, although he
should know alone, like a great prophet,
whatever is needful for the ruling of the
kingdom, whatever is becoming in him,
whatever ought to be done, truly he will
not conceal what he will decree from
those without whom he cannot effect
that which he will ordain. He will
therefore treat with his people about
bringing into effect the things which he
will not think of doing by himself. Why
will he not communicate his councils
[930] to those whose aid he will ask
supplicatingly? Whatever draws his
people to benignity, and makes friends
and cherishes unity, it is fit the royal
prudence should indicate it to those who
can augment his glory. Our Lord laid
open all things to his disciples, dividing
from the servants those whom he made
his friends; and as though he were
ignorant, he often inquired of his people
what was their opinion on matters which
he knew perfectly. Oh! if princes sought
the honour of God, [940] they would
rule their kingdoms rightly, and without
error. If princes had the knowledge of
God, they would exhibit their justice to
all. Ignorant of the Lord, as though they
were blind, they seek the praises of
men, delighted only with vanity. He
who does not know how to rule himself,
will be a bad ruler over others; if any
one will look at the Psalms, he will read
the same. Joseph as he ought to teach
princes, (?) on which account the king
willed that he should be set over others.
And David in the innocence of his heart
[950] and by his intelligence fed Israel.
From all that has been said, it may
appear evident, that it becomes a king to
see together with his nobles what things

Quid tunc debet fieri. Nam communitalis
Est ne fiant miseri duces dignitalis
Regiæ, sed optimi et electi viri,
Atque probatissimi qui possint inquiri.
Nam cum gubernatio regni sit cunctorum
Salus vel perditio, multum refert quorum
Sit regni custodia; sicut est 810
in navi;

Confunduntur omnia si præsent ignavi;
Si quis transfretantium positus in navi
Ad se pertinentium abutatur clavi,
Non refert si prospere navis gubernetur.
Sic qui regnum regere debent, cura detur
Si de regno quispiam non recte se regit;
Viam vadit inviam quam forsane elegit.

Optime res agitur universitalis,
Si regnum dirigitur via veritalis.
Et tamen si subditi sua 820
dissipare

Studeant, præpositi possunt refrenare
Suorum stultitiam et temeritatem,
Ne per insolentiam vel fatuitatem
Stultorum potentia regni subnervetur,
Hostibus audacia contra regnum detur.
Nam quocumque corporis membro
violato,

Fit minoris roboris corpus. Ita dato
Quod vel viri liceat propriis abuti,
Quamvis regno noceat; plures mox secuti
Et libertatem noxiam, sic 830
multiplicabunt

Erroris insaniam, quod totum
dampnabunt.

Nec libertas proprie debet nominari,
Quæ permittit inscie stultos dominari;
Sed libertas finibus juris limitetur,

... together with the nobles that things
are convenient for the government of
the kingdom, and what are expedient for
the preservation of peace; and that the
king have natives for his companions,
not foreigners, nor favourites, for his
councillors or for the great nobles of the
kingdom, who supplant others and
abolish good customs. For such discord
is a step-mother to peace, [960] and
produces battles, and plots treason. For
as the envy of the devil introduced
death, so hatred separates the troop. The
king shall hold the natives in their rank,
and by this governance he will have joy
in reigning. But if he study to degrade
his own people, if he pervert their rank,
it is in vain for him to ask why thus
deranged they do not obey him; in fact
they would be fools if they did.

Spretisque limitibus error reputetur.
Alioquin liberum dices furiosum,
Quamvis omne prosperum illi sit exosum.
Ergo regis ratio de suis subjectis,
Suomet arbitrio quorum volunt vectis,
Per hoc satis solvitur, satis 840
 infirmatur;
Dum quivis qui subditur majore domatur.
Quia nulli hominum dicemus licere
Quicquid vult, sed dominum quemlibet
 habere
Qui errantem corrigat, beneficientem
Adjuvat, et erigit quandoque cadentem.
Præmio præferimus universitatem;
Legem quoque dicimus regis dignitatem
Regere; nam credimus esse legem lucem,
Sine qua concludimus deviare ducem.
Lex qua mundus regitur 850
 atque regna mundi
Ignea describitur; quod sensus profundi
Continet mysterium, lucet, urit, calet;
Lucens vetat devium, contra frigus valet,
Purgat et incinerat quædam, dura mollit,
Et quod crudum fuerat ignis coquit, tollit
Torporem, et alia multa facit bona.
Sancta lex similia p'rat (?) regi dona.
Istam sapientiam Salomon petivit;
Ejus amicitiam tota vi quæsivit.
Si rex hac caruerit lege, 860
 deviabit;
Si hanc non tenuerit, turpiter errabit;
Istius præsentia recte dat regnare,
Et ejus absentia regnum perturbare.
Ista lex sic loquitur, "per me regnant
 reges;
Per me jus ostenditur hiis qui condunt

leges.”

Istam legem stabilem nullus rex mutabit;

Sed se variabilem per istam firmabit.

Si conformis fuerit huic legi, stabit;

Et si disconvenerit isti, vacillabit.

Dicitur vulgariter, “ut rex 870

vult, lex vadit:”

Veritas vult aliter, nam lex stat, rex cadit.

Veritas et caritas zelusque salutis

Legis est integritas, regimen virtutis;

Veritas, lux, caritas, calor, urit zelus;

Hæc legis varietas tollit omne scelus.

Quicquid rex statuerit, consonum sit istis;

Nam si secus fecerit, plebs reddetur
tristis;

Confundetur populus, si vel veritate

Caret regis oculus, sive caritate

Principis cor careat, vel 880

severitate

Zelum non adimpleat semper moderate.

Hiis tribus suppositis, quicquid placet
regi

Fiat; sed oppositis, rex resistit legi.

Sed recalcitratio stimulo non nocet;

Pauli sic instructio de cœlo nos docet.

Sic exhæredatio nulla fiet regi,

Si fiat provisio concors justæ legi.

Nam dissimulatio legem non mutabit,

Cujus firma ratio sine fine stabit.

Unde si quid utile diu est 890

dilatatum,

Irreprehensibile sit sero perlatum.

Et rex nihil proprium præferat communi;

Quia salus omnium sibi cessit uni.

Non enim præponitur sibimet victurus;

Sed ut hic qui subditur populus securus.

Reges esse noveris nomen relativum;
Nomen quoque sciveris esse protectivum;
Unde sibi vivere soli non licebat,
Qui multos protegere vivendo debebat.
Qui vult sibi vivere, non 900
debet præesse,
Sed seorsum degere, et ut solus esse.
Principis est gloria plurimos salvare;
Cum sua molestia multos relevare.
Non alleget igitur suimet profectum,
Sed in quibus creditur subditis
prospectum.
Si regnum salvaverit, quod est regis fecit;
Quicquid secus egerit in ipso defecit.
Vera regis ratio ex hiis satis patet;
Quod vacantem proprio status regis latet.
Namque vera caritas est 910
proprieta
Quasi contrarietas, et communitati
Fœdus insolubile, conflans velut ignis
Omne quod est habile, sicut fit in lignis
Quæ dant igni crescere patiens activo,
Subtracta decrescere modo recitativo.
Ergo si fervuerit princeps caritate,
Quantumcumque poterit de communitate,
Si sollicitabitur quod recte regatur,
Et nunquam lætabitur si destituatur,
Unde si dilexerit rex regni 920
magnates,
Quamvis solus sciverit, quasi magnus
vates,
Quicquid opus fuerit ad regnum
regendum,
Quicquid se decuerit, quicquid
faciendum,
Quod sane decreverit illis non celabit,

Præter quos non poterit id quod ordinabit
Ad effectum ducere; igitur tractabit
Cum suis, quæ facere per se [non]
putabit.

Cur sua consilia non communicabit,
A quibus auxilia supplex postulabit?
Quicquid suos allicit ad 930
benignitatem,

Et amicos efficit, fovet unitatem,
Regiam prudentiam decet indicare
Hiis qui suam gloriam possunt
augmentare.

Dominus discipulis cuncta patefecit,
Dividens a servulis quos amicos fecit;
Atque quasi nescius a suis quæsivit
Quid sentirent sæpius, quod profecte
scivit.

O! si Dei quærerent principes honorem,
Regna recte regerent, et præter errorem.
Si Dei notitiam principes 940
haberent,

Omnibus justitiam suam exhiberent.
Ignorantes dominum, velut excæcati,
Quærun't laudes hominum, vanis
delectati.

Qui se nescit regere, multos male reget;
Si quis vult inspicere Psalmos, idem
leget.

Joseph ut se debuit principes docere,
Propter quod rex voluit ipsum præminere.
Et in innocentia cordis sui David,
Et intelligentia, Israellem pavit.
Ex prædictis omnibus poterit 950
liquere,

Quod regem magnatibus incumbit videre
Quæ regni convenient gubernationi,

Plange plorans, Anglia, plena jam
 dolore;
 Tristis vides tristia, languens cum
 mærore;
 Nisi te respiciat Christus suo more,
 Eris vile canticum hostium in ore.
 Pepigerunt plurimi salvam te salvare,
 Sed jam nimis negligunt pactum
 procurare:
 Nam se quidam retrahunt, qui possunt
 juvare;
 Quidam subterfugium quærunt ultra
 mare.
 Hinc est quod incipiunt cæteri certare,
 Et in partes varias animos mutare;
 Dum quæ sic dissentiunt nolunt
 concordare,
 Sed incepta nequeunt bene terminare.
 Sic respublica perit, terra desolatur;
 Invalescit extera gens et sublimatur;
 Vilescit vir incola et subpeditatur:
 Sustinet injurias, non est qui loquatur.
 Tam miles quam clericus ambo fiunt
 muti;
 Facti sunt extranei loquaces astuti:
 Inter centum Anglicos non sunt duo tuti;
 Planctum et obprobrium jam sunt
 assecuti.
 O Comes Glovernæ, comple quod
 cœpisti;
 Nisi claudas congrue, multos decepisti.
 Age nunc viriliter sicut promisisti,
 Causam fove fortitur cujus fons fuisti.
 Si, quod absit! subtrahas manum et
 levamen,

TRANSLATION.—Lament with
 weeping, O England, full as thou now
 art with matter of grief, in sadness thou
 beholdest sorrowful things, languishing
 in sorrow; unless Christ in his manner
 have regard to thee, thou wilt be but a
 vile song in the mouth of thine enemies.
 —Very many have pledged themselves
 to preserve thee in safety, but now they
 have too much neglected their promise:
 for many desert, who have it in their
 power to help; and some slink away
 over the sea.—Hence the rest begin to
 quarrel, and to go over to different
 sides; while things which disagree in
 this manner will not be reconciled, and
 what has been begun is left unfinished.
 —Thus the state is ruined, and the land
 is laid waste; the stranger is
 strengthened and raised up; the native is
 debased and trodden under foot: while
 he sustains injuries, there is no one who
 will speak out.—The knight as well as
 the clergy are both become mute; the
 strangers are become talkative and
 cunning: among a hundred Englishmen
 there are not two who are safe; the lot
 which they have obtained is lamentation
 and disgrace.—O Earl of Gloucester,
 complete what thou hast commenced;
 unless thou endest as thou hast begun,
 thou hast deceived many. Act now
 courageously as thou hast promised,
 cherish steadily the cause of which thou
 wast the fountain.—If, from which God
 preserve us! thou withdrawest thy hand
 and support, acting treacherously
 towards the land, and inflicting a great
 injury upon it.... May he be cursed for
 ever! be it so! be it so! amen.—Earl
 Simon de Montfort, a strong man and a
 bold, fight now for thy country, and be
 the leader of the band; neither let threats
 scare thee, nor the fear of death; defend
 the state and thy own fortune.—O thou,
 Earl Bigot, keep unbroken thine
 agreement: as thou art a brave knight,
 now use thy hand: a small troop of dogs

Terræ fraudem faciens, inferens
gravamen:

Maledictus maneat! fiat! fiat! Amen.

Comes Simon de Muntford, vir potens
et fortis,

Pugna nunc pro patria, sisque dux
cohortis:

Non te minæ terreant neque timor mortis,
Rem defende publicam resque tuæ sortis.

O tu, Comes le Bygot, pactum serva
sanum:

Cum sis miles strenuus, nunc exerce
manum.

Totam turbat modica terra[m] turba
canum;

Exeat aut pereat genus tam prophanum.

O vos magni proceres, qui vos
obligastis

Observare firmiter illud quod jurastis;

Terræ si sit utile quod excogitastis,

Juvet illud citius id quod ordinastis.

Si velletis prosequi quod jam
inchoastis,

Consequi poteritis quod desiderastis;

Nisi finem capiat quod diu tractastis,

Vere dici poterit vane laborastis.

Honor nobis maximus erit laus et
digna,

Si respondet Anglia vestra gerens signa;

Quam ut cito liberet a peste maligna,

Adjuvet nunc Domini pietas benigna!

now use my hand, a small troop of dogs
puts in commotion the whole land: may
such a cursed race depart or perish!—O
you, great nobles, who bound
yourselves to observe firmly the oath
which you took; if what you imagined
be profitable to the land, let that which
you have ordained aid it immediately.—
If you will carry to an end that which
you have begun, you may obtain that
which you desired; unless the thing
which you have long had in hand be
perfected, it may be truly said that you
have laboured in vain.—It will be the
highest honour to you and a worthy
praise, if England answer by carrying
your standards; which that he may soon
deliver from the malignant plague, may
the benignant piety of the Lord now
help it!

The triumph of the barons did not last long. In the battle of Evesham, fought on the fourth of August in the year after that of Lewes, their great leader fell, with the best of his followers. The fate of Simon de Montfort was a subject of general lamentation; and long afterwards he was revered as a saint and martyr, and was even believed to work miracles. In MS. Cotton. Vespas. A. vi. will

be found a collection of these miracles, and a form of prayers to be said in his honour, among which is the following hymn (fol. 189, r^o).

Salve, Symon Montis-Fortis,
Totius flos militiæ,
Duras pœnas passus mortis,
Protector gentis Angliæ.
Sunt de sanctis inaudita,
Cunctis passis in hac vita,
Quemquam passum talia;
Manus, pedes amputari,
Caput, corpus vulnerari,
Abscidi virilia.
Sis pro nobis intercessor
Apud Deum, qui defensor
In terris extiteras.

The whole was preceded by a life of Simon de Montfort, occupying two pages of the manuscript, but which some hostile hand has carefully erased. The following song was evidently written immediately after the battle of Evesham.

THE LAMENT OF SIMON DE MONTFORT.

[MS. Harl. 2253, fol. 59 r^o, early in 14th cent.]

Chaunter m'estoit, mon cuer le voit, en
un dure langage,
Tut en ploraunt fust fet le chaunt de
nostre duz baronage,
Que pur la pees, si loynz après se
lessèrent detrerre,
Lur cors trencher, e demenbrer, pur salver
Engleterre.

Ore est ocys la flur de pris, qe taunt
savoit de guere,
Ly quens Montfort, sa dure mort molt
enplorra la terre.

Si com je qui, par un mardi, firent la
bataile,
Tot à cheval, fust le mal, sauntz nulle
pedaile;
Tresmalement y ferirent de le espie
forbie,
Qe la part sire Edward conquist la
mestrie.
Ore est ocis, etc.

Mès par sa mort, le cuens Mountfort
conquist la victorie,
Come ly martyr de Caunterbyr, finist sa
vie;
Ne voleit pas li bon Thomas qe perist
seinte Eglise,
Ly cuens auxi se combati, e morust
sauntz feyntise.
Ore est ocys, etc.

Sire Hue le fer, ly Despencer, tresnoble
justice,
Ore est à tort luvré à mort à tron male

TRANSLATION.—I am driven to sing, my heart wills it, in sorrowful language,—all with tears was made the song concerning our gentle barons,—who for the peace so long after suffered themselves to be destroyed,—their bodies to be cut and dismembered, to save England.—Now is slain the precious flower, who knew so much of war, the Earl Montfort, his hard death the land will deeply lament.

As I believe, it was on a Tuesday, that they fought the battle,—all on horse, which was the misfortune, without any foot,—very ill they there struck with the burnished sword,—that the party of Sir Edward gained the mastery. Now is slain, etc.

But by his death the Earl Montfort gained the victory,—like the martyr of Canterbury he finished his life;—the good Thomas would not suffer holy Church to perish,—the Earl fought in a similar cause, and died without flinching.—Now is slain, &c.

Sir Hugh the bold, the Despencer, a very noble justice,—is now wrongfully delivered to death, in too shameful a manner.—Sir Henry, in truth I say it, the son of the Earl of Leicester,—enough of others, as you will hear, by the Earl of Gloucester.—Now is slain, etc.

Because they were willing to die, and to maintain peace and right,—the holy martyr will cause them to enjoy his pure conscience,—who is willing to die and to sustain the men of the land,—to accomplish his good desire, for we think he does well.—Now is, etc.

Near his body, the good treasure, an heir they found,—the false ribalds, they were so wicked, and those who slew him;—what was much worse, they caused the worthy man to be dismembered,—who knew so well the

Ore est a tort ly vie a mort, a trop male
guise.

Sire Henri, pur veir le dy, fitz le cuens de
Leycestre,

Autres assez, come vus orrez, par le
cuens de Gloucestre.

Ore est ocis, etc.

Que voleint moryr, e mentenir la pees e la
dreyture,

Le seint martir lur fra joyr sa conscience
pure,

Que velt moryr e sustenir les hommes de la
terre,

Son bon desir acomplir, quar bien le
quidom fere.

Ore est, etc.

Près de son cors, le bon tresors, une heyre
troverent,

Les faus ribaus, tant furent maus, e ceux
qe le tuerent;

Molt fust pyr, qe demenbryr firent le
prodhonme,

Que de guerrier e fei tener si bien savoit la
sonme.

Ore est, etc.

Priez touz, mes amis douz, le fitz Seinte
Marie

Que l'enfant, her puissant, meigne en bone
vie;

Ne vueil nomer li escoler, ne vueil qe
l'em die,

Mès pur l'amour le salveour, priez pur la
clergie.

Ore est ocys la flur de pris, qe tant

dismembered,—who knew so well the
art of fighting and of holding faith.—
Now is, etc.

Pray all, my sweet friends, to the Son
of St. Mary,—that he lead in good life
the infant, the powerful heir;—I will not
name the scholar, I do not desire any
one to mention him,—but for the love of
the Saviour, pray for the clergy.—Now
is slain, etc.

I cannot find any thing that they did
well, neither baron nor earl,—the
knights and the esquires are all
disgraced,—on account of their loyalty
and truth, which is entirely annihilated;
—the deceitful man may reign, the fool
for his folly.—Now is slain, etc.

Sir Simon, the worthy man, and his
company,—are gone in joy up to
heaven, in everlasting life.—But Jesus
Christ, who placed himself on the cross,
and God have care of those,—who are
remitted, and detained in hard prison.—
Now is slain, etc.

savoit de guere,
Ly quens Montfort, sa dure mort molt
enplurra la terre.

Ne say trover rien qu'il firent bien, ne
baroun ne counte,
Les chivalers e esquiers touz sunt mys à
hounte,
Pur lur lealté e verité, que tut est anentie;
Le losenger purra reigner, le fol pur sa
folie.
Ore est ocis, etc.

Sire Simoun, ly prodhom, e sa
compagnie,
En joie vont en ciel amount, en
pardurable vie.
Mès Jhesu Crist, qe en croyz se mist,
Dieu en prenge cure,
Qe sunt remis, e detenuz en prisone dure.
Ore est ocys, etc.

REIGN OF EDWARD I. 1272–1307.

Henry outlived the defeat of the barons but a very few years. He died on the sixteenth of November, 1272, while his son Edward was occupied in warring against the infidels in the East. Edward was proclaimed king, while absent. A new monarch is generally welcomed with songs of praise; and the following, evidently the

work of a zealous opponent of the popular party, seems to have been written before his arrival in England.

THE PRAISE OF THE YOUNG EDWARD.

[MS. Cotton. Vespas. B. XIII. fol. 130 v^o, 13th cent.]

Eaduardi regis Anglorum me pepulere
Florida gesta loqui, pudor est famosa
tacere.

Hic tener ætate dum vixerat in juvenili,
Conflictus plures superavit corde virili.
Belliger ut pardus, fragrans dulcedine
nardus,

Dum viget Eaduardus, rutilat novus ecce
Ricardus.

Sic gemino flore Britones titulantur
honore,

Bella per Eaduardi similis et probitate
Ricardi.

Belligeri juvenis laudabat Gallia mores;
Ampla manus dantis meritos congegessit
honores.

Invida gens cupiens meritas extinguere
laudes,

Excogitando novas cœpit contexere
fraudes:

Anglorum procures legem fingendo
novellam,

Ubere de regno terram fecere misellam.

Rex pater et patruus cum bina prole
reguntur

Per sibi subjectos, ex quo mala multa
sequuntur.

Degener Anglorum gens, quæ servire
solebat,

Ordine mutato regem cum prole regebat.

Conjurat populus fruiturus lege novella;

Fædere mox rupto consurgunt horrida
bella.

Dum Leycestrensem comitem sibi plebs
sociavit,

TRANSLATION.—The flourishing deeds of Edward King of the English oblige me to talk, for it is shameful to let pass famous actions in silence. He, while yet in his tender youth, went through many conflicts with a manly heart. Warlike as a pard, fragrant with sweetness like spikenard, whilst Edward is in his vigour, behold he shines like a new Richard. Thus the Britons have a double claim to honour, by the wars of Edward equally and by the valour of Richard. France praised the manners of the warlike youth; the ample hand of the giver amassed merited honours. The envious people desiring to extinguish his merited praise, began to weave new plots in their mind: the English nobles, by inventing a new law, made a wretched land of a rich kingdom. The king his father, and his uncle, with their two children, are governed by their subjects, out of which many evils follow. The degenerate race of the English, which used to serve, inverting the order of things, ruled over the king and his children. The people conspires, in order to enjoy a new law; soon after, the league being broken, horrid wars arise. While the populace associated with itself the Earl of Leicester, it accumulated for itself internal exhaustion. The impious people attacks its own king, makes captive the son with his father and uncle, next seizes upon the government; the victors rejoice, their hearts swell. Edward escapes, and immediately new battles follow. He calls together assistance, leagues are established, the army of the leader increased, the deluded troop laments its crimes. The parties meet; weapons are clashed; the fields are moistened with blood by the vigour of the soldier Edward. The Earl is slain by the sword; the barons are put to death with the weapon's point; thus the vanquished conquer, and the conquerors are

Intestina sibi dispendia concumulavit.
In regem proprium gens irruit impia,
natum
Cum patre et patruo captivat, mox
dominatum
Consequitur, gaudent victores, corda
tumescent.
Effugit Eaduardus, statim nova prælia
crescunt.
Convocat auxilium, solidantur fædera,
crevit
Turma ducis, delusa cohors sua crimina
flevit.
Concurrunt partes, quatiuntur tela, vigore
/Militis Eaduardi madidantur rura
cruore.
Occidit ense Comes, proceres mucrone
necantur;
Sic vincunt victi, victores exsuperantur.
Regno pene suo spoliatus seditione,
Victrices turmas miro superavit agone.
Ad regimen regni patrem stirps clara
revexit,
Nequiter ablatum quod longo tempore
rexit.
Plebs devicta fremit, iterumque
potentibus unit
Turmas belligeras, dape, telis, oppida
munit.
Insula per proceres vastatur mox Eliensis.
Urbs regni nostri capitanea Londoniensis
Per quosdam capitur, quatitur certamine
diro;
Sed debellantur hæc omnia robore miro.
Pax optata redit, conduntur tela, nitescent
Nubila quæ fuerant, Anglorum gaudia

conquer, and the conquerors are overcome. Although by sedition almost robbed of his own kingdom, he overcame the conquering legions by a wonderful effort. The noble offspring carried back his father to the government of the kingdom, wickedly wrested from him, which he had long ruled. The conquered populace roars, and again joins its warlike squadrons to the barons; fortifies towns with provisions and weapons. Soon after the isle of Ely is ravaged by the popular leaders. London, the capital city of our kingdom, is occupied by some, and is shaken with fearful strife; but all these difficulties are conquered with wonderful strength. Peace, wished for, returns; the arms are laid by; clouds have given place to sunshine; the joys of the English increase. The active Edward, flying from idleness, next took up the sign of the cross, desirous of performing a worthy service to Christ, who had delivered him from this whirlwind of wars; a pious troop of men follows. The King of Sicily, brother of the King of France, had conducted a vast host to the kingdom of Tunis, that he might recover the tribute which had been refused, saying that this would be a safe way for the whole army to the Holy Land; the people which was signed with the cross lamented to see its object thus unpropitiously changed. Edward follows in the belief that there will be powerful fighting with the Saracens; but the Gentile King wisely avoiding battle, paid whatever he asked. King Louis dies with his eldest son; France lamented; King Charles returns, and brings back the troops, the English with the Sicilians; the anxious Britons wept. The King of Sicily wickedly broke his vow of crusading, and the people, deceived, lamented his changing. He arrives at the port of Trapani; soon a whirlwind from the north strikes the fleet; multitudes of people perish; all the money is sunk; but

crescunt.
Impiger Eaduardus devitans otia,
signum
Mox crucis assumpsit, cupiens exsolvere
dignum
Obsequium Christo, qui se liberavit ab
isto
Turbine bellorum; sequitur pia turba
virorum.
Francorum regis germanus rex Siculorum
Innumeros populos ad regnum
Tuniciorum
Duxerat, ut vetitum potuit rehabere
tributum,
Agminibus cunctis dicens iter hoc fore
tutum
In terram sanctam; cruce plebs signata
dolebat,
Dum sua vota male jam commutata
videbat.
Eaduardus sequitur credens bellare
potenter
Cum Sarracenis; gentilis rex sapienter
Prælia devitans, solvit quodcunque
petebat.
Rex Lodowicus obit cum prima prole,
dolebat
Gallia, rex Karolus remeat, turmasque
reduxit,
Anglos cum Siculis, Britonum plebs
anxia luxit.
Vota crucis Christi Siculorum rex male
frangit,
Et sua delusus populus discrimina
plangit.
Applicat in portu Trapennæ, mox borialis

people perish, all the money is sunk, but the English fleet is providentially saved, without losing the value of a farthing. The king refuses to proceed, or to perform his vow. The pious leader of the English and all his company alike embark, pass the sea, and make for the places which were besieged by the Gentiles, pressed under a long lasting storm. Acre takes breath, rejoicing in such a soldier, and rises as it were from the grave to sing new songs of praise. The Soldan was enraged, and thought to slay the noble leader, whom he caused to be stabbed by a detestable butcher. This assassin brought pretended messages from the Old Man of the Mountain, which were but false pretences; he enters the chamber and shuts the door; with a knife he adds wound upon wound; but Edward, on the other hand, resisted strenuously; with his strength he laid prostrate the murderer, whom he slew with a merited death by his own weapon. And because Christ knew that his servant was worthy, he healed his wounds with a sacred medicine.

Turbo quatit puppes, populus perit
innumeralis,
Mergitur æs totum, salvatur et Anglica
classis
Munere divino, quod non periit valor
assis.
Rex prodire negat, renuens sua solvere
vota.
Dux pius Anglorum similis et sua concio
tota
Puppes ascendit, mare transmeat, ad loca
tendit
Gentibus obsessa, longævo turbine
pressa.
Accon respirat de tanto milite gaudens,
Atque sepulta diu psallit nova cantica
plaudens.
Soldanus fremuit, procerem cogitando
necare,
Quem per carnificem dirum fecit
jugulare.
Hic assessinus Veteris de Monte ferebat
Nuncia conficta, quæ falso conficiebat;
Ingreditur thalamos præludens hostia,
cultro
Vulnera vulneribus impressit; strenuus
ultro
Restitit Eaduardus, tortorem robore
stravit,
Quem telo proprio condigna morte
necavit.
Et quia condignum Christus famulum sibi
novit,
Illius plagas sacro medicamine fovit.

Expliciunt versus secundum Thomam

*de Wýta compositi de domino Eadwardo
Angliæ rege illustrissimo.*

Popular dissatisfaction may be traced throughout Edward's reign, we may venture to say from the day in which he mounted the throne. The following song seems to have been popular soon after his accession; and it is written in Latin and Anglo-Norman, in order that it might be sung more generally. In the manuscript, each stanza of the Latin is followed by the corresponding stanza in Anglo-Norman. Between the Latin lines of the first stanza is left space apparently for music.

A SONG ON THE TIMES.

[From MS. Harl. 746, fol. 103 v^o, of the beginning of the reign of Edw. I.]

Vulneratur karitas, amor ægrotatur:
Regnat et perfidia, livor generatur.
Fraus primatum optinet, pax
subpeditatur;
Fides vincta carcere nimis desolatur.

In præsentī tempore non valet scriptura;
Sed sopita veluti latent legis jura,

Amur gist en maladie, charité est
nafré;

Ore regne tricherie, hayne est
engendré.

Boidie ad seignurie, pes est mise suz
pé;

Fei n'ad ki lui guie, en prisun est lié.

Ne lerray ke ne vus die, ne vaut ore
escripture;

Mès cum fust endormie e tapist
dreiture,

Et nephandi generis excæcata cura
Nullo sensu prævio formidat futura.

Resistentes subruunt iniquitatis nati;
Perit pax ecclesiæ, regnant et elati.
Hoc silendo sustinent improbi prælati,
Mortem pro justitia recusantes pati.

Strata pace penitus, amor refrigescit;
Tota tellus Angliæ mærore madescit,
Omnisque dilectio dulcis evanescit:
Cuncti consolatium quærunt quo quiescit.

De la gent haye avugle est la cure,

TRANSLATION.—Charity is wounded, love is sick; perfidy reigns, and malice is engendered. The fraud of the rulers prevails, peace is trodden under foot; faith fettered in prison is very desolate.—At present, a writing is of no use; but right and law lie as it were asleep, and the care of the wicked race is blind, it has not sufficient foresight to fear the future.—The sons of iniquity crush those who resist; the peace of the church perishes, and the proud reign. The wicked prelates support this state of things by their supineness, for they refuse to suffer death for justice.—Peace being altogether overthrown, love is cooled; all the land of England is moist with weeping, and all friendship and kindness has disappeared; all seek consolation and quiet.—The little orphans lament the loss of their father, and, deprived of their mother, they sorrow in the midst of hunger; they who at first were very powerful, now fall by the sword, and their parents

Ke el ne dute mie vengeance a venir
dure.

Les contre-estanz abatent li fiz de
felonie;

Lors perit seinte eglise, quant orgoil
la mestrie.

Ceo sustenent li prelaz ki s'i ne
peinent mie,

Pur dreiture sustenir nolent perdre
vie.

Pes est acravanté e amur refreidie;

La terre est desconforté e de plur
enmoistie,

Amur et amisté tut est anentie:

N'i ad nul ki ne quert confort et aye.

Patre carent parvuli pupilli plangentes,
Atque matre orphani fame jam deflentes;
Qui in primis penitus fuerunt potentes,
Nunc subcumbunt gladio, plorant et
parentes.

Ecce pravi pueri pauperes prædantur;
Ecce donis divites dolose ditantur;
Omnes pene proceres mala machinantur;
Insani satellites livore lætantur.

Ecce viri confluunt undique raptores;
Ecce pacis pereunt legisque latores;

Asez i ad des orphanins grant doel
demenanz,

Ke lur parenz sunt mis à fins, dunt il
en sunt dolenz,

Cil ki en comencent furent mult

weep.—Lo! wicked children
rob the poor; lo! the wealth of
the rich is increased by
exacting gifts; almost all the
nobles spend their time in
contriving evil; the mad
esquires delight in malice.—
Lo! the rapacious men appear
on every side; lo! the
supporters of peace and
justice perish; these cruel
butchers despise doctrine, and
the holy preachers have no
effect.—These men will not
be amended by the force of
sermons; nor do they make
any account of the lives of
men; they all plunder
together, like robbers. Take
vengeance upon them, O God
of vengeance.

pussanz,
Sunt suzmis à le espeye, e plorent li
parenz.

Li enfanz felons s'en vunt la povere
gent preer;
Li riches à tort enrichiz sunt de autri
aver;
A peine i ad haute home ki cesse mal
penser;
De hayne sunt haitez li felons
esquier.

De tote parz venent li bers ravisanz;
Ore perissent de pes e de la ley li
sustenanz;

Dogmata despiciunt truces hii tortores,
Et prodesse nequeunt sancti confessores.

Hii converti respuunt virtute sermonum,
Neque curam capiunt de vita vironum;
Omnes simul rapiunt, ut mos est
prædonum.
Hiis vindictam ingere, Deus ultionum!

Enseignement refusent ces cruels
tormentanz,
Espleyt ne poent fere cil ki vunt
prechanz.

Si il se ne volent amender pur dit ne
pur fesance,
Mès pur tuer quant ont poer ben ont
la voillance;
Trestuz en funt ravine, de Deu n'en
ont dotance.

Cels metez a declin, sire Deu de
venjance!

One of the legacies which St. Louis left to Christendom was the number of new orders of monks which had been created during his reign and by his encouragement. They soon spread from France into England; but they were very far from being popular in either country, and were the constant butt of the gibes and jokes of the poets. The following is a bitter satire upon the different orders of monks in England in the reign of Edward I. The idea of caricaturing them by feigning one order which should unite the different characteristic vices of all the others, was not new.

THE ORDER OF FAIR-EASE.

[MS. Harl. No. 2253, fol. 121 r^o. Reign of Ed. II.]

Qui vodra à moi entendre,
 Oyr purra e aprendre
 L'estoyre de un Ordre novel,
 Qe mout est delitous e bel:
 Je le vus dirroi come l'ay appris
 Des freres de mon pays.
 L'Ordre est si foundé à droit,
 Qe de tous ordres un point estroit,
 N'i ad ordre en cest mound
 Dont si n'i ad ascun point. 10
 Le noun de l'Ordre vus vueil dyre,
 Qe um ne me pust blamer de lire;
 Qy oyr velt si se teyse,
 C'est le Ordre de Bel-Eyse.
 De l'Ordre vus dirroi la sonme;
 Quar en l'Ordre est meint prodhonme,
 E meinte bele e bone dame.
 En cel Ordre sunt sanz blame
 Esquiers, vadletz, e serjauntz;
 Mès à ribaldz e à pesauntz 20
 Est l'Ordre del tot defendu,
 Qe jà nul ne soit rescu.
 Quar il frount à l'Ordre hounte.
 Quant rybaud ou vyleyn mounte
 En hauteesse ou baylie,
 Là oû il puet aver mestrie,
 N'i ad plus de mesure en eux
 Qe al le luop qe devoure aigneux.
 De cele gent lerroi ataunt,
 E de le Ordre dirroi avaunt. 30
 En cel Ordre dount je vus dy,
 Est primes issi estably,
 Que ceux qe à l'Ordre serrount,
 De Sympringham averount
 Un point, qe bien pleyasant serra,

TRANSLATION.—He who will
 listen to me, may hear and
 learn the history of a new
 Order, which is very pleasant
 and beautiful: I will tell it you
 as I have learnt it from the
 brethren of my country. The
 Order is so cleverly founded,
 that it takes a point from all
 the other orders; there is not
 an order in this world, of
 which there is not there some
 one point. The name of the
 Order I will tell you, that I
 may not be blamed for what I
 read; he who will hear, let him
 be silent, it is the Order of
 Fair-Ease. Of this Order I will
 tell you the sum; for in the
 order is many a worthy
 fellow, and many a fair and
 good dame. In this Order
 there are without blame,
 esquires, valets, and serjeants;
 but to ribalds and to peasants
 the Order is entirely
 forbidden, so that no one may
 be received into it. For they
 would bring disgrace upon the
 Order. When ribald or vilein
 mounts to high place or
 office, there where he can
 have power, there is no more
 moderation in them than in
 the wolf which devours

Come l'abbeie de Sympringham a,
 Freres e sueres ensemble;
 C'est bon Ordre, come me semble.
 Mès de tant ert changié, pur veyr,
 Q'à Sympringham doit aver 40
 Entre les freres e les sorours,
 Qe desplest à plusours,
 Fossés e murs de haute teyse;
 Mès en cet Ordre de Bel-Eyse
 Ne doit fossé ne mur aver,
 Ne nul autre destourber,
 Qe les freres à lur pleysyr
 Ne pussent à lor sueres venyr,
 E qu'il n'ait point de chalaunge.
 Jà n'i avera ne lyn ne launge 50
 Entre eux, e si le peil y a,
 Jà pur ce ne remeindra.
 De yleoque est ensi purveu,
 Qe cil q'à l'Ordre serrount rendu,
 De l'abbé deyvent bien estre:
 E ce comaund nostre mestre,
 Pur bien manger e à talent
 Treis foiz le jour, e plus sovent.
 E s'il le font pur compaignye,
 Le Ordre pur ce ne remeindra mie.
 De Beverleye ont un point 60
 treit,
 Qe serra tenu bien e dreit,
 Pur beyvre bien à mangier,
 E pus après desqu'à soper;
 E après al collacioun,
 Deit chescun aver un copoun
 De chandelle long desqu'al coute,
 E tant come remeindra goute
 De la chandelle à arder
 Deivent les freres à beyvre ser.

lambs. Of such people I will
 say no more, but I will go on
 to talk about the Order.

In this Order of which I tell
 you, it is first ordained thus,
 that those who shall belong to
 the Order, shall have one
 point of Sempringham, which
 will be very agreeable, as the
 Abbey of Sempringham has,
 brothers and sisters together;
 it is a good Order, as it seems
 to me. But so far, in truth, it is
 changed, that at Sempringham
 there must be between the
 brothers and the sisters (a
 thing which displeases many,)
 ditches and walls of high
 measure; but in this Order of
 Fair-Ease there must be
 neither ditch nor wall, nor any
 other impediment, to hinder
 the brethren at their pleasure
 from visiting the sisters, nor
 shall there be any watch-
 word. Their intimacy shall
 neither be separated by linen
 nor wool, or even by their
 very skins. From thence also
 it is provided, that they who
 shall enter the Order, must be
 well entertained by the abbot:
 and this our master
 commands, to eat well and
 plentifully three times a day,

Un point unt tret de 70
Hospitlers,
Qe sunt mult corteis chevalers,
E ount robes bien avenauntz,
Longes desqu'al pié traynantz,
Soudlers e chausés bien séantz,
E gros palefrois bien amblantz;
Si deyvent en nostre Ordre aver
Les freres e sueres, pur veyr.

De Chanoynes ont un point pris,
Qu'en l'Ordre ert bien assis; 80
Quar chanoygnes pur grant peyne
Mangent en la symeygne
Char en le refreitour treis jours;
Auxi deyvent nos sorours
E nos freres chescun jour
Char mangier en refreitour,
Fors le vendredi soulement,
E le samadi ensement.
E si issint avenist
Q'al samadi hoste fust, 90
E l'em ne ust plenté de pesshon,
L'estor qe fust en la mesoun
Purreint il par congié prendre,
Jà l'Ordre ne serra le meindre.

Un point ont tret de Moyne Neirs,
Que volenters beyvent, pur veyrs,
E sount cheschun jour yvre,
Quar ne sevent autre vivre;
Mès il le fount pur compagnie,
E ne mie pur glotonie. 100
Auxi est il purveu
Que chescun frere soit enbu,
De jour en jour tot adès
Devant manger e après.
E si il avenist ensi

and ottener. And it they do it
for company, the Order on
that account shall not be the
worse.

Of Beverley they have
taken a point, which shall be
kept well and accurately, to
drink well at their meat, and
then afterwards until supper;
and afterwards at the
collation, each must have a
piece of candle as long as the
arm below the elbow, and as
long as there shall remain a
morsel of the candle to burn,
the brethren must continue
their drinking.

A point they have taken
from the Hospitallers, who are
very courteous knights, and
have very becoming robes, so
long that they drag at their
feet; shoes and breeches
which fit elegantly, and great
palfreys that amble well; so in
our Order, in truth, the
brethren and sisters must have
them.

Of the Canons they have
taken a point, which will
agree well with the Order; for
the canons, for great pain, eat
in the refectory flesh three
days in the week; so must our

Qe à frere venist amy,
Dount se deyvent ensorter
Pur les freres solacer,
Qui savera bien juer le seyr;
Ce vus di-je de veir, 110
Yl dormira grant matinée,
Desque la male fumée
Seit de la teste issue,
Pur grant peril de la vewe.

Des Chanoygnes Seculers,
Qe dames servent volenters,
Ont nos mestres un point treit,
E vueillent qe cel point seit
Bien tenuz e bien uséez;
Quar c'est le point, bien sachez,
Que pluz ad en l'Ordre 120
mester,

Pur les freres solacer.
Si est, sur eschumygement,
Comaundé molt estroitement,
Que chescun frere à sa sorour
Deit fere le giw d'amour
Devant matines adescement,
E après matines ensement;
E s'il le fet avant son departyr
Troiz foiz à soun pleysyr, 130
Jà le frere blame ne avera,
Ne le Ordre enpeyré serra.

Gris Moignes sunt dure gent,
E de lur ordre nequedent
Vueillent nos mestres pur grever
L'Ordre un des lur poyntz aver;
E si n'est geres corteis,—
Quar à matines vont sanz breys.
Auxi deyvent nos freres fere,
Pur estre prest à lur affere. 140

sisters and our brethren eat
flesh in the refectory every
day, except only Friday, and
likewise Saturday. And if it so
happen that there be a fast on
the Saturday, and they have
not plenty of fish, they may
have leave to take what
provisions are in the house;
the Order will be none the
worse for it.

A point they have taken
from the Black Monks, that
they love drinking, forsooth,
and are drunk every day, for
they do not know any other
way of living. But they do it
for the sake of society, and
not at all out of gluttony. Also
it is provided, that each
brother drink before dinner
and after. And if it so happen
that a friend visit a brother
(for such must be at hand to
solace the brethren) who shall
know how to play in the
evening; this I tell you for
certain, he shall sleep late in
the morning, until the evil
fumes are issued from his
head, for great danger of the
sight.

Of the Secular Canons,
who willingly serve ladies,

E quant il fount nul oreysoun,
Si deyvent estre à genulloun,
Pur aver greindre devocioun
A fere lur executioun.
E ou un seyn sonnent santz plus,
C'est lur ordre e lur us:—
Mès nos freres pur doubler,
Ou deus seynz deyvent soner.
De taunt est nostre Ordre dyvers,
Qe no sueres deyvent envers 150
Gysyr e orer countre-mount,
Par grant devocioun le fount.

Issi pernent en patience,
C'est point de l'Ordre de Cilence;
Chaichons est bon ordre, sanz faile,
N'est nul des autres qe taunt vayle;—
Pur ce vueillent ascun point trere
De cel ordre à nostre affere.
Chescun est en sa celle enclos,
Pur estre soul en repos; 160
Auxi deyvent nos freres estre,
Si doit chescun à sa fenestre
Del herber aver pur solas,
E sa suere entre ces bras,
E estre enclos privéement,
Pur survenue de la gent.

Ne devomz pas entreoublier,
Si nostre ordre deit durer,
Les Frere Menours à nul suer,
Qe Dieu servent de bon cuer; 170
Si devomz ascun point aver
De lur ordre, pur mieux valer.
Lur ordre est fondé en poverte,
Pur quei yl vont la voie apierte
En ciel tot plenerement;
Si vus dirroi bien coment

our masters have taken a point, and will that this point be well observed and well used; for know that this point is more needful than any in the Order, in order to solace the brethren. And so it is commanded very straightly, on pain of excommunication, that the brethren be constant companions of the sisters, both before matins and after, so that the brethren be not blamed for neglecting them, nor the Order receive discredit.

The Grey Monks are a hard race; yet, nevertheless, from their order our masters will that the Order have one of their points for mortification; and in fact it is not over courteous,—for they go to matins without breeches. So ought our brethren to do, to be more at their ease. And when they make no prayer, they must be on their knees, to have greater and more effectual devotion: and they ring with one bell, and no more,—it is their order and usage:—but our brethren, to double it, must sound with two bells. Our Order has such

Yl querent poverte tot dis;
 Quaunt il vont par le pays,
 Al chief baroun ou chivaler
 Se lerrount il herberger, 180
 Ou à chief persone ou prestre,
 Là ou il purrount acese estre;
 Mès par Seint Piere de Ronme,
 Ne se herbigerount ou povre honme,—
 Taunt come plus riches serrount,
 Ostiel plustost demanderount.
 Ne ne deyvent nos freres fere
 Ostiel, ne autre lyu quere,
 Fors là ou il sevent plenté,
 E là deyvent en charité 190
 Char mangier e ce qu'il ount,
 Auxi come les Menours fount.

Pus qe avomz des menours,
 Auxi averomz des Prechours;
 Ne vont come les autres nuyz péez
 Eynz vont precher tot chaucéez,
 E s'il avient ascune feez
 Qu'il seient malades as piés,
 Yl purrount, s'il ount talent,
 Chevalcher tot plenerement 200
 Tote la journée entière.
 Mès tot en autre manere
 Deyvent nos freres fere,
 Quant il prechent par la terre;
 Car il deyvent tot adès
 Tot dis chevalcher loinz e près:
 E quant il fount nul sermoun,
 Si deyvent estre dedenz mesoun.
 E tote foiz après manger
 Deyvent il de dreit precher; 210
 Quar meint honme est de tiele manere,
 Qu'il ad le cuer pluz dur qe piere,

difference, that our sisters
 must lay down flat and pray
 on their backs, they do it out
 of great devotion.

Also they take in patience,
 it is a point from the Order of
 Silence; each is a good order,
 without doubt, but none of the
 others is so valuable;—
 therefore they will take one
 point of this order for our
 purpose. Each is shut up in his
 cell, to repose himself alone;
 so our brothers must be, and
 each at his window must have
 some plants to comfort him,
 and his sister in his arms, and
 he must be shut up privately,
 that nobody may disturb
 them.

We must not forget, if our
 Order is to last, the Friars
 Minors, in no case; so must
 we have a point of their order,
 to be of more account. Their
 order is founded in poverty,
 therefore they go the open
 way to heaven completely;
 and I will tell you exactly
 how they seek poverty
 always; when they travel
 through the country, they take
 up their lodgings with the
 chief baron or knight, or with
 the chief person or priest

Mès quant il avera ankes bu
Tost avera le Ordre entendu,
E les cuers serront enmoistez,
De plus leger serrount oyez,
Qe à l'Ordre se rendront
Quant le sermon oy averont.

Ensi est nostre ordre foundé,
E si ount nos freres en pensée,
Qe chescun counté doit aver 220

Un abbé, qe eit poer
A receyvre sueres e freres,
E fere e tenyr ordres pleneres,
E qe les pointz seient tenuz
Qe nos mestres ount purveuz.
Un provyncial en la terre

Doit aler e enquere,
Pur saver qy l'Ordre tendra.
E cely qe le enfreindra, 230

Serra privément chastié,
E de son meffet reprové.
E ceux qe serront trovez
Qe l'Ordre averount bien usez,
Si deyvent pur lur humilité
Estre mis en digneté,

E serrount abbés ou priours
A tenyr l'Ordre en honeurs.
Issi fount les Augustyns,
Qe tant sevent de devyns; 240

Par tot enquerent pleynement
Qy tienent l'Ordre lealment,
E ceux qe l'Ordre tendront
Par tot loé serrount.

Atant fine nostre Ordre,
Q'à touz bonz ordres se acorde,
E c'est l'Ordre de Bel-Eyse,
Qe à plusours trobien pleyse!

the chief person or priest, there where they can be satiated; but, by St. Peter of Rome! they will never lodge with a poor man,—so long as there are richer men to be found, they prefer asking a lodging of them. In the same manner our brethren must not take up their lodging, nor seek other place, than where they know there is plenty, and there they ought in charity to eat flesh and whatever they find, as the Friars Minors do.

As we owe something to the Minors, we will borrow also of the Preachers; they do not go bare-foot like the others, but they go preaching with shoes on, and if it happen any time that they have sore feet, they may, if they like, ride on horseback at their ease all the day long. But quite in another manner ought our brethren to do, when they preach through the land; for they must ride thus always both far and near: and when they make any sermon, they must be within doors. And always after dinner they ought rightly to preach; for many a man is of such a character, that his heart is harder than

stone; but when he shall have once drunk, then as soon as he has heard the Order, and the hearts shall be moistened, however little they might have heard, they will listen to the Order, when they have heard the sermon.

Thus is our Order founded, and our brothers have deemed right, that each county must have an abbot, who has power to receive sisters and brothers, and make and hold full orders, and that the points shall be held which our masters have provided. A provincial ought to go and inquire in the land, to know who will hold the Order. And he who shall break it, shall be chastised in private, and reproved for his trespass. And those who shall be found to have made good use of the order, must, for their humility, be raised to dignity, and they shall be abbots or priors to hold the order in honours. Thus do the Augustine Monks, who know so many devices; every where they give full encouragement to those who hold the Order loyally, and those who will

hold the Order shall be
praised everywhere.

Now ends our Order, which
agrees with all good orders,
and it is the Order of Fair-
Ease, which to many may it
please too well!

Edward endeavoured to call off the vigour of his subjects from domestic sedition to foreign wars. But the expenses dependent upon the latter only added to the many burdens under which the English peasantry laboured; and it is now that we begin to find the complaints of the latter vented in the shape of popular songs.

SONG OF THE HUSBANDMAN.

[MS. Harl. No. 2253, fol. 64, r^o; reign of Edw. II.]

Ich herde men upo mold make muche
mon,

Hou he beth i-tened of here tilyynge,
Gode 3eres and corn bothe beth a-gon,
Ne kepeth here no sawe ne no song
syng.

“Now we mote worche, nis ther non other
won,

Mai ich no lengore lyve with my
lesinge;
3et ther is a bitterore bid to the bon,
For ever the furthe peni mot to the
kyнге.

Thus we carpeth for the kyng, and carieth
ful colde,
And weneth for te kevere, and ever
buth a-cast;
Whose hath eny god, hopeth he nout to
holde,
Bote ever the levest we leoseth a-last.

Luther is to leosen ther ase lutel ys,
And haveth monie hynen that hopieth
therto;

The hayward heteth us harm to habben of
his;

The bailif bockneth us bale and weneth
wel do;

The wodeward waiteth us wo that loketh
under rys;

Ne mai us ryse no rest rycheis ne ro.
Thus me pileth the pore that is of lute
pris:

Nede in swot and in swynk swynde
mot a-ryse.”

TRANSLATION.—I heard men on the
earth make much lamentation,—how
they are injured in their tillage,—good
years and corn are both gone,—they
keep here no saying and sing no song.—
Now we must work, there is no other
custom,—I can no longer live with my
gleaning;—yet there is a bitterer asking
for the boon,—for ever the fourth penny
must [go] to the king.

Thus we complain for the king, and
care full coldly,—and think to recover,
and ever are cast;—he who hath any
goods, expects not to keep them,—but
ever the dearest we lose at last.

It is grievous to lose, where there is
little,—and we have many fellows who
expect it;—the hayward commandeth us
harm to have of his;—the bailiff causeth
us to know evil, and thinks to do well;
—the woodward has woe in keeping for
us, who looketh under branches;—there
may not arise to us or remain with us
riches or repose.—Thus they rob the
poor man, who is of little value;—he
must needs in sweat and in labour waste
away so.

He must needs pine away, though he
had swore (?),—that hath not a hood to
hide his head.—Thus will walketh in the
land, and law is destroyed,—and all the
pride of the rider is picked from the
poor.

Thus they rob the poor and pick him
full clean,—the rich lord it without any
right;—their lands and their people lay
full lean,—through asking of bailifs
such harm has befallen them.—Many of
religion hold them full abject,—baron
and bond-man, the clerk and the knight.
—Thus will walks in the land, and
consternation is frequent,—falsehood
fattens and marris with might.

He stands full in the place, and holds
him full sternly,—that makes beggars go

Mo then ten sithen told y my tax.
Thenne mot ych habbe hennen a-rost,
Feyr on fyhshe day launprey ant lax;
Forth to the chepyn geyneth ne chost,
Thah y sulle mi bil ant my borstax.

on account of the bad weather by brook
and by brink.—There wakes in the
world consternation and woe,—as good
is to perish at once as so to labour.

Ich mot legge my wed wel 3ef y wolle,
Other sulle mi corn on gras that is
grene.
3et I shal be foul cherl, thah he han the
fulle,
That ich alle 3er spare thenne y mot
spene.

Nede y mot spene that y spared 3ore,
A3eyn this cacherelles cometh thus y
mot care;
Cometh the maister budel Brust ase a
bore,
Seith he wole mi bugging bringe ful
bare.
Mede y mot muntten a mark other more,
Thah ich at the set dey sulle mi mare.
Ther the grene wax us greveth under
gore,
That me us honteth ase hound doth the
hare.

He us honteth ase hound hare doh on
hulle;
Seththe y tek to the lond such tene me
wes taht.
Nabbeth ner budeles boded ar sulle,
For he may scape ant we aren ever
caht.

Thus v kippe ant cacche cares ful colde,

Seththe y counte ant cot hade to kepe;
To seche selver to the kyng y mi seed
solde,
Forthi mi lond leye lith ant leorneth to
slepe.
Seththe he mi feire feh fatte y my folde,
When y thenk o mi weole wel neh y
wepe;
Thus bredeth monie beggares bolde,
Ant ure ruze ys roted ant ruls er we
repe.

Ruls ys oure ruze ant roted in the stre,
For wickede wederes by brok ant by
brynke.
Ther wakeneth in the world wondred ant
wee,
Ase god is swynden anon as so for te
swynke.

The following song appears to be directed against the gay fashions in Ladies' clothing which became prevalent about this time, and seem even to have been aped by the middle and lower ranks.

AGAINST THE PRIDE OF THE LADIES.

[MS. Harl. 2253, fol. 61, v^o; reign of Edw. II.]

Lord that lenest us lyf, ant lokest uch an
lede,
For te cocke with knyf nast thou none
nede;
Bothe wepmon ant wyf sore mowe drede,
Lest thou be sturne with strif, for bone
that thou bede,
in wunne
That monku[n]ne
Shulde shilde hem from sunne.

Nou hath prude the pris in everuche
plawe;
By mony wymmon un-wis y sugge mi
sawe,
For 3ef a ledy lyne is leid after lawe,
Uch a strumpet that ther is such drahtes
wl drawe;
in prude
Uch a screwe wol hire shrude
Thah he nabbe nout a smoke hire
foule ers to hude.

Furмест in boure were boses y-broht,
Levedis to honoure ichot he were wroht;
Uch gigelot wol loure, bote he hem habbe
soht;
Such shrewe fol soure ant duere hit hath
a-boht;
in helle
With develes he shule duelle,
For the clogges that cleveþ by here
chelle.

Nou ne lacketh hem no lyn boses in to
heren.

TRANSLATION.—Lord, that
givest us life, and regardest
every people,—to ... with
knife thou hast no need;—
both man and woman sorely
may dread,—lest thou be
stern with wrath, for the boon
that thou askedst,—in joy—
that mankind—should shield
themselves from sin.

Now pride hath the prize in
every play;—of many unwise
women I say my saw,—for if
a lady's linen is laid after law,
—every strumpet that there is
such draughts will draw;—in
pride—every shrew will
clothe herself,—though she
have not a smock to hide her
dirty tail.

First in bower were bosses
brought,—to honour ladies I
wot they were wrought;—
every giglot will lour, unless
she have them sought;—such
shrew full sourly and dearly
hath bought it;—in hell—with
devils they shall dwell,—on
account of the clogs which
hang by their jowls.

Now they want no linen to
bear bosses in;—they sit like
a slit swine which hangs its

seren,
He sitteth ase a slat swyn that hongeth is
eren.

Such a joustynde gyn uch wrecche wol
weren,

Al hit cometh in declyn this gigelotes
geren;

upo lofte

The devel may sitte softe,
Ant holden his halymotes ofte.

3ef ther lyth a loket by er outhur e3e,
That mot with worse be wet for lat of
other le3e;

The bout and the barbet wyth frountel
shule fe3e;

Habbe he a fauce filet, he halt hire hed
he3e,

to shewe

That heo be kud ant knewe
For strompet in rybaudes rewe.

a slit swine which hangs its
ears.—Such a justling
contrivance every wretch will
wear,—that these giglots' gear
all comes to nothing;—on
high—the devil may sit softly,
—and hold his sabbaths often.

If there lies a locket by ear
or eye,—that may with worse
be wet, for lack of other lye;
the but and the barbel with
frontlet shall quarrel;—if she
have a false fillet, she holds
her head high,—to show—
that she is famous and well
known—for a strumpet in the
ribalds' ranks.

Another song, written apparently about the same period, is a satire upon the smaller Ecclesiastical Courts, and the vexation which they caused to the peasantry.

A SATYRE ON THE CONSISTORY COURTS.

[MS. Harl. No. 2253, fol. 70, v^o; of reign of Edw. II.]

Ne mai no lewed lued libben in londe,
 Be he never in hyrt so haver of honde,
 So lerede us bi-ledes;
 3ef ich on molde mote with a mai,
 Y shal falle hem byfore ant lurnen huere
 lay,
 Ant rewen alle huere redes.
 Ah bote y be the furme day on folde hem
 by-fore,
 Ne shal y nout so skere scapen of huere
 score;
 So grimly he on me gredes,
 That y ne mot me lede ther with mi lawe,
 On alle maner othes that heo me wulleth
 awe,
 Heore boc ase un-bredes.
 Heo wendeth bokes un-brad,
 Ant maketh men a moneth a-mad;
 Of scathe y wol me skere,
 Ant fleo from my fere;
 Ne rohte he whet it were,
 Boten heo hit had.

Furst ther sit an old cherl in a blake hure,
 Of all that ther sitteth semeth best syre,
 And leyth ys leg o lonke.
 An heme in an herygoud with honginde
 sleven,
 Ant mo then fourti him by-fore my bales
 to breven,
 In sunnes 3ef y songe:
 Heo pynkes with heore penne on heore
 parchemyn,
 Ant sayen y am breved ant y-broht yn
 Of al my weole wlonke.

TRANSLATION.—No
 unlearned (lay) person may
 live in the land,—be he in
 assembly never so ... of hand,
 —the learned (the clergy) so
 lead us about;—if I chance to
 go on the earth with a maid,—
 I shall fall before them and
 learn their lay,—and rue all
 their counsels.—But unless I
 be on the foremost day in the
 land before them,—I shall not
 escape so clear of their score,
 —they cry on me so grimly,—
 that I may not lead myself
 there with my law,—on all
 kinds of oaths that they will
 give me,—their books as....—
 They turn over books that are
 not broad,—and make men a
 month mad;—from hurt I will
 save myself,—and fly from
 my companion;—she recked
 not what it were,—but she
 had it.

First, there sit an old churl
 in a black gown,—of all who
sit there he seems to be most
 the lord,—and lays his leg
 along.—A hem in a cloak
 with hanging sleeves,—and
 more than forty before him to
 write my bales,—in sins if I
 sung:—they pink with their

Alle heo bueth redy myn routhes to rede,
Ther y mot for menske munte sum mede,
Ant thonkfulliche hem thonke.

Shal y thonke hem ther er y go?
3e, the maister ant ys men bo.
3ef y am wreint in heore write,
Thenne am y bac-bite,
For moni mon heo maketh wyte
Of wymmene wo.

3et ther sitteth somenours syexe other
sevene,

Mys motinde men alle by here evene,
Ant recheth forth heore rolle;
Hyrd-men hem hatieth, ant uch mones
hyne,

For everuch a parosshe heo polketh in
pyne,

Ant clastreth with heore colle.
Nou wol uch fol clerik that is fayly,
Wende to the bysshop ant bugge bayly;
Nys no wyt in is nolle.

Come to countene court couren in a cope,
Ant suggen he hath privilegie proud of
the pope,

Swart ant al to-swolle.

Aren heo to-swolle for swore?
3e, the hatred of helle beo heore!
For ther heo beodeth a boke,
To sugge ase y folht toke;
Heo shulen in helle on an hoke
Honge therefore.

Ther stont up a 3eolumon, 3e3eth with a
3erde,

Ant hat out an heh that al the hyrt herde,
Ant cleoneth Ma33e ant Malle.

pens on their parchment,—
and say I am briefed and
brought in—of all my fair
wealth.—They are all ready to
read my sorrow—there I must
out of respect give some
bribe,—and gratefully thank
them.—Shall I thank them
there before I go?—Yea, the
master and his men both.—If
I am accused in their writing,
—then am I back-bitten,—for
many men they make to know
—woe from women.

Yet there sit somnours six
or seven,—misjudging men
all alike,—and reach forth
their roll;—herdsmen hate
them, and each man's servant,
—for every parish they put in
pain,—and clatter with their
collar (?).—Now will each
foolish clerk that is ..., go to
the bishop and buy bailywick;
—there is no sense in his
head.—He comes creeping to
the county court in a cope,—
and saying he hath proud
privilege of the pope,—black
and all swollen.—Are they
swollen for swearing (?)?—
yea, the hatred of hell be
theirs!—for there they offer a
book,—to say as I baptism
took;—they shall in hell on a
book hang for it.

Ant heo cometh by-modered ase a mor-
 hen,
 Ant scrynketh for shome, ant shometh for
 men,
 Un-comely under calle.
 Heo biginneth to shryke, ant scremeth
 anon,
 Ant saith, "by my gabbyng ne shal hit so
 gon,
 Ant that beo on ou alle;
 That thou shalt me wedde ant welde to
 wyf."
 Ah me were levere with lawe leose my
 lyf,
 Then so to fote hem falle.
 Shal y to fote falle for mi fo?
 3e monie by-swyketh heo swo.
 Of thralles y am ther thrat,
 That sitteth swart ant for-swat,
 Ther y mot hente me en hat,
 Er ich hom go.

Such chaffare y chepe at the chapitre,
 That maketh moni thryve-mon un-thenfol
 to be,
 With thonkes ful thunne:
 Ant seththe y go coure at constory,
 Ant falle to fote uch a fayly,
 Heore is this worldes wyne,
 Seththen y pleide at bisshopes plee.
 Ah! me were levere be sonken y the see,
 In sor withouten synne.
 At chirche ant thourh cheping ase dogge
 y am drive,
 That me were levere of lyve then so for te
 lyve,

hook—hang for it.

There stands up a yellow-
 man, and jogs with a rod,—
 and shouts out aloud that all
 the assembly heard,—and
 calls Mag and Mal;—and she
 comes be-mothered as a
 moor-hen,—and shrinks for
 shame, and is ashamed on
 account of the men,—un-
 comely under petticoat.—She
 begins to screech, and
 screams anon,—and says, "by
 my gabbing, it shall not go so,
 —and that be on you all;—
 that thou shalt wed me and
 have me to wife."—But I
 would rather with law lose my
 life,—than so fall at their feet.
 —Shall I fall at the feet of my
 foes?—Yea, many she
 deceiveth so.—I am there
 threatened by thralls,—who
 sit black and covered with
 sweat,—there I must take me
 a command,—before I go
 home.

Such merchandise I buy at
 the chapter,—that makes
 many thrifty men to be
 unthankful,—with very thin
 thanks:—and since I go
 creeping to the consistory,—
 and fall at the foot of each ...,
 —theirs is the world's joy,—

To care of al my kynne.

Atte constorie heo kenneth us
care,

Ant whissheth us evele ant worse
to fare;

A pruest proud ase a po,

Seththe weddeth us bo,

Wyde heo worcheth us wo,

For wymmene ware.

since I played at the bishop's
pleading.—But I had rather be
drowned in the sea,—in
sorrow without sin.—At
church and through the
market like a dog I am driven,
—that I would rather be dead
than so to live,—to have care
for all my kindred.—At the
consistory they teach us care,
—and wish us evil and worse
to fare;—a priest as proud as
a peacock—afterwards weds
us both,—widely they work
us woe,—for women's ware.

In the latter years of the thirteenth century, Edward became involved in the Scottish wars; and the enmity of the two nations was manifested in multitudes of songs, of which the greater part are lost, although a few are preserved, and a fragment or two of others are found in the old historians. The following song, attributed in the several manuscripts to different writers, was (if we may judge by the number of copies which remain,) very popular. Different persons seem, from time to time, to have altered it and added to it. It appears to have been composed in 1298, soon after the sanguinary battle of Falkirk; but the latter stanzas, found only in one manuscript, have apparently been added at a somewhat later period.

SONG ON THE SCOTTISH WARS.

[MS. Cotton. Claudius, D. vi. fol. 182, v^o; of the beginning of the fourteenth cent. (C. 1.)
—MS. Cotton. Titus, A. xx. fol. 64, v^o; of reign of Edw. III. (C. 2.)—MS. of Clare
Hall, Cambridge, of fourteenth cent. (*Cl.*)—MS. Sloan. No. 4934, fol. 103, r^o; a
modern copy from a MS. not now known. (*Sl.*)—MS. Bodl. Oxf. Rawl. B. 214, fol.
216, r^o; of the fifteenth cent.]

Ludere volentibus ludens paro lyram;
De mundi malitia rem demonstro miram;
Nil quod nocet referam, rem gestam
 requiram;
Scribo novam satyram, sed sic ne seminet
 iram.

Ira movet militum mentes
 modernorum,
Dum inermes detrahunt factis fortiorum;

VARIOUS READINGS.—2. *militia*, C. 2. & Cl.
demonstrans, C. 2.—3. *perquiram*, Cl.—7. *sed*
vos non commoveant, C. 1.

Te tamen non terreant dentes
 detractorum:

Cum recte vivas, ne cures verba
 malorum.

[Ira si duraverit, transit in livorem;
Livor non cohibitus agitat furorem;
Furor dies breviat, ducens in anguorem;
Ira odium generat, concordia nutrit
 amorem,

Amor orbis obiit, virus est in villa;
Prodiit ex odio pestis non pusilla;
Lator homicidii levavit †10
 vexilla:

Acrius invidia nichil est, nil nequius illa.

Invido nil nequius, nullus est qui
 nescit;

Nam de bono proximi dolor ejus crescit.

Unde justus proficit, hinc ipse tabescit.

Sincerum nisi vas, quodcumque infundis
 acescit.

Ut acescant igitur mentes malignorum,

TRANSLATION.—I playing
prepare a harp for those who
desire to play; I set forth a
wonderful matter concerning
the malice of the world; I will
tell nothing that is noxious,
but will relate a historical
incident; I write a new satire,
yet let it not on that account
sow anger.—Anger moves the
minds of the soldiers of the
present day, since the weak
detract from the praise of the
deeds of the strong; yet let not
teeth of the detractors scare
thee: if you live well, you
need not care for what evil
men say.—[If anger last, it
turns into malice; malice if
not restrained drives people
into rage; rage shortens our
days, by bringing us into
anguish; anger breeds hatred,
whilst concord nourishes
love.—The love which was in
the world is gone, and poison
has taken its place; out of
hatred has sprung no small
plague; the homicide has
raised his standard; nothing is
sharper than envy, and
nothing more wicked.—There
is nothing more wicked than
an envious man, as every one
knows; for his unhappiness

Narrabo quæ noveram de gestis
Anglorum.

VARIOUS READINGS.—8. Instead of this second tetrastich, the Sloane and Cambridge MSS. have the four which are here given in brackets.—[†7. *languorem*, Sl.—†9. *abiit*, Sl.—†12. *Nequius ... nil est, nil acrius*, Sl.

Non verebor a modo voces invidorum.
Cum recte vivas, ne cures verba
malorum.] †20

Malis inest proprium mala semper fari,
Validis detrahere, viles venerari.
Ex timore talium nolo vos 10
turbari;

Laus est discretis a pravis vituperari.
Pravis enim displicet vitæ rectitudo:
Lex in eis læditur, et est lis pro ludo.
Ribaldorum requies est inquietudo;
Dum stultos revoco, quasi frigida ferra
recudo.

Ferrum cudit frigidum quisquis
obstinato
Consulit ut redeat de suo peccato;
Dicit enim sapiens sermone sensato,
Verba serit vento qui prædicat infatuato.
Prædicantur undique 20
fraudes infidorum,

VARIOUS READINGS.—†19. *verebor animo*, Sl. *voces malignorum*, Cl.]—9. *inest spiritum*, C. 2. *proprie*, Cl.—10. *validos*, Sl.—11. *nubari*, Sl.—13. *sanctitudo*, C. 1 and 2.—15. *reproborum*, C. 1.—16. *stultum*, C. 2.—18. *suadet ut*, C. 1. *præcipit ut*, Sl. *ut fugiat*, Cl. *a suo*, Sl.—19. *serato*, Sl.—21. *malignorum*, Cl.

increases with the prosperity of his neighbour; he pines away by the very cause which brings profit to the just man. Unless the vessel be clean, whatever you pour in becomes soured.—In order, therefore, that the minds of the wicked may be soured, I will relate what I have learnt of the deeds of the English. Henceforward I will not fear the words of the envious. If you live well, you need not care for what evil men say.]—It is the property of wicked men always to say evil, to detract from the able, to respect the vile. I am unwilling that you should be disturbed by the fear of such men; it is praiseworthy in the prudent to be abused by the wicked.—For the wicked are displeased by rectitude of life: the law is injured in them, and they esteem strife as a joke. The repose of ribalds is inquietude; to attempt to convert fools is, as it were, to put cold iron on the anvil.—Every one strikes cold iron, who counsels the obstinate man to desert his sins; for the wise man says very sensibly, “he sows words in the wind

Qui molestant Angliam viribus armorum;
Franci, Scoti, Wallici, potestatem quorum
Comprimat omnipotens qui continet alta
polorum!

Polorum dispositor quem clamamus
Deum,
Qui per multa populum protexit
Hebræum,
Anglicis ex hostibus tribuat trophæum!
Mille viris præbere potest pincerna
Lyæum.

Ut pincerna pluribus dat per velle
potum,
Ita suis Dominus vires dat ad votum;
Edwardus rex inclitus istud 30
habet notum;
Christo devotum studeat se tradere totum.
Totus Christo traditur rex noster
Edwardus;
Velox est ad veniam, ad vindictam tardus;
Fugat adversarios tanquam leopardus;
Fama foetet fatui, justus redolet quasi
nardus.

VARIOUS READINGS.—24. *Destruat ipse Deus qui*, C. 1 and 2. *possidet*, C. 2.—25. *clamavimus*, Sl.—26. *cuncta*, Cl. *produxit*, C. 2.—29. *dare potest pot.* Cl. *paribus dare possit p.* Sl. *sicut unus pluribus dat pincerna pot.* C. 1.—31. *illud habet*, Cl. et Sl.—34. *ad* is omitted in C. 2 and Cl. In Sl. the two lines (34 and 35) are transposed.—35. *Hostes fugat singulos t.* C. 1. *fugat hostes undique t.* C. 2.

Tanquam nardus redolet laus regis
Anglorum,
Qui conatus reprimit hostium suorum;
Ipsam omnes timeant hostes Anglicorum:

who preaches to a madman.”—Every where are preached the fraudulent actions of the faithless men, who molest England by force of arms; the French, Scotch, and Welsh, whose power may the Omnipotent who holds the world repress!—May the Governor of the universe whom we address as God, who protected the Hebrew people through many difficulties, give the English victory over their enemies! The butler can furnish liquor to a thousand men.—As the butler at will gives drink to many, so the Lord gives strength at his will to those whom he has chosen; Edward the noble King knows this; and he labours to devote himself entirely to Christ.—Edward our King is entirely devoted to Christ; he is quick to pardon, and slow to vengeance; he puts to flight his adversaries like a leopard; the reputation of the fool stinks, the just man smells sweet as spikenard.—Like spikenard smells the fame of the King of the English, who represses the attempts of his enemies; him let all the

Sæpe molossus ovem tollit de fauce
luporum. 40

In luporum faucibus Angli sunt hiis
annis;

Nam, devictis omnibus Walliæ tyrannis,
Scoti levant lanceas armati sub pannis;
In paucis annis oriuntur mira Johannis.

Johannes jam Scotiæ clemens rex et
castus,

Regni tenens regimen, ut rex erat pastus,
Hunc tandem deposuit gentis suæ fastus.
Exulat ejectus de sede pia protoplastus.

Exulat et merito, quia, sicut legi,

VARIOUS READINGS.—36. C. *virtus redolet*, C. 1. *secet*, by an error, for *fetet*, Sl. *istius redolet*, Sl. *fama replens mundum fragrat velut optima n.* C. 2.—37. *quasi nardus*, Cl. and Sl.—38, 39. *Qui regit rempublicam more Romanorum* | *Innocentes erripit de manu pravorum*, C. 1. *Fama cujus attigit fines seculorum*; | *Ipsum tr'imēt Scotici fures jumentorum*, C. 2. *Dum conatus*, &c. Cl.—41. *faucibus hiis consistunt annis*, Sl.—42. *devinctis*, Sl.—45. *J. rex Sc. quondam cl. cast.* Cl. *quidem Scotiæ*, Sl.—47. *disposuit*, C. 1 et C. 2.—48. *sede sua*, C. 1 and Sl.—49. *Hic dum rexit Scotiam prout dudum legi*, C. 1. *Hic dum sedem tenuit regnum d. l.* Sl. *Hic dum regnum tenuit in scriptis jam l.* Cl.

Spondit homagium Anglicano regi;
Declinavit postea frango, 50
frangis, fregi:

Omnia quæ pepigi prodendo pacta peregi.
Pactum prætergressus est princeps
prænotatus,
Quando non compescuit pravorum
conatus;

Vox in Rama sonuit, fletus et ploratus;

enemies of the English fear: often the mastiff snatches the sheep from the wolves' jaws.—In the wolves' jaws the English have been of late; for, when all the turbulent chiefs of Wales were reduced, the Scotch raise their spears armed in their rags: a few years exhibit the wonderful fortune of John.—John being now King of Scotland, clement and chaste, governing the kingdom as though he had been bred a king, him at length the pride of his nation deposed. The first-created was an exile, driven from his pious seat.—He, however, was deservedly exiled, for, as I have read, he promised homage to the English King; afterwards he declined the verb *frango* (I break); by breaking all which I had promised, (said he,) I performed my agreement.—The aforesaid prince broke his promise, when he did not restrain the attempts of the wicked; a voice was heard in Rama, weeping and lamentation; a remiss master makes lazy servants.—By slack servants the King is dishonoured; holiness is

Mitis præliatus tacit ignavos famulatus.

Ab ignavis famulis rex inhonoratur;
Sanctitas subvertitur, lex evacuatur;
Sæpe fit seditio, pax periclitatur.
Sit maledicta domus ubi quisque cliens
dominatur! 60

Quando cliens imperat, et princeps
obedit,
Tunc ruit respublica, requies recedit.
O quantos impietas impunita lædit!
Inpius impunis semper se vincere credit.
Credebant duodecim Scotiæ prælati

VARIOUS READINGS.—50. *Quod fecit hom.* Cl.
and Sl.—51. *sed declinat*, C. 2.—55. *resonat*, Cl.
—61-68, are omitted in Cl.—64. *Inpius imprimis*,
Sl.

Anglorum resistere magnæ probitati;
Ceciderunt igitur plures vulnerati.
Dixit bufo crati, “maledicti tot dominati!”
Dominantes plurimi sub duce tantillo,
Conspirant in Anglicos, rege tunc
tranquillo; 70
Tandem simul obviant levato vexillo.
Flumina magna trahunt ortum de fonte
pusillo.

De pusillis fontibus magni surgunt rivi;
Sic de gente Scotiæ conatus lascivi.
Plurimi propterea ducti sunt captivi:
Quicquid delirant reges, plectuntur
Achivi.

Plebs Achiva periit ad Dunbar in bello,
Ubi Scoti cæsi sunt Anglorum flagello.
Videres cadavera, velut in macello
Vilia vendentis, tunicato stricta popello.
Tunicatus populus multus 80

overthrown, the law is made of no avail; there is frequent sedition, the peace is endangered. Cursed be the house, where every dependent is master!—When the dependant commands, and the prince is a servant, then the state is in danger, and quietness departs. O how many people impiety, when unpunished, injures! The impious man unpunished always thinks that he conquers.—The twelve rulers of Scotland thought that they could resist the great valour of the English; therefore many of them fell by the sword. Said the toad to the harrow, “cursed be so many rulers!”—Many rulers under such a diminutive leader conspire against the English, whilst the king was at peace; at length they meet with standards raised. Great rivers take their rise from a small fountain.—From small fountains great rivers arise; so it is with the wanton attempts of the people of Scotland. Many thereupon are led captives: whenever the kings run wild, it is the subjects who suffer.—The subject populace perished in

et immanis,

VARIOUS READINGS.—68. *bufo cuncti*, Sl.—69. *sub dicto*, C. 1.—70. *Anglico*, Cl.—71. *obviat*, C. 1. *sibi obviat*, Sl. *stulti levant lanceas armato* v. Cl.—74. *de Scotis miseris*, C. 1. *de plebe Scotiæ*, Sl.—77. *ad Berwik*, C. 2.—80. *Vilis*, C. 2. *strincta*, C. 2. et Cl. *cincta*, Sl.—81. *inanis*, C. 1. *vilis et inanis*, Sl.

Qui solet detrahere viris Anglicanis,
Apud Dunbarre corruit, jam fœtet ut
canis:

Sic faciunt stulti, quos gloria vexat
inanis.

Vana fecit gloria populum fallacem
Diffiteri dominum Scotiæ veracem;
Facto tamen prælio veniunt ad pacem.
De fatuo quandoque facit fortuna
sagacem.

Sagax est in prælio qui majori cedit;
Sed gens bruta Scotiæ cito fidem lædit.
Nemo potest tollere quod 90
natura dedit:

Osse radicatam raro de carne recedit.

Recessit rex inclitus, parcens plebi
tantæ;

Peragravit Scotiam turba comitante.
Angli castra muniunt, rege sic mandante;
Nam levius lædit quicquid providimus
ante.

VARIOUS READINGS.—83. *cadebant in foveis*, C. 1. *cadebant in prælio*, Sl.—85. *plebem contumacem*, C. 2. *facit ... prophetam fal.* Sl.—86. *Edwardum contempnere dominum* v. C. 2.—88. *quemcunque facit*, Sl.—90. *Scotica*, C. 2.—92. *de carne raro*, C. 1.—93. *recedit*, Sl. *rex igitur*, C. 1.—94. *Scotiam pertransiit*, C. 1.—95.

battle at Dunbar, where the Scotch were slain by the flail of the English. You might see the carcasses, as in the shambles of a seller of refuse meat, cut off from the kilted rabble.—The kilted people, numerous and savage, who are accustomed to detract from the Englishmen, fell at Dunbar, and now stink like a dog: thus do fools, who are tormented by vain glory.—Vain glory made the deceitful people deny the true lord of Scotland; but after the battle they seek peace. Sometimes fortune makes a wise man of a fool.—He is wise in battle who yields to his superior; but the wild people of Scotland soon break their faith. No one can take away what nature gave: the disease which is rooted in the bone, can seldom be expelled from the flesh.—The noble king departed, sparing so great a mass of populace; he traversed Scotland with a crowd of attendants. The English fortify castles, by the king's command; for that hurts less which we have provided against.—The wars are governed by the king's

rege procurante, C. 1 and Sl.—96. *prævidimus*, C. 1.

Regis providentia bella gubernantur;
Scotici proceres Anglis subjugantur:
Statuuntur iudices, leges renovantur;
Ipsæ etenim leges cupiunt ut jure
regantur. 100

Rex ad regni regimen dignum
deputavit,
Johannem Warenniæ, quem sæpe
probavit.

Hic in quantum valuit leges observavit;
Elatos perdens, humiles in pace locavit.

Rex in pace rediit hiis ita patris,
Comiti de Flandria succursurus gratis;
Magnam classem præparat tempestive
satis;

Tolle moram, semper nocuit differe
paratis.

Nec mora, conveniunt Scotici versuti;
Tactis Evangeliiis sacris sunt locuti,
110

VARIOUS READINGS.—97. *valla*, C. 1.—98. *Scotiani*, C. 1.—99. *revocantur*, Sl. *prænotantur*, C. 1.—100. *ipse rerum*, Sl.—102. *Johan Warene*, C. 1.—103. *potuit Scotos registravit*, C. 1. *valuit jura conservavit*, Sl.—104. *prodens*, Sl. *levavit*, C. 1.—105. *in pace rex*, C. 1.—107. *Morari non patitur, navibus paratis*, C. 1. *Præparat navigia tempestive satis*, Sl.—108. *deferre*, C. 1.

Quod Trentam non transient austro
constituti:

Pauca voluptati debentur, plura saluti.

Scotici proceres jurant omnes læte,
Et a rege singulis limitantur metæ:

providence; the Scottish nobles are subdued to the English; judges are appointed, the laws are revised; for the laws themselves require to be regulated aright.—The king appointed a worthy man to the government of the kingdom, John de Warene, whom he had often proved. He to the utmost of his power observed the laws; destroying the proud, he placed the humble in peace.—The king, after these things had been performed, returned in peace, preparing to aid gratuitously the Count of Flanders; he prepares a great fleet as quickly as he can; banish delay, to those who are prepared it is always injurious to procrastinate.—Nor was there any delay, for the cunning Scots meet together; with their hands on the gospels, they have said that from their station in the south they will not pass the Trent: little is owing to pleasure, more to safety.—The Scottish nobles all swear with alacrity, and their boundaries are limited to each by the king; see that they be not perjured, and fall into the net; for the

Vide ne perjuri sint, et ruant in rete;
Nam miranda canunt, sed non credenda,
poetæ.

Tunc rex mire credulus mare
transfretavit,
Et Francos in Flandria potens expugnavit;
Senectutis inmemor multos non expavit.
Consilio pollet, cui vim natura negavit.

Non negavit Dominus 120
robur et vigorem
Regi, quem constituit fore mundi florem;
Cujus acta singulos agunt in stuporem;
Quemvis namque potest animo sufferre
laborem.

Labor novus oritur; Sathan suscitatur;

VARIOUS READINGS.—111. *Quod trugam non*, C. 2.—112. *P. v. plura debent sal.* Sl.—113. *Per salutem regiam Scoti jurant l.* C. 1 and Sl.—114. *singuli*, Sl.—115. *ac ruant*, C. 1.—119. *sententiæ immemor*, Sl.—120. *vis*, C. 2.—122. *Regem, quem*, Sl.—123. *Ejus bella*, C. 1. *Actus ejus*, Sl.—124. *namque animo potuit*, Sl.

Scotorum fidelitas procul effugatur;
Anglicorum probitas falso depravatur.
Arbitrii nostri non est, quod quisque
loquatur.

Loquuntur ad invicem scurræ
derelictæ;
“Ecce dantur Anglicis triumphales vittæ.
O! Guylam de Wallia, nos 130
ad ipsos mitte:
Loricam duram possunt penetrare
sagittæ.

Omnes sagittarios nostros
convocemus;

poets sing wonderful things that are not to be believed.—Then the king, wonderfully credulous in them, passed the sea, and powerfully warred against the French in Flanders; unmindful of old age, he was not terrified by numbers. He flourishes by counsel, to whom nature has denied strength.—The Lord has not denied strength and vigour to the king, whom he ordained to be the flower of the world; whose acts excite everybody's wonder; for his mind is capable of undergoing every labour.—A new labour arises; Satan is raised up; the fidelity of the Scots disappears entirely; the valour of the English is undeservedly set at nought. What everybody says, does not rest upon our opinion.—The abandoned scoffers hold mutual conversations; “Lo! triumphant garlands are given to the English. O William de Wallace! send us to them: arrows can penetrate the hard mail.—Let us call together all our archers; let us hasten together against the Guardian of Scotland. For it is right that we should fight for our

Ad custodem Scotiæ simul properemus.
 Nam pro nostra patria fas est ut
 pugnemus:
 Victorem a victo superari sæpe videmus.”
 Custos ergo Scotiæ coarctatur nimis;
 Et ad Strivelyne convenit gens corde
 sublimis;
 Fraus occidit Anglicos, et ruunt in imis:
 Non eodem cursu respondent ultima
 primis. 140

VARIOUS READINGS.—127. *Et Anglorum*, C. 1 and Sl. *dampnatur*, Sl.—129. *turbæ de*. C. 2. *derilictæ*, C. 1.—131. *non ad*, Sl.—133. *Viros sag*. C. 1 and Sl. *omnes con*. Sl.—134. *cito prop*. C. 2. This line and the following are transposed in Sl.—135. *pat. est ut propugnemus*, Sl.—138. *Strivelyn*, C. 1. *Strevelyn*, Sl. *properat gens*, C. 2 and Sl.—139. *Defraudantur Anglici*, C. 2.

Primus pontem transiit comes dux
 Anglorum,
 Penetrans audaciter cuneos Scotorum;
 Sed seductus rediit, non ob vim virorum:
 Fraus est materia multorum sæpe
 malorum.
 Fraus effecit Anglicos rubore perfundi,
 Dum suorum sanguinem passim vident
 fundi.
 Reus fraudis Levenax est et Ricardus
 Lundi.
 Quam brevis est risus, quam longaue
 lacrima mundi!
 O mundi perfidia! quis te non miratur?
 Dolus in domesticis latens occultatur;
 Versutus pacifico semper 150
 adversatur:
 Pastor oves minat baculo, lupo ore

country: we often see the conqueror overcome by the vanquished.”—Accordingly the Guardian of Scotland is very hard pressed; and the people assemble at Stirling, proud in spirit; treachery destroys the English, and they are on the brink of ruin: the end does not correspond with the beginning.—The Earl, who was leader of the English, first passed the bridge, penetrating boldly into the Scottish columns; but he was driven back by treachery, and not by the force of arms: fraud is often the cause of many evils.—Fraud caused the English to blush, whilst they saw on all sides the blood of their own people flowing; Levenax and Richard Lundi are convicted of fraud. How short is the joy, and how lasting the sorrow, of the world!—O perfidiousness of the world! who is not astonished by thee? Treachery lies hid, concealed among our household; the cunning man is always opposed to the peaceful; the shepherd leads his sheep with a staff, the wolf threatens them with his mouth.—What does the

minatur.

Quid minatur barbara bruta gens et
stulta?

Numquid hæc perfidia manebit inulta?

VARIOUS READINGS.—142. *audacter cuneas*, Sl.
—144. *mater multorum*, Sl.—145. *Fraus confecit*,
C. 1. *robore*, Sl. *in campo confundi*, C. 2.—146.
bello vident, C. 1 and Sl.—147. *le faux est et*
Ricardus secundi, C. 1. *Letenax et*, C. 2. *Reus*
fraus L. Sl.—148. *usus quam*, C. 1. *longa lac.* C.
2 and Sl.—149. *O mundi malitia*, Sl.—151.
admiratur, C. 1 and C. 2.—152. *bac. minat.* Sl.—
153. *miraris*, Sl.—154. *hæc injuria*, Sl. *hæc* is
omitted in C. 1.

Veniet rex Angliæ manu non occulta,
Multa super Priamo rogicans, super
Hectore multa.

Multa sibi cumulat mala gens superba,
Anglicos ad prælia provocans acerba;
Verbera cum venient, tunc cessabunt
verba:

Cum totum fecisse putas, latet anguis in
herba. 160

["Non latebit," inquiunt, "nobis luce
Phœbus;

Per nos ruent Anglici simul hiis diebus,
Nullus pervilibus percel speciebus." (?)
Ludit in humanis divina potentia rebus.

O Dei potentia! te pro tuis peto!
Anglis in auxilium veni vultu læto!
Regis causam judicas, gratiam præbeto:
Tu sine principio non vincere falsa
jubeto.]

Post hæc dux fallaciæ suum vocat
cœtum,

barbarous brutal and foolish
race threaten? Will this
perfidy remain unavenged?
The King of England will
come with open force,
inquiring much about Priam
and much about Hector.—The
proud people raise a heap of
evils for themselves,
provoking the English to the
bitter contest; words will
cease, when the blows come;
though you think you have
finished entirely, there is a
snake concealed in the grass.
—["The sun," they say, "will
not be concealed from us with
his light; the time is come
when the English will all fall
by our hands; no one...." The
Divine power plays with the
prospects of men.—O power
of God! I petition thee in
favour of thy people! come
with a propitious countenance
to the aid of the English;
judge the king's cause, and
give him grace: thou who art
without beginning, do not let
falseness triumph.]—After
this the leader of the plot calls
together his party, knowing
that our king would be gone
over the sea; he made an
order to ravage
Northumberland: "we oft

VARIOUS READINGS.—157. *tibi cumulans*, Sl. *magna gens*, C. 2.—158. *Nam fortes*, Sl.—159. *Numquid non intelligit sapientis verba*, C. 1. *Non enim intel. sap. v.* C. 2.—160. The eight lines which follow (included in brackets) are found only in Sl.—161. *Statim dux fallacis*, C. 1. *Falsus d. f. convocavit c.* Sl.

Sciens quod abierit rex noster trans
fretum;

Cremare Northumbriam statuit decretum:
“Sæpe videmus,” ait, “post gaudia
rumpere fletum.”

Lugeat Northumbria nimis desolata!
Facta est ut vidua filiis orbata.
Vescy, Morley, Somerville, Bertram sunt
in fata:

O quibus, et quantis, et qualibet est
viduata!

In hac, cum sit vidua, cunei Scotorum
Redigunt in cineres prædia multorum.
Willelmus de Wallia dux est 170
indoctorum;

Gaudia stultorum cumulant augmenta
dolorum.

Ad augmentum sceleris hactenus
patrati,
Alnewyke dant ignibus viri scelerati;
Circumquaque cursitant velut incensati.
Electi pauci sunt, multi vero vocati.

VARIOUS READINGS.—165. *Luge nunc N.*, Sl. *Northumbriæ*, C. 1.—167. *V.*, *Bertram*, *Sum.*, *Merlaidi*, C. 1. *Vessy ... Borthram*, C. 2.—168. *in quantis*, C. 2. *es viduata*, Sl.—169. *In hanc*, C. 1. *hac, ergo vid.* C. 2. *In te cum sis*, Sl.—170. *in cinerem*, Sl. *Intrant et dant ignibus prædia proborum*, C. 1.—172. *cumulat ... malorum*, C. 1.—173. *augmenta*, Sl.—174. *Alnewik*, C. 1.

see,” says he, “weeping after joy.”—Northumberland, much desolated, may weep! She is made as a widow robbed of her children. Vescy, Morley, Somerville, Bertram are dead: Alas! of how many, and how great men in every part is she widowed!—In her, since she is a widow, the troops of the Scots reduce the estates of many to cinders. William Wallace is the leader of these savages; the rejoicings of fools breed increase of griefs.—To increase the wickedness which they had hitherto perpetrated, these wicked men deliver Alnwick to the flames; they run about on every side like madmen. Few are chosen, but many are called.—Many ask each other how it happened, that the Newminster was not touched by the fire. The monks promise gifts, but they do not fulfil their promise: as there was need, so was the thing carried into effect.—On this account they led away captive the prior of the monastery, whom they then found; having carried away the goods, they left the houses

Alnewyk, Sl.

Multi quærunt mutuo qualiter sit
factum,
Quod Newmonasterium non est igne
tactum.
Dona spondent monachi, sed non solvunt
pactum:
Sicut opus fuerat, sic res processit in
actum. 180

Hujus rei gratia captivum ducerunt
Priorem cœnobii, quem tunc reppererunt;
Captis rebus vacuas domos reliquerunt.
Munifici pauci, multi qui munera
querunt.

Jam redit in Scotiam populus
malignus;
Et Willelmo datum est militare pignus;
De prædone fit eques, ut de corvo cignus;
Accipit indignus sedem, cum non prope
dignus.

Digno tandem principi litera præbetur,
In qua rei series tota continetur.

190

VARIOUS READINGS.—177. *sit actum*, Sl.—178. *Nōmonasterium ... sit*, C. 2. *Novummonasterium*, Sl.—179. *non tenent*, C. 2.—180. *ad actum*, C. 2.—182. *invenerunt*, Sl.—183. *domus*, C. 2.—184. *qui præmia*, C. 1 and Sl.—185. *suam petit patriam pop.* C. 1. *suam petunt pat. pop.* Sl.—186. *Et Wallensis accipit m. p.* Sl. *Et Wallensem accipit*, C. 1.—188. *quam non*, C. 2. *Si non*, Sl.—189. *Digno tamen*, C. 1.

Si commotus fuerit, nullus admiretur:
Tranquillum nequit esse fretum, dum
peste movetur.

Motus, suos milites sic cœpit affari:

empty. Few are munificent, but there are many who seek after gifts.—Now the malignant people returns to Scotland; and the honour of knighthood is given to William; from a robber he becomes a knight, just as a swan is made out of a raven; an unworthy man takes the seat, when a worthy man is not by.—At length a letter reaches the worthy prince, in which the whole course of events is told. Let nobody be surprized if he was enraged at it: the sea cannot be quiet when the storm rages.—In his anger he began thus to address his knights: “Again you must prepare to fight for your country. I would rather conquer once, than be often tormented; wars are better than being troubled with lasting strife.”—“Do not be troubled,” said they, “if the Scottish thieves sharpen axes for their own heads; one Englishman will slay very many Scots. It is not the part of a man who has a beard to join mice to a little cart.”—Wallace, or Gilmaurus, is scarcely better than a mouse, to whose victory the laurel

“Adhuc vos pro patria decet præliari,—
Malo semel vincere, quam sæpe turbari:
Bella valent melius quam longa lite
gravari,”

“Ne graveris,” inquiunt, “si Scotorum
fures
Propriis capitibus acuant secures;
Unus Anglus perimet Scoticos quam
plures.

Non est plaustelo barbati jungere mures.”

Vix est mure melior 200

Walays, aut Gilmaurus,

Ad quorum victoriam nunquam crescet
laurus;

Desunt enim robora, deestque thesaurus:
Bella movet citius cui desunt cornua
taurus.

VARIOUS READINGS.—191. *Si turbatus*, C. 1 and Sl.—193. *Tunc rex suos*, C. 1. *affare*, C. 2.—194. *detur præliari*.—195. *Malo malos perdere, quam sic molestari*, C. 2. *Malos Scotos perdere, quam sic conturbari*, Sl.—196. *volunt melius*, C. 1.—199. *perimet totum sicut plures*, C. 2. *Unus nam Anglicus Scotos valet plures*, Sl.—200. *surgere mures*, C. 2. *mingere m.* C. 1.—201. *Vix est murus melior mari ait(?) Gilm.* C. 1. *melior Scotus Guilm.* Sl.—202. *Ad cujus vic. crescit*, C. 1 and Sl. *cresset*, C. 2.

Bello cadunt miseri die Magdalenæ;
Fere centum millia subdit rex arenæ;
Cæsorum cadaverum pascuæ sunt plenæ.
Oderunt peccare mali formidine pœnæ.

Pœnæ metu territus tergum dat
tyrannus,
Cuï quondam placuit decurtatus pannus;
Fallax die prælii fugit ut 210

will never grow; for they want strength and treasure: a bull who has lost his horns is the more eager for the war.—On St. Magdalen's day the wretches fall in battle; the king subdues in the field near a hundred thousand; the meadows are covered with their carcasses. The wicked hate sin from the fear of punishment.—Scared by the fear of punishment the tyrant turns his back, whom the short jacket once pleased; faithless in the day of battle he flies like a truant. One day often gives what the whole year denies.—In one day many wretches were slain; and the English pursue the Scots who had fled; they are transfixed with spears, and robbed of their clothes. The white thorns are cut down, while the black bilberries are gathered.—Wallace, thy reputation as a soldier is lost; since thou didst not defend thy people with the sword, it is just thou shouldst now be deprived of thy dominion.

But, in my view, thou wilt always be the ass thou wert formerly.—Thou wilt pass

trutanus.
Sæpe dat una dies quod totus denegat
annus.

Una die miseri multi perimuntur;
Et Scotos qui fugerant Angli
persequuntur;
Perforantur lanceis, vestesque tolluntur.
Alba ligustra cadunt, vaccinia nigra
leguntur.

Cadit, Waleys, tua laus, ut quid arma
geris,
Ex quo gentem gladio tuam non tueris,

VARIOUS READINGS.—207. *cæsis cadaveribus*,
C. 2 and Sl.—210. *cui quidem*, Sl.—213. *Illa die*
plurimi Scoti per. C. 1. *plurimi pravi puniuntur*,
Sl.—214. *Fugientes miseros Ang. per*. C. 1. *Fug.*
mis. Angl. prosequuntur, Sl.—216. *vaticinia*, Sl.
—218. *Ex quo tuum populum tuens non tueris*, C.
1. *Ex quo tuos gladio tutor non t.* Sl.

Jus est ut dominio tuo jam priveris.
Ast michi qui quondam semper asellus
eris. 220
Eris in proverbium quod non
præteribit;
Regnum tuum scissum est, et stare
nequibit;
Potum quem paraveras, gens tua jam
bibit.

Deridens alios, non inderisus abibit.
O res apta risui, patens hiis diebus!
Fortuna sub variis ludet speciebus.
Profugus de principe, de Juda fit Jebus.
Ludit in humanis divina potentia rebus.

Rebus sic ruentibus rura rex rimatur,
Et fures a foveis fugando venatur;
Omnis qui repertus est 220

into a lasting proverb; thy kingdom is divided, and cannot stand; thy people now drink of the cup which thou hast prepared. He who turns others into derision, will not escape being derided.—O laughable thing, that has been manifested in our time! Fortune will play in various ways. The prince has been turned into an outcast, Judah into Jebus. The Divine power plays with the prospects of men.—Things being brought to this pass, the king searches the country, and hunts the thieves out of their hiding places; every one who is found is put to the sword: justice requires this, that the punishment come after the fault.—[Next the king returns, that he may marry Queen Margaret, the flower of the French; through her the kingdoms receive a more complete peace. Anger begets slaughter, concord nourishes love.—When love buds between great princes, it drives away bitter sobs from their subjects; and now a firm peace is negotiated by frequent messengers: for by these things grace makes

Unius qui repertus est, 230
gladio mactatur:

Exigit hoc justum, quod culpam pœna
sequatur.

VARIOUS READINGS.—219. *Jam tuo dominio jus est ut pri.* C. 1. and Sl.—220. *acellus*, C. 2. In the Sl. MS. the song ends with this line. In C. 1, it ends with l. 232, the last twelve lines, however, being written by another and rather later hand. The rest is found only in C. 2.—221. *scissum quod stare*, C. 1.—226. *ludis speciebus*, C. 1.—227. *Profugo sub p. ... Gebus*, C. 1,—228. *divinis*, C. 1.—230. *a foveis fugat vel ven.* C. 2. *Et suis*, C. 1.

[Consequenter redit rex, ut Francorum
florem

Margaretam reginam ducat in uxorem;
Per hanc regna capiunt pacem plenioram.
Ira cædem generat, concordia nutrit
amorem.

Amor inter principes pullulans
præclaros

Exulat a subditis gemitus amarus;
Jamque fit per nuncios firma pax non
raros;

Hiis etenim rebus conjungit gratia caros.

Justus est gratiæ Scotis 240
pars pusilla,

Quia non est impiis pax aut mens
tranquilla.

Comyn, Karryk, Umfraville erigunt
vexilla:

Acrius invidia nichil est, nil nequius illa.

Nequam sponte natio non vult obedire;
Regem cogit inclitum cum suis redire;
Jam timent qui negligunt ad pacem
venire

people friends.—It is just that the Scots should have a small portion of grace, because the impious people have neither peace nor quiet of mind. Comyn, Carrick, Umfraville raise their standards: there is nothing more sharp than envy, nor more wicked.—The nation, voluntarily wicked, will not be obedient; it forces the illustrious king with his army to return; now they fear who neglect to come to peace, lest they perish languishingly by the sword of dire death.—Let them perish utterly both fathers and sons; unless they quickly give their feet to flight, flying they desert their towns and houses: the child Ganymedes drives about the hares on mount Ida.—In the midst of these transactions the King of France, sending without delay, asks an honourable truce of the King of England. The king accedes to his request, soon afterwards turning his reins: the grateful hour will arrive when it is least expected.—Who knows not that that would be the best hour for the Scots, in which the sword ceases from the weeping commonalty, and the

Sub gladio diræ mortis languendo perire.
 Deperirent protinus patres et hæredes;
 Nisi darent citius ad currendum pedes,
 Fugientes renuunt villulas et 250
 ædes:
 Idæos lepores puer exagitat Ganymedes.
 Inter hæc rex Franciæ, mittens absque
 mora,
 Regem rogat Angliæ pro treuga decora.
 Annuit rex precibus, mox reflectens lora:
 Grata superveniet quæ non sperabitur
 hora
 Horam Scotis optimam fore quis
 ignorat,
 In qua cessat gladius a plebe quæ plorat,
 Rexque suos proceres unit et honorat.
 Dum calor est et pulcra dies, formica
 laborat. 260
 Post hos et hujusmodi bellicos labores,
 Angli velut angeli semper sunt victores,
 Scoticis et Wallicis sunt præstantiores;
 Si vitam inspicias hominum sidereus (?)
 mores.
 Quasi sus insurgeret leonis virtuti,
 Sic expugnant Angliam Scotici polluti:
 Et rex illos idcirco subdet servituti:
 Serviet æterno qui parvo nesciet uti.]

king unites and honours the nobles. While it is warm and fair weather, the ant labours. —After all these warlike labours, the English like angels are always conquerors, they are more excellent than the Scotch and Welsh; you will learn people's manners by contemplating their lives. —As though a swine should resist the valour of the lion, so the filthy Scots attack England; and the king for that reason reduces them to slavery: he will ever be a slave, who cannot be content with the little which Providence has given him.]

The following verses seem to have been written immediately after John Baliol had retired to Normandy, in 1290. In the manuscript, they are accompanied by a picture representing a ship, full of people, passing the sea.

ON THE DEPOSITION OF BALIOL.

[From MS. Cotton. Julius, A. v. fol. 2, r^o. of beginning of 14th cent.]

Ecce dies veniunt Scoti sine principe
 fiunt;
 Regnum Balliolus perdit, transit mare
 solus.
 Defendi bello Scotus mucrone novello
 Sperans Gallorum, vires expectat eorum.
 De gwerra tuti Gallorum viribus uti
 Congaudent Scoti; currunt ad prælia
 moti.
 Gallia de parvo Scoto profecit in arvo.
 Cur in conflictu Scotus ter corrui ictu?
 Conflictu quarto Scoti ponuntur in arto:
 Quales sunt et erunt, carmina plura
 ferunt,
 Carmina qui didicit Trojam per prælia
 vicit,
 Ovidius docuit quæ sibi causa fuit.
 Percussis bellis, sterilis fit Troja puellis;
 Finitis motis, sic fiet Scotia Scotis.
 Vastantur gwerra Trojani, de prope terra
 Castrorum plena, cum finibus est aliena.
 Urbibus et villis proles dominatur
 Achillis;
 Pyrrhus vastat eas, Priamum ploravit
 Æneas.
 Merlinus scribit quod turba superba
 peribit;
 Latrans exhibit canis, et bos profugus ibit.
 Tunc nemus Eutherium pennata fronde
 carebit;
 Et genus Albaneum sua regna perire
 videbit.
 Scote miser, plora, tibi flendi jam venit
 hora;
 Nam regnum patrum desinet esse

TRANSLATION.—Lo! the time is come
 when the Scots are without a prince;
 Baliol loses the kingdom, and passes the
 sea alone. The Scot, hoping to be
 defended in battle by the new spear of
 the French, is waiting for their power.
 The Scots rejoice together in the belief
 that they will have the better in the war
 by the aid of the French; they rebel, and
 haste to fight. France will profit little the
 Scot in the field. Why has the Scot been
 beaten in three battles? By the fourth
 battle the Scots are reduced to
 extremities: such as they are and will
 ever be, very many songs tell. He who
 learnt songs conquered Troy in battle;
 Ovid has told us what was the cause of
 it. After the war, Troy was barren of
 maidens; when the rebellion is over, so
 will Scotland be of Scots. Troy is
 ravaged by war, the land near about
 being full of camps, it is with its
 boundaries become the property of
 another. The son of Achilles rules over
 the cities and towns; Pyrrhus lays them
 waste, Æneas has wept for Priam.
 Merlin writes that the proud crowd shall
 perish; the barking dog shall depart, and
 the ox shall go into exile. Then shall the
 Eutherian grove be stripped of its
 feathered branches; and the Albanian
 race will see their kingdom perish.
 Wretched Scot, lament, thy hour of
 weeping is now come; for the kingdom
 of thy forefathers ceases to be thine.
 Thou art deprived of a prince, and art so
 trodden down in the field, that by thy ill
 merits thou wilt always be an ass. A
 voice from the bottom of the Cambine
 waters calls thee, to be punished with
 such slaughter as the race of Adam has
 not yet seen. Hasten thither, and become
 the companion of the devil! Andrew will
 no longer be their leader.

tuum.
Principe privaris, campo sic subpeditaris,
Quod meritis miseris semper asellus
eris.
Vox de profundis Cambini te vocat undis,
Torquendum clade, quam non novit
genus Adæ.
Illuc tende vias, et dæmonis assecla fias!
Amplius Andreas ducere nescit eas.

The general hatred to the Scots did not hinder the people from feeling grieved by the heavy taxes which were raised to support the war, and more particularly the expeditions into Flanders, (which latter were ill managed, and produced no results,) or from showing their dissatisfaction. The King's measures of ambition were often thwarted by the stern opposition of the barons and the commons. The following song was directed more particularly against the unconstitutional seizure of wool, and generally against all the taxes raised for the Flemish war.

SONG AGAINST THE KING'S TAXES.

[MS. Harl. No. 2253, fol. 137, v^o, written in reign of Edw. II.]

Dieu, roy de magesté, ob personas trinas,
Nostre roy e sa meyné ne perire sinas;
Grantz mals ly fist aver gravesque ruinas,
Celi qe ly fist passer partes transmarinas.
Rex ut salvetur, falsis maledictio detur!

Roy ne doit à feore de gere extra regnum
ire,
For si la commune de sa terre velint
consentire:
Par tresoun voit honme sovent quam
plures perire;
A quy en fier seurement nemo potest
scire.
Non eat ex regno rex sine consilio.

Ore court en Engleterre de anno in annum
Le quinzyme denier, pur fere sic
commune dampnum.
E fet avaler que soleient sedere super
scamnum;
E vendre fet commune gent vaccas, vas,
et pannum.
Non placet ad summum quindenum sic
dare nummum.

Une chose est countre foy, unde gens
gravatur,
Que la meyté ne vient al roy, in regno
quod levatur.
Pur ce qu'il n'ad tot l'enter, prout sibi
datur,
Le pueple doit le plus doner, et sic
sincopatur.
Nam quæ taxantur, regi non omnia
dantur

TRANSLATION.—O God, king of majesty, for the sake of the Trinity,—do not permit our king and his household to perish;—great hurt and great ruin he caused him to have,—who made him pass over the sea.—In order that the king may prosper, may his false advisers be accursed.

A king ought not to go out of his kingdom to make war,—unless the commons of his land will consent:—by treason we often see very many perish;—no one can tell in whom to trust with certainty.—Let not the king go out of his kingdom without counsel.

Now goes in England from year to year—the fifteenth penny, to do thus a common harm.—And it makes them go down, who used to sit upon a bench;—and it obliges the common people to sell both cows, vessels, and clothes.—It does not please thus to pay the fifteenth to the last penny.

One thing is against faith, whereby the people is aggrieved,—that the half of what is raised in the kingdom does not come to the king.—Since he has not the whole, as it is given to him,—the people is obliged to give the more, and thus they are cut short.—For the taxes which are raised are not all given to the king.

The collecting of the wool grieves the common people still more,—which drives them commonly to sell their property.—Such counsel cannot be acceptable to God,—thus to destroy the poor people by a bitter burthen.—It is not sound law, which gives my wool to the king.

What is still more contrary to peace, as people witness,—they retain two or three parts in the sack.—To whom shall remain this wool? Some answer,—that neither king nor queen shall have it, but only the collectors. Such a false

Unquore plus greve à simple gent
 collectio lanarum,
 Que vendre fet communement divitias
 earum.
 Ne puet estre que tiel consail constat Deo
 carum,
 Issi destrure le poverail pondus per
 amarum,
 Non est lex sana, quod regi sit mea
 lana.

Uncore est plus outre peis, ut testantur
 gentes,
 En le sac deus pers ou treis per vim
 retinentes.
 A quy remeindra cele leyne? quidam
 respondentes,
 Que jà n'avera roy ne reygne, sed tantum
 colligentes.
 Pondus lanarum tam falsum constat
 amarum.

Depus que le roy voderà tam multum
 cepisse,
 Entre les riches si purra satis invenisse;
 E plus, à ce que m'est avys, et melius
 fecisse
 Des grantz partie aver pris, et parvis
 pepercisse.
 Qui capit argentum sine causa peccat
 egentum.

Honme ne doit à roy retter talem
 pravitatem,
 Mès al maveis consiler per ferocitatem.

only the collectors.—Such a false weight of wool is manifestly a bitter thing.

Since the king is determined to take so much,—he may find enough among the rich and he would get more and do better, as it appears to me,—to have taken a part from the great, and to have spared the little.—He sins who takes the money of the needy without cause.

We ought not to lay such wickedness to the charge of the king,—but to the bad counsellor, by his rapacity. The king is a young bachelor, and is not of an age—to compass any malice, but to do all probity.—Such counsel does general harm.

It is no trouble to the great thus to grant to the king a tax; the simple must pay it all, which is contrary to God's will.—This counsel is not at all good, but polluted with vice;—it is ill ordained, that those who grant should pay nothing.—For those who make the grant give nothing to the king, it is the needy only who give.

How will they perform good deeds out of the sweat of the poor,—whom the rich ought to spare, by gift or favour?—they ought to tax the great, for the fear of God;—and spare more the people, who live in pain.—Thou who art rich enough, live not thus upon the poor.

I see at the present day how people are proud,—with other people's goods they hold great court, which will quickly pass.—When the high judgment comes, the great day of wrath,—unless they make atonement, they must then perish.—The King says to the bad, "Go:" to the good, "Come."

O God, who wast crowned with the sharp thorn,—have pity with divine grace upon thy people!—May the world be comforted of such ruin!—To tell unvarnished truth, it is mere robbery.—

Le roy est ieune bachiler, nec habet
ætatem,

Nule malice compasser, sed omnem
probitatem.

Consilium tale dampnum confert
generale.

Rien greve les grantz graunter regi sic
tributum;

Les simples deyvent tot doner, contra Dei
nutum.

Cest consail n'est mye bien, sed vitiis
pollutum;

Ceux que grauntent ne paient ren, est
male constitutum.

Nam concedentes nil dant regi, sed
egentes.

Coment fra honme bon espleit ex
pauperum sudore,

Que les riches esparnyer doit, dono vel
favore?

Des grantz um le dust lever, Dei pro
timore;

Le pueple plus esparnyer, qui vivit in
dolore.

Qui satis es dives, non sic ex paupere
vives.

Je voy en siècle qu'ore court gentes
superbire,

D'autre biens tenir grant court, quod cito
vult transire.

Quant vendra le haut juggedment, magna
dies iræ,

S'il ne facent amendement, tunc debent
perire.

The property of the poor taken without
their will, is as it were stolen.

Such tribute can in no manner last
long;—out of emptiness who can give,
or touch anything with his hands.—
People are reduced to such ill plight,
that they can give no more;—I fear, if
they had a leader, they would rise in
rebellion.—Loss of property often
makes people fools.

There is so much scarcity of money
among people,—that people can in the
market, there are so few buyers,—
although they may have cloth or corn,
swine or sheep,—make nothing of them,
in truth, there are so many needy
people.—The people is not joyful, when
money is so scarce.

If the king would take my advice, I
would praise him then,—to take the
vessels of silver, and make money of
them;—it would be better to eat out of
wood, and to give money for victuals—
than to serve the body with silver, and
pay with wood.—It is a sign of vice, to
pay for victuals with wood.

The commissions of those who are
employed over sea are too dear;—now
the poor have not their lands to sustain
the same.—I do not know how they can
save their souls,—who would live upon
other people's goods, and save their
own.—They cannot doubt but they will
be punished, who covet the property of
others.

May God, for the sake of his holy
name, confound errors,—and those who
meditate treason, and the disturbers of
the peace!—and take vengeance on such
tormentors!—and confirm and grant
love between the kings!—May he lose
consolation who breaks the peace!
Amen.

Rex¹ dicit reprobis, “ite:”—“venite,”
probis.

Dieu, que fustes coronée cum acuta
spina,
De vostre pueple eiez pitée gratia divina!
Que le siècle soit aleggée de tali ruina!
A dire grosse veritée est quasi rapina.
Res inopum capta, nisi gratis, est quasi
rapta.

Tel tribut à nul feor diu nequit durare;
Devoyde qy puet doner, vel manibus
tractare?
Gentz sunt à tiel meschief quod nequeunt
plus dare;
Je me doute, s’ils ussent chief, quod
vellent levare.
Sæpe facit stultas gentes vacuata
facultas.

Yl y a tant escarceté monetæ inter gentes,
Qe honme puet en marché, quam parci
sunt ementes,
Tot eyt honme drap ou blée, porcos vel
bidentes,
Rien lever en verité, tam multi sunt
egentes.
Gens non est læta, cum sit tam parca
moneta.

Si le roy freyt moun consail, tunc vellem
laudare,
D’argent prendre le vessel, monetamque
parare;
Mieu valdreit de fust ma[n]ger, pro victu
summe dare

nummos dare,
Que d'argent le cors servyr, et lignum
pacare.

Est vitii signum pro victu solvere
lignum.

Lur commissiouns sunt trochiers qui sunt
ultra mare;

Ore lur terres n'ount povers eosdem
sustentare.

Je ne say coment purrout animas
salvare,

Que d'autrui vivre voderount, et propria
servare.

Non dubitant pœnas cupientes res
alienas.

Dieu pur soun seintime noun, confundat
errores,

E ceux que pensent fere tresoun, et pacis
turbatores!

E vengauce en facez ad tales vexatores!

E confermez e grantez inter reges
amores!

Perdat solamen qui pacem destruit!

AMEN.

Although the English people were grieved by the King's expensive and ill-conducted foreign wars, yet they were not wanting in commiseration for the Flemish burghers in their struggle against France. The song which follows was composed soon after the battle of Courtrai, in which the Comte d'Artois and his army were defeated and destroyed by the Flemings in 1302.

SONG ON THE FLEMISH INSURRECTION.

[MS. Harl. No. 2253, fol. 73, v^o. of reign of Edw. II.]

Lustneth, lordinges, bothe 3onge ant olde,
Of the Freynsshe-men that were so
proude ant bolde,
Hou the Flemmysse-men bohten hem
ant solde
upon a Wednesday.
Betere hem were at home in huere londe,
Then for te seche Flemmysse by the see
stronde,
Wharethourh moni Frenshe wyf
wryngeth hire honde,
ant singeth, weylaway!

The Kyng of Fraunce made statuz newe
In the lond of Flaundres, among false ant
trewe,
That the commun of Bruges ful sore con
a-rewe,
ant seiden amonges hem,
“Gedere we us togedere hardilyche at
ene,
Take we the bailifs by twenty ant by tene,
Clappe we of the hevedes an oven o the
grene,
ant caste we y the fen.”

The webbes ant the fullaris assembleden
hem alle,
Ant makeden huere consail in huere
commune halle;
Token Peter Conyng huere kyng to calle,
ant beo huere cheventeyn.
Hue nomen huere rouncyns out of the
stalle,
Ant closeden the toun withinne the walle;
Sixti hardies ant ten hue maden a down

Sixti baylies ant ten hue maaden a-down
falle,
ant moni another sweyn.

Tho wolde the baylies, that were come
from Fraunce,
Dryve the Flemisshe that made the
destaunce;
Hue turnden hem azeynes with suerd ant
with launce,
stronge men ant lyht.
Y telle ou for sothe, for al huere
bobaunce,
Ne for the avowerie of the Kyng of
Fraunce,
Tuenti score ant fyve haden ther
meschaunce
by day ant eke by nyht.

Sire Jakes de Seint Poul y-herde hou hit
was;
Sixtene hundred of horsmen asemblede o
the gras;
He wende toward Bruges *pas pur pas*,
with swithe gret mounde.
The Flemmysshe y-herden telle the cas;
A-gynneth to clynken huere basyns of
bras,
Ant al hem to-dryven ase ston doth the
glas,
ant fellen hem to grounde.

Sixtene hundred of horsmen hede ther
here fyn;
Hue leyzen y the stretes y-styked ase
swyn;
Ther hue loren huere stedes, ant mony

rouncyn,
thourh huere ounne prude.
Sire Jakes ascapede by a coynte gyn,
Out at one posterne ther me solde wyn,
Out of the fyhte hom to ys yn,
in wel muchele drede.

Tho the Kyng of Fraunce y-herde this,
anon
Assemblede he is dousse pers everuchon,
The proude Eorl of Artoys ant other
mony on,
to come to Paris.
The barouns of Fraunce thider conne gon,
Into the paleis that paved is with ston,
To jugge the Flemmisshe to bernen ant to
slon,
thourh the flour-de-lis.

Thenne seide the Kyng Philip, “Lustneth
nou to me,
Myn eorles ant my barouns gentil ant fre,
Goth, faccheth me the tray tours y-
bounde to my kne,
hastifliche ant blyve.”
Tho suor the Eorl of Seint Poul, “*Par la
goule Dé!*
We shule facche the rybaus wher thi wille
be,
Ant drawn hem [with] wilde hors out of
the countré,
by thousandes fyve.”

“Sire Rauf Devel,” sayth the Eorl of
Boloyne,
“*Nus ne lerrum en vie chanoun ne moyne,*
Wende we forth anon witht withoute any

TRANSLATION.—Listen,
Lordings, both young and old,
—of the Frenchmen that were
so proud and bold,—how the
Flemmish men bought and
sold them—upon a
Wednesday.—Better it had
been for them at home in their
country,—than to seek
Flemings by the sea-strand,—
through which many a French
woman wrings her hands,—
and sings, weladay!

The King of France made
new statutes—in the land of
Flanders, among false and
true,—that the commons of
Bruges full sorely began to
rue,—and said amongst
themselves,—“Let us
assemble together boldly in
the evening,—let us take the
bailiffs by twenties and by
tens,—let us clap off their
heads above on the green,—
and let us cast them in the
fen.”

The weavers and the fullers
assembled them all,—and
held their council in their
common hall,—they took
Peter Conyng to be called
their king,—and to be their
chieftain. They took their

chertam.—They took men horses out of the stable,—and closed the town within the wall;—seventy bailiffs they made down fall,—and many another man.

Then would the bailiffs that were come from France—drive out the Flemings who made the disturbance;—but they turned against them with sword and with lance,—strong men and nimble.—I tell you for truth, in spite of their vaunting,—and in spite of the patronage of the King of France,—four hundred and five had there mischance—by day and also by night.

Sir Jacques de St. Paul heard how it was:—he assembled sixteen hundred knights on the grass;—they went towards Bruges step by step,—with a very great body of people.—The Flemings heard tell of the case; they begin to clink their basins of brass,—and they break them all to pieces as a stone does glass,—and fell them to the ground.

Sixteen hundred knights had there their end;—they lay

in the streets stuck like swine;
—there they lost their steeds,
and many a horse,—through
their own pride;—Sir Jacques
escaped by a cunning
contrivance,—out at a postern
where they sold wine,—out of
the fight home to his lodging,
—in very great fear.

When the King of France
heard this, anon—he
assembled his douze peers
every one,—the proud Comte
d’Artois and others many a
one,—to come to Paris.—The
barons of France began to go
thither,—into the palace that
is paved with stone,—to judge
the Flemings to be burnt and
slain,—through the fleur-de-
lis.

Then said King Philip,
“Listen now to me,—my earls
and my barons gentle and
free,—go, fetch me the
traitors in bonds to my knees,
—hastily and quickly.”—
Then swore the Comte de
Saint Paul, “By the throat of
God!—we shall fetch the
ribalds wherever it be thy
will,—and draw them with
wild horses out of the country
—by five-thousands.”

“Sir Ralf Devel,” says the Comte de Bologne,—“we will not leave alive either canon or monk,—let us go forth anon right without any excuse,—nor no man alive (?).—We shall flay the Conyng (rabbit), and cause his loins to be roasted;—the fame of him shall spring as far as Cologne,—so shall it to Acre and into Saxony,—and make them full pale.”

Seven counts and forty barons in number,—fifteen hundred knights proud and very bold,—sixty thousand squires what with young and old,—to take the Flemings.—The Flemings boldly came against them;—these proud French comtes, their knights, and their men—they killed and slew over the hills and the plains,—all for their King’s sake.

These French came to Flanders as light as the hare;—before it was midnight there fell upon them care;—they were caught in the net as a bird is in the snare,—with horse and with steed.—The Flemings dab them on the

bare head;—they will take for
them neither ransom nor pay;
—they dod off their heads,
happen what may,—and
thereto have they need.

Then saith the Comte
d'Artois, “I yield me to thee,
—Peter Conyng by name, if
thou art gentle and free,—that
I may suffer no shame nor
disgrace,—and that I may not
be slain.”—Then swore a
butcher, “By my loyalty!—
thou shalt never more see the
King of France,—nor be in
prison in the town of Bruges,
—thou wouldest consume
bread.”

There they were heaped
into the pit-full,—these
counts and barons and all
their knights;—their ladies
may wait for them in bower
and in hall—very long.—In
their place must their king call
other knights,—and take other
steeds out of their stables:—
there they have drunk bitterer
than gall,—upon the dry land.

When the King of France
heard these tidings,—he cast
down his head, his hands he
began to wring.—Throughout

all France the news began to
spread;—woe was to them
all!—Much was the sorrow
and the weeping—that was in
all France among old and
young;—The greatest part of
the land began to sing,
—“Alas! and welaway!”

Away, thou young pope!
what will be thy counsel?—
Thou hast lost thy cardinals at
thy greatest need;—thou wilt
never recover them for any
kind of reward,—for truth I
tell thee.—Go forth to Rome
to atone for thy misdeeds;—
pray to good saints that they
let thee speed better:—unless
thou workest more wisely,
thou lovest land and people,—
the crown fell well to the. (?)

Alas! thou simple France, it
may appear a shame for thee,
—that a few fullers make thee
so tame;—sixty thousand in a
day they made trip quickly,
(?)—with count and knight.—
Thereof have the Flemings
very good game,—and swear
by St. Omer and eke by St.
James,—if they come there
any more, it will fall them to
shame,—with them to fight.

I tell you for truth, the

battle thus begun,—between
France and Flanders, how
they were foes;—for the
French had put the Count of
Flanders in prison,—with
treason faithlessly.—If the
Prince of Wales his life might
have,—it will happen to the
King of France more bitter
than soot;—unless he before-
hand do make good amends
for it,—very sorely he shall
rue it.

The following song seems to have been popular about the beginning of the fourteenth century. The wolf and the fox portray exactly the characters of the two classes of people who then oppressed and plundered the middle and lower classes.

A SONG ON THE TIMES.

[MS. Harl. No. 913, fol. 44, v^o. written about A.D. 1308.]

Whose thenchith up this carful lif,
Nizte and dai that we beth inne,
So moch we seeth of sorow and strif,
And lite ther is of worldis winne,
Hate and wreth ther is wel rive,
And trew love is ful thinne:
Men that beth in heizist live
Mest i-charged beth with sinne.

Fals and lither is this lond,
As al dai we mai i-se:
Therin is bothe hate and onde,—
Ic wene that ever so wol be.
Coveitise hath the law an honde,
That the trewthe he ne mai i-se:
Nou is maister pride and onde;—
Alas! Loverde, whi suffrith he?

Wold holi cherch pilt is mizte,
And law of lond pilt him to;
Than scholde coveitise and un-rizte
Ute of lond ben y-do.
Holi cherch schold hold is rikt
For no eie no for no love;
That hi ne schold schow har mikt
For lordingen boste that beth above.

To entredite and amonsi
Al thai, whate hi evir be,
That lafful men doth robbi,
Whate in lond what in see;
And thos hoblurs, namelich,
That husbond benimeth eri of grund;
Men ne schold ham biri in non chirch,
Bot cast ham ute as a hund.

TRANSLATION.—Whoso
reflecteth upon this life which
is full of care,—night and day
that we are in,—so much we
see of sorrow and strife,—and
little there is of world's joy.—
Hate and wrath there is very
rife,—and true love is very
rare:—men who are in the
highest station of life,—are
most laden with sin.

False and wicked is this
land,—as every day we may
see:—in it there is both hate
and contention,—I think it
will always be so.—
Covetousness hath the law in
hand,—that he may not see
the truth:—Now pride is
master, and contention;—
Alas! Lord! why suffereth he?

If holy church would exert
its might,—and the law of the
land exert it too;—then
should covetousness and
injustice—out of the land be
driven.—Holy church should
withhold its right—for no fear
nor for no love;—that they
should not show their might
—for the boast of lordings
that are above.

To interdict and admonish

Thos kingis ministris beth i-schend,
To riȝt and law that ssold tak hede,
And al the lond for t' amend,
Of thos thevis hi taketh mede.
Be the lafful man to deth i-broȝt,
And his catel awei y-nom;
Of his deth ne tellith hi noȝt,
Bot of har prei hi hab som.

Hab hi the silver, and the mede,
And the catel under-fo,
Of feloni hi ne taketh hede,
Al thilk trepas is a-go.
Of thos a vorbisen ic herd telle;
The Lion is king of all beeste,
And—herknith al to mi spelle—
In his lond he did an heste.

The Lyon lete cri, as hit was do,
For he hird lome to telle;
And eke him was i-told also
That the wolf didde noȝte welle.
And the fox, that lither grome,
With the wolf, i-wreiid was;
To-for har lord hi schold come,
To amend har trepas.

And so men didde that seli asse,
That trepasid noȝt, no did no gilte,
With ham bothe i-wreiid was,
And in the ditement was i-pilt.
The voxe hird amang al menne,
And told the wolf with the brode
crune;
That on him send gees and henne,
That other geet and motune.

—all those, whatever they be,
—who lawful men do rob,—
whether on the land or on the
sea;—and those hoblers in
particular,—that take from the
husbandman the tillage of the
ground;—men ought not to
bury them in any church,—
but to throw them out like a
dog.

Those king's ministers are
corrupted,—that should take
heed to right and law,—and
all the land for to amend,—of
these thieves they take bribe.
—If the man who acts
lawfully is brought to death,
—and his property taken
away;—of his death they
make no account,—but of
their prey they have a share.

If they have the silver and
the bribe—and the property
received,—they take no heed
of felony,—every trespass is
allowed to pass.—Of these a
parable I heard tell;—the Lion
is king of all beasts,—and
(hearken all to my tale)—in
his land he made a command.

The Lion caused to be
proclaimed, as it was done,—
for he heard frequently tell;—

The seli aasse wend was saf,
For he ne eete noȝt bote grasse;
None ȝiftes he ne ȝaf,
No wend that no harm nasse.
Tho hi to har lord com to tune,
He told to ham law and skille;
Thos wikid bestis luid a-dune,
“Lord,” hi seiid, “what is thi wille?”

Tho spek the Lion hem to,
To the fox anone his wille,—
“Tel me, boi, what hast i-do?
Men beth aboute the to spille.”
Tho spek the fox first anone,
“Lord King, nou thi wille;
Thos men me wreiith of the tune,
And wold me gladlich for to spille.—

Gees no hen nad ic noȝt,
Sire, for soth ic the sigge,
Bot as ic ham dere boȝt,
And bere ham up myn owen rigge.”
”Godis grame most hi have,
That in the curte the so pilt!
Whan hit is so, ich vouchsave,
Ic forȝive the this gilte.”

The fals wolf stode behind;
He was doggid and ek felle:—
“Ic am i-com of grete kind,
Pes thou graunt me, that miȝt ful
welle.”

“What hast i-do, bel amy,
That thou me so oxist pes?”
“Sire,” he seiid, “I nel noȝt lie,
If thou me woldist hire a res.

and eke it was told him also—
that the wolf did not well.—
And the fox, that wicked
fellow,—with the wolf was
accused;—before their lord
they must come,—to make
amends for their trespass.

And so men did [accuse]
the simple ass,—that
trespassed not, nor did any
crime,—with them both he
was accused,—and in the
indictment was put.—The fox
heard [talk of it] among all
men,—and told the wolf with
the broad crown;—the one
sent to him [the Lion] geese
and hens,—the other kids and
mutton.

The simple ass thought he
was safe,—for he eat nothing
but grass;—no gifts he gave,
—nor suspected that there
was any harm.—When they
came in the presence of their
Lord,—he counted out to
them law and reason;—these
wicked beasts laid themselves
down [prostrate],—“Lord,”
said they, “what is thy will?”

Then spake the Lion to
them,—to the fox in the first
place [he declared] his will,
—“Tell me fellow what hast

For ic huntid up the doune,
To loke, Sire, mi bizete;
Ther ic slow a motune,
3e, Sir, and fewe gete.
Ic am i-wreiid, Sire, to the,
For that ilk gilt;—
Sire, ichul sker me,
I ne 3ef ham dint no pilt.”

“For soth I sigge the, bel ami,
Hi nadde no gode munde,
Thai that wreiid the to mei,
Thou ne diddist no3t bot thi kund.—
Sei thou me, asse, wat hast i-do?
Me thenchith thou cannist no gode.
Whi nadistou, as other mo?
Thou come of lither stode.”

“Sertis, Sire, not ic no3t;
Ic ete sage alnil gras,—
More harm ne did ic no3t;
Therfor i-wreiid ic was.”
“Bel ami, that was mis-do,
That was a3e thi kund,
For to ete such gras so:—
Hastilich 3e him bind;

Al his bonis 3e to-draw,
Loke that 3e no3t lete;
And that ic 3ive al for lawe,
That his fleis be al i-frette.”—
Also hit farith nou in lond,
Whose wol tak therto hede:
Of thai that habbith an hond,
Of thevis hi takith mede.

“Tell me, fellow, what hast
thou done?—Men are about
thee to ruin.”—Then spake
the fox first,—“Lord King,
now thy will;—these men
accuse me of the town,—and
would gladly ruin me.

“Gees nor hen had I not,—
Sire, for truth I tell thee,—but
as I bought them dearly,—and
bore them upon my own
back.”—“God’s anger may
they have,—that in the court
so placed thee!—Since it is
so, I vouchsafe,—I forgive
thee this guilt.”

The false wolf stood
behind;—he was dogged and
eke fell:—“I am come of a
great race,—grant thou me
peace, who may full
well.”—“What hast thou
done, fair friend,—that thou
so askest me
peace?”—“Sire,” he said, “I
will not lie,—if thou wouldst
hear me a little while.

“For I hunted up the
downs,—to look, Sire, after
my gain;—There I slew a
mutton,—yea, Sire, and a few
kids.—I am accused, sire, to
thee,—for that same crime;—
Sire, I shall clear myself,—I

The lafful man ssal be i-bund,
And i-do in strang pine,
And i-hold in fast prisund,
Fort that he mak fine.
And the thef to skap so,
That doth ever aze the rízt.
God take hede therto,
That is al ful of mízt!

Thus farith al the world nuthe,
As we mai al i-se,
Both est and west, north and suthe;
God us help and the Trinité!
Trewth is i-faillid with fremid and sibbe,
And so wide as al this lond
Ne mai no man therin libbe,
What thro3 coveitise and thro3 onde.

Tho3 lafful man wold hold is lif
In love, in charité, and in pes,
Sone me ssul compas is lif,
And that in a litil res.
Prude is maister and coveitise,
The thrid brother men clippith ond;
Nízt and dai he fondith i-wisse
Lafful men, to hab har lond.

Whan erth hath erthe i-gette
And of erthe so hath i-nou3,
Whan he is therin i-stekke,
Wo is him that was in wou3!
What is the gode that man ssal hab,
Ute of this world whan he ssal go?
A sori wed,—whi ssal ic gab?—
For he bro3t him no mo.

Dist as he com, he ssal wend

gave them neither blow nor hurt.”

“For truth I tell thee, fair friend,—they had no good mind,—they who accused thee to me,—thou didst nothing but thy nature.—Tell thou me, ass, what hast thou done?—Methinks thou art capable of no good.—Why haddest thou not [done] as others more?—thou art come of wicked place.”

“Certes, Sire, I know not;—I eat sage and only grass,—more harm did I not;—therefore was I accused.”—“Fair friend, that was misdona,—that was against thy nature,—for to eat such grass so:—hastily ye him bind;

“Draw ye all his bones to pieces,—look that ye do not fail;—and that I give all for law,—that his flesh be all torn to pieces.”—Thus it fares now in the land,—whoever will take heed thereto:—of they that have in hand,—of thieves they take gifts.

The man who acts according to law shall be

Ri3t as he com, he ssal wellu,
In wo, in pine, in poverté;—
Takith gode hede, men, to 3ure end,
For as I sigge, so hit wol be.
Y not wharof beth men so prute;
Of erthe and axen, felle and bone?
Be the soule enis ute,
A vilir caraing nis ther non.

The caraing is so lolich to see,
That under erth men mot it hide;
Bothe wif and child wol fram him fle,
Ther nis no frend that wol him bide.
What wol men for the sowle del?
Corne no mel, wel thou wost;
Bot wel seld at the mele
A row3 bare trenchur, other a crust.

The begger that the crust ssal hab,
Wel hokerlich he lokith theran:
Soth to sigge, and no3t to gabbe,
Ri3t no3t he is i-paiid a pan.
Than seiith the begger in is mode,
“The crust is bothe hard and tough,
The wreche was hard that ow the gode,
Hard for hard is gode y-now3.”

Moch misanter that for him bidde
Pater noster other crede;
Bot let him hab as he didde,
For of the 3ift nath he no mede.
Ic red up no man thou hab triste.
No uppon non other;
Ok del hit with 3ure owen fist,
Trist to soster no brother.

Anurith God and holi chirch,

bound,—and condemned to
strong pain,—and held in fast
prison,—until he pays a fine.
—And the thief to escape so,
—that acts ever against the
right!—God take heed
thereto,—who is all full of
might!

Thus fares all the world
now,—as we may all see,—
both east and west, north and
south;—God and the Trinity
help us!—Truth is failed with
stranger and relation,—and as
wide as all this land—no man
can live therein,—what
through covetousness and
through contention.

Though the man who acts
according to law would hold
his life—in love, in charity,
and in peace,—soon they will
compass his life,—and that in
a little space of time.—Pride
is master and covetousness—
the third brother is called
contention;—night and day
they labour certainly—lawful
men, to have their land.

When earth has obtained
earth,—and thus of earth hast
enough,—when he is stuck
therein,—woe to him that was

And 3iveth the pour that habbith nede;
So Godis wille 3e ssul wirche,
And joi of heven hab to mede.
To whoch joi us bring
Jhesus Crist heven king! AMEN.

in wickedness!—What is the good that man shall have,—when he shall go out of this world?—A sorry garment,—why shall I joke?—For he brought him no more.

Just as he came, he shall go,—in woe, in pain, in poverty;—take good heed, men, to your end,—for as I say, so it will be.—I know not of what men are so proud;—of earth, and ashes, skin and bone?—when the soul is once out,—there is no viler carcase.

The carcase is so loathsome to see,—that under earth men must it hide;—both wife and child will from him fly,—there is no friend that will stay with him.—What will men for the soul give?—corn nor meal, well thou knowest;—but very seldom at their meal,—a rough bare trencher, or a crust.

The beggar that the crust shall have,—right scornfully he looks thereon:—truth to say, and not to joke,—right not a pan he is paid.—Then saith the beggar in his mood,—“The crust is both hard and

tough,—the wretch was hard
that possessed the goods,—
hard for hard is good
enough.”

May he have much
misadventure who for him
saith—Pater-noster or creed;
—but let him have as he did,
—for of the gift hath he no
reward.—I counsel thee have
trust in no man,—nor upon no
other;—but share it with your
own fist,—trust neither to
sister nor brother.

Honour God and holy
church,—and give to the poor
that have need;—Thus ye
shall work God’s will,—and
have for reward the joy of
heaven.—To which joy us
bring—Jesus Christ heaven’s
King. AMEN.

The scholastic philosophy flourished through the thirteenth century, the age of Albertus Magnus, of Grosteste, and of Roger Bacon; but, towards the close of that period, the importance of the schools and universities was rapidly declining. They had received a shock from the triumph of the monks over the scholars during the reign of St. Louis, which they could never recover. Political events, and the great change which was then operating in the whole

political—we may perhaps say social—system, hastened their fall. The nice quibbles of the dialectitian, although they still had their weight in the cloister, began to be sneered at in the world without. The following song, which perhaps belongs to the beginning of the fourteenth century, is directed against the *artistæ*, or those who studied the seven arts, the scholastic *trivium* and *quadrivium*.

SONG AGAINST THE SCHOLASTIC STUDIES.

[From MS. Cotton. Titus A. xx. fol. 66, v^o, written in reign of Edw. II.; and MS. Bodl. Oxford. Rawl. B. 214, fol. 168, v^o, of 15th cent.]

Meum est propositum gentis imperitæ
Artes frugi reddere melioris vitæ,
Et ad artes singulas procedatis rite:
Ad mea decepti juvenes documenta
venite.

Adversatur legibus omne genus cleri,
Cujus status hodie peior est quam heri;
Sua sacra presbiter quisque vult tueri.
Ingenium magni livor detraxit Homeri.

Quando contra boream nauta pandit
velum,
Et asellus vincere cursu vult camelum,
Non formidat ponere manus os in cœlum:
Vulneror et clausum porto sub pectore
telum.

Præferri bidentibus capra vult hirsuta,
Stulta non considerans unde sit induta;
Illi æqua vellera non sunt attributa:
Pennatis avibus quondam testudo locuta.

Cum sint nuda gloria logici contenti,
Sub egentis propere vivunt indumenti,
Verumtamen invident opulentæ genti.
Summa petit livor, perflant altissima
venti.

Modus est invidiæ semper, ut ab imis
Sursum tendant, ultima contradicunt
primis:

Invidere negligit infimo sublimis.
Invidus alterius rebus macescit opimis.

Si non cupis vivere pauper et
mendicus,

Semper in laboribus sicut servus Stichus,
Igni digna subjici sine fructu ficus,
Dilige sic alios ut sis tibi carus amicus.

Expedit pauperibus abhærere legi;

TRANSLATION.—It is my design to turn the arts of an unskilful race to the fruit of a better life, and so proceed ye to each of the arts in order: O youth who have been deceived, come to my lessons.—Every class of the clergy is opposed to the laws, of whom the condition to-day is worse than it was yesterday; every priest will hold his own rites: envy detracted from the talents of great Homer.—When the sailor spreads his sail against the north wind, and the ass thinks to conquer the camel in the race, then the hand fears not to put the face towards heaven; I am wounded and carry the weapon shut up in my breast.—The shaggy she-goat wishes to be preferred to the sheep, in her folly not considering with what she is clothed; so fine a fleece has not been given to her: as the tortoise once said to the winged birds.—Although the logicians are satisfied with naked glory, and live under the garb of the needy, nevertheless they envy the rich. Envy seeks the summit, the wind blows vehemently on lofty places.—It is always the manner of envy, that they aim from the bottom upwards, the last speak against the first: he who is elevated does not think it worth while to envy him who is most low. The envious man becomes lean by regarding the fatness of another.—If you do not desire to live poor and beggarly, always labouring like the servant Stichus, a fig-tree without fruit worthy to be cast in the fire; love others so that thou mayest be a dear friend to thyself.—It is good for poor men to adhere to the law; I have chosen to labour much on the arts. I am ignorant therefore how I may be guided, who once composed verses, while my study flourished.—If any one will expend his labour upon logic, will it not produce him thorns and brambles? in too much sweat he will eat his bread; and even that his talkative tongue will

Insudare nimium artibus elegi.
Ignoro propterea unde possum regi,
Carmina qui quondam studio florente
peregi.

Nonne circa logicam si quis laborabit,
Spinas atque tribulos illi germinabit?
In sudore nimio panem manducabit;
Vix tamen hoc illi garula lingua dabit.

In arenam logicus frustra semen serit,
Nam metendi tempore fructus nullus erit;
Circa ficum sterilem labor omnis perit.
Arbor qualis erit, talia poma gerit.

Licet sis ad apicem artium provectus,
Fies junioribus in brevi despectus;
Dicunt de te, "senio desipit affectus."
Æmula quid cessas finem properare
senectus?

Veræ pestilentiae cathedra tu sedes,
Qui Thebanas lectitas vel Trojanas cædes;
Affluunt divitiis legistarum sedes,
Et modo vadit equis qui solet ire pedes.

Propter artes vigilans est revera stultus;
Cur circa Georgicam pateris singultus?
Ager sic per steriles jaceat incultus,
Telluris si forte velis cognoscere cultus.

Propter leges merito labor est ferendus;
Ager reddens centuplum non est
deferendus.

Est libellus pauperum pauperi legendus;
Hic tibi præcipue sit pura mente
colendus.

Circa dialecticam tempus cur
consumis,
Tu qui nullos redditus aliunde sumis?
Colat qui per patriam natus est e summis,
Dives agro, dives positus in fænore

and even that his talkative tongue will hardly give him.—The logician in vain sows his seed in the sand, for in harvest time there will be no fruit; upon a barren fig-tree all labour is lost. Such as is the tree, such will be the fruit it bears.—Although you be arrived at the summit of the arts, you will be in a short time despised by the younger aspirants; they will say of thee, "he doats, affected with old age." Old age, why do you emulous cease to hasten the end?—Thou sittest in the chair of a true pestilence, who readest the tragedy of Thebes or of Troy; [whilst] the seats of the legists abound in riches, and now he goes on horseback who used to go on foot.—He who sits up at night to study the arts is truly a fool; why do you yawn over the Georgic? thus the field may lie neglected and barren, while by chance you may be desirous of understanding the culture of the earth.—It is right that we should labour upon the laws; a field that produces a hundred-fold is not to be set aside. The book of the poor is to be read by the poor man; this chiefly is the book to be devotedly cultivated by thee.—Why do you consume your time upon dialectics, thou who receivest no income from other sources? Let him cultivate it who is born of high family in the country, rich in land and rich in money laid out at interest.—Let the rich man learn to be strong in fallacies; let him learn to make a she-goat of the person of chance. Let him never desert the arts, before the hour of his death. Satisfied with fame, let Lucan lie hid in the gardens.—If imbued in the arts he should chance to fail, he will fly to the legists if he will be safe: because he knows no more how to defend himself than one who is dumb, having pursued too much and too often the study of the Greeks.—I see the halls of the nobles open; when the legist comes, the bolts are undone; thou, shut out, mayest sit at the door, although thou thyself Homer

nummis.

Dives in fallaciis discat esse fortis;
Discat capram facere de persona sortis.
Artes nunquam deserat citra tempus
mortis.

Contentus fama lateat Lucanus in hortis.

Si forte deliquerit artibus imbutus,
Ad legistas fugiet si vult esse tutus:
Quia se defendere nescit plus quam
mutus,
Græcorum studia nimium diuque
sequutus.

Atria nobilium video patere;
Cum legista venerit dissolvuntur ceræ.
Exclusus ad januam poteris sedere,
Ipse licet venias musis comitatus,
Homere.

Logicus araneæ potest comparari,
Quæ subtiles didicit telas operari,
Quæ suis visceribus volunt consummari;
Est pretium musca, si forte queat
laqueari.

Si fortuna logico favet in privigno,
Vultu namque logicum respicit benigno;
Si sit dives logicus hoc sub cœli signo;
Rara avis in terra nigroque simillima
cigno.

Naturæ cognoscere si velis archana,
Stude circa physicam quæ dat membra
sana:

Sat quicquid expostulat egestas humana,
Sat Galienus opes et sanctio Justiniana.

the door, although thou thyself, Homer, shouldst come along with the muses.—The logician may be compared to a spider, which learns to spin subtle webs, that are made out of its own bowels; the reward is a fly, if by chance it can be netted.—If fortune favour a logician in his kindred, for she looks upon the logician with a benignant countenance; if a logician be rich under this sign of the heavens; he is a rare bird upon earth, and very like a black swan.—If you wish to know the secrets of nature, study physic which gives health to the limbs; what man's need requires is enough, Galen and the sanction of Justinian are riches enough.

The following English verses, composed at the same period, seem also intended as a satire upon the studies and arguments of the dialectitians.

THE SONG OF "NEGO."

[From MS. Harl. No. 913, fol. 58, v^o. written in 1308.]

Hit nis bot trewth, I wend, an afte
For te sette *nego* in eni crafte;
Trewth so drawith to heven blisse,
Nego doth noȝt so i-wisse.
For-sak and save is thef in lore,
Nego is pouer clark in store.
Whan menne horlith ham here and there,
Nego savith ham fram care.
Awei with *nego* ute of place!
Whose wol have Goddis grace;
Whoso wol azens the devil fizte,
Ther mai *nego* sit a-riȝte.
Ak loke that we never more
Nego sette in trew lore.
For whoso can lite, hath sone i-do,
Anone he drawith to *nego*.
Now o clerk seiith *nego*;
And that other *dubito*;
Seiith another *concedo*;
And another *obligo*,
Verum falsum sette therto;
Than is al the lore i-do.
Thus the fals clerkes of har hevid,
Makith men trewth of ham be revid.

TRANSLATION.—It is
contrary to truth, I believe,
and ...—to set *nego* in any
craft;—truth draweth us to the
joy of heaven,—*nego* does
not so certainly.—Forsake and
save is a thief in doctrine,—
nego is a poor clerk in store.
—When men hurl them here
and there,—*nego* saves them
from care.—Away with *nego*
out of the place!—whoever
will have God's grace;—he
who will against the devil
fight,—there may *nego* sit
rightly.—But see that we
never more—set *nego* in true
doctrine.—For he who knows
little has soon done,—anon he
draws to *nego*.—Now one
clerk says *nego*;—and the
other *dubito*;—saith another
concedo;—and another
obligo,—with *verum falsum*
set to it;—then is all their
learning done.—Thus the
false clerks of their head,—
make men of truth through
them be bereaved.

The Scottish wars occupied incessantly the remaining years of Edward's reign. The following song was composed probably in the September of the year 1306, soon after the battle of Kirkencliff, and on the immediate occasion of the execution of Sir Simon Fraser, who was taken prisoner there.

SONG ON THE EXECUTION OF SIR SIMON FRASER.

[MS. Harl. 2253, fol. 59, v^o. of reign of Edw. II.]

Lystneth, lordynges, a newe song ichulle
bigynne,
Of the traytours of Scotlond that take
beth wyth gynne;
Mon that loveth falsnesse and nule never
blynne,
Sore may him drede the lyf that he is
ynne,

ich understonde:
Selde wes he glad
That never nes a-sad
of nythe ant of
onde.

That y sugge by this Scottes that bueth
nou to-drawe,
The hevedes o Londone brugge whose
con y-knawe:
He wenden han buen kynges, ant seiden
so in sawe;
Betere hem were han y-be barouns ant
libbe in Godes lawe,
wyth love.

Whose hateth soth ant ryht,
Lutel he douteth Godes
myht,
the heye kyng
above.

To warny alle the gentilmen that bueth in
Scotlonde,
The Waleis wes to-drawe, seththe he was
an-honge,
Al quic biheveded, ys bowels y-brend,
The heved to Londone brugge wes send
to chide

TRANSLATION.—Listen,
lordings, a new song I will
begin,—of the traitors of
Scotland who are taken with a
trap;—he who loves
falseness, and will never leave
it,—sore may he dread the life
that he is in,—I believe:—
seldom was he glad—that
never was sorrowful—for his
wickedness and turbulence.

I say that of these Scots
who are now drawn,—their
heads on London bridge
anybody may recognise:—
they thought to have been
kings, and said so in their
talk;—better was it for them
to have been barons and live
in God's law,—with love.—
He who hateth truth and right,
—little he fears God's might,
—the high king above.

To be a warning to all the
gentlemen who are in
Scotland,—the Wallace was
drawn, and afterwards was
hanged,—beheaded all alive,
his bowels burnt,—the head
to London Bridge was sent—
to remain there.—Afterwards
Simon Fraser, who was traitor
and fickle,—and known full
wide

to abyue.

After Simond Frysel,
That wes traytour ant fykell,
and y-cud ful
wyde.

Sire Edward oure kyng, that ful ys of
pieté,
The Waleis quarters sende to is oun
contré,
On four half to honge, huere myrour to
be,
Therupon to thenche, that monie myhten
se

ant drede.

Why nolden he be war
Of the bataile of Donbar,
hou evele hem con
spede?

Bysshopes and barouns come to the
kynges pes,
Ase men that weren fals, fykel, ant les,
Othes hue him sworn in stude ther he
wes,
To buen him hold ant trewe for ailes
cunnes res,

thrye,

That hue ne shulden azeyn
him go,
So hue were temed tho;
weht halt hit to
lye?

To the kyng Edward hii fasten huere fay;
Fais wes here foreward so forst is in May,
That sonne from the southward wypeth

wiue.

Sir Edward our king, who
is full of piety,—sent the
Wallace's quarters to his own
country,—to hang in four
parts (of the country), to be
their mirror,—thereupon to
think, in order that many
might see—and dread.—Why
would they not take warning
—of the battle of Dunbar,—
how ill they sped?

Bishops and barons came
to the king's peace,—as men
that were false, fickle, and
lying,—oaths they swore to
him in the place where he
was,—to be firm and true to
him in all kinds of moments,
—thrice (?),—that they
should not against him go,—
so were they tamed then;—
what profits it to lie?

To King Edward they plight
their faith;—false was their
covenant as frost is in May,—
which the sun from the
southward wipes away;—
many a proud Scot thereof
may lament—in year.—Was
never Scotland—by dint of
man's hand—altogether
bought so dear.

away:
Moni proud Scot therof mene may
 to zere.
Nes never Scotlond
With dunt of monnes hond
 allinge a-boht so
 duere!

The Bisshop of Glascou ychot he was y-
 laht;
The Bisshop of Seint André bothe he beth
 y-caht;
The Abbot of Scon with the Kyng nis
 nout saht;
Al here purpos y-come hit ys to naht,
 thurh ryhte.
Hii were unwis
When hii thohte pris
 a3eyn huere kyng
 to fyhte.

Thourh consail of thes bisshopes y-
 nemned byfore,
Sire Robert the Bruytz furst kyng wes y-
 core,
He mai everuche day ys fon him se
 byfore;
3ef hee mowen him hente, ichot he bith
 forlore,
 sauntz fayle.
Soht for te sugge,
Duere he shal abugge
 that he bigon
 batayle.

Hii that him crounede proude were ant
 holde

The Bishop of Glasgow, I
wot he was taken;—the
Bishop of St. Andrew, too, he
is caught;—the Abbot of
Scone with the King is not ...;
—all their purpose is come to
nothing,—by right.—They
were unwise—when they
thought it praiseworthy—
against their king to fight.

Through counsel of these
bishops named before,—Sir
Robert the Bruce first was
chosen king,—he may every
day his foes see before him;—
if they may catch him, I wot
he is undone,—without fail.—
To say the truth,—dearly he
shall pay—for having begun
battle.

They that crowned him
were proud and bold,—they
made a king of summer, as
they never should,—they set
on his head a crown of red
gold,—and gave him a sceptre
as one should to a king,—to
judge.—When he was set on a
throne,—little good knew he
—a kingdom to rule.

Now King Hobbe gangeth
in the moors,—to come to
town he has no desire;—the
barons of England if they

bourde,
Hii maden kyng of somere, so hii ner ne
sholde,
Hii setten on ys heved a croune of rede
golde,
Ant token him a kyne-zerde so me kyng
sholde,

to deme.
Tho he wes set in see,
Lutel god couthe he
kyne-riche to
3eme.

Now Kyng Hobbe in the mures 3ongeth,
For te come to toun nout him ne
longeth;
The barouns of Engeland, myhte hue him
gripe,
He him wolde techen on Englysshe to
pype,

thourh streynthe:
Ne be he ner so stout,
3et he bith y-soht out
o brede and o
leynthe.

Sire Edward of Carnarvan, Jhesu him
save ant see!
Sire Emer de Valence, gentil knyht ant
free,
Habbeth y-suore huere oht that, *par la*
grace Dée!
Hee wollith ous delyvren of that false
contree,

3ef hii conne.
Much hath Scotlond forlore,
Whet a-last, whet bifore,

barons of England if they
might gripe him,—they would
teach him to pipe in English,
—through strength:—be he
never so stout,—yet he is
sought out—wide and far.

Sir Edward of Caernarvon,
(Jesus save him and have him
in regard!)—and Sir Aymer de
Valence, a gentle knight and
liberal,—they have sworn
their oath that, by the grace of
God!—they will deliver us
from that false country,—if
they can.—Much hath
Scotland lost,—what latterly
and what before,—and little
praise won.

Now I shall take up where I
left off before,—and tell you
of Fraser, as I promised you;
—in the battle of Kirkencliff
Fraser was taken;—his
countenance ceased from
making any boast—near
Stirling:—knights and swains,
—freemen and thanes,—
many with him.

They were so beset on
every part,—some were slain
and some drowned
themselves.—Sir John de
Lyndsay would not remain,—
he waded into the water with

ant lutel pris
wonne.

Nou ichulle fonge ther ich er let,
Ant tellen ou of Frisel, ase ich ou byhet;
In the batayle of Kyrkenclyf, Frysel was
y-take;

Ys continuaunce abated eny bost to make
byside Strivelyn:
Knyhtes ant sweynes,
Fremen ant theynes,
monye with hym.

So hii weren byset on everuche halve,
Somme slaye were, ant somme dreynte
hem-selve;
Sire Johan of Lyndeseye nolde nout
abyde,

He wod into the water his feren him
bysyde

to adrenche.
Whi nolden hii be war?
Ther nis non azeyn stare:—
why nolden by
hem by-
thenche?

This wes byfore Seint Bartholomeus
masse,

That Frysel wes y-take, were hit more
other lasse:

To Sire Thomas of Multone, gentil
baroun ant fre,

Ant to Sire Johan Jose, bytake tho wes he
to honde:

He wes y-fetered weel

his companions beside him—to drown.—Why would not they beware?—There is none looked again (?):—why would not they reflect?

It was before St. Bartholomew's mass,—that Fraser was taken, were it more or less:—To Sir Thomas de Multon, a gentle knight and liberal,—and to Sir John Jose, he was delivered then—in hand:—he was well fettered—both with iron and with steel,—to bring out of Scotland.

Soon afterwards the tidings came to the king;—they sent him to London with many an armed man;—he came in at Newgate, I tell it you faithfully,—a garland of leaves placed on his head—of green;—because he should be known—both by high and by low—as a traitor, I ween.

Fettered were his legs under his horse's belly;—both with iron and with steel manacled were his hands;—a garland of periwinkle set on his head;—much was the power that was taken from him—in land.—As may God

Both with yrn ant wyth steel,
to bringen of
Scotlonde.

Sone therafter the tydyng to the kyng
com;
He him sende to Londone with mony
armed grom;
He com yn at Newegate, y telle yt ou
aplyht,
A gerland of leues on ys hed y-dyht
of grene;
For he shulde ben y-knowe
Bothe of heze ant of lowe
for treytour, y
wene.

Y-fetered were ys legges under his horse
wombe;
Bothe with yrn ant with stel mankled
were ys honde;
A gerland of peruenke set on ys heved;
Muche wes the poer that him wes
byreved
in londe:
So God me amende!
Lutel he wende
so be broht in
honde.

Sire Herbert of Morham, feyr knyht ant
bold,
For the love of Frysel ys lyf wes y-sold;
A wajour he made, so hit wes y-told,
Ys heved of to smhyte zef me him brohte
in hold,
wat so bytyde.

amend me!—he little
supposed—so to be brought
in hand.

Sir Herbert of Morham, a
fair knight and bold,—for the
love of Fraser his life was
sold;—a wager he made, so it
was said,—to smite off his
head if they took him in hold,
—whatever betide.—Sorry
was he then,—when he might
know him—to ride through
the town.

Then said his squire a word
anon right,—“Sir, we are
dead, there is no creature to
help us;”—(the squire was
named Thomas de Bois)
—“now I wot our wager turns
to our sorrow,—so bet.”—I
give you to know,—their
heads were smitten off—
before the gate of the Tower.

It was on our Lady’s eve,
for truth I understand,—the
justices sat for the knights of
Scotland,—Sir Thomas de
Multon, a gentle knight and
wise,—and Sir Ralph de
Sandwich, who is much
esteemed in worth,—and Sir
John Abel;—more I might tell
by reckoning,—both of great

Sory wes he thenne,
Tho he myhte him kenne
thourh the toun
ryde.

Thenne seide ys scwyer a word anon
ryht,
“Sire, we beth dede, ne helpeth hit no
wyht,”—
(Thomas de Boys the scwyer wes to
nome)—
“Nou ychot oure wajour turneth us to
grome,
so y-bate.”

Y do ou to wyte,
Here heved wes of smyte
byfore the Tour
gate.

This wes on oure Levedy even, for sothe
ych understonde,
The justices seten for the knyhtes of
Scotlonde,
Sire Thomas of Multone, an hendy knyht
ant wys,
Ant Sire Rauf of Sondwyche that muchel
is told in pris,
ant Sire Johan
Abel;
Mo y mihte telle by tale,
Bothe of grete ant of smale,
3e knowen suythe
wel.

Thenne saide the justice, that gentil is ant
fre,

and of small,—ye know very
well.

Then said the justice, who
is gentle and free,—“Sir
Simon Fraser, the king’s
traitor hast thou been,—on
water and on land, as many
may see:—what sayest thou
thereto? how wilt thou clear
thyself?—do say.”—He knew
himself to be so foul,—he had
not whereon to trust—to say,
nay.

There he was judged, as it
was the law of the land,—
because he was traitor to his
lord, first he was drawn,—
upon a bullock’s hide forth he
was led:—for once in his life
he was a moody knight—in
heart.—Wickedness and sin,
—it is little gain—that makes
the body smart.

For all his great power, still
he was taken;—falseness and
treachery all come to nothing;
—when he was in Scotland,
little was his thought—of the
hard judgment which was
prepared for him—in a short
time.—He was four times
perjured—to the king there
before,—and that brought him
to the ground

"Sire Simond Frysel, the kynges traytour
hast thou be,
In water ant in londe, that monie myhten
se:
What sayst thou thareto? hou wolt thou
quite the?

do say."
So foul he him wiste,
Nede waron truste
for to segge, nay.

Ther he wes y-demed, so hit wes londes
lawe,
For that he wes lord-swyke, furst he wes
to-drawe,
Upon a retheres hude forth he wes y-tuht:
Sum while in ys time he wes a modi
knyht,

in huerte.
Wickednesse ant sunne,
Hit is lutel wunne
that maketh the
body
smerte.

For al is grete poer, 3et he wes y-laht;
Falsnesse ant swykedom, al hit geth to
naht;
Tho he wes in Scotlond, lutel wes ys
thoht
Of the harde jugement that him wes
bysoht

in stounde.
He wes four-sithe for-swore
To the kyng ther bifore,
ant that him brohte
to grounde

to the grounde.

With fetters and with gyves
I wot he was drawn,—from
the Tower of London, that
many might know,—in a
kirtle of sack-cloth in strange
wise,—and a garland on his
head of the new guise,—
through Cheap;—many a man
of England—to see Simon—
thither began to leap.

When he came to the
gallows, first he was hanged,
—beheaded all alive, though
it seemed to him long,—
afterwards he was opened, his
bowels burnt,—the head to
London Bridge was sent—for
disgrace:—As I may ever
thrive!—at one time he
thought—little there to stand.

They ride through the city,
as I may tell,—with game and
with solace, that was their
play,—to London Bridge they
took the way,—many was the
woman's child that thereon
lacks-a-day,—and said, alas!
—that he was born,—and so
vilely undone,—so fair a man
as he was.

Now stands the head above
the twi-bridge,—fast by

to ground.

With feteres ant with gyves ichot he wes
to-drowe,
From the Tour of Londone, that monie
myhte knowe,
In a curtel of burel a selkethe wyse,
Ant a gerland on ys heved of the newe
guyse,

thurh Cheepe;
Moni mon of Engeland
For to se Symond
thideward con
lepe.

Tho he com to galewes, furst he wes an-
honge,
Al quic by-heveded, thah him thohte
longe,
Seththe he wes y-opened, is boweles y-
brend,
The heved to Londone-brugge wes send
to shonde:
So ich ever mote the!
Sum while wende he
ther lutel to stonde.

He rideth thourh the sité, as y telle may,
With gomen and wyth solas, that wes
here play,
To Londone-brugge hee nome the way,
Moni wes the wyves chil that theron
laketh a day,

ant seide, alas!
That he wes i-bore,
Ant so villiche for-lore,
so feir mon ase he

Wallace, to say the truth;—
after succour from Scotland
long they may pray,—and
after help from France what
profits it to wait, (?)—I ween.
—It were better for him in
Scotland—with his axe in his
hand—to play on the green.

And the body hangs fast on
the gallows,—with iron clasps
long to last;—to guard well
the body, and the Scotch to
drive away (?),—four-and-
twenty there are for sooth at
least—by night.—If any one
were so hardy—the body to
remove—immediately to
attack them.

If Sir Robert the Bruce
were come to this land,—and
the Earl of Athol that is hard
in hand,—all the rest of the
common people, for truth I
understand,—might be full
blith, and thank God's
sending,—with right:—then
might each man—both ride
and go—in peace, without
fighting.

The traitors of Scotland
took counsel with themselves,
—to bring the barons of
England to death;—Charles of
France, as many a one said,—

was.

Nou stont the heved above the tu-brugge,
Faste bi Waleis, soth for te sugge;
After socour of Scotlond longe he mowe
prye,
Ant after help of Fraunce wet halt hit to
lye,

ich wene.

Betere him were in Scotlond
With is ax in ys hond
to pleyen o the
grene.

Ant the body hongeth at the galewes
faste,
With yrnene claspes longe to laste;
For te wyte wel the body, ant Scottyshe to
garste,
Foure ant twenti ther beoth to sothe ate
laste

by nyhte.

3ef eny were so hardi
The body to remuy
al so to dyhte.

Were Sire Robert the Bruytz y-come to
this londe,
Ant the Erl of Asseles, that harde is an
honde,
Alle the other pouraille, for sothe ich
understonde,
Mihten be ful blythe ant thonke Godes
sonde,

wyth ryhte:

Thenne myhte uch mon
Rothe riden ant son

with might and with strength
would help them,—thanks to
him!—Tprot, Scot, for thy
strife!—hang up thy hatchet
and thy knife,—while life
lasts to him—with the long
shanks.

Some men are gon
in pes withoute
vyhte.

The traytours of Scotlond token hem to
rede,
The barouns of Engelond to brynge to
dede;
Charles of Fraunce, so moni mon tolde,
With myht ant with streynthe hem helpe
wolde,

his thonkes!
Tprot, Scot, for thi strif!
Hang up thyn hachet ant thi
knyf,
Whil him lasteth the lyf
with the longe
shonkes.

The following song, remarkable for the playfulness of its metres and rhymes, gives us a strong picture of the extortions committed at this period of our history upon the weak and defenceless, by the magistrates and the officers connected with the courts of law.

SONG ON THE VENALITY OF THE JUDGES.

[From MS. Harl. No. 913, fol. 59, r^o. of the beginning of the 14th century.
This song is in the MS. written as prose.]

Beati qui esuriunt
Et sitiunt, et faciunt
justitiam,
Et odiunt et fugiunt
injuriae nequitiam;
Quos nec auri copia
Nec divitum encennia
trahunt a rigore,
nec pauperum clamore;
Quae sunt justa judicant,
Et a jure non claudicant
divitum favore.
Sed nunc miro more
Multos fallit seculum,
Et trahit in periculum,
mundi ob favorem,
ut lambeant honorem.
Hoc facit pecunia,
Quam omnis fere curia
jam duxit in uxorem.

Sunt justitiiarii,
Quos favor et denarii
alliciunt a jure;
Hii sunt nam bene recolo,
Quod censum dant diabolo,
et serviunt hii pure.
Nam jubet lex naturae,
Quod judex in judicio
Nec prece nec pretio
acceptor sit personae;
quid, Jhesu ergo bone,
Fiet de iudicibus,
Qui prece vel muneribus
cedunt a ratione?

TRANSLATION.—Blessed are they who hunger and thirst, and do justice, and hate and avoid the wickedness of injustice; whom neither abundance of gold nor the jewels of the rich draw from their inflexibility, or from the cry of the poor; they judge what is just, and do not fall off from the right for the sake of the rich. But now the age deceives many in a wonderful manner, and draws them into danger, for love of the world, that they may lick up honours. The cause of this is money, to which almost every court has now wedded itself.

There are judges, whom partiality and bribes seduce from justice; these are they, I remember well, that pay toll to the devil, and they serve him alone. For the law of nature commands, that a judge in giving judgment should not be an acceptor of anybody either for prayer or money; what therefore, O good Jesus, will be done with the judges, who for prayers or gifts recede from what is just?

In fact, such judges have

Revera tales iudices
Nuncios multiplices
 habent;—audi quare.
 Si terram vis rogare,
Accedet ad te nuncius,
Et loquitur discretius,
 dicens, “Amice care,
 vis tu placitare?
Sum cum iustitiano
Qui te modo vario
 possum adjuvare;
 si vis impetrare
Per suum subsidium,
Da michi dimidium,
 et te volo iuvare.”

Ad pedes sedent clerici,
Qui velut famelici
 sunt, donis inhiantes;
 et pro lege dantes,
Quod hii qui nichil dederint,
Quamvis cito venerint,
 erunt expectantes.

Sed si quædam nobilis,
Pulcra vel amabilis,
 cum capite cornuto,
 auro circumvoluto,
Accedat ad iudicium,
Hæc expedit negotium
 ore suo muto.

Si pauper muliercula,
Non habens munuscula,
 formam neque genus,
 quam non pungit Venus,

in fact such judges have
numerous messengers;—
listen for what purpose. If you
wish to claim land, a
messenger will come to you,
and speaks in confidence,
saying, “Dear friend, do you
wish to plead? I am one who
can help you in various ways
with the judge; if you wish to
obtain anything by his aid,
give me half, and I will help
you.”

At his feet sit clerks, who
are like people half-famished,
gaping for gifts; and
proclaiming it as law, that
those who give nothing,
although they come early, will
have to wait.

But if some noble lady, fair
and lovely, with horns on her
head, and that encircled with
gold, come for judgment,
such a one despatches her
business without having to
say a word.

If the woman be poor, and
has no gifts, neither beauty
nor rich relationship, whom
Venus does not stimulate, she
goes home without effecting
her business, sorrowful at
heart.

Infecto negotio
 Suo pergit hospitio,
 dolendo corde tenus.

 Sunt quidam ad hanc curiam,
 Qui exprimunt iudicium;
 dicuntur relatores;
 cæteris peiores.
 Utraque manu capiunt,
 Et sic eos decipiunt
 quorum sunt tutores.
 Et quid janitores?
 Qui dicunt pauperibus
 Curiam sequentibus,
 “Pauper, cur laboras?
 Cur facis hic moras?
 Nisi des pecuniam
 Cuique ad hanc curiam,
 in vanum laboras.
 Quid, miser, ergo ploras?
 Si nichil attuleris,
 stabis omnino foras.”

 De vicecomitibus,
 Quam duri sunt pauperibus,
 quis potest enarrare?
 Qui nichil potest dare,
 Huc et illuc trahitur,
 Et in assisis ponitur,
 et cogitur jurare,
 non ausus murmurare.
 Quod si murmuraverit,
 Ni statim satisfecerit,
 est totum salsum mare.

 Hoc idem habent vitium,
 Cum subeunt hospitium

There are some at this
 court, who express judgment;
 whom they call relaters,
 worse than the others. They
 take with both hands, and so
 deceive those whose
 defenders they are. And what
 shall we say to the ushers?
 who say to the poor that
 follow the court, “Poor man,
 why do you trouble yourself?
 why do you wait here? unless
 you give money to everybody
 in this court, you labour in
 vain. Why then, wretch, do
 you lament? If you have
 brought nothing, you will
 stand altogether out of doors.”

Concerning the sheriffs,
 who can relate with sufficient
 fulness how hard they are to
 the poor? He who has nothing
 to give is dragged hither and
 thither, and is placed in the
 assises, and is obliged to take
 his oath, without daring to
 murmur. But if he should
 murmur, unless he
 immediately make
 satisfaction, it is all salt sea.

The same people have this
 vice, when they enter the
 house of some countryman, or
 of a famous abbey, where

Cum subeunt hospitium
 cujusdam patriotæ,
 vel abbathiæ notæ,
Quo potus et cibaria,
Et cuncta necessaria,
 eis dentur devote.
Nil prosunt sibi talia,
Nisi mox jocalia
 post prandium sequantur,
 et cunctis largiantur,
Bedellis, garcionibus,
Et qui sunt secum omnibus.
 Nec adhuc pacantur,
 nisi transmittantur
Robæ suis uxoribus
Ex variis coloribus.
 Si non clam mittantur,
 Et post sic operantur;
Quotquot habent averia
Ad sua maneria
 cum impetu fugantur,
 et ipsi imparcantur
Quousque satisfecerint,
Ita quod duplum dederint;
 tunc demum liberantur.

Clericos irrideo
Suos, quos prius video
 satis indigentes,
 et quasi nil habentes,
Quando ballivam capiunt;
Qua capta mox superbiunt,
 et crescunt sibi dentes,
 collaque erigentes,
Incipiunt perpropere
Terras et domos emere,
 et redditus placentes.

of a famous abbey, where
drink and victuals, and all
things necessary, are given to
them devoutly. Such things
are of no avail, unless by and
by the jewels follow after the
meal, and are distributed to
all, bedels and garçons, and
all who are with them. Nor
even yet are they paid, unless
robes of various colours are
transmitted to their wives. If
these are not sent privately,
then they proceed as follows;
whatever cattle they find, are
driven off violently to their
own manors, and the owners
themselves are put in
confinement until they make
satisfaction, so that they give
the double: then at length they
are liberated.

I laugh at their clerks,
whom I see at first indigent
enough, and possessing next
to nothing, when they receive
a bailiwick; which received
they next show themselves
proud, and their teeth grow,
and holding up their necks
they begin very hastily to buy
lands and houses, and
agreeable rents; and amassing
money themselves, they
despise the poor, and make
new laws oppressing their

et regibus placentes,
nummosque colligentes,
Pauperes despiciunt,
Et novas leges faciunt,
vicinos opprimentes;
fiuntque sapientes.
In hoc malum faciunt,
Et patriam decipiunt,
nemini parcentes.

new laws, oppressing their
neighbours; and they become
wise men. In this they do
wickedness, and deceive their
country, sparing no one.

The next song was doubtlessly considered as very libellous at the time when it was composed, and professes to have been written in the wild wood; the means of publication being to drop it on the high road, that it might fall into the hands of passengers. It is directed against one of the king's ordinances.

THE OUTLAW'S SONG OF TRAILLEBASTON.

[MS. Harl. No. 2253, fol. 113, v^o. of the reign of Edw. II.]

Talent me prent de rymer e de geste fere
 D'une purveaunce qe purveu est en la
 terre;
 Mieux valsit uncore que la chose fust à
 fere:
 Si Dieu ne prenge garde, je quy que
 sourdra guere.

Ce sunt les articles de Trayllebastoun;
 Salve le roi meismes, de Dieu eit
 maleysoun
 Qe a de primes graunta tiel commissioun!
 Quar en ascuns des pointz n'est mie
 resoun.

Sire, si je voderai mon garsoun chastier
 De une buffe ou de deus, pur ly amender,
 Sur moi betera bille, e me frad atachier,
 E avant qe isse de prisone raunsoun grant
 doner.

Quaraunte souz pernent pur ma raunsoun,
 E le viscounte vint à son guerdoun,
 Qu'il ne me mette en parfonde prisoun.
 Ore agardez, seigneurs, est-ce resoun?

Pur ce me tendrai antre bois sur le jolyf
 umbray;
 Là n'y a fauceté ne nulle male lay;—
 En le bois de Belregard, où vole le jay,
 E chaunte russinole touz jours santz
 delay.

Mès le male doseynes, dount Dieu n'ait
 jà pieté!
 Parmi lur fauce bouches me ont enditée

TRANSLATION.—I am seized with the desire to rhyme and to make a story,—of a purveyance which is provided in the land;—it would be much better if the thing were still undone:—if God does not avert it, I think that there will arise war.

It is the articles of Traillebaston;—except the king himself, may he have God's curse—whoever first granted such a commission!—For there is little reason in any of the points of it.

Sire, if I wished to chastise my lad—with a slap or two, to amend him,—he will ask a bill against me, and will cause me to be arrested,—and to give a great ransom before I escape from prison.

Forty shillings they take for my ransom,—and the sheriff comes for his fee,—that he may not put me in deep prison.—Now consider, lords, is this right?

For this cause I will keep myself among the woods, in the beautiful shade;—where there is no falseness and no bad law;—in the wood of Beauregard, where the jay flies,—and where the nightingale sings always without ceasing.

But the bad idlers, on whom may God have no pity!—with their false mouths have indited me—of ill robberies and other delinquency,—so that I dare not be received among my friends.

I have served my lord the king in peace and in war,—in Flanders, Scotland, and his land of Gascony;—but now I do not know how to make any expedient for myself;—all my time I have spent in vain to please such a man.

If these wicked jurors will not amend,—that I may be able to ride and go at my peace,—if I can reach them I will make their heads fly off,—I would not give a penny for all their threats

De male robberies e autre mavestée,
Que je n'os entre mes amis estre
receptée.

J'ai servi my sire le roy en péés e en
guere,
En Flaundres, Escoce, en Gascoyne sa
terre;
Mès ore ne me sai-je point chevisaunce
fere;—
Tot mon temps ay mis en veyn pur tiel
honme plere.

Si ces maveis jurours ne se vueillent
amender,
Que je pus à mon pais chevalcher e aler,
Si je les pus ateindre la teste lur froi
voler,
De touz lur manaces ne dorroi un denier.

Ly Martyn et ly Knoville sunt gent de
pieté,
E prient pur les povres qu'il eyent
sauveté;
Spigurnel e Belflour sunt gent de cruelté,
Si il fuissent en ma baylie ne serreynt
retornée.

Je lur apre[n]droy le giw de
Traylebastoun,
E lur bruseroy l'eschyne e le cropoun,
Les bras e les jaunbes, ce serreit resoun,
La lange lur tondroy e la bouche ensoun.

Qy cestes choses primes comença,
Jà jour de sa vie amendé ne serra;
Je vus di pur veyr, trop graunt pecché en

give a penny for an evil threat.

The Martin and the Knoville are people of piety,—and pray for the poor that they may have safety;—Spigurnel and Belflour are people of cruelty,—if they were in my keeping they should not be returned.

I would teach them the game of Trailebaston,—and would break their backbone and their crupper,—their arms and their legs, it would be but right,—I would cut their tongues and their mouths likewise.

He who first commenced these things,—never in his life will he be amended;—I tell you for truth, he has committed therein too great a sin,—for out of the fear of prison there will be many a robber made.

He will become a robber who was never so before,—who for fear of prison dare not come to peace;—it is necessary to have livelihood every day as it comes;—he who commenced this thing, undertook a great task.

Well may merchants and monks bestow a curse—on all those who ordained the Trailebaston;—the royal protection will not be worth a garlic to them,—if they do not repay the pence without recompense.

You who are indited, I advise you, come to me,—to the green wood of Beauregard, there where there is no plea,—except wild beast and beautiful shade;—for the common law is too much to be feared.

If thou knowest letters, and art enraged,—thou shalt be called before the justices;—again you may be returned to prison,—in keeping of the bishop, until you be cleansed;—and suffer mis-ease and too hard penance,—and perchance you will never have deliverance.

THE END OF THE FIRST PART.

a,
Quar pur doute de prisone meint laroun
serra.

Ytel devendra leres que ne fust unque
mès,
Que pur doute de prisone ne ose venir à
pes;
Vivre covient avoir chescum jour adès;
Qy ceste chose comenca, yl emprist grant
fes.

Bien devoient marchaunz e moygnes
doner maliçoun
A tous iceux que ordinerent le
Traillebastoun;
Ne lur vaudra un ayle le roial
proteccioun,
Que il ne rendront les deners sauntz
regerdoun.

Vus qy estes endité, je lou, venez à moy,
Al vert bois de Belregard, là n'y a nul
ploy,
Forque beste savage e jolyf umbroy;
Car trop est dotouse la commune loy.

Si tu sachez de lettrure, e estes coroucé,
Devaunt les justices serrez appellée;
Uncore poez estre à prisone retournée,
En garde de le evesque, jesque seiez
purgée,
E soffryr messayse e trop dure penaunce,
E par cas n'averez jamès delyveraunce.

Pur ce valt plus ou moi à bois demorer,
N'en prisone le evesque fverge avser

Therefore it is better to dwell with me
in the wood,—than to lie cast in the
bishop's prison.—Too much is the
penance, and hard to suffer;—he who
has the opportunity to select what is
better, is a fool if he does not make the
choice.

Before I knew little what was good,
now I am less wise;—the bad laws
cause this by very great outrage,—so
that I dare not come to the peace among
my kindred;—the rich are put to
ransom, the poor to prison.

It would be penible to engage what
cannot be acquitted;—that is the life of
man which is so dearly loved;—and I
have not at all the goods wherewith to
be bought off;—but if I were in their
power I should be put to death.

Yet if I should expect grace and hear
people talk,—those would say evil to
me who dare not approach me,—and
would willingly see my body disgraced.
—But God can save a man in the midst
of a thousand devils.

He can save me, who is the son of
Mary;—for I am not culpable, I am
indited out of malice;—God's curse be
on those who drove me to this place!—
The world is so variable, that he is a
fool who trusts in it.

If I am a companion and know
archery,—my neighbour will go and say,
“This man belongs to a company,—to
go hunt in the wood and do other
folly;”—so now I will live as a pig will
lead his life.

If I happen to know more law than
they know,—they will say this
conspirator begins to be treasonable,—
and I will not approach home within ten
leagues of them;—of all
neighbourhoods cursed be those.

I pray all good people that they will
pray for me,—that I may be able to go

Q en prison le évesque l'erge gysen.
Trop est la penaunce e dure à soffrer;
Quy le mieux puet eslyre, fol est qe ne
velt choyser.

Avant savoy poy de bien, ore su-je meins
sage;
Ce me fount les male leis par mout grant
outrage,
Qe n'os à la pes venyr entre mon lignage;
Les riches sunt à raunsoun, povres à
escolage.

Fort serroit engager ce qe ne puet estre
aquytée,
C'est la vie de honme que taunt est cher
amée.
E je n'ay mye le chatel de estre rechatée;
Mès si je fusse en lur baundoun à mort
serroi lyverée;

Uncore attendroy grace e orroi gent
parler,
Tiels me dient le mal que me ne osent
aprochier.
E volenters verroient mon corps
ledenger;
Mès entre myl debles Dieu puet un
honme sauver.

Cely me pust salver que est le fitz Marie;
Car je ne su coupable, endité su par
envye;
Qy en cesti lu me mist, Dieu lur maldie!
Le siècle est si variant, fous est qe
s'affye.

Si ie poi compaignon e esche de

and ride to my country;—I was never a
homicide, at least by design,—nor an ill
robber to do people damage.

This rhyme was made in the wood
beneath a bay tree,—there sings the
thrush, the nightingale, and the hawk
cries (?);—it was written on parchment
to be better remembered,—and cast in
the highway, that people may find it.

Si je sei compaignoun e sachie de
archerye,
Mon veisyn irra disaunt, “cesti est de
compagnie,
De aler bercer à bois e fere autre folie;”
Que ore vueille vivre come pork merra sa
vye.

Si je sache plus de ley qe ne sevent eux,
Yl dirrout, “cesti conspyratour comence
de estre faus,”
E le heyre n’aprocheroy de x. lywes en
d’eus;
De tous veysinages hony seient ceux.

Je pri tote bone gent qe pur moi vueillent
prier,
Qe je pus à mon pais aler e chyvaucher;
Unqe ne fu homicide, certes à moun
voler,
Ne mal robberes pur gent damager.

Cest rym fust fet al bois desouz un lorer,
Là chaunte merle, russinole, e cyre
l’esperver;
Escrit estoit en parchemyn pur mout
remenbrer,
E gitté en haut chemyn, qe um le dust
trover.

The following song is a satire upon the numerous retinues of the nobles and rich people, whose idle attendants and servants preyed upon the produce of the industrious peasantry. It shows us how

great were the pride and ostentation of the courtiers of the latter years of Edward the First.

A SONG AGAINST THE RETINUES OF THE GREAT PEOPLE.

[MS. Harl. 2253, fol. 124, v^o; of reign of Edw. II.]

Of ribaudz y ryme
Ant rede o mi rolle,
Of gedelynges, gromes,
Of Colyn ant of Colle,
Harlotes, hors-knaves,
Bi pate ant by polle;
To devel ich hem to-lvyre
Ant take to tolle!

The gedelynges were gedered
Of gonnylde gnoste;
Palefreiours ant pages,
Ant boyes with boste;
Alle weren y-haht
Of an horse thoste:
The devel huem afretye,
Rau other a-roste!

The shuppare that huem shupte,
To shome he huem shadde,
To fles ant to fleye,
To tyke ant to tadde;
So seyth Romaunz,
Whose ryht radde,—
Fleh com of flore,
Ant lous com of ladde.

The harlotes bueth horlynges,
Ant haunteth the plawe:
The gedelynges bueth glotouns,
Ant drynketh er hit dawe.
Sathanas huere syre
Seyde on is sawe,
Gobelyn made is gerner
Of gromene mawe.

TRANSLATION.—Of ribalds I
rhyme—and read in my roll,
—of gadlings, grooms,—of
Colin and of Colle,—
scoundrels, horse-boys,—by
pate and by poll;—to the devil
I them deliver—and give for
toll.

The gadlings were gathered
—of ...;—palfrey-keepers and
pages,—and boys with boast;
—all were ...—of a horse ...:
—may the devil devour them
—raw or roasted!

The maker that made them,
—he shed them to shame,—to
fleas and to fly,—to tyke and
to toad;—so saith Romanz,—
whoever read right,—fly
comes of flower,—and louse
comes of lad.

The rogues are horelings,—
and haunt the play:—the
gadlings are gluttons,—and
drink before it dawns.—Satan
their sire—said in his saying,
—Goblin made his garner—
of the grooms' maw.

The knave crams his crop
—before the cock crows;—he
mumbles and mocks,—and
marrs his maw;—when he is

The knave crommeth is crop,
Er the cok crawe;
He momeleth ant moccheth,
Ant marreth is mawe;
When he is al for-laped,
Ant lad over lawe,
A doseyn of doggen
Ne myhte hyre drawe.

The rybaudz a-ryseth
Er the day rewe;
He shrapeth on is shabbes,
Ant draweth huem to dewe.
Sene is on is browe
Ant on is eze-brewе,
That he louseth a losynger,
And shoyeth a shrewe.

Nou beth capel-claweres
With shome to-shrude;
Hue bosketh huem with botouns,
Ase hit were a brute;
With lowe lacede shon
Of an hayfre hude,
Hue pyketh of here provendre
Al huere prude.

Whose rykeneth with knaves
Huere coustage,
The luthernesse of the ladde,
The prude of the page,
Thah he zeve hem cattes-dryt
To huere companage,
3et hym shulde a-rewen
Of the arrerage.

Whil God was on earth

all weary of lapping (?),—and
laid over law,—a dozen of
dogs—could not draw him.

The ribalds arise—before
the day breaks;—they scrape
on their scabs,—and draw
themselves to the dew.—Seen
it is on his forehead—and on
his eye-brows, that he looseth
a flatterer,—and shoeth a
shrew.

Now are horse-clawes—
shamefully clothed;—they
busk them with buttons—as it
were a bride:—with low laced
shoes—of a heifer's hide,—
they pick out of their
provender—all their pride.

Whoever reckons with
knaves—their expense,—the
perverseness of the lad,—the
pride of the page,—though he
give them cats' dirt—for their
sustenance,—yet he shall rue
—of the arrears.

While God was on earth—
and wandered wide,—what
was the reason—why he
would not ride?—Because he
would not have a groom—to
go by his side,—nor the
grudging of any gadling—to
jeer or to chide.

with God wes on erthe
And wondrede wyde,
Whet wes the resoun
Why he nolde ryde?
For he nolde no grom
To go by ys syde,
Ne grucchyng of no gedelyng
To chaule ne to chyde.

Spedeth ou to spewen,
Ase me doth to spelle;
The fend ou afretie
With fleis ant with felle!
Herkneth hideward, horsmen,
A tidying ich ou telle,
That 3e shulen hongen,
Ant herbarewen in helle!

jaw or to chide.

Haste you to spew,—as
men do to spell (talk);—may
the fiend devour you—with
flesh and with skin!—Harken
this way, horsemen,—a tiding
I tell you,—that ye shall hang,
—and be lodged in hell.

REIGN OF EDWARD II. 1307–1327.

Edward the First quitted the stage at a period when wars from without and internal troubles were gathering fast over his country. His son and successor, a weak and ill-advised prince, was little calculated to repel the one or to calm the other; and the following song shows us that, contrary to the general rule in such cases, the people were more sorrowful for their loss than pleased with the novelty of a new monarch.

LAMENT ON THE DEATH OF EDWARD I.

[MS. Bibl. Publ. Cantab. Gg. I. 1, fol. 489, of the reign of Edw. II.]

Seigniurs, oiez, pur Dieu le grant,
 Chançonete de dure pité,
De la mort un rei vaillaunt;
 Homme fu de grant bounté,
 E que par sa leauté
Mut grant encuntre ad sustenue;
 Ceste chose est bien prové;
De sa terre n'ad rien perdue.
 Priom Dieu en devocioun
 Que de ses pecchez le face pardoun.

De Engleterre il fu sire,
 E rey qe mut savoit de guere;
En nule livre puet home lire
 De rei qe mieuz sustint sa tere.
 Toutes les choses qu'il vodreit fere,
Sagement les tinst à fine.
 Ore si gist soun cors en tere:
Si va le siècle en decline.

Le rei de Fraunce grant pecché fist,
 Le passage à desturber
Qe rei Edward pur Dieu emprist,
 Sur Sarazins l'ewe passer.
 Sun tresour fust outre la mere,
E ordine sa purveaunce
 Seint eglise pur sustenire:
Ore est la tere en desperaunce.

Jerusalem, tu as perdu
 La flour de ta chivalerie,
Rey Edward le viel chanu,
 Qe tant ama ta seignurie.
 Ore est-il mort; jeo ne sai mie
Toun baner qi le meintindra:
 Sun duz quor nar grant drierie

TRANSLATION.—Lords,
listen, for the sake of God the
great,—a little song of
grievous sorrow,—for the
death of a precious king;—a
man he was of great
goodness,—and who by his
loyalty—has sustained many
a great encounter;—this thing
is proved well;—of his land
he lost none.—Let us pray
God with devotion—that he
pardon him his sins.

Of England he was lord,—
and a king who knew much of
war;—in no book can we read
—of a king who sustained
better his land.—All the
things which he would do,—
wisely he brought them to an
end.—Now his body lies in
the earth;—and the world is
going to ruin.

The King of France did
great sin,—to hinder the
voyage—which King Edward
undertook for God's sake,—to
pass the water against the
Saracens.—His treasure was
beyond the sea,—and he
ordains his purveyance—to
sustain holy church:—now is
the land in despair.

Outre la mere vous mandera.

Un jour avant que mort li prist,
Od son barnage voleit parler;
Les chivalers devant li vist,
Durement commença de plurer.
“Jeo murrai,” dist, “par estover,
Jeo vei ma mort que me vent quere;
Fetes mon fiz rey corouner,
Qe Dampnt-Dieu li don bien fere!”

A Peiters à l’apostoile
Une messenger la mort li dist;
E la Pape vesti l’estole,
A dure lermes les lettres prist.
“Alas!” ceo dist, “comment? morist
A qi Dieu donna tant honur?
A l’alme en face Dieu mercist!
De seint eglise il fu la flour.”

L’apostoile en sa chambre entra,
A pein le poeit sustenir;
E les cardinals trestuz manda,
Durement commença de plurir.
Les cardinals li funt teisir,
En haut commencent lur servise:
Parmy la cité funt sonir,
Et servir Dieu en seint eglise.

L’apostoile meimes vint à la messe,
Oue mult grant sollempnité;
L’alme pur soudre sovent se dresse,
E dist par grant humilité:
“Place à Dieu en Trinité,
Qe vostre fiz en pust conquere
Jerusalem la digne cité,

Jerusalem, thou hast lost—
the flower of thy chivalry,—
King Edward the old and
hoary,—who loved so much
thy lordship.—Now he is
dead; I know not at all—who
will maintain thy banner:—
his gentle heart for great love
—he will send you over the
sea.

One day before death took
him,—he would talk with his
baronage;—he saw the
knights before him,—
grievously he began to weep.
—“I shall die,” he said, “of
necessity,—I see my death
which comes to seek me;—
cause my son to be crowned
king,—may the Lord God
give him grace to do well!”

At Poitiers to the pope—a
messenger told his death;—
and the pope put on the stole,
—with bitter tears he took the
letters.—“Alas!” he said,
“how? is he dead—to whom
God gave so much honour?—
May God grant mercy to his
soul!—he was the flower of
holy church.”

The pope entered in his
chamber,—he could scarcely

E passer en la seinte tere!”

Le jeofne Edward d’Engleterre
Rey est enoint e corouné:
Dieu le doint teil conseil trere,
Ki le pais seit gouverné;
E la coroune si garder,
Qe la tere seit entere,
E lui crestre en bounté,
Car prodhome i fust son pere.

Si Aristotle fuste en vie,
E Virgile qe savoit l’art,
Les valurs ne dirr[ai]ent mie
Del prodhome la disme part.
Ore est mort le rei Edward,
Pur qui mon quor est en trafoun;
L’alme Dieu la salve garde,
Pur sa seintime passioun! AMEN.

support it;—and he sent for all the cardinals,—grievously he began to weep.—The cardinals made him desist,—aloud they begin their service they cause the bells to be rung through the city,—and God’s service to be performed in holy church.

The pope himself came to the mass,—with very great solemnity;—he often applies himself to absolve the soul,—and said in great humility:—“May it please God in Trinity,—that your son may effect the conquest—of Jerusalem the noble city,—and pass into the Holy Land!”

The young Edward of England—is anointed and crowned king:—may God grant that he follow such counsel,—that the country may be governed;—and so to keep the crown,—that the land may be entire,—and himself to increase in goodness,—for his father was a worthy man.

If Aristotle were alive,—and Virgil who knew skill,—they would not say the value—of the worthy man a tenth

OF THE WORLDLY MAN A TENDR
part.—Now is dead King
Edward,—for whom my heart
is in desolation;—may God
preserve his soul in safety,—
for the sake of his holy
passion! Amen.

The following song, in English, on the same event, is preserved in another manuscript. It is somewhat singular that one of these songs is clearly translated from the other, the variations being comparatively small, and consisting chiefly in the transposition of some of the stanzas. The French song was probably the original.

ELEGY ON THE DEATH OF EDWARD I.

[MS. Harl. No. 2253, fol. 73, r^o. of the reign of Edw. II.]

Alle that beoth of huerte trewe,
 A stounde herkneth to my song,
 Of duel that deth hath diht us newe,
 That maketh me syke ant sorewe
 among;
 Of a knyht that wes so strong,
 Of wham God hath don ys wille:
 Me thuncheth that deth hath don us
 wrong,
 That he so sone shal ligge stille.

Al Englund ahte for te knowe
 Of wham that song is that y synge;—
 Of Edward kyng that lith so lowe,
 3ent al this world is nome con springe.
 Trewest mon of alle thinge,
 Ant in werre war ant wys,
 For him we ahte oure honden wrynge,
 Of Christendome he ber the prys.

Byfore that oure kyng wes ded,
 He speke ase mon that wes in care,—
 “Clerkes, knyhtes, barouns,” he sayde,
 “Y charge ou by oure sware,
 That 3e to Englonde be trewe.
 Y de3e, y ne may lyven na more;
 Helpeth mi sone ant crouneth him
 newe,
 For he is nest to buen y-core.

“Ich biquethe myn herte aryht,
 That hit be write at mi devys,
 Over the see that hue be diht,
 With fourscore knyhtes al of prys,
 In werre that buen war ant wys,
 A3evn the hethene for te fvhte

TRANSLATION.—All that are
 true of heart,—a while
 hearken to my song,—of grief
 that death hath wrought us
 now,—which makes me sigh
 and sorrow in turns.—Of a
 knight that was so powerful,
 —on whom God hath done
 his will;—methinks that death
 has done us wrong,—that he
 so soon shall lie still.

All England ought to know
 —of whom the song is that I
 sing;—of Edward the king
 that lies so low,—through all
 this world his name sprang.—
 Trewest man of all things,—
 and in war wary and wise,—
 for him we ought our hands to
 wring,—of Christendom he
 bare the prize.

Before that our king was
 dead,—he spoke as one that
 was in care,—“Clergy,
 knights, barons,” he said,—“I
 charge you by your oath,—
 that ye to England be true.—I
 die, I may not live any more;
 —help my son, and crown
 him now,—for he is next to be
 chosen.

“I bequeath my heart
 rightlv—that it be written at

Ageyn the heathen for to fynde,

To wynne the croiz that lowe lys;
Myself ycholde ȝef that y myhte.”

Kyng of Fraunce, thou hevedest sunne,
That thou the counsail woldest fonde,
To latte the wille of kyng Edward
To wende to the holy londe:
That oure kyng hede take on honde
Al Engeland to ȝeme ant wysse,
To wenden into the Holy Londe,
To wynnen us heve[n]riche blisse.

The messenger to the Pope com,
And seyde that oure kyng was ded:
Ys oune hond the lettre he nom,
Y-wis his herte was ful gret:
The Pope himself the lettre redde,
Ant spec a word of gret honour,—
“Alas!” he seide, “is Edward ded?
Of Christendome he ber the flour!”

The Pope to is chaumbre wende,
For del ne mihte he speke na more;
Ant after cardinals he sende,
That muche couthen of Cristes lore,
Bothe the lasse ant eke the more,
Bed hem bothe rede ant synge:
Gret deol me myhte se thore,
Mony mon is honde wrynge.

The Pope of Peyters stod at is masse,
With ful gret solempneté,
Ther me con the soule blesse:—
“Kyng Edward, honoured thou be!
God lene thi sone come after the
Bringe to ende that thou hast bygonne;

rightly, and it be written at
my devise,—over the sea that
it be sent,—with fourscore
knights all of repute,—in war
that are wary and wise,—
against the heathen for to
fight,—to win the cross which
lies low;—myself I would
[go] if I could.”

King of France, thou hadst
sin,—that thou shouldest seek
counsel,—to hinder the will
of King Edward—to go to the
Holy Land:—that our king
had taken in hand—all
England to rule and teach,—
to go into the Holy Land,—to
win us heaven’s bliss.

The messenger to the pope
came,—and said that our king
was dead:—to his own hand
the letter he took,—truly his
heart was very full:—the pope
himself the letter read,—and
spake a word of great honour,
—“Alas!” he said, “is Edward
dead?—of Christendom he
bare the flower!”

The pope to his chamber
went,—he could speak no
more for grief;—and after the
cardinals he sent,—who knew
much of Christ’s doctrine,—
both the less and also the

The holy crois y-mad of tre,
So fain thou woldest hit han y-wonne!

“Jerusalem, thou hast i-lore
The flour of al chivalerie;
Now Kyng Edward liveth na more:—
Alas! that he ȝet shulde deye!
He wolde ha rered up fol heyȝe
Oure baners, that bueth broht to grounde;
Wel longe we mowe clepe and crie
Er we a such kyng han y-founde!”

Nou is Edward of Carnarvan
King of Engeland al aplyht,
God lete him ner be worse man
Then is fader, ne lasse of myht
To holden is pore-men to ryht,
Ant understonde good consail,
Al Engeland for te wisse ant diht;
Of gode knyhtes darh him nout fail.

Thah mi tonge were mad of stel,
Ant min herte y-ȝote of bras,
The godnesse myht y never telle
That with Kyng Edward was:
Kyng, as thou art cleped conquerour,
In uch bataille thou hadest pris;
God bringe thi soule to the honour
That ever wes ant ever ys,
That lesteth ay withouten ende!
Bidde we God ant oure Ledy,
To thilke blisse Jesus us sende. AMEN.

greater,—bade them both read
and sing;—great grief might
be seen there,—many a man
to wring his hands.

The pope of Poitiers stood
at his mass,—with very great
solemnity,—there they began
to bless the soul:—“King
Edward, honoured be thou!—
God give thy son, who comes
after thee,—to bring to end
what thou hast begun;—the
holy cross made of wood,—so
fain thou wouldst it have won.

“Jerusalem, thou hast lost
—the flower of all chivalry;
—now King Edward lives no
more:—Alas! that he yet
should die!—He would have
reared up full high—our
banners, that are brought to
the ground;—very long we
may call and cry—before we
have found such a king!”

Now is Edward of
Caernarvon—entirely King of
England,—God let him never
be worse man—than his
father, nor less of might—to
hold his commons to right,—
and to understand good
counsel,—all England to
direct and manage;—of good
knyghts there need not fail

might have need not fail
him.

Though my tongue were
made of steel,—and my heart
produced out of brass,—I
could never tell the goodness
—that was with King
Edward:—King, as thou art
called conqueror,—in each
battle thou haddest prize;—
God bring thy soul to the
honour—which ever was and
ever is,—which lasts ever
without end!—Pray we God
and our Lady,—to that bliss
Jesus us send! AMEN.

The old cry against the oppression of the poor and honest by the rich, and the general corruption of the age, is repeated in the following piece. It probably describes the state of feeling amongst many in the earlier years of Edward's reign.

SONG ON THE TIMES.

[MS. Reg. 12, C. xii. fol. 7, r^o. of reign of Edw. II.]

Quant honme deit parleir, videat quæ
 verba loquatur;
 Sen covent aver, ne stultior inveniatur.
 Quando quis loquitur, bote resoun reste
 therynne,
 Derisum patitur, ant lutel so shal he
 wyne.
 En seynt eglise sunt multi sæpe priores;
 Summe beoth wyse, multi sunt inferiores.
 When mon may mest do, tunc velle suum
 manifestat,
 In donis also, si vult tibi præmia præstat.
 Ingrato benefac, post hæc à peyne te
 verra;
 Pur bon vin tibi lac non dat, nec rem tibi
 rendra.
 Sensum custodi, quasi mieu valt sen qe ta
 mesoun;
 Thah thou be mody, robur nichil est sine
 resoun.
 Lex lyth doun over al, fallax fraus fallit
 ubique;
 Ant love nys bote smal, quia gens se
 gestat inique.
 Wo walketh wyde, quoniam movet ira
 potentes:
 Ryht con nout ryde, quia vadit ad
 insipientes.
 Dummodo fraus superest, lex nul nout
 lonen y londe;
 Et quia sic res est, ryth may nout
 radlyche stonde.
 Fals mon freynt covenant, quamvis tibi
 dicat, "habebis."
 Vix dabit un veu gaunt, lene les mon

TRANSLATION.—When a man has to
 speak, let him consider what words he
 utters;—he ought to pay attention to
 them, lest he appear a fool.—When any
 one speaks, unless reason rest therein,—
 he is laughed at, and so he shall gain
 little.—In holy church there are often
 many who hold advanced situations;—
 some are wise, many are inferior.—
 When a man may do most, then he
 exhibits his will,—in gifts also, if he
 will he gives thee presents.—Do a
 kindness to an ungrateful man, and
 afterwards he will scarcely look at you;
 —he will not even give you milk for
 good wine, nor will he make you any
 return.—Take care of thy intellect, as of
 a thing which is worth more than thy
 house;—although thou be moody,
 strength is nothing without reason.—
 Law lies down over all, false fraud
 deceives everywhere;—and there is but
 little love, because people conduct
 themselves wickedly.—Woe walks
 wide, since anger moves those who are
 powerful;—right cannot ride, because it
 goes to the ignorant.—Now that fraud is
 alive, law will not dwell in the land;—
 and since the matter is in that position,
 right may not easily stand.—The false
 man breaks his promise, although he say
 to thee, "thou shalt have it."—He will
 scarcely give an old glove, ... thou shalt
 afterwards weep.—Mine and thine are
 two, which break the love of the people;
 —these two for us will cause frequent
 grief.—Treason injures, and reason is
 given to few;—reason makes sure,
 while treason confounds all things.—
 Peace may not well be, while it stands
 by two names;—Lord Christ, do thou
 look to it, through thee may there be a
 medicine for these things!—The sick
 man dies, although the art of medicine
 lie by his side;—the living man is
 deceived, there is none who shall abide
 here.—You will find many such as will
 take very much from you: in the end

postea flebis.
Myn ant thyn duo sunt, qui frangunt
plebis amorem;
Ce deus pur nus sunt facienda sæpe
dolorem.
Tresoun dampnificat, et paucis est data
resoun;
Resoun certificat, confundit et omnia
tresoun.
Pees may nout wel be, dum stat per
nomina bina;
Lord Crist, that thou se, per te sit in hiis
medicina!
Infirmus moritur, thah lechcraft ligge
bysyde;
Vivus decipitur, nis non that her shal
abyde
Tels plusours troverez, qui de te plurima
prendrout;
Au dreyn bien verrez, quod nullam rem
tibi rendrout.
Esto pacificus, so myh thou welde thy
wylle;
Also veridicus, ant stond pro tempore
stille.
Pees seit en tere, per te, Deus, alma
potestas!
Defendez guere, ne nos invadat egestas.
God Lord Almyhty, da pacem, Christe
benigne!
Thou const al dyhty, fac ne pereamus in
igne!

take very much from you,—in the end
you will see well, that they will return
you nothing.—Be pacific, so mayest
thou possess thy will;—also a teller of
truth, and stand for the time still.—May
there be peace in the land, through thee,
God, kind power!—forbid war, lest
want invade us.—Good Lord Almighty,
give peace, O benignant Christ!—Thou
canst do all things, hinder us from
perishing in the fire.

The following song appears to have been made in the latter end of the year 1311, on the occasion of the King's journey to the North, where he was joined by his lately banished favourite, Peter

de Gaveston, and disregarded the charter which he had confirmed in the beginning of the October of that year.

ON THE KING'S BREAKING HIS CONFIRMATION OF MAGNA CHARTA.

[The Auchinleck MS. in the Advocates' Library, at Edinburgh, art. 21, of the reign of Edw. II.]

L'en puet fere et defere,
 Ceo fait-il trop sovent;
 It nis nouthur wel ne faire;
 Therefore Engeland is shent.
 Nostre prince de Engleterre,
 Par le conseil de sa gent,
 At Westminster after the feire
 Made a gret parlement.
 La chartre fet de cyre,
 Jeo l'enteink et bien le crey,
 It was holde to neih the fire,
 And is molten al away.
 Ore ne say mès que dire,
 Tout i va à Tripolay,
 Hundred, chapitle, court, and shire,
 Al hit goth a devel way.
 Des plusages de la tere
 Ore escotez un sarmoun,
 Of iiij. wise-men that ther were,
 Whi Engeland is brouht adoun.

The ferste seide, "I understonde
 Ne may no king wel ben in londe,
 Under God Almihte,
 But he cunne himself rede,
 Hou he shal in londe lede
 Everi man wid rihte.
 For might is riht,
 Liht is night,
 And fiht is fliht.
 For miht is riht, the lond is laweles;
 For niht is liht, the lond is loreles;
 For fiht is fliht, the lond is nameles."

That other seide a word ful god,
 "Wherfore cometh again the fied

TRANSLATION.—A person
 may make, and unmake,—it
 is what he too often does;—it
 is neither well nor fair;—on
 account of it England is
 ruined.—Our prince of
 England,—by the counsel of
 his people,—at Westminster
 after the fair—made a great
 parliament.—The charter he
 made of wax,—so I
 understand, and I readily
 believe it,—it was held too
 near the fire,—and is all
 melted away.—Now I know
 not what more to say,—all
 goes to Tripoly,—hundred,
 chapter, court, and shire,—all
 it goes the devil's way.—Of
 the wisest men of the land—
 now listen to a discourse,—of
 four wise men that there were,
 —why England is brought
 down.

The first said, "I understand
 —no king may be prosperous
 in land—under God Almighty,
 —unless he can counsel
 himself,—how he shall in
 land lead—every man with
 right.—For might is right,—
 light is darkness,—and fight
 is flight.—Because might is
 right, the land is lawless;—

whoso roweth agene the flood,
Off sorwe he shal drinke;
Also hit fareth bi the unsele,
A man shal have litel hele
Ther agein to swinke.

Nu on is two,
Another is wo,
And frend is fo.
For on is two, that lond is streintheles;
For wel is wo, the lond is reutheles;
For frend is fo, the lond is loveles.”

That thridde seide, “It is no wonder
Off thise eyres that goth under,
Whan theih comen to londe
Proude and stoute, and ginneth zelpe,
Ac of thing that sholde helpe
Have theih noht on honde.

Nu lust haveth leve,
Thef is reve,
And pride hath sleve.
For lust hath leve, the lond is theweles;
For thef is reve, the lond is penyles;
For pride hath sleve, the lond is
almusles.”

The ferthe seide, that he is wod
That dwelleth to muchel in the flod,
For gold or for auhte;
For gold or silver, or any wele,
Hunger or thirst, hete or chele,
Al shal gon to nohte.

Nu wille is red,
Wit is qued,
And god is ded.
For wille is red, the lond is wrecful;
For wit is qued, the lond is wrongful;

because darkness is light, the
land is without doctrine;—
because fight is flight, the
land is without reputation.”

The second said a very
good word,—“Whoever rows
against the flood,—he shall
drink of sorrow;—thus it fares
by the unfortunate,—a man
shall have little strength—to
labour against it.—Now one
is two,—another is woe,—and
friend is foe.—Because one is
two, the land is without
strength;—because weal is
woe, the land is without ruth;
—because friend is foe, the
land is without love.”

The third said, “It is no
wonder—of these heirs that
go under,—when they come
to land—proud and stout, and
begin to yelp,—but of
anything that might help—
they have nought in hand.—
Now lust hath leave,—thief is
magistrate,—and pride hath
sleeves.—Because lust hath
leave, the land is destitute of
morality;—because thief is
magistrate, the land is
pennyless;—because pride
hath sleeves, the land is
without alms.”

For god is ded, the lond is sinful.

Wid wordes as we han pleid,
Sum wisdom we han seid
 Off olde men and 3unge;
Off many a thinge that is in londe,
Whoso coude it understonde,
 So have I told wid tongue.

Riche and pore, bonde and fre,
That love is god, 3e mai se;
 Love clepeth ech man brother;
For it that he to blame be,
For3if hit him *par charité*,
 Al theih he do other.

Love we God, and he us alle,
That was born in an oxe stalle,
 And for us don on rode.
His swete herte-blod he let
For us, and us faire het
 That we sholde be gode.

Be we nu gode and stedefast,
So that we muwen at the last
 Haven hevene blisse.
To God Almihti I preie
Lat us never in sinne deie,
 That joye for to misse.

Ac lene us alle so don here,
And leve in love and god manere,
 The devel for to shende;
That we moten alle i-fere
Sen him that us bouhte dere,
 In joye withoute ende. AMEN.

The fourth said, "That he is mad—who dwells too much in the flood,—for gold or for property;—for gold or silver, or any weal,—hunger or thirst, heat or cold,—all shall go to nothing.—Now will is counsel,—wit is wicked,—and good is dead.—Because will is counsel, the land is full of revenge;—because wit is wicked, the land is full of wrong;—because good is dead, the land is full of sin."

With words as we have played,—some wisdom we have said—of old men and young;—of many a thing that is in land,—whoever might understand it,—thus have I told with tongue.

Rich and poor, bond and free,—that love is good, ye may see;—love calls every man brother;—for that for which he may be to blame,—forgive it him in charity,—although he do other.

Love we God, and may he love us all,—who was born in an oxe's stable,—and for us placed on the cross.—His sweet heart's blood he shed—

for us, and bade us fairly—
that we should be good.

Be we now good and
steadfast,—so that we may at
last—have the bliss of
heaven.—To God Almighty I
pray,—let us never die in sin,
—to miss that joy.

But grant us all so to do
here,—and live in love and
good manner,—the devil for
to shame;—that we may all in
company—see him that
bought us dearly,—in joy
everlasting. AMEN.

Edward's wretched favourite, Peter de Gaveston, was beheaded by the Barons in the May of 1312. The two following songs exhibit the general feeling of exultation which attended this execution. It is scarcely necessary to say that they are parodies on two hymns in the old church service.

SONGS ON THE DEATH OF PETER DE GAVESTON.

[MS. Trin. Coll. Cambr. O. 9. 38. 15th cent. on paper.]

I.

De Petro de Gaverstone.

Vexilla regni prodeunt,
 fulget cometa comitum,
 Comes dico Lancastriæ
 qui domuit indomitum;
 Quo vulneratus pestifer
 mucronibus Walensium,
 Truncatus est atrociter
 in sexto mense mensium.
 Impleta sunt quæ censuit
 auctoritas sublimium;
 Mors Petri sero patuit,—
 regnavit diu nimium.
 Arbor mala succiditur,
 dum collo Petrus cæditur:—
 Sit benedicta framea
 quæ Petrum sic aggreditur!
 Beata manus jugulans!
 beatus jubens jugulum!
 Beatum ferrum feriens
 quem ferre nollet sæculum!
 O crux, quæ pati pateris
 hanc miseram miseriam,
 Tu nobis omnem subtrahe
 miseriæ materiam!
 Te, summa Deus Trinitas,
 oramus prece sedula,
 Fautores Petri destruas
 et conteras per sæcula! AMEN.

II.

Pange. lingua. necem Petri qui turbavit

TRANSLATION.—I. The
 banners of the kingdom go
 forth, the comet of Earls
 shines, I mean the Earl of
 Lancaster, who tamed him
 whom nobody else could
 tame; whereby the pestiferous
 one being wounded by the
 blades of the Welsh, was
 disgracefully beheaded in the
 sixth month. What the
 authority of the powers above
 willed has been fulfilled; the
 death of Peter at last has been
 effected,—he reigned much
 too long. The bad tree is cut
 down, when Peter is struck on
 the neck:—Blessed be the
 weapon which thus
 approached Peter! Blessed be
 the hand which executed him!
 blessed the man who ordered
 the execution! blessed the
 steel which struck him whom
 the world would not bear any
 longer! O Cross, which
 allowed to be suffered this
 wretched misery, do thou take
 from us all the material of
 misery. Thee, highest God in
 Trinity, we pray earnestly,
 destroy and crush for ever the
 maintainers of Peter. AMEN.

II. Celebrate, my tongue,

Angliam,
 Quem rex amans super omnem prætulit
 Cornubiam;
 Vult hinc comes, et non Petrus, dici per
 superbiam.
 Gens est regni de thesauri fraude facta
 condolens,
 Quando Petrus de thesauro prodige fit
 insolens,
 Quid ventura sibi dies pariat non
 recolens.
 Hoc opus nostræ salutis, quod Petrus
 interiit;
 Multiformis proditoris ars tota deperiit;
 Ex nunc omen cor lætetur, quia væ
 præteriit.
 Quando venit apta rei plenitudo
 temporis,
 Est præcisum caput ei de junctura
 corporis;
 Turbans turbas intra regnum nunc
 turbatur a foris.
 Nulli volens comparari, summo fastu
 præditus,
 Se nolente subdit collum passioni
 deditus;
 De condigna morte cujus est hic hymnus
 editus.
 Perdit caput qui se caput paribus
 præposuit:
 Rite corpus perforatur cujus cor sic
 tumuit:
 Terra, pontus, astra, mundus, plaudant
 quod hic corruit.
 Trux, crudelis inter omnes, nunc a
 nomnis abstinet:

the death of Peter who
 disturbed England, whom the
 king in his love for him
 placed over all Cornwall;
 hence in his pride he will be
 called Earl, and not Peter.—
 The people of the kingdom
 was made sorrowful for the
 fraud upon the treasure, when
 Peter becomes wastefully
 insolent with the treasury, not
 bearing in mind what the
 future day may produce for
 him.—This is the work of our
 salvation, that Peter is dead;
 all the artfulness of the
 multifarious traitor has
 perished; henceforth let the
 good omen rejoice our hearts,
 for sorrow is past.—When the
 fulness of time which was fit
 for the thing came, his head is
 cut off from the juncture of
 the body; he who raised
 troubles within the kingdom
 is now troubled from without.
 —He who was unwilling to
 have an equal, clothed in the
 extreme of pride, against his
 will bends his neck to the
 executioner; of whose merited
 death this hymn is set forth.—
 He who placed himself as a
 head above his equals, loses
 his own head; justly his body
 is pierced, whose heart was so

~~Pompæ summus,~~
Jam non ultra sicut comes, vel ut rex, se
 continet;
Vir indignus, morte dignus, mortem
 dignam sustinet.
Flexis ramis arbor illa ruit in
 proverbia;
Nam rigor lentescit ille quem dedit
 superbia;
Sic debet humiliari qui sapit sublimia.
Ædes Petri qua tenetur non sit fulta
 robore;
Sit prophanus alter locus, sit et in
 dedecore,
Quem fœdus cruor fœdavit fusus Petri
 corpore!
Gloria sit creatori! gloria comitibus
Qui fecerunt Petrum mori cum suis
 carminibus!
A modo sit pax et plausus in Anglorum
 finibus! AMEN.

putted up; both land, sea, stars, and world, rejoice in his fall.—Ferocious and cruel among all men, he ceases now from his pomp; now he no longer behaves himself like an earl, or a king; the unworthy man, worthy of death, undergoes the death which he merits.—This tree with its branches bent falls into a proverb; for the stiffness which pride gave is softened; thus ought the ambitious and aspiring man to be humbled.—May the house of Peter, in which he is held, not be supported in strength; may the other place be profane, and may it be in disgrace, which the filthy gore spilled from Peter's body has defiled!—Glory be to the Creator! Glory to the Earls who have made Peter die with his charms! Henceforth may there be peace and rejoicing throughout England! AMEN.

The events of the Scottish war during the reign of Edward II. were not of a character to draw forth the songs of triumph which had attended the campaigns of his father. The loss of his father's conquests, and the reverses of his own arms, while they produced

universal dejection, only tended to widen the breach which his own folly had made between himself and his people. The following song was made in 1313, immediately after the disastrous battle of Bannockburn, where the Earl of Gloucester was slain. The writer, while he laments the humiliation to which his country had been reduced, glances from time to time at the evil counsels which had led to it.

THE BATTLE OF BANNOCKBURN.

[From MS. Cotton. Titus, A. xx., fol. 68 r^o. written in the reign of Ed. III.]

*Quomodo comes Gloverniæ fuerat
occisus apud Strivelyn, et Anglici
victi.*

Me cordis augustia cogit mira fari,
Scotiæ quod Anglia cæpit subjugari:
Nova jam prodigia dicitur patrari,
Quando matri filia sumit dominari.

Regionum Anglia plurimum matrona,
Cui tributaria jam dabantur dona,
Proth dolor! nunc cogitur nimis esse
prona

Filiæ, qua læditur materna corona.

Exiit per Angliam edictum vulgare,
Admonendo quempiam arma præparare,
Ut adiret Scotiam phalanx vindicare
Jura, vel injuriam posse vindicare.

Ad quod thema debeam nimis
protelare:

Rex cæpit militiam suam adunare,
Inconsultus abiit Scotos debellare.
Ira sponte rediit nolens plus obstare.

Erant in exercitu plures generosi,
Milites in exitu nimis et pomposi;
Cum ad bellum venerant tot impetuosius,
Satis prompti fuerant hostes animosi.

Animosi fuerant et hoc apparebat;
Cum partes certaverant, illa permanebat
Stabilis, sed fugiit quæ superbiebat.
Inproba succubuit, astuta vincebat.

Inauditus ingruit inter hos conflictus;
Primitus prosiliit Acteus invictus,
Comes heu! Gloverniæ dans funestos
ictus;

Assistens in acie qui fit derelictus.

Hic phalanges hostium diemini coegit

TRANSLATION.—Perplexity of heart compels me to tell wonderful things, that England begins to be subjected to Scotland: it is said that new prodigies are now performed, when the daughter takes upon her to lord it over the mother.—England the matron of many regions, to whom tributary gifts were given, is now, alas! constrained too much to be prostrate to the daughter, by whom the maternal crown is injured.—A general proclamation went through England, admonishing everybody to take up arms, that the army might go to Scotland to vindicate our rights, or to be able to avenge our injury.—To which theme I ought to procrastinate very much; the king began to assemble his troops, unadvisedly he went to make war on the Scots: his anger voluntarily subsided, unwilling longer to hold out.—There were in the army many nobles, knights who were too showy and pompous; when so many impetuous men came to the conflict, the courageous enemies were ready enough.—They were courageous, as will appear; when the two sides engaged, that one remained firm, but that which had shown so much pride fled. The wicked party succumbed, the cunning one conquered.—An unheard-of battle thickened between them; first rushed forward the unconquered Actæus, the Earl of Gloucester, alas! giving fatal blows; who, standing in the thick of the battle, is deserted.—He compelled the troops of the enemy to break, and subdued the bodies of strong men; but one of his own chosen retainers, he was not a fool when he ruined the affair.—This is the traitorous man, Bartholomew, whom in all victories may God confound! Because he has been to his master as changeable as a

Ant.—Gaude Thoma, ducum decus,
 lucerna Lancastriæ,
 Qui per necem imitaris Thomam
 Cantuariæ;
 Cujus caput conculcatur pacem ob
 ecclesiæ,
 Atque tuum detruncatur causa
 pacis Angliæ;
 Esto nobis pius tutor in omni
 discrimine.

Oratio.—Deus, qui, pro pace et
 tranquillitate regnicolarum Angliæ,
 beatum Thomam martyrem tuum atque
 comitem gladio persecutoris occumbere
 voluisti, concede propitius, ut omnes qui
 ejus memoriam devote venerantur in
 terris, præmia condigna cum ipso
 consequi mereantur in cœlis, p̄ dñ. ñ.

Prosa.—Sospitati dat ægrotos precum Thomæ
 fusio;
 Comes pius mox languentum adest in
 præsidio;
 Relevantur ab infirmis infirmi suffragio.
 Sancti Thomæ quod monstratur signorum
 indicio.
 Vas regale trucidatur regni pro remedio,
 O quam probat sanctum ducem morborum
 curatio!
 Ergo laudes Thomæ sancto canamus cum
 gaudio;
 Nam devote poscens illum, statim
 proculdubio

TRANSLATION.—*Anthem.*—
 Rejoice, Thomas, the glory of
 chieftains, the light of
 Lancaster, who by thy death
 imitatest Thomas of
 Canterbury; whose head was
 broken on account of the
 peace of the Church, and
 thine is cut off for the cause
 of the peace of England; be to
 us an affectionate guardian in
 every difficulty.

Prayer. O God, who, for
 the peace and tranquillity of
 the inhabitants of England,
 willed that the blessed
 Thomas thy martyr and Earl
 should fall by the sword of
 the persecutor, grant
 propitious, that all who
 devoutly reverence his
 memory on earth, may merit
 to obtain worthy reward along
 with him in heaven, through
 our Lord.

Prosa. The pouring out of
 prayers to Thomas restores
 the sick to health; the pious
 Earl comes immediately to
 the aid of those who are
 feeble; they are relieved from
 their infirmities by the
 suffrage of one who was
 edited. So that it is shown by

Sequentia.—Summum regem honoremus,
 dulcis pro memoria
 Martyris, quem collaudemus
 summa reverentia.
 Thomas comes appellatur,
 stemmate egregio;
 Sine causa condempnatur,
 natus thoro regio.
 Qui cum plebem totam cernit
 labi sub naufragio,
 Non pro jure mori spernit,
 lætali commercio.
 O flos militum regalis,
 tuam hanc familiam
 Semper conserves a malis,
 perducens ad gloriam!
 AMEN.

Pange, lingua, gloriosi comitis
 martyrium,
 Sanguinisque præciosi Thomæ floris
 militum,
 Germinisque generosi laudis, lucis
 comitum.

De parentis utriusque regali prosapia
 Prodit Thomas, cujus pater proles erat
 regia,
 Matrem atque sublimavit reginam
 Navarria.

Dux fidelis suum gregem dum
 dispersum conspicit,
 Æmulumque suum regem sibi motum
 meminit,

the evidence of the miracles of St. Thomas, that the royal vessel is beheaded for the cure of the kingdom. O how the cure of diseases declares the sainted leader! Therefore with rejoicing let us sing praises to St. Thomas; for he who asks him devoutly, immediately without doubt he will return healed.

Sequence. Let us honour the highest King, for the memory of the sweet martyr, whom we join in praising with the utmost reverence. He is called Earl Thomas, of an illustrious race; he is condemned without cause, who was born of a royal bed. Who when he perceived that the whole commons were falling into wreck, did not shrink from dying for the right, in the fatal commerce. O royal flower of knights, preserve ever from evils this thy family, bringing them to glory! AMEN.

Declare, my tongue, the martyrdom of the glorious Earl, and of the precious blood of Thomas the flower of knights, and of the praise

Mox carnalem juxta legem in mirum
contremuit.

Benedicti benedictus capitur vigilia,
Agonista fit invictus statim die tertia,
Diræ neci est addictus, ob quod luget
Anglia.

Proht dolor! acephalatur plebis pro
juvamine,
Suorumque desolatur militum stipamine,
Dum dolose defiantur per sudam
Hoylandiæ.

Ad sepulcrum cujus fiunt frequenter
miracula,
Cæci, claudi, surdi, muti, membra
paralytica,

Prece sua consequuntur optata præsidia.

Trinitati laus et honor, virtus et
potentia
Patri, proli, flaminique sacro sit per
sæcula,

Quæ nos salvat a peccatis Thomæ per
suffragia! AMEN.

O jam Christi pietas,
Atque Thomæ caritas
palam elucescit!
Heu! nunc languet æquitas,
Viget et impietas,
veritas vilescit!
Nempe Thomæ bonitas,
Ejus atque sanctitas,
indies acrescit;
Ad cujus tumbam sospitas
Ægris datur, ut veritas
cunctis nunc clarescit.
Coniosæ caritatis

of the noble sprout, the light
of Earls.—Thomas sprang
from a royal race by both his
parents, whose father was the
son of a king, and whose
mother Navarre raised to be a
queen.—The faithful leader
when he saw that his flock
was dispersed, and he called
to mind that his king was
moved with jealousy towards
him, soon according to the
law of the flesh he trembled
wonderfully.—The blessed
man is taken on the vigil of
St. Benet, on the third day he
is suddenly made an
unconquered champion, he is
delivered to dire death, on
account of which England
mourns.—Alas! he is
beheaded for the aid of the
commons, he is deserted by
the company of his knights,
whilst he is treacherously
deserted by Robert de
Hoyland.—At whose tomb
are frequently performed
miracles; the blind, the lame,
the deaf, the dumb, and
paralytics, by his prayer
obtain the help they desire.—
Praise and honour, virtue and
power be to the Trinity,
Father, Son, and Holy Ghost,
for ever, which preserve us

Soprano Cantata

Thoma pugil strenue,
Qui pro lege libertatis
decertasti Angliæ,
Interpella pro peccatis
nostris patrem gloriæ
Ut ascribat cum beatis
nos cœlestis curiæ. AMEN.

from sin through the
intercession of Thomas!
AMEN.

O now the piety of Christ,
and the charity of Thomas,
shine openly! Alas! equity
now pines away, and impiety
flourishes, truth is made vile!
Yet the goodness of Thomas,
and his sanctity, daily
increase; at whose tomb
health is given to the sick, that
the truth may now be clear to
all.

O Thomas, strenuous
champion of plentiful charity,
who didst combat for the law
of England's liberty, intercede
for our sins with the Father of
Glory, that he may give us a
place with the blessed in the
heavenly court. AMEN.

APPENDIX.

EXTRACTS FROM PETER LANGTOFT'S CHRONICLE.

EDWARD THE FIRST'S WAR WITH SCOTLAND IN 1294.

[From a MS. in the Public Library of the University of Cambridge, Gg. I. 1, fol. 337, written early in the reign of Edw. II.—The Collations are from MS. Cotton. Julius, A. v. fol. 137, v^o. (C.), of about the same age; and MSS. Reg. 20, A. II. fol. 123, r^o. (R. 1), and 20, A. XI. fol. 105, r^o. (R. 2), both of the fourteenth century.]

* * * *

Gales soit maldit de Deus e de Saint
Symoun!
Car tuz jours ad esté pleins de tresoun.

Escoce soit maldit de la Mere Dé!
E parfount à diable Gales enfoundré!

VARIOUS READINGS.—The two first lines are wanting in C.—1. *Dieu*, R. 1 and 2.—2. *plein*, R. 1 and 2.—3. *maudite*, C.

En l'un ne en li autre fust unkes verité.
Car si toust en Gales guere est comencé,
Et de Aquitaine le covenaut taillé
Fu par le rai de Fraunce rumpu e refusé,
E Edward e Philippe comencent medlé,
Li fol rai de Escoce, Jon Baliol nommé,
Qe par le ray Edward al 10
regne est aproché,
Par l'enticement de sun faus barné,
Encuntre sun homage e encuntre sa
fealté,
Ad la court de Rome ad messagers
maundé,
A Celestine la pape, ke al heure tint le sé,
Par suggestioun ad fausement demustré
Qe le regne d'Escoce ouf la dignité
Dait de li tenir par antiquité,
Et li rais Edward par poer e posté
Li fist fere homage encuntre volonté;

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VARIOUS READINGS.—5. *ne l'autre fu*, C.—9. *Et Sir Eduuard*, C. *comenscalt*, R. 1.—10. *Bayllolf*, C. *Baylliolf*, R. 1. *Johan Baillol*, R. 2.—12. *Par le*

TRANSLATION.—May Wales be accursed of God and of St. Simon!—for it has always been full of treason.

May Scotland be accursed of the mother of God!—and may Wales be sunk down deep to the devil!—In neither of them was there ever truth.—For as soon as war was commenced in Wales,—and the covenant which had been cut out in Aquitaine—was broken and refused by the King of France,—and Edward and Philip began hostilities,—the foolish King of Scotland, named John Baliol,—who was brought to the kingdom by King Edward,—by the seductions of his false baronage,—against his homage and against his fealty,—sent messengers to the court of Rome—to pope Celestin, who at the time held the see,—by a trick falsely showed—that the kingdom of Scotland with the dignity—ought to hold of him by testimony of ancient times,—and that King Edward by

consail ... fol b., C.—15. que cel h., R. 2.—16. out ... moustré, C. ad ... moustré, R. 1 and 2.—19. le rei, R. 2.

E prie q'il seit assolz e devolupé
De la fay le ray, à ki il fu joré.
La pape Celestine, trop desayvisé,
Assolt le rai d'Escoce par lettre enbullé.
Si toust cum en Escoce [la] chose est
nuncié,
Les barnez unt fest ad lour hounteté
Duze peres d'Escoce, et sunt counsaillé
Desheriter Edward de la souverainté.
Pour le graunt honur ke Edward le sené
Fist à Johan Bailloil, tele est la bounté
Dunt le rays Edward 30
Du ray Johan musard
est regwerdoné.
De Escoce sait cum pot,
Parfornir nus estoet
la geste avaunt parlé.

Quant Morgan est renduz, e Madok est
pris,
Le ray revient à Loundres, par
cunsail des amys.

VARIOUS READINGS.—22. *la fay ly roys*, R. 1.—
23. *fu trop*, R. 2.—25. *la chose*, C., R. 1.—27. *en*
Escoce, C.—28. *Sire Edward à la s.*, R. 1.—30.
Bayllof, C., R. 1.—32. *mosard*, R. 1.—37.
Morgar, R. 2.

Deus chardinals de Rome la pape i ad
transmys,
Ke ouf le ray de Fraunce parleint à Parys;
Del amur entre eus la pape 40
est entremys

force and might—made him do homage against his will;—and prays that he may be absolved and delivered—from his faith to the king, to whom he was sworn.—Pope Celestin, too unadvised,—absolves the King of Scotland by his bull.—As soon as the thing is announced in Scotland,—the barons have made to their disgrace—twelve peers of Scotland, and have taken counsel—to disinherit Edward of the sovereignty.—For the great honour which Edward the prudent—did to John Baliol, such is the goodness—with which King Edward—by King John the sleeveless—is rewarded.—With Scotland let it be as it may,—it is needful for us to complete—the history before mentioned.

When Morgan has submitted, and Madoc is taken,—the king returns to London by the advice of his friends.—Two cardinals of Rome the none has sent there

est enemys.

Les chardinals al rai ount dist lur avis;
Edward e Philippe ount durement requis
Reposer une pesce chascoun en son pais,
Issint qe bone gent de poer e de pris,
Qe ad nule parte se facent enemys;
Ou la pape meissme sait par là justis,
Ad parfere l'acorde de quant qe sait
mespris.

Taunt cum les cardinales de la pes
parlaint,

Les gens de Normendie suz Dover
arivaint, 50
En la compaignie les Kauleys estaint.
En la vile de Dover sodainement entraint,
E parti du burge arder comensaynt;

VARIOUS READINGS.—40. *plaint*, R. 1.—41. *ad entremys*, R. 1. *s'est entremis*, R. 2.—42. *al rays*, C. *le reis*, R. 1.—43. *Sir Eduuard*, C. *E Edward*, R. 2.—45. *Issi ke*, C., R. 1. This line is omitted in R. 2.—47, 48. *soit*, R. 2.—50. *suth Dover*, C.—51. *les Kalays*, C. *Calays*, R. 1 and 2.

Des joevenes e des vels .xiii. homes
tuaynt.

Quant vindrent à la cunte .x. pur un
lessaint.

Li gardain du chastel e cels qe manaynt,
En meismes de la celle, ke bien se
gwiaint,

Se pristrent à defense, e les escriaint;
Normaunz e Picards, ke forfet avaint,
Furent degagés; les chapels demorrait
Ouf le chef des uns, le[s] 60
autres s'en alaint.

Un moygne i fu pur veir, à ki .xx.

ROME the pope has sent here,
—who had talked with the
King of France at Paris;—the
pope has interfered to
establish love between them.
—The cardinals have stated
their object to the king;—
pressingly they have
requested Edward and Philip
—to remain in peace each in
his country,—like good
people of power and value,—
who on no side make
themselves enemies;—or that
the pope himself should be
their judge,—to effect the
reconciliation wherever might
be the trespass.

Whilst the cardinals were
talking of the peace,—the
people of Normandy came to
Dover,—along with them
were those of Calais.—They
entered suddenly into the
town of Dover,—and began to
burn a part of the town;—of
young and old they killed
thirteen men.—When they
came to the reckoning, they
left ten for one.—The keeper
of the castle and those who
remained,—and the monks of
the cell, who bare themselves
well,—took to their defence
and cried out upon them;—
Normans and Picards who

enclinaint,
 E si les assoit, mot plus ne savaint.
 Les cardinals après ad Paris repeiraint;
 Ne sai leqel respouns du ray enportaint.
 Noun pur ceo plusurs entre els disaint,
 Qe toutes les parlaunces à drein
 descendaint,
 Ke Edward e Philippe lur gent
 sustrarraint,

VARIOUS READINGS.—54. *i tuaynt*, C.—55. *.xx. pur un*, R. 1.—56. *del chastel et cel ke la m.*, C.—57. *Et moynes de la c.*, C. *E moignes*, R. 1 and 2.—59. *Pikard*, C. *forfez*, R. 1.—61. *Of les chefs*, C., R. 1 and 2.—62. *Un moyne de la celle à ky*, C.—63. *Et cyl les ... sonaynt*, C., R. 1 and 2.—65. *Ne sai quels respouns*, C., R. 2. *Ne say quel respons*, R. 1. *reportaient*, R. 2. 67. *Qe totes ... descendraint*, R. 1.—68. *lur genz suthrayeraynt*, C., R. 2. *gentz*, R. 1.

Issi qe genz par mer et par tere irraint
 En soffraunce de pesse, ke amys purraint;
 Parfournir l'acorde les 70
 Englais volaint,
 Et les Alemaunz ad sei se assentiraint.

Taunt cum les cardinals se sunt entremis
 De reformer la pes, e fere les rays
 amis,
 Thomas de Turbeville, ke ad Rouns fu
 pris,
 Taunt ad parlé al provost de Parys,
 Ke fet l'ad soun homage, et hostages mys
 Ses deuz fiz en garde, e seurement
 promis
 Aler en Engleterre espier le pais,
 E dire al ray Edward k'il vent futifs,

had put themselves in debt,—
 were let out of pledge; the
 hats remained—with the
 heads of some, the others
 went away.—There was a
 monk in truth, to whom
 twenty bowed down,—and he
 absolved them all, they knew
 not a word more.—The
 cardinals afterwards repaired
 to Paris;—I do not know what
 answer they carried from the
 king.—Nevertheless divers
 among them said,—that all
 the conversations would come
 to this at last,—that Edward
 and Philip should withdraw
 their people,—so that people
 should go by sea and by land,
 —in sufferance of peace, as
 friends could;—the English
 would perform the agreement,
 —if the Germans would agree
 with them.

Whilst the cardinals are
 interfering—to re-establish
 the peace, and to make the
 kings friends,—Thomas de
 Turbeville, who was taken at
 Rion,—has talked so much to

Hear now how the grace of Jesus Christ—warned the gentle King Edward of the treason.—Thomas came to England and said to the king,—that he had escaped out of prison by night,—and that he had run so great a risk out of love to Sir Edward.—The king showed him in return courtesy enough; and

... nuyt aunte issist, C. nutaunte, R. 2.—92. This line is omitted in C. *l'amur Edward à tielle se p.*, R. 1 and 2.—93. *Curtaisye ... li rays*, C., R. 1. *Curtaisie*, R. 2.

L'estate de tote part, tel cum entendist,
Of les cardinals par un de sons tramist
Al provost de Paris, ke joie 100
assez en fist.

Li cleirs ke la lettre ad Turbeville escrit,
Ad plus privé le rais l'entente
discoverist.

Li lers l'aparcust, ad fust tost se mist,
Un serjaunt as armes, ke plus près suist,
Le tierz jour après le Turbeville surprist.

Le traitour est pris, e à Lundres remené,
Ouf mult grant fausine ke sur lui fust
trové.

Chose[s] que sunt dites, quels il ad
graunté,

Par volunté le rai sunt mis desuz pié,
Jeskes seo siècle seit 110
autrement turné.

Turbeville en curt cum traitur est jugé;
Par my la vile de Lundres primes fu
trainé,

VARIOUS READINGS.—99. *Les estat de tote parz*, C. *L'estat de totes partz*, R. 2.—102. *Li clerk*, C. —103. *le rei*, R. 2.—104. *Ly leers tost l'ap.*, R. 1. —106. *Le tierce jour après le traytour soupryst*, C.—109. *Choses*, C., R. 1 and 2.—110. *le rays*, C., R. 1. *mis suth pé*, R. 2.—111. *Jekes à ço ... chaungé*, C., R. 1. *chaungé*, R. 2.—113. This line is omitted in C.

E puis pendu cum lers, pur sa malfeté.

courtesy enough,—and afterwards Turbeville inquired day by day—the state of the land, and provided for his going—from place to place to seek of great and of little,—how he could do such injury to the English,—that King Edward should lose his land.—The condition of every part, as he understood it,—he sent over with the cardinals by one of his own servants—to the Provost of Paris, who made joy enough about it.—The clerk who wrote the letter for Turbeville,—made known its contents to the king's most secret counsellor.—The thief got to know this, and immediately took to flight;—a serjeant at arms, who followed him very closely,—surprised Turbeville the third day after.

The traitor is taken, and brought to London,—with very great wickedness which was found upon him.—The things which are aforesaid, which he had agreed to do,—by the king's will are put under foot,—until the world is otherwise turned.—Turbeville is judged in the court as a traitor.—he was first drawn

Pur nostre rais Edward mult ad Deus
overé
Ore et autre fiez ad sa sauveté.

Quant de Turbeville fet est la vengauce,
Les cardinales de Rome repeirez en
Fraunce

Ont ouf le rei Phelippe sovent eu
parlaunce,
Et sovent requis li rais des Alemaunce,
E par clers e leys ount fet 120
demonstraunce

Ad gentil rais Edward, ke dure est les
destaunce

Dunt li e Philippe sunt en descordaunce;
Par ount il unt fet une tele ordinaunce,
Ke li e les deus rais enverrount sanz
tarjaunce

A Kaumbré clers e lays de grant
conyssaunce,

Ad trere de la pees, e juger la grevance,

VARIOUS READINGS.—114. *E pendu ... malveté*,
R. 1. *maveisté*, R. 2.—115. *rei*, R. 2.—118.
repairent, C.—120. *ly ray*, C. *del Almaunz*, R. 1.
le rei, R. 2.—122. *rey*, R. 1 and 2.—125. *Ke ly e*
ly altre env., R. 1 and 2.—126. *à Kaumbray*, C.
Kambrai, R. 1. *Kaunbrai*, R. 2.—127. *à treter*, C.,
R. 1 and 2.

E fere les amendes de la contrariaunce.

Ly rays Edward s'assent en bone
affiaunce;

A Kaumbray ad maundé saunz nule
delaiaunce 130

Eveskes e barouns de graunt apparaunce:

Les garde de tresoun Dieu par sa
puissaunce!

... he was first drawn
through the town of London,
—and then hanged like a
thief, for his malpractices.—
For our King Edward God has
interfered much—now and at
other times for his safety.

When vengeance is done
upon Turbeville,—the
cardinals of Rome, who had
repaired to France—have had
frequent conversation with
King Philip,—and have often
besought the King of
Germany,—and have
demonstrated by clerks and
laymen—to the gentle King
Edward, that the variance is
hard—about which he and
King Philip are at discord;—
whereby they have so
ordained the matter,—that he
and the two kings shall send
without delay—to Cambrai
clerks and laymen of great
knowledge,—to treat of the
peace, and to judge the
grievances,—and to make the
amends for the war.—King
Edward agrees to it with good
faith;—to Cambrai he has
sent without any delay—
bishops and barons of great
account.—May God by his
power guard them from
treason!

Taunt cum cels seignurs sunt alez cel
message,

Sire Edmund frere le rai de gentil
corage,

Le counte de Nincole ouf toute sun
menage,

Sir Willeam de Vescy, chivaler prus e
sage,

Barouns e vavasours de gentil linnage,
Chivalers e serjaunce ouf lur cosynage,
Genz à pié saunz noubre de more e de
boscage,

E Galais qe sevent combatir par usage,
Sunt alez en Gascoyn, e 140
entrés en passage,

Ouf .xxx. et .vi. baners de meillur
escuage

Ke feust en Engleterre, salve le vacellage

VARIOUS READINGS.—134. *le rays*, C. *ly roys*,
R. 1.—135. *Nicole of tote ses menages*, C.—139.
gent, R. 2.—142. *Of .xxvj. baneresce del m.*, C.
Ouf .xx. et .vj., R. 1. *od vint e sis*, R. 2.—143.
vassellage, R. 1 and 2.

De cels qe ore ne faillent ad lour
seignurage.

Car cels qe sunt remis garder lur heritage.
Ad le rei requis e pris en sun veiage

Sur le ray d'Escoce e sur sun fals
barnage,

Ke ad ray Edward dedient lur homage.

Le primer jour de Marce, en tot le graunt
orage,

Vint le ray Edward à trop grant costage
A Novechastel-sur-Tyne, pur 150

While these lords are gone
upon this message,—Sir
Edward the brother of the
King of gentle spirit,—the
Earl of Lincoln with all his
retainers,—Sir William de
Vescy, a good and prudent
knight,—barons and vavasors
of gentle lineage,—knights
and sergeants with their
cousinage,—footmen without
number from moor and wood,
—and Welshmen who know
how to fight from frequent
practice,—are gone into
Gascony, and entered on the
passage,—with thirty-six
banners of the best escuage—
that was in England, except
the vassalage—of those who
now perform their seignorage.
—For those who are left to
guard their inheritance,—the
king has required and taken
into his expedition—against
the King of Scotland and his
false baronage,—who have
withdrawn their homage from
King Edward.—The first day
of March, in all the great

Robert de Ros de Werke des Englais s'en
fuist,
E ouf les genz d'Escoce à la gwere
se mist.
Li rais Sire Edward sun chastel seისტ,

La feste de pasche y tint, après s'en
partist 160
Devers Berwike-sur-Twede, e la vile
assist.
Le people maluré al primour surprist
Deus navez des Anglais, e tuer le fist.
Li rays Edward l'oït dire, les portes
assailist;
Les fossés passait li Anglais sanz respit.
Le vendredi de pasche ad truele conquist
La vile de Berwike; li Anglais lo occist
Quatre mile de Escoce, e autres plus
perdist.
Chivaler un saunz plus Sire Edward i
perdist,

Robert de Ros of Wark fled from the English,—and entered into the war with the people of Scotland.—The King Sir Edward seized his castle,—held the festival of Easter there, and afterwards went—towards Berwick-on-Tweed, and besieged the town.—The ill-fated people at first surprised—two ships of English, and put them to death.—King Edward heard of it, and attacked the gates;—the English passed the ditches without respite.—On Easter Friday in the afternoon he conquered—the town of Berwick; the English slew there—four thousand Scotchmen, and many others perished.—Sir Edward lost

Richard de Cornewalle, un Fleming li
ferist 170

Hors de [la] sale rouge d'u[n] quarel qu'il
tendist.

Tost fu la sale pris, le fu en fist tut quist.
Li gardein du chasteil quant la force vist,
Le chastel saunz assalt al rais Edward
rendist.

VARIOUS READINGS.—160. *de la paske*, C. *departist*, R. 1.—161. *Vers B.*, R. 1.—163. *les fist*, C.—165. *les Englais*, C.—166. *al releve conquyst*, C. *al revele*, R. 1. *au relevée*, R. 2.—167. *i occyst*, C. *Les Englais oc.*, R. 2.—168. *e ankes plus*, C., R. 1 and 2.—171. *du sale*, C. *de la sale*, R. 1 and 2. *d'un*, R. 2.

Willeam de Douglass dedens esteit elist,
E Ricard Fresel, pur fere al ray despit;
Le ray les ad prisoune, merci Jhesu Crist!

Li quens de la Merche, Patrik li renomé,
Ad la pes le rays se rendist de gré;
Gilbert de Umfravile avaunt fust demoré
Ouf le rais Edward, à ki il fu 180
joré;
Sire Robert de Brus of toute sa mesné
Vers le rais Edward tint tuz jours sa
fealté,
Encuntre les Escotes amurs li ad mustré.
Quant Berwike fu pris, [de]denz estait
trové
Or e argent saunz noumbre, des autres
metals plenté,
E toute la nobley ke apendait à cité.
Ly Bailloill ad perdu li issu e l'entré
De la plus noble vile qe fust en sa poesté.
Le rais Edward la tent conquis par l'espé,

there one knight and no more,
—Richard de Cornwall [was
he], a Fleming struck him—
with an arrow which he shot
out of the red hall.—Soon
was the hall taken, the fire
cleared the way.—The keeper
of the castle when he saw the
necessity,—delivered the
castle to King Edward before
it was assaulted.—William
Douglas was chosen in it,—
and Richard Fraser, to do
injury to the king;—the king
has them prisoners. Jesus
Christ be thanked!

The Earl of the March, the
famous Patrick,—of his own
free will came in to the king's
peace;—Gilbert de
Umfraville before remained—
with King Edward, to whom
he was sworn;—Sir Robert de
Bruce with all his household
—holds always his fealty to
King Edward,—and has
shown him love in his wars
against the Scots.—When
Berwick was taken, there was
found within it—gold and
silver without measure and

VARIOUS READINGS.—176. *Richard Fres'*, C. *Simoun Fresel*, R. 1. *Simon Fresele*, R. 2.—177. *prisouns*, C., R. 1 and 2. *merciez*, R. 2.—179. *le rei*.—181. *al rays*, C. *od le rei*, R. 2.—183. *vers le roy*, R. 1 and 2.—185. *dedenz estayt*, C., R. 1 and 2.—186. *or, argent assez, des*, C.—187. *la noblye*, C.—188. *Balliol*, C.

La fet environner de fossé large e lé,
En restrovant l'Escote k'ad de li chaunté,
E par mokerie en Englais rymaié.

Piket hym and diket him,
On scorne saiden he,
 hu best hit mai be.
He pikes and he dikes,
On lengthe alle him likes,
 als by mowe best y-se.
Scatered heir the Scotas,
Hodred in the hottes, 200
 never thai ne the:
Ritht if y rede,
Thay touble in Twede
 that woned bi the se.

VARIOUS READINGS.—191. This line is omitted in C.—192. *reprovant*, C., R. 1 and 2.—193. *rymeyé*, C., R. 1 and 2.—194. *Pykit*, C. *Pikit ... dikit*, R. 2.—195. *scoren sayd*, C. *in scoren*, R. 1. *in scorn*, R. 2.—196. *best may*, C. Where this line is given in place of line 199, which is omitted. It is the same in R. 1 and 2.—197. *He dikes, he pikes*, C., R. 1 and 2.—198. *On lenche als hym*, C. *On leghe als hym*, R. 1. *als*, R. 2.—200. *Skaterd he the*, C. *Scatird er*, R. 1. *are the Scottis*, R. 2.—201. *Hoderd in thar*, C. *Hodird in thaire*, R. 1. *Hodered in their*, R. 2.—202. *nevere*, R. 2.—203. *zif*, R. 2.—204. *tumbed*, C., R. 2. *toumbe*, R. 1.—205. *be*, R. 2.

SILVER WITHOUT MEASURE, and plenty of the other metals,—and all the nobility which belonged to a city.—The Baliol has lost the issue and entry—of the noblest town that was in his power.—King Edward holds it conquered by the sword,—causes it to be surrounded with a ditch large and broad,—in reproof of the Scot who had sung of him,—and made rhymes in English for mockery.—Let him pike and let him dike,—they said in scorn,—how it may best be.—He pikes and he dikes,—in length as he likes,—as they may best see.—Scattered are the Scots,—huddled in their huts,—they never thrive:—Right if I read,—they tumble in Tweed—who dwelt by the sea.

Whilst Sir Edward with
earls and barons—caused

Taunt cum Sire Edward ouf cuntes e
barouns

Fist Berwiche enclore de fossez
envirrouns,
Issuz sunt d'Escoce trais countes, par
nouns
De Mar, de Ros, de Montesce, [of] .xl.
mile felouns;
Estaint en la rute alaunt en tapisouns,
Tyndale unt destruite en 210
cendres e carbouns,
La vile de Corbridge e deuz religiouns
De Exillesham e Lanercost en unt
destruite par arcouns,
Du people du pais ount fet occisiouns,
Enporté les biens, en chacé les chanouns.
Après la ravine cum foles e bricouns
Sunt alez de Dunbar à lur confusiouns.
Le chastel unt pris, estendent pavillouns,
Ad Counte de la Marche esteint les
mesouns.

VARIOUS READINGS.—209. *De Mare, de Rosse, de Menethet, of .xl., C. De Ros, Assetle, de Menetz*, R. 1. *De Ros, Ascetel, de Menetest*, R. 2.—210. *alaunz*, C.—211. *En passan unt d.*, R. 1. *En passaunt*, R. 2.—213. *De Hexhilescham et Lanercost ennentiz par arsouns*, C. *De Exilsham e Lanertoft enenty*, R. 1. *De Exilham ... anenti*, R. 2.—215. *Emportez*, R. 1. *emportez ... enchacez*, R. 2.—216. *ravye cum fols*, C.—217. *à Dunbar*, C., R. 1 and 2.—218. *estendi*, R. 1.—219. *al counte*, C.

Le rais Edward l'oït dire, fet fere les
somouns 220
Dunbar pur recovre, e prendre les
larouns,
Ke de saint edlice unt fet destrucciouns

Berwick to be surrounded with ditches,—there are issued from Scotland three earls, by name—Mar, Ross, and Menteith, with forty thousand rascals;—they were going in the route in parties,—they reduced Tindale to ashes and cinders,—the town of Corbridge and the two monasteries—of Hexham and Lanercost they have destroyed by fire,—they have made slaughter of the people of the country,—carried off their goods, driven away the canons.—After the ravage like fools and miserable wretches—they are gone to Dunbar to their confusion.—They have taken the castle, and erect their tents,—the houses belonged to the Earl of the March.—King Edward heard tell of it, and issued summonses—to recover Dunbar, and take the thieves—who had made destruction of holy church.—A little before this time, through the regions,—the cardinal returned from Cambrai with an answer—of the King of France, as we shall hear afterwards;—Sire Amy de Savoy, a count of great

Exillisham e Lanercost, n'esparnaynt
muster, 240
Pris avaint Dunbar, chastel sur la mer,
Ouf li quens Patrik tint sa mulier.
Li rais Sire Edward par taunt i fist
maunder
Le counte de Garenne ouf tute sun poer,
Le counte de Warwik e Hüge le
[De]spencer,
Barouns e vavasours, chivaler, esquier;
Sorrais e Norrais i alaint de bon quer;
Assez de gent à pié i menent al mester,
E venent à Dunbar li chastel asseger.

VARIOUS READINGS.—236. *Deu*, C., R. 1 and 2.
—237. *En le mays de May*, C., R. 1 and 2.—238.
oyst le ray, C. oit, R. 2.—240. *Hexlesham*, C.
Exilsham e Lanertoft, R. 1. *Exilham*, R. 2.—245.
le Despenser, C. W. *Sire Hughe le Despenser*, R.
1. *e* is also omitted in R. 2.—247. *Surays et*
Norays, C. *Sorais e Norais il a.*, R. 1. *Surrais*, R.
2.—248. *de genz ... et menent*, C. *gentz ... il m.*, R.
1.

Se atirent al saut, ne volent demorer.
Les foles felouns dedenz 250
espairent ayde aver;
Se sotillent coment les Englais enginner.
Sire Richard Syward, ke solait demorer
Ouf nostre rays Edward ad robe e à
dener,
Maudent par descayt ouf nos Englais
treiter;
Si les vent, e dist, ke mult tres volenter
Les fra le chastel rendre, si il volent
graunter
Treis jours de respit, ke il puissent
consailler

Edward forthwith caused to
be sent there—the Earl of
Warrenne with all his power,—
the Earl of Warwick and Hugh
le Despenser,—barons and
vavasours, knights, squires;—
Southerns and Northerns went
there right courageously;—
they take there footmen
enough for their need,—and
come to Dunbar to besiege the
castle.—They prepared for
the attack, and would not
delay.—The foolish felons
within hoped to have aid;—
they plotted together how to
trick the English.—Sir
Richard Syward, who used to
dwell—with our King
Edward, at robe and pay,—
they send deceitfully to treat
with our English;—so he
comes to them, and says, that
very willingly—he will cause
the castle to be delivered to
them, if they will grant—three
days' respite, that they may
consult—the King Baliol, and
tell him their condition.—And
if he at that time do not come
to raise the siege,—they will
deliver the castle without
further delay.—Forthwith he
gives hostages, and causes to
be announced—to the host of
Scotland in the same manner,
as you will hear after he

Dunt vus les porrez vendre, si non par
descait,

VARIOUS READINGS.—266. *Al ray Jon Bayllof
là ou il estayt*, C.—267. *enfourné*, R. 1.—268.
dur esplayt, C., R. 1. *sire rei*, R. 2.—269. *en
chauns*, C.—272. *quant vynt*, C.—274. *taunt cum
il porrait*, C. *taunt beel parlait*, R. 1.—275. *Pur
trewe de .iij. ... grauntait*, C.—276. *par quai*, C.
—279. Omitted in R. 2.

Dedenz le terme de treve ke l'Englais nus
grauntait. 280

A demayn cele hour k'em manghehust e
bait,

Alez de ceste part hastivement l'andrait;
Les nos du chastel vous verrunt par agait;
Istrunt sur li Englais ke lour venir ne
creit;

Happés-les entre vous, si tenés-les si
estreit,

Ke mès en champ ne venent fere à les
voz surfait.

Vous ne avez autre vaie qe valer vous
dait.

Ore armez-vous, si aloums, nul alme ne
se trait

Qe nos enemis quant serrunt pris merci
nul en ayt.

Ferrez du braund; 290
Northumberlaund

le vostre ert de drait;

Tote Engleterre

Par ceste guere

volez qe perdu sait:

Unkes Albanie

Par coup d'espeie

To-morrow at the hour when
people eat and drink,—go
hence hastily straight there;—
ours in the castle will watch
for you;—they will issue
upon the English who do not
expect their coming,—entrap
them between you and hold
them so tight,—that they shall
no more come in the field to
do annoyance to yours.—You
have no other way that will
avail you.—Now arm, and let
us go, and may no soul
survive—who shall have any
mercy on our enemies when
they are taken!—Strike with
the sword—Northumberland
—will be yours by right;—All
England—by this war—you
will that it be lost:—Never
did Albania—by stroke of the
sword—do so great an
exploit.”—On the green—that
keen generation—gathered
like goats;—I reckon—on
some it is seen,—where the
bit bit.

At the saying of the
messenger the rout of

VARIOUS READINGS.—280. All which follows, to line 354, is omitted in R. 1.—281. *k'em mangeust*, C.—284. *sur les*, C.—286. *pur fere les voz*, C.—288. *ne se retrayt*, C.—289. *qe serrunt ... n'eit*, R. 2.—295. *voyliez*, C.

fist si bon esplait.”

On grene,
That kindrede kene 300
 gaderid als gait;
Y wene
On sum it is sene,
 ware the bit bait.

Al dit le messenger la route de rascaylle
Arenger se comence al foer de
 bataille.

Sir Richard Siward, qe dona ceste
 counsaille,

Vent à nos Englais, dis[t], “Si Dieu me
 vaille!

Jeo voy gent venir de mult grant
 apparaille,

Cum batailler vousissent, saunz nombre
 de pittaille. 310

Je vois, si vous [loez], feir .i. disturbaille,
Ke plus [près] ne venent.” Les nos dient,
 “nun kaille,”

E pernent li Siward, ke plus avaunt n'i
 aille;

VARIOUS READINGS.—299. *on the g.*, R. 2.—
300. *kynered*, C. *kinred*, R. 2.—301. *als the gait*,
R. 2.—303. *summe it es*, C. *summe is it*, R. 2.—
304. *whar*, C. *whare*, R. 2.—305. *al route*, C.—
308. *et dist si*, C.—309. *genz*, C.—311. *vus loez*
fere .i. d., C.—312. *plus près*, R. 2. *noun kaylle*,
C., R. 2.

vagabonds—begin to arrange themselves in order of battle. —Sir Richard Siward, who gave this counsel,—comes to the English, and says, “God help me!—I see people coming in very great apparel, —as though they would give battle, without number of footmen.—I go, if you think well, to hinder them,—that they may not come nearer.”—Our people say, “Do not trouble yourself!”—And they take Siward, that he may proceed no further;—they place guards at the gate and at the wall;—Humphrey de Bohun the younger is keeper of the guard,—to hinder aid from the castle from attacking their rear;—and they mount their steeds, and spur to the hill;—he who can run fastest springs before the others.—The Scot sees them come, and turns his tail like a quail,—he flies away as straw does before the wind.—The English pursue them like a sheep—when it flies at the sight of the wolf issuing from the wood.—The proud Scot imagines that he is as good as —the Duke Sir Corineus, who conquered Cornwall.—Of so

Establient gardayns al porte e al muraille;
 Umfray de Boune le jovene tent le garde
 en baille,
 Ke aide du chastel lur rergarde ne
 assaille;
 E mountent les destrers, les brouchent al
 mountaille,
 Ke plus tost peust coure avaunt li altre
 saille.
 L'Escote les vait venir, la cove les turne
 cum quaille,
 En enfuaunt se vole al vent cum fet la
 paille. 320
 Les Englais après les chacent cum
 owaille,
 Cum feust quant veit le lowe venir de
 boscaille.
 Li surquider Escote quide ke
 countrevaille
 Le duk sire Corynée, qe conquist
 Cornwaille.
 De taunt des genz as armes mult ai grant
 mervaille
 Ke nes un de tuz al fet vaut un maille,
 Fors Patrick de Graham, ke demourt e
 daille
 Del espé furbie, mes tuez est saunz faille.
 Dis mil .i. et .iiij. sunt tuez al travaille;

VARIOUS READINGS.—316. *lur' ne regard ne*, C.
rereward, R. 2.—320. *S'en vole*, C.—322. *Ke*
fuiſt, C.—323. *surquiders*, C.—325. *De taunz de*
gens armez, C., R. 2.

many men at arms I marvel
 very much—that there is not
 one of them all worth a
 farthing in action,—except
 Patrick de Graham, who
 remains and strikes—with the
 burnished sword, but he is
 slain without fail.—Ten
 thousand and fifty-four are
 slain in the engagement;—
 they are all Scots, I have the
 number by reckoning.—These
 were the caitiffs who
 butchered the cattle—in
 Northumberland, and left the
 entrails to the dogs.—They
 were excommunicated by
 book and candle,—because
 neither holy church nor priest
 or clergy—they spared no
 more than bake-house or barn.
 —Sin has driven them to such
 a hap—that they have lost in
 the field the head with the
 ears.—The foot-people—put
 the Scots in the poke,—and
 made bare their backsides:—
 By way—heard I never tell—
 of readier pages,—to pick—
 the robes off the men,—who
 in the field fell.—They took
 of each man;—the rough
 ragged devil—tear them in
 hell!

Trestuz sunt d'Escoce, le noubre ai par
 taille 320

Cels furent les cheitifs [qe] demaglaynt le
 aumaille
 Par mi Northumberlaund, as chiens
 lessaint le[n]traille;
 Escomegez estaint al livre e kaundaille,
 Pur ceo ke saint eglise, ne prestre, ne
 clerjaille,
 Nent plus esparnent ke four ou toraille.
 Pecché les ad chacé à tele arivaille,
 Ke perduz unt al champ le chief oufveke
 l'oraille.
 The fote folke
 Puth the Scotcs in the polke,
 and nakned their nages:
 By waie 340
 Herd i never saie
 of prestre pages,
 To pike
 The robes of the riche

VARIOUS READINGS.—331. *les cheftayns ke demaglerent*, C. *qe de.*, R. 2.—332. *l'entraylle*, C., R. 2.—337. *les chefs of le oraylle*, C.—338. *fotfolk*, R. 2.—339. *That the*, R. 2.—340. *nackened thair nages*, C. *nakid their nages*, R. 2.—341. *By wai | her I nevere sai | of prestere p.*, R. 2.—343. *prester*, C.—345. *rike*, C., R. 2.

that in the felde felle.
 Thai token ath tulke;
 The roglre raggi sculke
 rug ham in helle!

De bataille ne puingce feust unkes
 recordez, 350
 Ke taunt de genz si tost estaient
 outraiez,

In battle or encounter it was never recorded—that so many people were destroyed so soon,—or thus turned their backs without making any defence.—May the crows have the bodies, and the devils the souls—of all that thus have conducted the wars!—For of this part there was never once,—within town or without, a good action proved,—but only prowling and robbing the towns,—burning holy church, killing the clergy,—may God be praised who has revenged it at Dunbar!—The earls who had done the wicked deeds,—as soon as they knew and were aware—of the defeat of their kindred,—have delivered the castle to the English on their return,—and without conditions obliged themselves—to the King Sir Edward, to do his will.—The king next day came there to his

N'ensint saunz defence lez renes
rethornez.

Corfs ayent les cors, les almes les malfez
De trestuz k'esint gweres ount gwiez!
Car de cele part fut unkes une fez,
Deinz vile ne dehors, un bon fet
esprovez,

Mès for gopiller e robber les vilez,
Arder seint eglise, tuer les ordinez,
Cil Dieu sait loé k'ad Dunbar l'ad
vengez!

Les countes qe avaint fet les malvestez,
Si toust cum savoint e furent 360
avisez

VARIOUS READINGS.—346. For this line and the three following, R. 2 has—*And in the dik souue | Thou wiffin | Scot of Abrenityn, | cloutid is thi houue.*—348. *roghe raggy sculke*, C.—351. *Ke taunz*, C.—352. *Ne issynt*, C.—353. *seient sauvez*, R. 2.—354. *ke issint*, C.

De la desconfiture sur lur parentez,
As Englais quant repairent le chastel ount
liverez,

E saunz condiciouns els memes obligez
Al ray Sire Edward, dunt fere ses
voluntez.

Li rais lendemayn i vint à ses barnez,
Le[s] prisouns ke sunt pris li unt
presentez,

Treis countes, treis barouns, treis banerés
nomez,

E saunz eus .xxviiij. chivalers adubbez,
Ouf .v. vinz gentilles homes ke illeukes
sunt trovez; 370

Deus clers e deus Pikards par entre sunt

day came there to his baronage,—the prisoners who are taken they have presented to him,—three earls, three barons, three bannerets,—and besides them twenty-eight dubbed knights,—with five score gentlemen who were found there;—two clerks and two Picards are counted among them.—The Earls are sent to the Tower of London.—Some of the barons are associated with them;—the others are sent to different castles,—two by two mounted together on a hackney;—some with their feet fettered in carts;—in such kind of dance their game ended!—Throughout England in every country—people will always talk of their pride—as long as the world lasts, people have scoffed at their action.—For the Scots—I reckon for sots,—and wretches unwary;—ill luck—to give blows—drew them to Dunbar.

Now it is time to tell the plot—of the twelve peers of

numbrez.
 A la Tour de Loundres les countes sunt
 maundeiz.
 Les uns de[s] baro[uns] les sunt associez;
 A diverse chasteles les autres ad envoiez,
 Par deus e deus ensemble une hakenai
 muntez,
 Les uns en charrettes enfirgez les peeiz;
 En tel pleit de carole lour jue est
 terminez!
 Par my Engleterre en toutes les countrez,

VARIOUS READINGS.—362. *de lur*, R. 1.—365.
Al reis, R. 1.—366. *e ses b.*, R. 1.—367. *les*
prisouns ... li sunt p., C., R. 1 and 2.—373. *Les*
uns des barons, R. 1 and 2.—375. *sur hakenays*,
 R. 1.—378. This line is omitted in C.

De lur surquideri ert tuz jours parlés
 Taunt cum le siècle dure, lour fet les ad
 mokés. 380
 For S[c]ottes
 Telle I for sottes,
 and wirches unwarre;
 Unsele
 Dintes to dele
 thaim drohg to
 Dunbarre.

Des ore est tens à dire du compassement
 Les .xii. peres d'Escoce, qe quidaint
 seurement
 Engleterre destrure, bien vous dirrai
 coment.
 Quant le ray de Fraunce, après le
 dayllement 390
 De cele mariage dunt fu parlé sovent,

Scotland, who thought surely
 —to destroy England, I will
 just tell you how.—When the
 King of France, after the
 breaking off—of that
 marriage which was often
 talked of,—would retain
 Gascony by abatement,—and
 King Edward sent thither his
 people,—and re-took a part
 by war from the French;—
 King John of Scotland, by the
 enticement—of earls and
 barons, and of clerks also,—
 sent to France by common
 agreement—the bishop of St.
 Andrew's, by whose
 procurement—the brother of
 the King of France, namely,
 Charles,—made an alliance
 for the son of the King of
 Scotland,—who was to marry
 his daughter, and afterwards
 by oath—the French and
 Scots should go conjointly—
 into England to destroy from
 the Tweed to Kent;—and that
 the King of France should
 land,—when he would,
 suddenly in the Tweed,—
 forthwith he should suddenly
 take all Northumberland,—
 and then all the land without
 hindrance;—that he should
 not leave a man alive, neither
 father nor kindred.—The

Volait tenir Gascoyn par abatement;
 E le rays Edward illok maunda sa gent,
 E partie par gwere de su Frauncays
 reprent;
 Li rai Johan d'Escoce, par l'enticement

VARIOUS READINGS.—380. *fet ad mokez*, R. 2.
 —381. *For Scottes*, C., R. 1. *For the Scottis*, R. 2.
 —383. *And wrecches unwar*, C. *wreches*, R. 1.
wecchis unwar, R. 2.—386. *tham drohu to*
Dunbar, C. *droght*, R. 1. *drouh to Dunbar*, R. 2.
 —390. *le dallyement*, C. *daliement*, R. 1.—394.
guere sur Fr., C. *sur Français*, R. 1 and 2.

De countes e barouns, de clers ensement,
 Ad maundez en Fraunce par commune
 assent
 L'eveske de Seint Andreu, par ki
 procurement
 Frere le rai de Fraunce, Charles
 nomément,
 Pur fiz le ray d'Escoce ad fet aliement,
 Dount marier sa fille, e après 400
 par serment
 Fraunsays e les Escoce irraint uniement
 En Engleterre destrure de Twede jekes en
 Kent;
 E ke le rai de Fraunce prendrait
 arivement
 Qe l'heure q'il vousist, en Twede
 prestement,
 Parunt Northumberlaund prendrait
 sodainement,
 E peus la tere toute sanz desturbement;
 Ne larrait home en vie, ne pere ne parent.
 La faus purparlauns saunz espleit attent;
 Le seneschall d'Escoce est venu
 honement 410

traitorous negotiation being entered upon without completion,—the seneschal of Scotland is come in without more ado—to the King Sir Edward, with all that belongs to him,—earls and barons and bishops fully,—are come to his peace all at his desire.—King John and his son, without land or tenement,—are led to London to support judgment.—Now King Edward possesses Scotland entirely,—like Albanac had it at the beginning.—The Welsh and Irish—to our English—aid doughtily.—Whereby the Scots—have through ours—imprisonment;—and that land—by this war—is lost for ever.—The Welsh are gone home,—and the Irish returned—with sail and with wind.—You English remain there;—you ought to pray devoutly—that the Lord God forbid,—to take Aman into favour again,—and exile Mardocheus,—in royal parliament.—Edward, amid all your accusations,—please to remember the burnings,—of the temple of God Almighty,—at Hexham, where that host—of the cross made roast,—the figure of

vous Englais t'admonestrez, 430
 Devoutement prier devez
 ke Dampne-Deu defent,
 Aman recosilier,
 E Mardocheum exiler
 en regal parlement.
 Edward, par my tuz vos reisuns,
 Volez penser des arsouns
 du temple Deu
 omnipotent,
 Ad Exlysham, où cel hoste
 De la croiz faisait roste, 440
 figure de humaine
 salvement.
 Herodes i fert, l'emphle mourt,
 En ceste anguisse Rachel plourt;
 Edward, or fa le
 vengement.
 Tu averas jugé, jugez à dreit;
 Soffrez qu'il pent ke pendre deit,

VARIOUS READINGS.—431. *Doucement*, C.—
 432. *Dampne Deu omnipotent*, C.—434. *E*
Marche, R. 2.—436. *vos respons*, R. 2.—437.
Voilliez, C.—438. *En temple*, R. 1.—439.
Hexelesham, C. *Exilsham*, R. 1.—440. *de la*
croice fesaint, C. *croice fesaunt*, R. 1.—442.
emphle, R. 1. *Herodes fert, l'enfant murt*, R. 2.
 —445. *avera*, R. 1.—446. *suffrez pendre*, R. 2.

 la ley le vol[t]
 certainement.
 La peine est dure e cruele,
 Car ele est perpetuele,
 à tuz qe jugent
 autrement.
 Vos enemys ore chastiez, 450
 K'il ne se movent altre fez,

Pride in a country, is like a
 nettle in the garden,—which
 overgrows the rose and
 pushes it back;—so it is with
 Baliol, that, by him the twelve
 peers—are fallen down for

en un novele torment.
 Home dait mercy aver;
 Mès à traitour ne dait valer,
 ilokes la ley la suspent.
 Pur amy ne pur dener
 Ray ne dait esparnier,
 k'il ne juge owelement.
 Si li ray volt Dieu servir, 460
 La lei le convient maintenir;
 si noun, il pecche e mult
 mesprent.
 Pur veir quant Johan Balliolle
 Leissa sun livre e l'escole,

VARIOUS READINGS.—448. *molt cruele*, C.—
 453. *turnayment*, R. 1. *un novel turnement*, R. 2.
 —456. *la lei les*, R. 2.—460. *Si li rays*, C.—463.
J. de Bailliole, R. 1.—464. *sun liver à l'escol*, C.

 desceu fut trop
 malement.
 ¶ For boule bred in his boke,
 Whenne he tint that he toke
 with the kinge-dome;
 For he haves ovirhipped,
 Hise typeth is typped, 470
 hise tabard es tome.
 He loghe wil him liked,
 His paclir es thurck piked,
 he wende e were liale;
 Begkot an bride,
 Rede him at ride
 in the dismale.

Orgoyl en pays est urtille en herber,
 Ke surcrest la rose e la boutte arer;
 Einsint est du Baliol, ke par li [li] .xii. per

their wicked proceeding,—he
 has lost his realm, and is gone
 to lodge—in the Tower of
 London, at another's expense.
 —The King Sir Edward
 makes guard enough;—the
 Earl John de Warenne is chief
 justice,—and Henry de Percy
 has Galway to rule;—at
 Berwick-upon-Tweed is
 established the exchequer,—
 and Hugh de Cressingham is
 treasurer there;—and Walter
 de Amundisham is chancellor.
 —The King to nourish the
 peace causes his bench to be
 proclaimed there,—and five
 judges to govern the law.—
 Sheriffs and bailiffs are
 established for the need—of
 the English who could and
 would judge according to
 right.—The guard is
 established so good and so
 perfect,—neither Fleming nor
 Frenchman henceforth shall
 have the power,—to enter into
 Scotland, unless it be for
 commerce.—Of all those of
 most account who were to
 remain—the homages are
 taken, the King makes them
 swear—that they will be loyal
 by land and by sea.—They
 who began the war and the
 advisers of it—are sent

Sunt chay aval pur lur vil 480
mister,

VARIOUS READINGS.—466. *bredde*, R. 1. *his book*, R. 2.—467. *Wen*, R. 1. *Whan ... took*, R. 2.—468. *kyngdome*, R. 1. *kingdom*, R. 2.—469. *over-hippede*, R. 1. *has*, R. 2.—470. *tipet*, C., R. 1 and 2. *typpede*, R. 1.—472-477. These six lines are omitted in C., and R. 1 and 2.—478. *urtiz*, R. 2.—479. *suztret*, C. *reboute*, R. 2.—480. This line is omitted in R. 1 and 2.—481. This line is omitted in C.

Perduz ait realme, e va sojorner
A la Tour de Loundres sur autri dener.
Li reis Sire Edward eces fet garder;
Li quens Jon de Gwarenne est chief
justicer,
E Henri de Perci aid Galwei à gwier;
A Berwick-sur-Twede a la cheker,
Et Hüge de Cressingham illokes est
tresorer;
Et li Amundisham Walter est chanceler.
Li reis puis pes norir baunc i fet crier,
Et justis .v. le rei à gouverner. 490
Viscundes e baillifs sunt mis al mester
Des Engleis qe sevent e voleint dreit
juger.
La garde est establi si bon e si enter,
Ne Flemyng ne Fraunceis de quer avera
poer
Entrer en Escoce, si non pur
marchaunder.
De tuz les mels vanez ke deivent demorer

VARIOUS READINGS.—484. *Escoce fet g.*, C., R. 1. *Le rei ... Escoce*, R. 2.—485. *quens de G. i est*, C. q. *Johan de G. i est j.*, R. 1.—487. *Twede assise est la ascheker*, C. *assise ad l'esc.*, R. 1 and

beyond the Trent to repose in the south,—so long as the war lasts in Gascony.—Thus ought the lord to chastise his men.—The bishop of Durham, who did much worthy of praise,—in conquering the land was always the first,—were it not for his activity and boldness of heart,—things now finished would be to begin.—The twelve peers—go away to the friars—to confess them,—the judgment—which awaits them—they may fear.—Kambynoy—holds himself all coy,—he will not help.—The sorcery—of Albania—cannot avail.—Andrew sleeps,—or he is dead—at the monastery.—What will the Scot do,—when he will hear—the King talk,—at St. Edmund's,—and of treason—accuse—earl and baron,—who by burning—destroys the altar?—He can go no further,—there he must—stand like a thief;—and by judgment—King Edward—determine.—And so may man teach—the Scots to run,—and begin war.—To some is left nothing—but his torn raveling—to hop therein.—Their King's seat of

ussise est le escheier, C. ussise du t esc., R. 1 and 2.—489. *Hamundesham*, C. *Aymundesham*, R. 2.—490. *pur pes ... baunk*, C., R. 1 and 2.—491. *la lay à g.*, C., R. 1 and 2.—495. *dès ore n'avera*, C. *dès or av.*, R. 1.

Scone—is driven over down,
—and led to London.—In
town I heard tell,—the ... and
the bell—are stolen and fled.

Pris sunt les homages, li reis le[s] fist
 jurer,
Ke leals li seront par tere e par mer.
Ki comensaint la gwere e li consailler
Sunt maundés delà la Trent 500
 en sew à repoter,
Taunt cum en Gascoyne la gwer deit
 durer.
Issint deit li sires ses homes chacer.
Le eveske de Duram, ke mout fet à loer,
En conquerant la tere fu tuz jours li
 primer;
Ne fussent ses enprises e hardiment de
 quouer,
Choses or chyviaus serraint à comencer.
 Les duze peres
 S'en vount as freres
 els confesser;
 Le jugement 510
 Ke les attent
 purrount doter.
 Kambynoy
 Se tent tut coy,

VARIOUS READINGS.—498. *les fist*, C., R. 1. *pris unt*, R. 2.—501. *reposer*, C., R. 1. *delà Tr. en southe reposer*, R. 2.—503. *li sire, ... chastier*, R. 2.—506. *quer*, R. 1.—507. *ore chevyes*, C., R. 1 and 2.—510. *pur els*, C., R. 2.—513. *il doter*, C.

O God! how often Merlin
said truth—in his prophecies!
As you read,—now are the
two waters come into one,—
which have been separated by
great mountains; and one
realm is made out of two

ne volt aider.
La sorcerye

ben filched and
fled.

Deus! cum Merlins dist sovent veritez
En ses propheciez! si 550
cum vous lisez,
Ore sunt le deus ewes en un arivez,
Ke par graunt mountaignes ount esté
severez;

VARIOUS READINGS.—538. *men*, R. 2.—540. *werre*, C. *were*, R. 1 and 2.—541. *somme*, C. *is lest*, R. 2.—542. *bot his rough*, C. *bot his riven*, R. 1. *but the riven r.*, R. 2.—543. *thar ynne*, C. *inne*, R. 1 and 2.—544. *sette*, C. *thar king set ous Sc.*, R. 1. *The kinges sete*, R. 2.—545. *over done*, C., R. 1 and 2.—546. *i-ledde*, C., R. 1.—547. *In toune*, C., R. 2.—548. *Thair b. and thair*, C.—549. *fledde*, C. *fliched and fledde*, R. 1. *bien*, R. 2.—550. *Ha Deus ke Merlyn*, C. *E! Deus com Merlyn*, R. 1. *A! Dieu cum Merlin*, R. 2.—552. *les .ij.*, C., R. 1.

Et un realme est fet [de] deus diverse
regnez,
Ke solaint par deus rays estre gouvernez.
Ore sunt les insulanes trestuz assemblez,
Et Albanye rejoynte à les regaltez,
Des quels li rais Edward est seignur
clamez;
Cornewale e Galez sunt en ses poestez,
E Irlaunde la graunte à sez voluntez.
Reis n'i ad nent plus de tut 560
les cuntrez
Fors li rais Edward k'ensi les ad visitez.
Arthur n'i avait unkes si plainement les
fez.
Dès ore n'ait ke fere for porver ses alez,
Sur le ray de Fraunce conquer sez heritez

—Merlin of him—
prophesied;—three regions—
in his possession—shall be
gained.—Let not be blamed—
the prophecy—sinfully;—
Lord God Almighty,—at St.
Edmund's at the parliament—
give him counsel.—And on
false Philip of France—by thy
virtue to have vengeance,—
that he may never be
advanced—for his mere
falseness.

Sur le ray de France conquer sez nez,
 E puis porter la croiz où Jhesu Crist fu
 nez.

Ses enemys,

Deu mercis!

sunt châtiez;

VARIOUS READINGS.—554. *Et une r. fet de
 diverse regnez, C. E un r., de d., R. 1 and 2.*—561.
ad ne prince de tuz les, C. a. n. p. de totes, R. 1.
Rei n'i ad ne p., R. 2.—562. *fors le ray ... joustez,*
C. li ad justicez, R. 1 and 2.—568. *Deus mercys,*
C.

Trestuz sunt maz, 570

Et pris cum raz,

enlachés.

Il ad corouns

E combatons

bien assez,

Od deuz rays

Ad un fays,

et utraés;

Celi de sà

Ore aille de là, 580

od ses barnés.

Jon e Thomas

Li lerount pas

desaydés;

Cuthbert li vent,

Ke od li tent

en les medlez.

En Deu vous die,

Merlin de li

ad prophetez;

590

VARIOUS READINGS.—572. *enlacez, C., R. 1 and
 2.*—573, 574. *coruz | Et combatuz, C., R. 1. coru*

To the borough of St. Edmund, on the day which was fixed,—are come the bishops, with the company—of laymen and clerks, of whom the king prays—aid and courtesy of the goods of holy church,—as they had promised before in the abbey—of Westminster, whereby the king trusts to it—for the help of his war which is not finished.—Earls and barons, with the knights,—for themselves and for the people grant in aid—the tenth penny, and for the merchants—the seventh part for the aid of his treasury.—And the archbishop, who holds the primacy—of the see of Canterbury, studies for an answer,—and explains to the king by two bishops—the condition of holy church, which is much impoverished.—The bishop afterwards goes to the king and says,—“Sire, for God’s sake, do not grieve yourself at all about that,—for all holy church, I certify thee,—under God there is no soul alive in the world—who has over holy church power or

mastery,—except the pope of Rome, who holds the vicary—which St. Peter the apostle had in keeping.—The pope is our head, he keeps and rules us,—and he has made a statute which binds us closely,—on privation of rent and of prelacy,—that neither tenth, nor twentieth, nor half, nor part—none of us give to thee or to any other,—without his commandment and allowance,—upon it he solemnly excommunicates and curses—every son of a mother that by lordship—injures holy church, which may God help in its freedom!”—“Sir clerk,” said the King, “thou hast talked folly;—promise is debt due, if faith be not forgotten;—but if I saw thee here in possession of the bull—as well as all the others, by the son of Mary!—you should not be relieved of this aid.”

Al burk de Seint Edmond le jour est
establie,
Sunt venuz les eveskes, ouf la
compaignie
De lais e clers, ad quels li ray prie
Des biens de seint eglise ayde e curtaysie,
Einsint cum els pramistrent auntane en
l'abie

“Sire,” said the Archbishop, “very willingly—thee as our lord we will all aid—with the leave of the pope, if thou wilt.”

Coumes e barouns a la 610
chivalerie

Pur eus e pur le people grauntent en aie
[Le disime dener, et pur la marchaundye]

Le setim par my aide sa tresorie.

E li erceveske, ke tent la primacie

Deu sé de Canturbirs, sur respouns
estudie,

E par deus eveskes al ray signefie

L'estat de seint eglise, ke mult est
empoverie.

Le erceveske après al rais va e die,

"Sire, pur Deu! là sus ne te greves mie,

Pur tut seint eglise [je te 620
certefye,

Desuz Deus en terre est nul alme en vye

Ke ad sur saint eglise] por ne mestrie,

For la pape de Rome, qe tent la vicarie

VARIOUS READINGS.—610. This line is omitted in R. 1 and 2.—611. *e la chiv.*, C., R. 2. *ly grant en aye*, R. 1.—612. The following line is not found in the Cambridge MS.—613. *parmye à sa tresorye*, C., R. 1 and 2.—616. *sur respouns estodye*, C., R. 1 and 2.—617. *al reis*, R. 1.—619. *al ray*, C.—620. *eglise je te certefye*, C.—622. *Qe south Dieu*, R. 2.—623. *poesté et mestrye*, C.

Qe seint Pere li apostoille avoit en baillie.

La pape est nostre chef, il nous garde e
guye,

E estatute ad fet qe durement nous lie,

Sur privaciune de rent e de prelatie,

Ke disme, ne .v.time, ne moitié, ne partie

A tei ne à nul autre nul de nous otrie

Saunz sun maundement en 630
avowerie,

Sur le sollempnement escomege e maldie

leave of the pope, if thou wilt send to him—by one of thy clerks with our messenger,—who could relate to him thy condition and ours;—and according to the message which the pope shall send us back,—we will as far as our abilities go courteously aid thee."—"Sir clerk," says the King again, "I have no need—for thee to advise me to consult the pope;—but if thou wilt have respite in this case,—cause thy clerks to assemble when thou wilt,—talk to them of the promise, and treat heartily of it;—after St. Hilary's day come to Westminster,—and make the answer without more talk!"—"Sire," said the Archbishop, "for the sake of God and St. Richard!—please to command here and there thy people,—who are thy agents for the twelfth penny,—that they cause to be molested neither us nor our tenants,—nor tax our temporalities along with the layman."—"Sir," answers the King, "you need not fear it,—for they shall do neither well nor ill to none of thy power.—Nevertheless, fair Sir, I pray and require that throughout

Trestuz le fiz de mere qe par seignurie
Aserveint seint eglise, ke Deus aide en
fraunchie.”

“Sire cler,” dit li rais, “tu as parlé folie;
Promis est dette due, si fay ne seit oublie;
Mès ke joe te vais de boule saysie
Einsint tuz li autre, par le fiz Marie!
Ne puriez de ceste ayde estre desublie.”

VARIOUS READINGS.—627. *Estatute ad*, C.—
629. *vintime*, C., R. 1 and 2.—630. *à ly altre*, C.,
R. 1.—632. *Sur co*, C., R. 1.—633. *les fiz*, C., R.
1.—634. *Deus ad f.*, C. *ad enf.*, R. 1 and 2.—635.
Sire clers, R. 1 and 2.—636. *promesse*, R. 1 and
2.—637. *jeo te vaise de la bulle s.*, R. 1. *jeo vei de
la bulle s.*, R. 2.—638. *Ansint tuz les altres*, C.—
639. *ne purrai*, R. 2.

“Sire,” dit le erceveske, “mout
trevolunter 640

Ad tei cum al seignur volums tuz
aider

Par geongé de la pape, si tu le volez
maunder

Par un de tes clers ouf nostre messenger,
Ke toun estate e nostre li purroit cunter;
E sur ceo qe la pape nous fra remaunder,
Volum solum nos aises curtaisement
ayder.”

“Sire clers,” reedit li rais, “jeo n’ai pas
mester

De ceo qe tu me dais la pape consailler;
Mès si tu vols respit en ceo kas aver,
Fa quant tu vodras tes clers assembler,
Enparlés du promesse, e 650

tretez ent du quer;

Après la Seint Hillari venez à
Westmouster

and require,—that throughout
thy diocese thou commandest
to pray—for me and mine,
and to thank God,—who has
done largely for us in our
recent affairs.”—The
Archbishop grants it, and does
his duty.—A little before this
time returned the treasurer—
Walter de Langton, who had
passed the sea—with the
cardinal, to treat of the peace.
—The answer which they
bring no man can know,—
except those of the council
who dare not reveal it.—
Messengers afterwards came
to announce—to the King Sir
Edward a form of arranging—the
strife of Gascony, and to
cause him to agree—with
King Philip, without further
war,—as the cardinals had
caused it to be ordained.—
King Edward forthwith sent
back—Walter de Langton and
Hugh le Despenser,—and
John de Berwick, a clerk and
a valiant knight.—May God
conduct them there, and bring
them well back again!

E fras la respouns sanz plus à parler.”
 “Sire,” dist le erceveske, “pur Deu e
 Seint Richer!
 Volez si e là tes gens comander,

VARIOUS READINGS.—642. *congé*, C., R. 1.—
 644. *porrout moustrer*, C., R. 1 and 2.—645. *Et*
soulom ço ke, C.—646. *Voloums souloum*, C.
Volums nus de nostre aider e prester, R. 1 and 2.
 —651. *Perfournir la pr. ... enparler*, C.—653.
fetez, ... en parler, R. 1 and 2.—655. *Voylliez*, C.

Ke sunt tes ministres ad .xii. dener,
 Ke nous ne nos tenaunz facent molester,
 Ne nos temperaltez ouf les lays taxer.”
 “Sire,” respount li rays, “ceo n’estut
 doter;
 Car ben ne mal ne frunt ad nule de ton
 poer. 660
 Noun pur ceo, bel sire, jeo prie e requer,
 Par my ta deocise comandez prier
 Pur moy e pur le[s] menz, e Deu mercier,
 Ke largement pur nous fet ad cea en
 arer.”

Le erceveske otrie, e fet sun dever.
 Poi avaunt cel heure revint le tresorer
 Water de Langetoune, ke fu passé la mer
 Ouf le cardinale de la pes treter.
 Respouns qu’els i port ne pot nule home
 saver,
 Fors cels du consaille qe ne l’osent
 reveler. 670
 Messagers après vindrent nuncier
 Al rays Sire Edward forme de amouer

VARIOUS READINGS.—657. *ne facent*, C.—659.
ço dist le rais, C.—661. *li rays li prie*, C.—663.

Of the barons of Scotland,
 at this parliament—reason
 was not rendered, nor
 judgment given.—The King
 is so courteous, so full of pity,
 —and of so great mercy, I
 believe certainly—that his
 mercy will be the saving—of
 those who have fully deserved
 death,—by their deeds
 attainted of felony.—The
 great pity of heart which he
 has often had—upon the
 felons of Wales, every body
 talks of it;—when he was
 most occupied for his
 advancement,—they made
 war upon him, and cause a
 diversion,—whereby he was
 obliged to leave his goings
 elsewhere.

After the day of St. Hilary,
 when the King thought (to
 hold)—parliament at London,
 as he had ordained,—news
 came to him by him who was
 then—come from Cambrai,
 and announced to him—that
 the talk of peace was made
 with no intention of coming to

les mens, R. 2.—664. *fet sla*, C. *fet ad ça*, R. 1. *fet de scea*, R. 2.—665. *l'ottrye, e fet*, R. 1 and 2.—668. *les chardinals*, C.

Contek de Gascoyne, e fet acorder
 Li ouf le Rey Phellipp sanz plus guerrer,
 Si cum les cardinals ount fet ordiner.
 Li Rays Edward par taunt ad fet retorner
 Water de Langetoun, e Hugue le
 Dispenser,
 E Jon de Beruik, clerk avertik ber.
 Counduire les face Dieus, e bien
 remener!

Les barouns d'Escoce à cel parlement
 Ne fu resoun rendu, ne 680
 doné jugement,
 Ly rais est si corteis, de si pitouse talent,
 E de si graunt merci, jeo crei
 certainement
 Ke sa misericorde serra sauvement
 A cels ke ount la mort deservi
 plainement,
 E des fez attainz felonousement.
 La grant pité du quer q'il ad eu sovent
 Des felons de Gales, en parlent tote gent,

VARIOUS READINGS.—672. *de amourer*, C. *de amurer*, R. 1. *au rei ... de amourer*, R. 2.—673. *du contek du ... fere*, C., R. 1. *du c. ... fere*, R. 2.—674. *guerrayer*, C., R. 1. *guerreier*, R. 2.—678. *anerty*, C. *Johan de Berwike ... avertiz*, R. 1. *Johan ... clerk e averti*, R. 2.—680. *Des barouns*, C.—681. *renduz*, C.—686. *de fez*, C.

Quan[t] plus ad eu affer pur son
 avancement,
 Meuz li ount la gwere, e fet

an end.—Wherefore King Edward remained and prepared—by sea and by land that he might not be betrayed;—at Westminster he collected his people—to treat about what aid the clergy should give him.—The Lord of Canterbury held himself very rigid on this matter,—he vowed to St. Thomas for him and his parish,—that no one of his church should be any more taxed,—nor placed in servage as long as he lived,—without command of the pope, who ought to govern them.—The Lord of Lincoln agreed to this,—Bishop Oliver, who was not used to bend.—The King was so enraged against the clergy,—that he commanded them to be judged out of his peace.—But now afterwards he repealed that decree.—This did those bishops who willingly consented—to aid their lord whereby to recover his right,—to defend holy church from shame and loss.—The elect of York, who desired peace,—said that willingly as far as concerned him—he would give the fifth penny wherewith to defend

desturbement, 690
Dunt ses alez aillours laisser li covient.

Apres le Seint Hillori, quant le rays
quidait

Parlement à Loundres, cum ordinez
aveit,

Noveles li vindrent par cil ke les estayt
Venuz de Kaumbray, e li nunciait
Ke la parlande de pez se fist pur nul
esplait.

Par quey le rais Edward demourt e se
purvait

Par mer e par tere ke trahi ne sait;
En Westmouster de ses gens equait
Treter de sour quel ayde la clergie li frait.

Ly Sire de Canturbir sur ceo 700
se tint etrahit,

Pur luy e sa paroche à Seint Thomas
vouait

Ke nul de sa eglise taillé plus ne serrait,

VARIOUS READINGS.—691. *ses alers*, R. 1.—
693. *tenir à L.*, C.—694. *lors estait*, C., R. 1 and
2.—697. *le rei*, R. 2.—698. *Par tere et par mer*,
C. *mer ne par t.*, R. 2.—699. *en vait*, C., R. 1 and
2. *E à W.*, R. 1.—700. *Treter sur quele aide*, C.,
R. 1.—702. *et pur sa p.*, C.

Ne mis en servage taunt cum il viverait,
Saunz maundement la pape, ke gouverner
le deit.

Li sire de Nichole ataunt se [a]cordait;
Oliver li eveske, ke flecher ne solait.
Li rais vers la clergie par taunt se
corucait,

E hors de sa pese juguer la comaundait.

holy church.—Not a soul
spoke there of the caitiff
Scots:—they remained in
keeping in the same care,—as
they were before, Dunbar
caused them vexation.—For
there were they burnt ...—he
... them thither,—and drove to
dote.—For Scots at Dunbar—
had at their ...—shame of
their note.—Never were dogs
there—hurled out of....

mes meintenaunt apres ceie iet repellaient.
 Co feceint les eveskes ki 710
 volunté chascail
 Aider à lur seignur dunt recoverir soun
 drait,
 A seinte eglise defendre de hounte e de
 fourfait.
 L'elyt de Everwyke, ke pes desirrait,
 Dit ke volunters pur quanke li tuchait,
 Dount saint eglise defendre le quint dener
 mettrait.
 Des Escosz chaitifs nule aime i parlait:
 Demorez sunt suz garde en autel plait,
 Cum avaunt estaient, Dunbar les
 achascail.

VARIOUS READINGS.—705. *les dait*, C., R. 1.—
 713. *Et sainte*, C., R. 1. *surfait*, R. 1.—718. *sunt*
uncore suz g. en a. esplait, C. *sont en garde mult*
à lour deshait, R. 1. *tut à lour desheit*, R. 2.—
 719. This line ends in C., and R. 1 and 2, with the
 words *escotez ke ço dayt*, and the English lines
 following are omitted.

For thar wer thai bal brend,
 He kauged ham thidre 720
 kend,
 aut dreved to dote.
 For Scottes at Dunbar
 Haved at thayre gau char
 schame of thar note.
 Wer never dogges there
 Hurlled out of herre
 fro coylthe ne cotte.

THE TRAILEBASTONS, AND EXECUTION OF WALLACE.

[From MS. Cotton. Julius A. v. fol. 162, v^o. collated with MS. Reg. 20, A. II. fol. 144, r^o. (R. 1.); and with MS. Reg. 20, A. XI. fol. 125, r^o. (R. 2.)]

En Septembre après Estrivelyn est rendu;
 Ly reys Sire Edwarde ses travayls ad
 sentu,
 Vers Brustewik sur Humbre son chemyn
 ad tenu,

VARIOUS READINGS.—2. *au rei*, R. 2.—3. *est
 meu*, R. 1. *en son ch. est meu*, R. 2.

Sugior une pece i prist pur sa salu.
 Sire Jon de Warenne, count been conu,
 Mortz fu lors et prest à mette en sarcu.
 Ly reys, ke Deu garde! en alaunt vers le
 su,
 Par my Lendesei enquist de lu en lu,
 Taunt com en Escos en sa guere fu,
 Ky out sa pees enfraynt, ki out sa pees
 tenu; 10
 Pur taunt com il volait, remede fu purveu
 Sur cil ke fust ataynt de sa pees rumpu.

Respouns ount fet au reys gentz de been
 voyllance,

Coment parmy la tere fet est grant
 grevaunce
 Par comune contekours, ke sunt par
 fiaunce
 Obligez ensemble à une purviaunce;
 Traylbastouns sunt nomez de cel
 retenaunce,
 En fayres et marchez se proferent fere
 covenance,

VARIOUS READINGS.—5. *Johan ... counte*, R. 1
 and 2.—6. *mort*, R. 2.—7. *le rei, le sieu*, R. 2.—8.
Lyndesei, R. 1.—10. *qi l'ount tenu*, R. 2.—11.

TRANSLATION.—In
 September after Stirling was
 delivered;—the King Sir
 Edward was fatigued with his
 labours,—he held his way
 towards Burstwick on
 Humber,—he remained there
 a while for his health.—Sir
 John de Warenne, an Earl well
 known,—was then dead and
 ready to be put in his coffin.
 —The King, whom God
 keep! in going towards his
 own,—through Lindsey
 inquired from place to place,
 —whilst he had been in
 Scotland in his war,—who
 had broken his peace, and
 who had held it;—straight at
 his will, remedy was provided
 —for him who was attainted
 of having broken his peace.

People of good will have
 made answer to the King,—
 how a great grievance is made
 in the land—by common
 squabblers, who are by oath—
 obliged together to a
 purveyance;—this company
 are called Trailebastons,—
 they offer to make
 conventions at fairs and
 markets,—for three or four
 shillings, or merely to show

volait, R. 1. *cum avolait*, R. 2.—13. *au rei*, R. 2.
—15. *comuns*, R. 2.

Pur treys souz ou .iiii., ou pur la
valiaunce,
Batre un prodomme ke unk fist nosaunce
A cors Cristiene, par nuli 20
temoygnaunce.
Si homme countredye à nul de l'aliaunce,
Ou marchaund de ses merz li vee fere
creaunce,
En sa mesoun demené, sauntz altre
daliaunce,
Batuz serrait been, ou pur l'acordaunce
Dora de ses deners et prendre aquitaunce.
Si en la riot ne seit fet disturbaunce,
Une commune guere se levera par
chaunce.
Entendu ad ly reys la plaint et la
parlaunce,
Escutez ore coment purveu est la
vengaunce. 30

Parmy Engleterre gentz de graunz resouns
Assignez sunt justizes sur les
traylbastouns;
Les uns par enquest sunt jugez à
prisouns;

VARIOUS READINGS.—19. *voillaunce*, R. 1.—
20. *ne fist*, R. 2.—23. *vee de er.*, R. 2.—26.
prendra, R. 2.—31. *grant resons*, R. 1. *gent de*
grant, R. 2.

Li altre alez à fourches à pendre
envirouns;
Plusours sunt privez de [lour]

their courage,—to beat a good man, who never did hurt—to any Christian body, by the testimony of no one.—If a man contradict any one of the alliance,—or a merchant will not trust them for his merchandise,—taken in his own house, without other interference,—he shall be well beaten, or by agreement—he shall give of his money and take acquittance.—If there were no hindrance made to their riot,—a war among the commons would by chance arise.—The King has heard the complaint and the talk,—now hear how the punishment is provided.

Throughout England men of great account—are assigned as judges on the Trailebastons;—some by inquest are judged to prisons;—others to go to the gallows, to hang there about;—many are deprived of their possessions;—those who had done least ill are obliged to pay fines. If there was not chastisement of ribalds and rascals,—people would not dare to live in their houses.—O! how God is good in his just dealings,—who has so

possessiouns;
 Ke meyns mesfesaynt sunt passez par
 raunsouns.
 Si chastiment ne fust de ribaldes et
 bricouns,
 Osé ne serrait homme vivre en mesouns.
 O! cum Deus est bons de drayturels
 guerdouns,
 Ke taunt sovent nous ad vengé de
 felouns! 40
 Novel avoms oy entre compaygnouns
 De William le Walays, mestre de larouns;
 Sire Jon de Meneteft li suist à talouns,
 Enprès de sa puteyne li prist en
 tapisouns;
 A Loundres le menait en ferges et
 laceouns,
 Où jugez esteit sur cels condiciouns;
 En primer à fourches fust trayné pur
 tresouns,
 Pendu pur robberyes et pur occisiouns,

VARIOUS READINGS.—34. *altres*, R. 1 and 2.—
 36. *passé*, R. 2.—39. *est draiturels e de bone*, R.
 1.—40. *vengés*, R. 2.—41. *Novels*, R. 1.—42. *des*
barouns, R. 1.—43. *Johan de Menetest*, R. 1.
Mentest, R. 2.—44. *Semprès de sa*, R. 2.

Et pur ceo k'il avait ennenty par arsouns.
 Viles et eglises et religiouns, 50
 Avalez est de fourches, et overt les
 ventrouns,
 Le quoyer et la bowel brullez en carbouns,
 Et copé la teste par tels mesprisiouns,
 Pur ceo ke il avait par ces havyllouns
 Maintenuz la guere, doné protecciouns,
 Seysye seygnurye en ses subjecciouns

just dealings,—who has so
 often revenged us of felons!
 —We have heard news among
 companions—of William
 Wallace, the master of the
 thieves;—Sir John de
 Menteith followed him close
 at his heels,—and took him in
 bed beside his strumpet;—he
 brought him to London in
 fetters and bonds,—where he
 was judged on the following
 conditions:—first to be drawn
 to the gallows for his
 treasons,—to be hung for
 robbery and for slaughter,—
 and because he had destroyed
 by burning—towns and
 churches and monasteries,—
 he is taken down from the
 gallows, and his belly opened,
 —the heart and bowels burnt
 to ashes,—and his head cut
 off for such faults,—because
 he had by these ...,—
 maintained war, given
 protections,—seized lordship
 into his subjection—of the
 realm of another by his
 intrusions.—His body was cut
 into four parts,—each hung
 by itself in memory of his
 name,—instead of his banner
 these are his standards.—To
 finish his history,—at London
 is his head,—his body is
 divided in four good towns

divided—in four good towns,
—whereby to honour the isles
—that are in Albania.—And
thus may you hear,—a lad to
learn—to build in peace.—It
falls in his eye,—who hacks
too high,—with the Wallace.

ke sunt en Albanye.
And tus may you here,
A ladde to lere
to bigken in pais.
It falles in his eghe, 70
That hackes ovre heghe,
wit at Walays.

The Simonie.

Whii werre and wrake in londe and manslauht is i-come,
Whii hungger and derthe on eorthe the pore hath undernome,
Whii bestes ben thus storve, whii corn hath ben so dere,

GLOSSARY.—1. *werre and wrake*, war and mischief.—2. *undernome*, undertaken, seized upon.—3. *storve*, starved, perished.

3e that wolen abide, listneth and 3e muwen here
the skile.

I nelle lizen for no man, herkne who so wile.

God greteth wel the clergie, and seith theih don amis,
And doth hem to understonde that litel treuthe ther is;
For at the court of Rome, ther treuthe sholde biginne,
Him is forboden the paleis, dar he noht com therinne 10
for doute;

And thouh the pope clepe him in, 3it shal he stonde theroute.

Alle the popes clerkes ban taken hem to red,
If treuthe come amonges hem, that he shal be ded.
There dar he noht shewen him for doute to be slain,
Among none of the cardinaus dar he noht be sein,
for feerd,
If Symonie may mete wid him he wole shaken his berd.

Voiz of clerk is sielde i-herd at the court of Rome;
Ne were he nevere swich a clerk, silverles if he come, 20
Thouh he were the wiseste that evere was i-born,
But if he swete ar he go, al his weye is lorn
i-souht,
Or he shal singe *si dedero*, or al geineth him noht.

For if there be in countre an horeling, a shrewe,
Lat him come to the court hise nedes for to shewe,

GLOSSARY.—4. *wolen*, will (pl.). *muwen*, may.—5. *skile*, cause, reason.—6. *nelle lizen*, will not lie.—7. *theih*, they.—10. *paleis*, palace.—11. *doute*, fear.—12. *clepe*, call.—13. *han*, have (pl.). *red*, counsel.—19. *voiz*, voice. *sielde i-herd*, seldom heard.—20. *swich*, such.—22. *ar*, before.

And bringe wid him silver and non other wed,
Be he nevere so muchel a wrecche, hise nedes sholen be spede
ful stille,
For Coveytise and Symonie han the world to wille.

30

And erchebishop and bishop, that ouhte for to enquire
 Off alle men of holi church of what lif theih were,
 Summe beth foles hemself, and leden a sory lif,
 Therefore doren hii noht speke for rising of strif
 thurw clerkes,
 And that everich biwreied other of here wrecchede werkes.

But certes holi churche is muchel i-brouht ther doune,
Siththen Seint Thomas was slain and smiten of his croune.
He was a piler ariht to holden up holi churche,
Thise othere ben to slouwe, and feinteliche kunnen worche, 40
 i-wis;
Therefore in holi churche hit fareth the more amis.

But everi man may wel i-wite, who so take ȝeme,
That no man may wel serve tweie lordes to queme.
Summe beth in office wid the king, and gaderen tresor to hepe,
And the fraunchise of holi churche hii laten ligge slepe
ful stille;
Al to manye ther beth swiche, if hit were Godes wille.

GLOSSARY.—27. *wed*, pledge.—28. *muchel a wrecche*, great a wretch. *sholen be*, shall be.—29. *stille*, quietly.—34. *doren hii*, dare they.—35. *thurw*, through.—36. *everich*, every one. *biwreied*, accused.—38. *Siththen*, since.—39. *piler*, pillar.—40. *slouwe*, slothful. *kunnen*, know how.—41. *i-wis*, truly, in truth.—43. *i-wite*, know. *zeme*, care (*take zeme*, pay attention).—44. *queme*, pleasure.—45. *qaderen*, gather. *to hepe*, in a heap.

And thise ersedeknes that ben set to visite holi churche,
 Everich fondeth hu he may shrewedelicheſt worche; 50
 He wole take mede of that on and that other,
 And late the parsoun have a wyf, and the preſt another,
 at wille;
 Coveytise ſhal ſtoppen here mouth, and maken hem al ſtille.

For ſone ſo a parsoun is ded and in eorthe i-don,
 Thanne ſhal the patrour have ȝiftes anon;
 The clerkes of the cuntré wolen him faſte wowe,
 And ſenden him faire ȝiftes and preſentes i-nowe,
 and the biſhop;
 And there ſhal Symonye ben taken bi the cop. 60

Coveytise upon his hors he wole be ſone there,
 And bringe the biſhop ſilver, and rounen in his ere,
 That alle the pore that ther comen, on ydel ſholen theih worche,
 For he that allermoſt may ȝive, he ſhal have the churche;
 i-wis,
 Everich man nu bi dawe may ſen that thus hit is.

And whan this newe parsoun is inſtitut in his churche,
 He biſthenketh him hu he may ſhrewedelicheſt worche;
 Ne ſhal the corn in his berne ben eten wid no muiſ,

GLOSSARY.—49. *ersedeknes*, archdeacons.—50. *fondeth*, ſeeketh, endeavours.
shrewedelicheſt worche, work moſt curſedly.—51. *mede*, bribe.—52. *late*, let.—54.
stoppen, ſtop.—55. *ſone ſo*, as ſoon as.—57. *wowe*, woo, court.—58. *i-nowe*, enough.—
 60. *cop*, head.—62. *rounen*, whiſper. *ere*, ear.—63. *on ydel*, fruitleſſly, to no avail.—64.
allermoſt, moſt of all.—66. *nu bi dawe*, now-a-days.—68. *hu*, how.—69. *muſ*, mouſe.

But hit shal ben i-spended in a shrewede huis; 70
if he may,
Al shal ben i-beten out or Cristemesse-day.

And whan he hath i-gadered markes and poundes,
He priketh out of toune wid haukes and wid houndes
Into a straunge contré, and halt a wenche in cracche;
And wel is hire that first may swich a parsoun kacche
in londe.
And thus theih serven the chapele, and laten the churche stonde.

He taketh al that he may, and maketh the churche pore,
And leveth thare behinde a thief and an hore, 80
A serjaunt and a deie that leden a sory lif;
Al so faire hii gon to bedde as housebonde and wif;
wid sorwe
Shal there no pore lif fare the bet nouthen on even ne on morwe.

And whan he hath the silver of wolfe and of lomb,
He put in his pautener an honne and a komb,
A myrour and a koeverchef to binde wid his crok,
And rat on the rouwe bible and on other bok
no mo;
But unthank have the bishop that lat hit so go. 90

For thowh the bishop hit wite, that hit bename kouth,
He may wid a litel silver stoppen his mouth;

GLOSSARY.—70. *huis*, house.—74. *priketh*, rideth.—75. *cracche*, properly a manger, perhaps here, a cradle.—76. *wel is hire*, it is well for her.—81. *deie*, dairymaid.—85. *lomb*, lamb.—86. *pautener ... honne*,....—87. *koeverchef*, kerchief. *crok*, crook.—88. *rat*, reads. *rouwe*, rough.—89. *mo*, more.—91. *bename kouth*, could take in hand. (?)

He medeth wid the clerkes, and halt forth the wenche,
And lat the parish for-worthe; the devel him adrenche
for his werk!
And sory may his fader ben, that evere made him clerk.

And if the parsoun have a prest of a clene lyf,
That be a god consailler to maiden and to wif,
Shal comen a daffe and putte him out for a litel lasse,
That can noht a ferthing worth of god, unnethe singe a masse 100
but ille.
And thus shal al the parish for lac of lore spille.

For riht me thinketh hit fareth bi a prest that is lewed,
As bi a jay in a kage, that himself hath bishrewed;
God English he speketh, ac he wot nevere what;
No more wot a lewed prest in boke what he rat
bi day.
Thanne is a lewed prest no betir than a jay.

But everi man may wel i-wite, bi the swete rode!
Ther heth so manye prestes, hii ne muwe noht alle be gode. 110
And natheles thise gode men fallen oft in fame,
For thise wantoune prestes that pleien here nice game,
bi nihte,
Hii gon wid swerd and bokeler as men that wolde fihte.

GLOSSARY.—93. *medeth*, takes bribe.—94. *for-worthe*, go to nought. *adrenche*, drown.—
96. *ben*, be.—97. *prest*, priest.—99. *daffe*, fool. *lasse*, less.—100. *unnethe*, hardly.—102.
for lac of lore spille, be ruined for want of teaching.—104. *bishrewed*, cursed.—105. *wot*,
knows.—106. *rat*, reads.—109. *rode*, cross, rood.—110. *muwe*, may.

Thus is God nu served thurwout religioun;
There is he al to sielde i-sein in eny devocioun; 140
His meyné is unwelcome, comen hii erliche or late;
The porter hath comaundement to holde hem widoute the gate,
in the fen.

Hu mihte theih loven that loverd, that serven thus his men?

This is the penaunce that monekes don for ure lordes love:
Hii weren sockes in here shon, and felted botes above;
He hath forsake for Godes love bothe hunger and cold;
But if he have hod and cappe fured, he nis noht i-told
in covent;
Ac certes wlaunknesse of wele hem hath al ablent. 150

Religioun was first founded duresce for to drie;
And nu is the moste del i-went to eise and glotonie.
Where shal men nu finde fattere or raddere of leres?
Or betre farende folk than monekes, chanons, and freres?
In uch toun

I wot non eysiere lyf than is religioun.

Religioun wot red I uch day what he shal don?
He ne carez noht to muche for his mete at non;
For hous-hire ne for clothes he ne carez noht;

GLOSSARY.—140. *to sielde i-sein*, too seldom seen.—141. *meyné* (*maisné*, Fr.), household, people. *erliche*, early.—145. *ure*, our.—146. *Hii weren*, they wear. *shon*, shoes. *botes*, boots.—148. *But if*, unless. *hod*, hood. *fured*, furred. *he nis noht i-told*, he is not reckoned, or esteemed.—150. *wlaunknesse*, pride. *wele*, weal. *ablent*, blinded.—151. *duresce*, hardness. *drie*, bear, suffer.—152. *nu*, now. *moste del*, greatest part.—153. *raddere of leres*, redder of complexion.—155. *uch*, each.—156. *wot*, know. *eysiere*, more easy.

But whan he cometh to the mete, he maketh his mawe touht 160
 off the beste;
And anon therafter he fondeth to kacche reste.

And ȝit ther is another ordre, Menour and Jacobin,
 And freres of the Carme, and of Seint Austin,
 That wolde preche more for a busshel of whete,
 Than for to bringe a soule from helle out of the hete
 to rest.
 And thus is coveytise loverd bothe est and west.

If a pore man come to a frere for to aske shrifte,
And ther come a ricchere and bringe him a zifte;
He shal into the freitur and ben i-mad ful glad;
And that other stant theroute, as a man that were mad
in sorwe;
Ȝit shal his ernde ben undon til that other morwe.

And if there be a riche man that evel hath undernome,
 Thanne wolen thise freres al day thider come;
 And if hit be a pore lyf in poverté and in care,
 Sorwe on that o frere that kepeth come thare
 ful loth;
 Alle wite ȝe, gode men, hu the gamen goth.

And if the riche man deie that was of eny mihte,
Thanne wolen the freres for the cors fihte.

GLOSSARY.—160. *touht*, full.—162. *fondeth to kacche*, seeketh to take.—163. *zit*, yet.—168. *loverd*, lord.—169. *shrifte*, confession.—170. *zifte*, gift.—171. *freitur*, refectory. *i-mad*, made.—172. *stant*, stands.—173. *sorwe*, sorrow.—174. *ernde*, errand. *morwe*, morrow.—175. *undernome*, undertaken.—178. *o*, one. *that kepeth*, that cares.—180. *wite 3e*, know ye. *gamen*, game.

Hit nis noht al for the calf that kow louweth,
Ac hit is for the grene gras that in the medewe grouweth
so god.

Alle wite 3e what I mene, that kunnen eny god.

For als ich evere brouke min hod under min hat,
The frere wole to the direge, if the cors is fat;
Ac bi the feith I owe to God, if the cors is lene,
He wole wagge aboute the cloistre and kepen hise fet clene 190
in house.

Hu mihte theih faire forsake that hii ne ben coveytouse?

And officials and denes that chapitles sholden holde,
Theih sholde chastise the folk, and theih maken hem bolde.
Mak a present to the den ther thu thenkest to dwelle,
And have leve longe i-nouh to serve the fend of helle
to queme;
For have he silver, of sinne taketh he nevere 3eme.

If a man have a wif, and he ne love hire noht,
Bring hire to the constorie ther treuthe sholde be souht, 200
And bringge tweye false wid him and him self the thridde,
And he shal ben to-parted so faire as he wole bidde
from his wif;
He shal ben holpen wel i-nouh to lede a shrewede lyf.

GLOSSARY.—183. *Hit nis*, it is not. *louweth*, lows.—184. *Ac*, but.—186. *kunnen*, know.
—187. *als*, as. *brouke*, use, hold.—192. *theih*, they.—193. *chapitles*, chapters.—195. *ther*,
where.—196. *i-nouh*, enough. *fend*, fiend.—197. *queme*, pleasure.—198. *3eme*, care.—200.
constorie, consistory. *souht*, sought.—202. *to-parted*, separated. *bidde*, ask.

And whan he is thus i-deled from his rihte spouse,
He taketh his neiheboures wif and bringeth hire to his house;
And whiles he hath eny silver the clerkes to sende,
He may holde hire at his wille to his lifes ende
wid unskile;
And but that be wel i-loked, curs in here bile. 210

And ȝit ther is another craft that toucheth the clergie,
That ben thise false fisiciens that helpen men to die;
He wole wagge his urine in a vessel of glaz,
And swereth that he is sekere than evere ȝit he was,
and sein,
“Dame, for faute of helpe, thin housebonde is neih slain.”

Thus he wole afraien al that ther is inne,
And make many a lesing silver for to winne.
Ac afterward he fondeth to comforte the wif,
And seith, “Dame, for of thin I wole holde his lyf,” 220
 a[n]d liȝe;
Thouh he wite no more than a gos wheither he wole live or die.

Anon he wole biginne to blere the wives eize;
He wole aske half a pound to bien spicerie;
The .viij. shillinges sholen up to the win and the ale;
And bringe rotes and rindes bret ful a male
 off noht;
Hit shal be dere on a lek, whan hit is al i-wrouht.

GLOSSARY.—205. *i-deled*, parted.—209. *wid unskile*, with wrong.—210. *here*, their.—215. *sein*, say.—218. *lesing*, falsehood.—219. *he fondeth*, he tries.—221. *lize*, lie.—222. *gos*, goose.—223. *eize*, eyes.—224. *bien*, buy.—226. *bret ful*, broad full, filled up. *male*, chest, pannier.—228. *on a lek*, for a leek. (?)

I leve,
He sholde stonde starc naked twye o day or eve.

Godes soule is al day sworn, the knif stant a-strout,
And thouh the botes be torn, ȝit wole he maken hit stout;
The hod hangeth on his brest, as he wolde spewe therinne,
Ac shortliche al his contrefaiture is colour of sinne, 280
and bost,
To wraththe God and paien the fend hit serveth allermost.

A newe taille of squierie is nu in everi toun;
The raye is turned overthuert that sholde stonde adoun;
Hii ben degised as turmentours that comen from clerkes plei;
Hii ben i-laft wid pride, and cast nurture away
in diche;
Gentille men that sholde ben, ne beth hii none i-liche.

And justises, shirreves, meires, baillifs, if I shal rede aricht,
Hii kunnen of the faire day make the derke niht; 290
Hii gon out of the heie wey, ne leven hii for no sklaundre,
And maken the mot-halle at hom in here chaumbre,
wid wouh;
For be the hond i-whited, it shal go god i-nouh.

If the king in his werre sent after mihti men,
To helpe him in his nede, of sum toun .ix. or .x.,

GLOSSARY.—275. *I leve*, I believe.—276. *twye*, twice.—277. *a-strout*, sticking out (?).—
282. *allermost*, most of all.—283. *newe taille*, new cut.—284. *raye*, cloth, garment.
overthuert, crosswise.—286. *ben i-laft wid*, have separated from, or have sent away.—289.
shirreves, sheriffs.—290. *kunnen*, know how, they can.—292. *mot-halle*, hall of meeting,
the justice-hall.—293. *wouh*, wrong.—294. *i-whited*, whitened.

The stiffeste sholen bileve at hom for .x. shillinges or .xii.,
And sende forth a wrecche that may noht helpe himselve
at nede.
Thus is the king deceyved, and pore men shent for mede. 300

And if the king in his lond maketh a taxacioun,
And everi man is i-set to a certein raunczoun,
Hit shal be so for-pinched, to-toilled, and to-twiht,
That halvendel shal gon in the fendes fliht
off helle;
Ther beth so manye parteners may no tunge telle.

A man of .xl. poundes-worth god is leid to .xii. pans rounde;
And also much paieth another that poverte hath brouht to grounde,
And hath an hep of girles sittende aboute the flet.
Godes curs moten hii have! but that be wel set 310
and sworn,
That the pore is thus i-piled, and the riche forborn.

Ac if the king hit wiste, I trowe he wolde be wroth,
Hou the pore beth i-piled, and hu the silver goth;
Hit is so deskatered bothe hider and thidere,
That halvendel shal ben stole ar hit come togidere,
and accounted;
An if a pore man speke a word, he shal be foule afrounted.

GLOSSARY.—297. *bileve*, remain.—300. *shent*, ruined. *mede*, reward, bribery.—303. *for-pinched*, pinched to pieces. *to-toilled*, laboured away. *to-twiht*, twitted away.—304. *halvendel*, one half.—307. *god*, goods. *pans*, pence.—309. *flet*, floor.—312. *i-piled*, robbed.—315. *deskatered*, scattered about.—318. *afrounted*, accosted (French, *affronter*).

Ac were the king wel avised, and wolde worche bi skile,
 Litel nede sholde he have swiche pore to pile; 320
 Thurfte him noht seke tresor so fer, he mihte finde ner,
 At justices, at shirreves, cheiturs, and chaunceler,
 and at les;
 Swiche mihte finde him i-nouh, and late pore men have pes.

For who so is in swich office, come he nevere so pore,
He fareth in a while as thowh he hadde silver ore;
Theih bien londes and ledes, ne may hem non astonde.
What sholde pore men [ben] i-piled, when swiche men beth in londe
so fele?
Theih pleien wid the kinges silver, and breiden wod for wele. 330

Ac shrewedeliche for sothe hii don the kinges heste;
Whan everi man hath his part, the king hath the leste.
Everi man is aboute to fille his owen purs;
And the king hath the leste part, and he hath al the curs,
 wid wronge.
God sende treuthe into this lond, for tricherie dureth to longe.

And baillifs and bedeles under the shirreve,
 Everich fondeth hu he may pore men most greve.
 The pore men beth over al somouned on assise;
 And the riche sholen sitte at hom, and ther wole silver rise 340
 to shon.
 Godes curs moten hii have, but that be wel don!

GLOSSARY.—319. *skile*, reason, right.—320. *swiche*, such.—321. *thurfte him*, need he.
ner, near.—322. *cheiturs*, escheators.—324. *pes*, peace.—327. *bien*, buy. *ledes*,
possessions. *astonde*, withstand.—329. *fele*, many.—330. *wod*, wood.—331. *heste*,
command.—332. *leste*, least.—338. *fondeth*, tries, endeavours.—341. *shon*, to be shewn, to
be seen.—342. *moten*, may.

And countours in benche that stondeth at the barre,
Theih wolen bigile the in thin hond, but if thu be the warre.
He wole take .xl. pans for to do down his hod,
And speke for the a word or to, and don the litel god,

I trouwe.

And have he turned the bak, he makketh the a mouwe.

Attourneis in cuntré theih geten silver for noht;
Theih maken men biginne that they nevere hadden thouht; 350
And whan theih comen to the ring, hoppe if hii kunne.
Al that theih muwen so gete, al thinketh hem i-wonne
wid skile.

Ne triste no man to hem, so false theih beth in the bile.

And sumtime were chapmen that troweliche bouhten and solde;

And nu is thilke assise broke, and nas noht ȝore holde.

Chaffare was woned to be meintened wid treuthe,
And nu is al turned to treccherie, and that is muchel reuthe
to wite,

That alle manere godnesse is thus adoun i-smite. 360

Unnethe is nu eny man that can eny craft,
That he nis a party los in the haft;
For falsnesse is so fer forth over al the londe i-sprunge,

GLOSSARY.—345. *pans*, pence.—348. *mouwe*, mow, contemptuous gesture.—352. *muwen*, may. *i-wonne*, won.—353. *skile*, reason.—354. *triste*, trust. *beth*, are.—355. *chapmen*, merchants. *troweliche*, truly.—356. *nas noht ȝore holde*, has not been held a long time.—357. *Chaffare*, traffic.—358. *muchel reuthe*, great pity.—361. *can*, knows.—362. *party los in the haft*,....

That wel neih nis no treuthe in hond, ne in tunge,
ne in herte;
And tharfore nis no wonder thouh al the world it smerte.

Ther was a gamen in Engeland that durede 3er and other;
Erliche upon the Monenday uch man bishrewed other;
So longe lastede that gamen among lered and lewed, 369
That nolde theih nevere stinten, or al the world were bishrewed,
i-wis;
And therefore al that helpe sholde, fareth the more amis.

So that for that shrewedom that regneth in the lond,
I drede me that God us hath for-laft out of his hond,
Thurw wederes that he hath i-sent cold and unkinde;
And 3it ne haveth no man of him the more minde
ariht;
Unnethe is any man aferd of Godes muchele miht.

God hath ben wroth wid the world, and that is wel i-sene;
For al that whilom was murthe, is turned to treie and tene. 380
He sente us plenté i-nouh, suffre whiles we wolde,
Off alle manere sustenaunce grouwende upon molde
so thicke;
And evere ageines his godnesse we weren i-liche wicke.

GLOSSARY.—367. *gamen*, game. *3er and other*, a year and an other, *i. e.* two years.—369. *lered and lewed*, learned and unlearned, clergy and laity.—370. *nolde theih*, they would not. *stinten*, desist. *or*, before. *bishrewed*, accursed.—373. *shrewedom*, cursedness.—374. *for-laft*, dismissed.—375. *Thurw*, through. *wederes*, weathers.—380. *treie and tene*, vexation and sorrow.—382. *grouwende*, growing. *molde*, earth.—384. *i-liche wicke*, equally wicked.

Men sholde noht sumtime finde a boy for to bere a lettre,
That wolde eten eny mete, but it were the betre.
For beof ne for bakoun, ne for swich stor of house,
Unnethe wolde eny don a char, so were theih daungerouse
for wlaunke;
And siththen bicom ful reulich, that thanne weren so ranke. 390

For tho God seiþ that the world was so over gart,
He sente a derthe on eorthe, and made hit ful smart.
A busshel of whete was at foure shillinges or more,
And so men mihte han i-had a quarter noht 3ore
i-gon;
So can God make wane, ther rathere was won.

And thanne gan bleiken here ble, that arst lowen so loude,
 And to waxen al hand-tame that rathere weren so proude.
 A mannes herte mihte blede for to here the crie
 Off pore men that gradden, “Allas! for hungger I die 400
 up rihte!”
 This auhte make men aferd of Godes muchele miht.

And after that ilke wante com eft wele i-nouh,
And plenté of alle gode grouwende on uch a bouh.
Tho god 3er was a3ein i-come, and god chep of corn,
Tho were we also muchele shrewes as we were befor.

GLOSSARY.—388. *don a char*, do a turn, or task.—389. *wlaunke*, pride.—390. *siththen*, since. *reulich*, pitiful.—391. *tho*, when. *over gart*, over proud.—394-95. *noht zore i-gon*, not long ago.—397. *gan bleiken here ble*, their complexion turned pale. *arst lowen*, formerly laughed.—398. *rathere*, earlier, before.—400. *gradden*, said lamentingly.—403. *eft*, again.—405-6. *Tho ... tho*, when ... then.

or more;
Also swithe we forȝeten his wreche and his lore.

Tho com ther another sorwe that spradde over al the lond;
A thusent winter ther bifore com nevere non so strong. 410
To binde alle the mene men in mourning and in care,
The orf deiede al bidene, and maden the lond al bare,
so faste,
Com nevere wrecche into Engeland that made men more agaste.

And tho that qualm was astin[t] of beste that bar horn,
Tho sente God on eorthe another derthe of corn,
That spradde over al Engeland bothe north and south,
And made seli pore men afingred in here mouth
ful sore;
And ȝit unnethe any man dredeth God the more. 420

And wid that laste derthe com ther another shame,
That ouhte be god skile maken us alle tame.
The fend kidde his maistri, and arerede a strif,
That everi lording was bisi to sauve his owen lyf,
and his god.
God do bote theron, for his blessedde blod!

Gret nede hit were to bidde that the pes were brouht,
For the lordinges of the lond, that swich wo han i-wrouht,

GLOSSARY.—408. *wreche*, punishment. *lore*, teaching.—409. *sorwe*, sorrow.—412. *orf deiede al bidene*, cattle died all forthwith.—414. *wrecche*, punishment.—415. *qualm*, mortality. *astint*, stopped.—418. *seli*, simple. *afingred*, hungry.—422. *god skile*, good reason.—423. *fend*, fiend, devil. *kidde*, showed. *arerede*, raised.—424. *bisi*, busy.—426. *do bote*, make a remedy.—427. *bidde*, pray.

That nolde spare for kin that o kosin that other;
So the fend hem prokede uch man to mourdren other 430
 wid wille,
That al Engeland i-wis was in point to spille.

Pride prikede hem so faste, that nolde theih nevere have pes
Ar theih hadden in this lond maked swich a res,
That the beste blod of the lond shamliche was brouht to grounde,
If hit betre mihte a ben, allas! the harde stounde
bitid,
That of so gentille blod i-born swich wreche was i-kid.

Allas! that evere sholde hit bifalle that in so litel a throwe,
Swiche men sholde swich deth thole, and ben i-leid so lowe. 440
Off eorles ant of barouns baldest hii were;
And nu hit is of hem bicomme riht as theih nevere ne were
i-born.
God loke to the soules, that hii ne be noht lorn!

Ac whiles thise grete lordinges thus han i-hurled to hepe,
Thise prelatz of holi church to longe theih han i-slepe;
Al to late theih wakenen, and that was muchel reuthe;
Theih weren ablent wid coveytise, and mihte noht se the treuthe
for mist. 449
Theih dradden more here lond to lese, than love of Jhesu Crist.

GLOSSARY.—430. *prokede*, urged.—432. *spille*, to be ruined, spoil.—434. *Ar*, before. *swich a res*, such a rage.—438. *wreche*, destruction. *i-kid*, shown.—440. *thole*, undergo, bear. *i-leid*, laid.—444. *lorn*, lost.—445. *i-hurled to hepe*, thrown on a heap.—448. *ablent*, blinded.—450. *dradden*, dreaded. *lese*, lose.

[Page 1](#), line 10, *Savory of Mauleon*.—For an interesting article on this Baron and his poems, see the eighteenth volume of the *Histoire Littéraire de France*, pp. 671-682. His name is of frequent occurrence in the English rolls and charters of the reigns of John and Henry III.

— *l. 20, laxait Bordelois*.—Alphonso VIII. King of Castille, married Alianor, daughter of Henry II. of England, and in her right he claimed Gascony, in opposition to King John, and invaded it. In 1206, he laid siege to Bourdeaux. See Dom. Bouquet, *Collect. des Historiens de France*, tom. xviii. p. 245.

[P. 3](#), *l. 2, lois* is the Latin *laudes*.

— *l. 19, par presen*.—It has been suggested that this may mean *as though he were present*; but I think the translation adopted is preferable.

[P. 4](#), *l. 6, Lo rei Richard*.—Richard I. was in Aquitaine when he received the wound which caused his death.

— *l. 17, Lozoics ... Guillelme ... ad Aurenga*.—The allusion, I suppose, is to the inedited romance of Guillaume d'Orange.

[P. 5](#), *l. 20, Cadoing*.—Perhaps *Cadomum*, or Caen, as here translated. But there was also a place called Cadoing near Périgueux, which had a celebrated abbey.

It may be observed, as a peculiar characteristic of the Provençal songs of this class, that the poet generally introduces an address to a lady, although she has nothing to do with the subject.

[P. 6](#), *l. 11. SONG ON THE BISHOPS*.—Since this part of the volume was printed, I have found among the manuscripts of the British Museum (MS. Reg. 7 F, V, fol. 1, r^o, written in a contemporary hand) a copy of this song, containing important variations, which would have enabled me to give the text more correctly. In this manuscript the lines are arranged thus in each stanza:—

Complange tuum, Anglia, melos suspendens organi;
Et maxime tu, Cantia, de mora tui Stephani.
Thomam habes sed alterum, secundum habes iterum
Stephanum, qui trans hominem induens fortitudinem signa facit in populo.
Dolos doles metropolis quos subdoli parturiunt,
Orbata tuis incolis, dolose quos ejiciunt,
Largos emittis gemitus, patre privata penitus.
Sed cum habebis Stephanum, assumes tibi tympanum, chelym tangens
sub modulo.

The following are the various readings offered by this MS.—[P. 6](#), *l. 1, tuum*.—[P. 7](#), *l. 4, doles*.—15, *vel legem*.—17, *quis Nathan David*.—19, *vel postibus*.—21, *jam liberetur*.—[P. 8](#), *l. 2, exurge*.—4, *ancilla*.—5, *jam superductis aliam*.—7, *Portæ prævalent inferi*, with *Tartari* written over the last word.—8, *nam ludo*.—16, *Scriptis* omitted.—19, *Patet interpretatio | et arduis et infimis, | Nam regni, &c.*—[P. 9](#), *l. 2, et sacerdos*, with *et* erased and *nam* written over it.—3, *concurrit ad*.—7, *sudet*.—12, *eos*.—15, *et deicit*.—20, *debent et suum fundere*.—22, *jactant*.—[P. 10](#), *l. 8, in hac*.—11, *clamet*.—16, *dum*.—17, *perit*.—20, *sedet ad*.—22, *Euvangelium*.—23, after this line should come the

following, *Ad nummos vertit oculum*.—[P. 11](#), l. 1, *lucro lucam*.—2, *Marcum marca*.—3, *librum libra*.—8, *Amplectuntur*.—13, *sunt appositi* | *Sed longe*.—20, *ob hoc*.—[P. 12](#), l. 1, *In canes nostri*.—10, *Eliensis*.—11, *datus*.—12, *Eli et ensis*.—14, *Elios*.—16, *Et Babilonis*.—19, *Wlstani*.—[P. 13](#), l. 1, *Wlstani*.—4, *Effot, mitram, et anulum*.—8, *et* is omitted.—9, *Hinc est, et hinc a latere* | *Et pauper*.—13, *non causatur*.—14, *des. Cantia*.

—— l. 16, *tui Stephani*.—Stephen Langton, whom the Pope had appointed to the archbishopric of Canterbury, in opposition to the election of the monks and the King. He was archbishop from 1207 to 1229.

[P. 7](#), l. 17, *natum* should be *Nathan*; see the above various readings for this as well as for some other necessary corrections, which would have rendered the translation less difficult.

[P. 8](#), l. 3, *Agar ... filium*.—The marginal note in Flacius says, Joannem Graye Episcopum Nordovicensem intelligit. It is not said whether these side-notes are given from the MS. which Flacius used, or are of his own making.

[P. 8](#), l. 14.—The same side-notes tell us the *scribentem digitum* means the Pope—Papam intelligit.

[P. 9](#), l. 12, *Non est qui*.—The allusion, according to the side-note, is to Pandulph the legate. This explanation is, however, rather doubtful.

[P. 10](#), l. 1, *præsuli Bathoniæ*.—Joceline de Welles, Bishop of Bath and Wells from 1205 to 1242. He fled out of England with the Bishops of London, Ely, and Worcester, who had published the interdict.

—— l. 10, *Norwicensis bestia*.—John Graye, Bishop of Norwich, who was designed by the King to the see of Canterbury. The three Bishops who took part with the King, whom Matthew Paris calls “tres episcopi curiales,” were those of Norwich, Winchester, and Durham.

—— l. 15, *Cato quondam tertius*.—I do not quite understand the allusion. It occurs again at the end of the *Apocalypsis Goliae*—

De cælo cecidi ut Cato tertius,
Nec summi venio secreti nuncius,
Sed meus michi quod inscripsit socius,
Hoc vobis dicere possum fidelius.

—— l. 19, *Wintoniensis armiger*.—Peter de Rupibus, Bishop of Winchester, from 1204 to 1238. He was a native of Poitiers in France, and had been a knight before his consecration. He, with the Bishops of Durham and Norwich, supported the party of the King against the Pope. In 1214 he was made chief-justice of England, and he was protector of the realm during the minority of Henry III. See *Godwin, de Præsulibus*.

[P. 11](#), l. 1, *lucro Lucam ... Marco marcam ... libræ librum*.—These puns are frequently repeated in the satirical poetry of the thirteenth century. They will be found further on in the present volume, pp. [16](#) and [31](#), as well as in some of the poems of Walter Mapes. Giraldus Cambrensis uses a similar pun in relating his journey to Rome, where he says he differed in one particular from others who went there, for he offered *libros, non libras*. *Libra* in the song should probably be translated *a pound*, as at p. [31](#), not *the scales*.

[P. 12](#), l. 1, *Joannes ... decanus*.—For Joannes, the King's MS. has *canes*, which is perhaps right, as *canus* and *canit* in the following line seem to be continued puns upon the word.

[P. 12](#), l. 10, *Heliensis*.—Eustace, Bishop of Ely, from 1197 to 1214. As has been observed, he was one of the three who published the pope's interdict.

— l. 19, *Wolstani subambule*.—Maugerius, Bishop of Worcester, from 1200 to 1212. He was also one of those who published the interdict, and having like the others fled to the Continent, he died in exile at Pontiniac, in 1212. It is hardly necessary to observe that St. Wolstan had held the see of Worcester in the eleventh century.

[P. 13](#), l. 6, *De Roffensi episcopo*.—Gilbert de Glanville, Bishop of Rochester, from 1185 to 1214. Between him and his monks there was perpetual contention, and he diminished much the goods of his church. See Godwin.

— l. 10, *pauper Sarisburiae*.—Robert, Bishop of Salisbury, who seems to have lived in obscurity. Godwin says he could find no other information relating to him, except the date of his being bishop.

— l. 15, *I Romam*.—Flacius Illyricus gives here the following side-note—"Golias ad librum, vel Gualterus Mapes."

[P. 14](#), l. 6-10.—This information is conveyed in two side-notes in Flacius Illyricus, who has printed this Song imperfectly; but whether these notes were composed by the editor, or found in the manuscript, we are not told. There are no circumstances in the Song itself which would lead us to fix it to this date rather than to any other in the first half of the thirteenth century. The two notes are at the beginning,—"Leo, Joannes Rex; aselli, episcopi sunt;"—and at the end, "Jupiter Rex Joannes est: Pluto, Romanus pontifex." On reference, however, to Bale, I find that he speaks of Mapes as calling King John sometimes a lion and sometimes Jupiter, and as designating the Pope by the name of Pluto, and the bishops as asses, which seems to prove that he had read these side-notes, perhaps in the manuscript from which Flacius's transcript was made. It is not indeed improbable that the latter obtained it from Bale himself, who was perhaps the author of the side-notes.

— l. 11, SONG ON THE TIMES.—Flacius has printed this Song in his *Varia Doctorum, etc. Poemata*, p. 406, with the omission of the three first stanzas, which he had previously given as a separate song at p. 159. The text now printed is made up from a comparison of the manuscript with the printed text. The variations are as follows:—L. 1, *utor*, Flacius.—3, *deaurati belli*, Fl.—9, *Facies in opere*, MS.—10, *Tegunt partem an.*, Fl.—[P. 15](#), l. 2, *congruit ramum in*, Fl.—3, *caput mundi*, Fl.—5, *Trahit enim ... et sec.*, Fl.—7, *singula*, Fl.—9, *Romæ sunt v.*, Fl.—11, *In hoc cons.*, Fl.—17, *petunt quando petis*, Fl.—18, *seminas, eadem tu metis*, Fl.—[P. 16](#), l. 4, *Munus al. pollet sing.*, Fl.—6, *rot. placet, totum pl.*, Fl.—7, *Et c. ita pl. ... Romanis*, Fl.—10, *objiciat*, Fl.—12, *transeunt, ut bursa det g.*, Fl.—13, *Romam avaritiæ vitet manus p.*, Fl.—16, *At est*, MS.—[P. 17](#), l. 1, *non sit*, Fl.—2, *Respondet, hæc tybia non est michi tanti*, MS.—4, *pappare*, Fl.—5, *nomen Gallicum*, Fl.—6, *Paies, paies, dist le mot*, Fl.—7-10, These four lines are not found in the MS.—11, *Da istis, da aliis, addas*, Fl.—[P. 18](#), l. 1, *Burse*, Fl.—4, *Ut cum fiat vacuus, magis imp.*, Fl.—6, *habet Pl.*, Fl.—In Fl. the two last tetrastichs are transposed.

[P. 16](#), l. 6, *crux placet*.—The face of the coin was marked with a cross.

[P. 20](#), l. 1, *prima rabies*.—The insurrection of the Barons.

— l. 2, *altera belligeras Francorum*.—The expedition of Prince Louis to help the Barons, who were hard pressed by John's foreign auxiliaries.

—— *l. 3, Scottorum tertia.*—*l. 4, Flexit quarta Galenses.*—Both the Scots and Welsh joined actively in the war, or rather took that occasion of invading the kingdom.

—— *l. 6, turres.*—The MS. has *turmas* in the text, and “*vel turres*” in the margin.

[P. 22](#), *l. 13.*—The writer evidently intended a pun, or rather a double meaning, in the word *parentis* at the end of the line.

[P. 23](#), *l. 5, viri, i. e.* Gualo the legate. The poem was evidently written by a strong partizan of the Pope.

—— *l. 10, truces.*—The MS. has *traces*.

—— *l. 15, &c.*—Louis and his party were at London, which they quitted in the November after King John’s death, in order to march towards the North. On the 6th December they took Hertford Castle, and that of Berkhamstead on the 20th, and proceeded to St. Alban’s. A truce was then agreed to, which continued till after Easter.

[P. 24](#), *l. 2, Montique Sorello.*—When hostilities recommenced, the Barons of the king’s party laid siege to Mount Sorrel, in Lincolnshire, but were obliged to retreat by the approach of a part of the army of Louis under the command of the Comte de Perche.

—— *l. 7, Cestrensis clipeus.*—Ranulph de Blundeville, Earl of Chester, one of the most powerful Barons on the king’s party, who now commanded the army which had besieged Mount Sorrel, and which soon afterwards defeated the Comte de Perche at Lincoln.

[P. 24](#), *ll. 8, 9, 10*, in the margin, opposite these three lines respectively, the original scribe has written, “S. Nottingham. Trente. Nicole.” The *nobilis matrona* was Nichola, widow of Gerard de Camville, who defended Lincoln Castle against the French.

—— *l. 11.*—It may be well to point out the remarkable alliteration in this line and the following.

—— *l. 14, signa.*—The MS. has *singna*, a form not uncommon in such words.

—— *l. 15, ora.*—The MS. has *hora*.

[P. 25](#), *l. 2, Sabbatum.*—Saturday, May 20, 1217. The next day was Trinity Sunday.

[P. 28](#), *l. 11, Sabinæ.*—Sabina was a very common term for a modest woman in low Latin, just as Thais was for a strumpet. See on the latter word a note in the *Early Mysteries and other Latin Poems*, p. 131.

—— *l. 12, Arabes.*—Arabia, the land of gems and spices, was believed to contain inexhaustible stores of riches.

[P. 33](#), *l. 4, Refert ad focariam.*—*Focaria* was the name given to the wives or concubines of the priests and clergy, who had been recently proscribed. It occurs again in the *Apocalypsis Goliæ*—

Seductam nuncii fraude præambuli,
Capit focariam, ut per cubiculi
Fortunam habeat fortunam loculi,
Et per vehiculum omen vehiculi.

I have rendered the word, according to its derivation, by *fire-side woman*, for it is explained in an old gloss as *meretrix foco assidens*. See *Ducange* in v. Fuller (Church Hist. p. 27, folio edit.) makes very needless difficulties on the meaning of this word, apparently for the sake of introducing some equally needless jokes. The following article in the *decreta* of Pope Alexander, printed in the History of Henry of Huntingdon (Scriptores post Bedam, fol. 1601), p. 589, which one would think must have passed under his eyes, left little room for doubt;—

“*Ne clerici in sacris ordinibus constituti focarias habeant.*”

“Clerici in sacris ordinibus constituti, qui mulierculas in domibus suis sub incontinentiæ nota tenuerint, aut abjiciant eas et continenter vivant, aut beneficio et officio fiant ecclesiastico alieni.”

In the statutes of Stephen, Archbishop of Canterbury, MS. Cotton. Julius D. II. fol. 167, r^o, we find also a chapter—

“*De focariis amovendis.*”

“Sacerdotibus vero præcipue et spiritualiter in virtute Spiritus Sancti et sub periculo beneficii districte præcipimus quod continenter vivant et honeste, concubinas suas a domibus suis procul expellant, et nullam familiaritatem cum eis de cætero habeant, nec in propriis domibus nec in alienis, nisi volunt simul beneficiis et officiis contra hoc agendo privari,” etc.

And again, just after, we have the following title:—

“*De pœna et satisfactione focariarum.*”

“Concubinæ sacerdotum frequenter moneantur ab archidiaconis, et præcipue a sacerdotibus in quorum parochia morantur, vel ut contrahant, vel ut claustrum ingrediantur, vel sicut publice peccaverunt publicam agant pœnentiam.”

The word *focaria* is often used by Giraldus Cambrensis. Speaking of a priest on the Borders of Wales, he says, “More sacerdotum parochialium Angliæ fere cunctorum damnabili quidem et detestabili, publicam secum habebat comitem individuum et *in foco focariam* et in cubiculo concubinam.” (Wharton, Anglia Sacr. vol. ii. p. 525.) From this passage it is clear that the name *focaria* was given to them because they lived publicly with the priests in their houses, and *shared their fire-sides*; and from some other circumstances mentioned in Giraldus, it appears that they were in reality married to the priests, though the stricter party considered the marriage to be uncanonical.

[P. 36](#), l. 2, *Omina*.—The MS. has *Homina*.

—— *Bernard de Rovenac*.—For all that is known of this poet, see the *Histoire Littéraire de France*, tom. xviii. p. 667.

[P. 48](#), ll. 7-10, *Regnat nunc impietas*, &c. These four lines resemble very closely the first four lines of another song, in MS. Sloane, No. 1580, fol. 160, v^o, which will be printed among the Poems of Walter Mapes—

Captivata largitas longe relegatur,
Exulansque probitas misere fugatur,
Dum virtuti veritas prave novercatur,
Inperat cupiditas atque principatur.

[P. 49](#), l. 8, *Wandelardus*.—Perhaps a *Vandal*.

— ll. 15-18. With the little information given in the song, it is difficult to ascertain who were the four brothers the writer intended to satirise. This punning way of deriving and explaining proper names was by no means uncommon during the middle ages. In a splendid Bible in three volumes folio, written in England early in the twelfth century, and now preserved in the Library of St. Geneviève at Paris, the scribe gives the following very curious account of his family. Its being previously inedited will be a sufficient excuse for inserting it here.

“Hanc Bibliothecam scripsit Mainerus scriptor Cantuariensis. Sed ne ab ignorantibus parentelam suam putaretur nothus, sive spurius, placuit ei nomen proprium suum et nomen propinquorum parentum suorum scribere et ethimo-logizare. Ipse itaque scriptor inter suos recto nomine Mainerus nominabatur, quod nomen ei desienter datum est; Mainerus enim interpretatus est, imitata in sua manu gnatus, quia peritus fuit et gnarus in arte scribendi. Pater ejus Wimundus nominabatur, quod nomen interpretatum Latine sonat *hodie mundus*; poterat enim de eo dici cotidie quod mundus esset, quod mundus in mundo munde vixit, ad Creatorem suum sine immunditia migravit. Nomen matris suæ dicebatur Anglice Livena, quod Latine sonat *lætitia*; fuit enim mulier hylaris, facie decora, moribus ornata et pudica, et semper in largiendo bona sua pro Dei amore datrix hilaris; sana et incolumis per .lxxx. annos et plus feliciter vixit. Avus suus nominabatur Ulgerus, i. ulnas gerens; fuit enim vir magnus et fortis, qui magnas habebat ulnas. Nomen aviæ suæ dicebatur Anglice Elvera, quod interpretatur *Dei vidua*, quæ et in bona viduitate diu vixit. Quatuor habuit fratres et unam sororem, quorum primus vocabatur Radulphus, i. ratus et adustus, i. firmus in adolescentia; fortis enim valde juvenis fuit. Secundus dicebatur Robertus, quia a re nomen habuit, spoliator enim diu fuit et prædo. Tertius nuncupabatur Giroldus, girovagus enim fuit omnibus diebus vitæ suæ. Quartus nominabatur Johannes, quod nomen interpretatum sonat *Dei gratia*; et iste gratiam Dei gratia Dei adeptus est; fuit enim juvenis ætate, senex moribus, virgo castitate, vita beatus. Soror ipsius dicebatur Dionisia, id est Deo nitens; nitebatur enim semper bonis operibus ad Deum venire. Animæ omnium istorum et animæ omnium fidelium defunctorum per misericordiam Dei requiescant in pace! Amen!”

[P. 51](#). SONG UPON THE TAILORS.—It is scarcely necessary to say that the three lines which form the theme of this song, are the commencement of Ovid’s *Metamorphoses*. Llewellyn, Prince of Wales, invaded the Marches in 1263.

[P. 53](#), l. 3, *capucium*.—The name capuce was given sometimes to a separate piece of apparel with which the head was covered, and at others to the upper part of the tunic of the monks which covered the head. In the present instance it must be taken in the former sense. A full account of the different senses of the word will be found in Ducange.

— l. 6, *almucium*.—The aumuce was a separate article of clothing which covered both head and shoulders. One of the articles of the canons for the behaviour of the monks, given by Pope Clement V., was, “ut almutiis de panno nigro, vel pellibus, caputiorum loco, uterentur.”

— l. 14, *Tyeis*.—The French and Anglo-Norman form of the Latin *Teutonicus*. It is the origin of the name of several old English families.

[P. 57](#), l. 4, *Cernite*.—The MS. has *scernite*.

[P. 58](#), l. 2, *Frollo*.—This personage is a famous character in the fabulous history of Arthur, and is there said to have been King of Paris under the Romans. When hard pressed by Arthur, who had conquered “all France and all Germany,” he took refuge in Paris, and was besieged there. The people in the city beginning to feel the effects of famine, persuaded Frollo to engage Arthur in single combat. The battle was said to have taken place in the “isle” (*insula Parisiensis*), the part of the

French capital included between the two branches of the Seine, in which, at the present day, stand Nôtre-Dame and the Palais de Justice, with its beautiful Sainte-Chapelle. The story of Arthur and Frolo is told at length in Geoffrey of Monmouth.

— ll. 10, 11, *Arthurus*.—King Arthur, the hero of so many romances. *Broinsius*. (?) *Constantinus*.—Constantine the Great, whose mother Helena was said to have been a British lady. *Brennius*: the conqueror of Rome, who, according to the British history, was a Briton.

[P. 58](#), ll. 13, 14, *Karolum*—Charlemagne; *Ricardum*—Richard Cœur-de-Lion: both of whom were the heroes of romances and popular songs. The same two heroes of French and English fable are mentioned in a curious passage of the *Polychronica* of Ralph Higden: “Quemadmodum Græci suum Alexandrum, Romani suum Octavium, Angli suum Ricardum, Franci suum Karolum, sic Britones suum Arthurum præconiantur.” P. 225, in Gale’s *Scriptores*.

[P. 59](#). THE SONG OF THE BARONS.—The transcript of this curious fragment was communicated to me by Sir Frederick Madden. The original is written in a contemporary hand on a roll twenty-two inches long, by three broad, and was evidently intended to be carried about by the minstrel who was to sing it. On the reverse had been written a curious interlocutory poem in English of a later period, entitled, “*Interludium de Clerico et Puella*.” It was, in 1838, in the possession of the Rev. Dr. Richard Yerburgh, Vicar of Sleaford, in Lincolnshire.

Such rolls appear to have been in common use. A very curious vellum roll of the fifteenth century, containing chiefly religious songs with the music, and, among the rest, a copy of the well-known song on the battle of Agincourt printed by Percy, has been recently deposited in the Library of Trinity College, Cambridge. I am informed that another, of the thirteenth century, has been lately found among the archives of Sir John Hanmer, Bart., containing an Anglo-Norman romance previously unknown, on the adventures of Melors, son of Melians of Cornwall. Among the Sloane MSS. in the British Museum (No. 809), is an early copy of the curious poem of Walter de Bibbesworth, designed for the instruction of children in the French language, written in a similar manner on a roll of parchment, evidently for the purpose of being more easily used in a school.

— l. 1, *de Warenne ly bon quens ... en Norfolk*.—John, Earl of Warenne, a staunch supporter of the royal party, in whose cause we shall soon afterwards find him fighting at Lewes.

— l. 7, *Sire Jon Giffard*.—Sir John Giffard, of Brimsfield, in Gloucestershire, a firm adherent of the Barons. When Sir Roger de Clifford delivered Gloucester to Prince Edward, Giffard fortified his castle of Brimsfield, and greatly annoyed the royalist garrison of the former place. For an account of his exploits at this time, see Robert of Gloucester’s *Chronicle*, pp. 538, 539. He was on the Barons’ party at the battle of Lewes, and was taken prisoner there; but afterwards, when Simon de Montfort was in the height of his power, Giffard deserted him. See Robert of Gloucester, p. 550.

[P. 60](#), l. 1, *Sire Jon Dayvile*.—Sir John Dayvile, or D’Ayvile (Robert of Gloucester calls him in one place De Eivile) does not appear very prominent in these troubles till after the death of Simon de Montfort at Evesham. He then headed those of the Barons who established themselves at Chesterford in the Peak, and afterwards was the chief of those who held the Isle of Ely against the King. Knighton calls him “*homo callidus et bellator fortis*.” See Knighton (in Twysden), col. 2454; *Chron. Thomæ Wikes* (Gale), pp. 81, 82; Robert of Gloucester, p. 564.

— l. 7, *De Clifford ly bon Roger*.—Roger de Clifford first took part with the Barons, but early in the war deserted them, and delivered Gloucester castle, which he held for them, to Prince Edward. He was with the King at Northampton.

—— *l. 13, Sire Roger de Leyburne ... ses pertes que Sire Edward le fist.*—Sir Roger de Leyburn was at first a partizan of the Barons, and had been taken prisoner at Rochester Castle, and committed to the custody of John Mareschall. It was on this occasion, probably, that he was visited with the penalties alluded to in the song. He was afterwards seduced by the royal party, and made Warden of the Cinque Ports. He was with the King at the taking of Northampton, at the defence of Rochester, where he was wounded, and at Lewes.

[P. 61](#), *l. 16, Ly éveske de Herefort.*—Peter de Egueblanche, Bishop of Hereford, a staunch adherent to the King, and, by his oppressions, exceedingly obnoxious to the Commons. In 1263, the Barons seized and imprisoned him, and confiscated his treasures. He was a native of Savoy.

[P. 62](#), *l. 1, ly pastors de Norwis.*—Simon de Wanton, Bishop of Norwich, from 1257 to 1265, chaplain to King Henry III., and one of his justices.

—— *l. 7, Sire Jon de Langelé.*—According to the Annales de Dunstaple, the estates of G. de Langley were plundered soon after the arrest of the Bishop of Hereford:—“idem facientes de maneriis G. de Langele et ejus bonis.” Vol. i. p. 354. Perhaps this was the same person.

[P. 62](#), *l. 13, Sire Mathi de Besile.*—We should perhaps read *Machi*; Robert of Gloucester and Stow call him *Macy*. He was a French knight, who had been made Sheriff of Gloucester, after the King had sworn to the articles of Oxford. The Barons ejected him, and put another sheriff in his place; Sir Macy came with a body of armed men and the authority of the King, reinstated himself by force, and drove away his rival. Sir Roger de Clifford and Sir John Giffard came against him, besieged and took Gloucester Castle, and imprisoned him along with the “Freinss bissop” of Hereford, whom they seized immediately afterwards. Robert of Gloucester mentions the confiscation of his property:—

“And Sir Jon Giffard nom to him is quic eigte echon,
And al that he fond of is, and nameliche at Sserton.”

The song here printed was evidently written just after this event, and previous to the subsequent desertion of Clifford and others mentioned in it.

—— *l. 18, treget.*—It has been suggested that this word represents the Latin *treugellum*, a little truce.

—— *l. 19, mi Sire Jon de Gray.*—John de Gray held on the King’s party, and was rewarded for his loyalty by the grant of various high offices. The circumstance alluded to in the song is thus told in the Annales de Dunstaple (Ed. Hearne, vol. i. p. 357); it occurred in the disturbances in London in 1263. —“Quo perpetrato facinore, cives Londoniarum contra ipsum et alios de consilio regis in civitate commorantes, insurrexerunt; in tantum quod hospitium Johannis de Grey extra Ludgate invaserunt, et equos ejus triginta duo et alia quæcunque ibidem inventa abduxerunt: ipso Johanne cum difficultate maxima ultra alveum de Flete fugam arripiente. Idem fecerunt de domibus et bonis Simonis Passelewe.”

—— *l. 21, que must, quod movit.*

[P. 63](#), *l. 4, Sire Willem le Latimer.*—Sir William le Latimer was a firm adherent of the King, and held at different times several offices of trust. He suffered considerable losses in the Barons’ wars. He afterwards appears to have accompanied Prince Edward to the Holy Land, and was at the siege of Carlaverock in 1300. He died in 1305, at a very advanced age. Knighton calls him *miles strenuissimus*.

[P. 63](#). SONG OF THE PEACE WITH ENGLAND.—It has been suggested to me that the word *cul* in this song is only a form of *col* (collum); and I am told that among the titles of some fables in the same manuscript there is one of the stork “au long *cul*.” In this song, however, I am inclined to think such an interpretation not admissible. It is a rude burlesque not only upon the event to which it relates, but upon the English in general, and contains much coarse humour such as is not uncommonly used at the present day. The grammatical construction is, evidently by design, a complete confusion of tenses, numbers, and genders. It appears to me that not a little of the effect it was intended to produce, depended upon the coarse play upon words involved in the use of the expression above mentioned. When the reciter introduced King Henry to his auditors, and they expected he was going to sigh from his heart, instead of completing the sentence *il suspire de cœur* ([p. 65](#)), i. e. ille suspirat de corde, he introduces another word beginning with the same letter, and says *il suspire de cul* (ille suspirat de culo). That *Trichart* in the preceding line was intended for a pun upon *Richard*, we may conjecture from the rhymes in the English song on the same person’s name, [p. 69](#). Again, at [p. 66](#), it would naturally be expected that he would place his lance against his enemy’s *cœur*; the blow was to be so strong, that if his opponent did not give way, he would himself suffer in that part which was in communication with the saddle, and where, of course, the resistance was concentrated. These jokes must have been extremely diverting to the class of people for whom this song was designed.

The Song of the Peace with England had been previously printed by Mons. Achille Jubinal, well known for his numerous publications of early French literature, in a very curious volume entitled “Jongleurs et Trouvères,” 8vo. Paris, 1835. M. Jubinal also gave a translation into modern French of this song, as well as of the piece I am now going to mention, in the “Journal de l’Institut Historique,” Jan. 1835, which has been reproduced in the *Histoire de Saint Louis*, by the Marquis de Villeneuve-Trans, 8vo. Paris, 1839, vol. iii. p. 614. In the manuscript from which this song is printed, it is accompanied by a piece in prose on the same event, and of a similar character, entitled *Le Chartre de la Pais aus Anglois*, which I venture to reprint here from M. Jubinal’s book, as the latter is now out of print, and very scarce. It will be observed that the same style of gross joking which is found in the song, runs through the charter; a double meaning was evidently intended, for example, in the words *qu’il fu fet .i. gros pes entre, etc.*, which might be taken as signifying, in this broken French, either *grossa pax*, or *grossus peditus*.

La Chartre de la Pais aus Anglois.

“Ce sache sil qui sont et qui ne sont mi, et qui ne doivent mi estre, qu’il fu fet .i. gros pes entre ce rai Hari d’Inglete, et ce riche homme Loys à Parris, sarra forretier de ce grant forrest à Normandi. Et quant ce rai Hari d’Inglete voudra vauchier par son terre, ce riche homme Loys à Parris voudra donier à ce rai Hari meismes .ii. poronssores à mester soz son houses, por ester plus minet; et quant ce rai Hari voudra aler de mort à vie, cestui riche homme Loys à Parris, devra donier à d’Adouart sa fils cesti chos meism, souz vise quitement, francement di-je, c’avant c’arier. C’est donques à saver .i. poronssores quant il voudra vauchier par son terre à meter soz son houses, por ester plus minet aussinc comme à sa piere. Et por ce que je véele que ce chos fout fiens en estable, je véele pendez ma saiele à ce cul par derrier, avoecques la saiele à mi barons d’Inglete. L’an de l’incarnacion nostres sinors Jesouciet mimes qui souffri mort à la crucefimie por nous, m. cc. lx. i. ij. et iij., à ce jodi assolier, derrière ce vendredi, à orre que Marri Masalaine chata ce honissement à honissier les .v. plais Jesouciet nostre sinors mimes, qui souffra mort à la croucefin por nous, et Marri Mauvaise-alaine portez ce honissement à la Saint Supoucre; et Marri Mauvaise-alaine véez l’angiel, et l’angiel pona: “Marri! Marri! quei quieré vous quei?” Et Marri pona: “Je queres Jhesum qui fout à la crucefimie.” Et l’angel pona à Marri: “Marri! Marri! aléici, aléici: il ne fout pas çï, il fout alé cestui matin à Gallerie.”

[P. 64](#), l. 6, *choison*; from *choir* (cadere).

[P. 65](#), l. 6, *gondre Glais grondier*, contra Anglos grunnire.

—— l. 9, *à l'art*.—Perhaps it should be *alart*, and is derived from the Latin *alacriter*.

—— l. 11, *la conte à Clocestre*.—Gilbert de Clare, who succeeded his father in the Earldoms of Hereford and Gloucester in 1262, and was a zealous partizan of the Barons, until he deserted Simon de Montfort before the battle of Evesham.

—— l. 15, *la cont Vincestre*.—Roger de Quincy, Earl of Winchester. Why his name is introduced so prominently, does not seem clear. He died in the year following (1264), and the title became extinct.

[P. 67](#), l. 3, *Rogier Bigot*.—Roger Bigod, Earl of Norfolk.

[P. 67](#), l. 18, *Saint Amont*, means, probably, St. Edmund.

[P. 69](#). SONG AGAINST THE KING OF ALMAIGNE.—This song was first printed in Percy's *Reliques of Ancient English Poetry*.

—— l. 2, *Kyn of Alemaigne*.—It is hardly necessary to say that this was Richard Earl of Cornwall, the King's brother.

—— l. 3, *Thritti thousent pound*.—The Barons had offered him this sum, if he would by his intermediation persuade the King to agree to a peace with them, and at the same time accept the terms they demanded.

—— l. 10, *Walingford*.—The honour of Wallingford had been conferred on Richard in 1243.

—— l. 12.—Windsor was the stronghold of the royal party, and had been garrisoned by foreigners.

—— l. 15, *mulne*.—"After the battle was lost, Richard, King of the Romans, took refuge in a windmill, which he barricadoed, and maintained for some time against the Barons, but in the evening was obliged to surrender. See a very full account of this in the *Chronicle of Mailros*." *Percy*.

[P. 70](#), l. 8.—The Earl of Warenne escaped from the battle, and fled into France.

—— l. 20, *Sire Hue de Bigot*.—Hugh Bigod escaped with the Earl of Warenne to Pevensey, and from thence to France. He was cousin to the Hugh Bigod who took part with the Barons, and was slain at Lewes.

[P. 71](#), l. 6, *lyard*.—This word (in low Latin *liardus*) means, properly, a dapple-grey horse; but it is often used, like several other similar words, as a common name for a horse in general. I have interpreted it as meaning a hack; but probably the passage implies a sneer at Edward, who had been more than once with his army to Dover, in the hope of taking the castle from the Barons, and the word may mean simply his horse.

[P. 72](#), l. 13.—The battle of Lewes was fought on Thursday, (?) May 14, 1264.

[P. 73](#), l. 36, *in claustro*.—A great part of those of the King's party who quitted the field, took shelter in the abbey of Lewes, where they were besieged by the Barons.

[P. 74](#), l. 47, *apud Northamptoniam*.—Northampton had been taken by the King on the third of April preceding.

[P. 74](#), l. 55, *monasterium, quod Bellum vocatur*.—I have not found any notice elsewhere of the contributions forced from the abbeys of Battle and Robertsbridge.

[P. 75](#), l. 1, *monachi Cystercii de Ponte-Roberti*.—There was an abbey of Cistercian monks at Robertsbridge, in Sussex.

— ll. 73-77.—With these lines may be compared a passage in Knighton's Chronicle (ap. Twysden), col. 2445:—"Et sicut Simon Machabæus surrexit pro fratre suo Juda, ut pro populo Dei et lege paterna certaret ad mortem; sic et Simon de Monteforti pro Anglia erexit se, ut pro legibus et libertatibus ejus usque ad mortis perniciem dimicaret."

[P. 76](#), l. 94, *intumuit*.—In the MS. the scribe has written *intumuit* in the margin, either as a various reading, or as an improvement of his own.

[P. 78](#), l. 128, *bellici*.—The MS. has *vellici*.

[P. 79](#), l. 145, *gaudii*.—The MS. has *gladii* in the text, with *gaudii* written in the margin.

[P. 81](#), l. 193, *S. divina gratia præsul Cycestrensis*.—Stephen de Berkstead, Bishop of Chichester. He was excommunicated for his staunch adherence to the party of Simon de Montfort.

[P. 88](#), l. 325, *movisset*.—The MS. has *novisset*.

— l. 330, *for* proponerat, *read* proponeret.

[P. 89](#), l. 252, *invenire*.—The MS. has *inveniere*.

[P. 94](#), l. 437, *Testis sit Glovernia*.—Alluding to the delivery of Gloucester to Prince Edward, and his treatment of the town.

[P. 102](#), l. 609, *regis et*.—The MS. has *regisset*.

[P. 104](#), l. 635, *Unius rex, etc.*—This line appears to be very corrupt, as are one or two others in the poem.

[P. 114](#), l. 833, *Nec libertas proprie debet nominari, | quæ permittit inscie stultos dominari*.—The reader will hardly fail to call to mind the similar sentiment expressed in the line of Milton—

“Licence they mean, when they cry liberty.”

[P. 115](#), l. 858, *p’rat*.—The MS. has *p̄rat*, the meaning of which is by no means clear.

[P. 116](#), l. 875, *Veritas, lux, caritas, calor, urit zelus*.—Perhaps the commas should be omitted after *veritas* and *caritas*, and the whole be translated, “Truth is light, charity is warmth, zeal burns.”

[P. 117](#), *Regis esse noveris nomen relativum*.—It would be by no means uninteresting to collect the expressions of the popular doctrine concerning the kingly character held by our forefathers at different periods. Perhaps it may not be considered altogether foreign to the subject to point out here a few of them.

I.—In a MS. of the tenth century (MS. Cotton. Nero, A. i., fol. 71, r^o.) we have, among some other things of a similar kind, the following sketch of the opinion of the Anglo-Saxons on this subject, said to be from the pen of Alfric:—

Cristenum cyninge ge-byreð on cristenre þeode, þæt he sy eal swa hit riht is folces frofer, 7 rihtwis hyrde ofer cristene heorde, 7 hym ge-byreð þæt he eallum mægene cristendom rære, 7 Godes cyrcan æghwar georne fyrðrie 7 friðrie, 7 eal cristen folc sibbie 7 sehte mid rihtre lage, swa he geornost mæge, 7 þurh ælc þing riht-wisnesse lufie, for Gode 7 for worolde. For þam þurh þæt he sceal sylf fyrrest ge-þeon, 7 his þeodscype eac swa, þe he riht lufige, for Gode 7 for worolde. 7 him ge-byreð þæt he geornlice fylste þam þe riht willan, 7 á hetelice yre þam þe þryres willan.

He sceal mán dæde men þreagean þearle, mid woroldlicre steore; 7 he sceal ryperas 7 reaferas 7 worold-struderas hatian 7 hynan; 7 eallum Godes feondum styrnlice wiðstandan; 7 ægðer he sceal beon mid rihte ge milde ge reðe, milde þam godum, 7 styrne þam yfelum. Ðæt bið cyninges riht, 7 cynelic ge-wuna, 7 þæt sceal on þeode swyðost ge-fremian. La! þurh hwæt sceal Godes þeowum 7 Godes þearfum frið 7 fultum cuman, butan þurh Crist 7 þurh cristenne cyning? Ðurh cyninges wisdom folc wyrð ge-sælig, gesundful, 7 sigefæst, 7 þy sceal wis cyning Cristendom 7 cynedom miclian 7 mærsian, 7 á he sceal hæpendom hindrian 7 hyrwan.

He sceal boc-larum hlystan swyþe georne, 7 Godes beboda geornlice healdan, 7 ge-lome wið witan wisdom smeagan, gyf he gode wile rihtlice hyran. 7 gif hwa to þam stræt sy ahwar on þeode, þæt riht nelle healdan swa swa he scolde, ac Godes lage wyrde, oððe folc lage myrre, þonne cyþe hit man þam cynges, gif man þæt nyde scyle, 7 he þonne sona ræde ymbe þa bote 7 gewylde hine georne, to þam þe his þearf sy huru unþances, gif he elles ne mæge. 7 do swa him þearf is, clænsige his þeode, for Gode 7 for worolde, gif he Godes miltse ge-earnian wylle.

It behoves a Christian King in a Christian people, that he be all as it is right the people's protector, and a just shepherd over the Christian flock, and it behoves him that he with all his might raise Christendom, and advance and protect God's church everywhere diligently, and pacify and reconcile with just law all Christian people, as he most earnestly may, and love justice in every thing, before God and before the world. Because by that he shall profit himself in the first place, and also his people, whom let him love rightly, before God and before the world. And it behoveth him that he diligently help those who wish for justice, and ever most hatefully persecute those who wish for wrong. He shall punish men severely for evil deeds, with secular punishment; and he shall hate and put down thieves and robbers and oppressors of the world; and sternly resist all God's enemies; and he shall be with justice both mild and severe, mild to the good and stern to the bad. This is the king's right, and the manner of a king, and this shall be most efficient in the people. Lo! through what shall peace and help come to God's servants and to God's poor, except through Christ and through a Christian king? Through the king's wisdom the people shall be happy, prosperous, and victorious, and on that account shall a wise king enlarge and increase Christianity and royalty, and ever he shall hinder and persecute heathendom. He shall listen very diligently to scholars, and diligently hold God's commandments, and frequently search wisdom from his witans, if he will rightly hear what is good. And if any one openly be any where in the people, that will not hold justice as he should, but infringes God's law, or obstructs the law of the people, then let people declare it to the king, if they would

extinguish that violence, and there let them soon take counsel for the amends, and subdue him diligently, until that he be reduced at last by force, if he may not otherwise. And let him do as it is needful for him, purify his people, before God and before the world, if he will earn God's mercy.

And again, a little further on (fol. 72, r^o.)—

Ælc riht cynestol stent on þrim stapelum, þe fullice ariht stænt. An is *Oratores*, 7 oðer is *Laboratores*, 7 þridde is *Bellatores*. *Oratores* syndon gebedmen, þe Gode scylan þeowian, 7 dæges 7 nihtes for ealne þeodscype þingigan georne. *Laboratores* syndon weorc-men, þe tilian scylan þæs þe eal þeodscype big sceal libban. *Bellatores* syndon wig-men, þe eard scylon werian, wiglice mid wæpnum. On þyssum þrim stapelum sceal ælc cynestol standan mid rihte on Cristenre þeode. 7 awacie heora ænig, sona se stol scylfð; 7 ful berste heora ænig, þonne hryst se stol nyþer, 7 þæt wyrð þære þeode eal to un-þearfe.

Ac stapelige man 7 strangige and trymme hy georne, mid wislicre Godes lage 7 mid rihtlicre worold lage, þæt wyrð þam ðeodscype to langsuman ræde. 7 soð is þæt ic secge, awacie se Cristendom, sona scylfð se cynedom; 7 arære man un-laga ahwar on lande oððon únsida lufige ahwar to swyþe, þæt cymð þære þeode eal to un-þearfe. Ac do man swa hit þearf is, alecge man un-riht, 7 rære up Godes riht, þæt mæg to þearfe for Gode 7 for worolde. *Amen*.

Every just throne stands on three props, that stands perfectly right. One is *Oratores*, and the other is *Laboratores*, and the third is *Bellatores*. The *Oratores* are the men of prayer, who shall serve God, and by day and night intercede for the whole nation. The *Laboratores* are the workmen, who shall labour in order that all the nation shall live thereby. The *Bellatores* are the men of war (*i. e.* knights), who shall defend the land, valiantly with weapons. On these three props shall every throne stand with justice among Christian people. And if any of them become weakened, soon the throne wavers; and if any one of them fail entirely, then the throne falls down, and that will be the entire ruin of the people. But let man establish and strengthen and confirm them diligently, with the wise law of God and just law of the world, that will be to the nation for a lasting counsel. And it is true what I say, if Christendom be weakened, soon royalty wavers; and if people raise lawlessness everywhere in the land, or love everywhere wickedness too much, that brings the people entirely to ruin. But let people do as it is needful, let people put down injustice, and raise up God's justice, that may bring it to prosperity before God and before the world. *Amen*.

II. In the curious poem of the proverbs of Alfred, composed perhaps in the twelfth century, and which is here quoted from a MS. of the earlier part of the thirteenth century (MS. Trin. Coll. Cambridge, B. 14, 39) is the following account of the duties of King and People.

¶ þus quad Alfred,
Englene frovere:
May no riche king
ben onder Crist selves,
bote þif he be booc-lerid,
7 he writes wel kenne,
7 bote he cunne letteris,
lokin himselven
wu he sule his lond
laweliche holden.

¶ þus quad Helfred:
þe herl 7 þe heþeling
þo ben under þe King,
þe lond to leden
mid lauelich i-dedin,
boþe þe clerc 7 þe cnit
demen evenliche rict.
For after þat mon souit,
als inpich sal he mouin,
7 everiches monnes dom
to his oge dure cherricd.

¶ þus quad Alfred:
þe cnith biovit
kerliche to cnouen
for to weriin þe lond
of here 7 of here-gong,
þat þe riche habbe gryt,
7 þe cherril be in frit,
his sedis to souin,
his medis to mowen,
his plouis to drivin,
to ure alre bi-lif.
þis is þe cnichs lage,
loke þat hit wel fare.

Thus saith Alfred,
the protector of the English:
There may no just king
be under Christ himself,
unless he be book-learned,
and he know well writings,
and unless he know letters,
to look himself
how he shall his land
hold with good laws.

Thus saith Alfred:
The Earl and the Atheling
they are under the King,
the land to lead
by example of lawful deeds,
both the clerk and the knight
to judge impartially right.
For according as a man sows,
so shall he mow,
and every man's judgment
falls at his own door.

Thus saith Alfred:
It behoves the knight
carefully to know
how to defend the land
from army and from invasion,
that the rich may have peace,
and the churl be in tranquillity,
his seeds to sow,
his meadows to mow,
to drive his ploughs,
for the sustenance of us all.
This is the knights' law,
see that it goes well.

III. In the middle of the thirteenth century, at the period of the Barons' wars, we have the passage to which this forms a note.

IV. In the reign of Edward III. the writer of Piers Ploughman gives us the following description of the relative duties of the different orders of society.

Thanne kam ther a kyng,
 kny3thod hym ladde,
 miȝt of the communes
 made hym to regne.
 And thanne cam kynde wit,
 and clerkes he made,
 for to counseillen the kyng,
 and the commune save.
 The kyng and kny3thod,
 and clergie bothe,
 casten that the commune
 sholde hemself fynde.
 The commune contrevod
 of kynde wit craftes,
 and for profit of al the peple
 plowmen ordeyned,
 to tilie and to travaille,
 as trewe lif asketh.
 The kyng and the commune,
 and kynde wit the thridde,
 shopen lawe and leauté,
 ech man to knowe his owene.

Then came there a king,
 knighthood led him,
 the power of the commons
 made him to reign.
 And then came natural sense,
 and he made clerks,
 in order to counsel the king,
 and to be a safeguard to the commons,
 The king and knighthood,
 and clergy along with them,
 determined that the commons
 should find themselves.
 The commons contrived
 arts by means of natural sense,
 and for the profit of the people
 ordained ploughmen,
 to till and to labour,
 as true life requires.
 The king and the commons,
 and natural sense the third,
 created law and loyalty,
 each man to know his own.

V. We may compare all these with the Alliterative Poem on the Deposition of Richard the Second, p. 23, to which, as it is one of the Publications of the Camden Society, I need do no more than refer.

[P. 120](#), l. 947.—This line cannot be construed as it stands, and is evidently corrupt.

[P. 121](#). *William de Rishanger* was a monk of St. Alban's, and is said to have been the King's historiographer (*historiographus regius*) after Matthew Paris's death. He died in 1312. He tells us that this song was written before, and not after, the battle of Lewes; and that it was the defection of some of the Barons mentioned in the song at [p. 59](#), which gave rise to it. It is, therefore, probably placed wrongly after the battle of Lewes.

[P. 122](#), l. 19, *O Comes Gloverniæ*.—This was Gilbert de Clare, who was extremely active in the cause of the Barons, and distinguished himself at the battle of Lewes.

[P. 123](#), l. 3.—The second line of this tetrastich seems to be lost.

— l. 10, *Comes le Bygot*.—This was Roger Bigod, Earl of Norfolk, whom the Barons made Governor of Orford in Suffolk, after the battle of Lewes.

[P. 124](#), l. 3, *nobis*.—A mere error of the press for *vobis*.

[P. 125](#). THE LAMENT OF SIMON DE MONTFORT.—This song was printed privately, with some other Anglo-Norman poems from the same MS., by Sir Francis Palgrave, in 1818, in a collection which is now extremely rare. It was also inserted in the second edition of Ritson's *Ancient Songs* (1829), where it is accompanied with a translation in English verse by George Ellis.

—— l. 8, *Tot à cheval*.—The Barons were surprised at Evesham before they were joined by their foot soldiers, and when therefore they were unprepared for this decisive conflict.

[P. 126](#), l. 4, *Sire Hue le fer, ly Despencer, tresnoble justice*.—Hugh Despencer, appointed justiciary of England by the Barons. He fell at Evesham.

—— l. 6, *Sire Henri ... fitz le cuens de Leycestre*.—The eldest son of Simon de Montfort; he fell in the battle.

—— l. 7, *par le cuens de Gloucestre*.—After the battle of Lewes, the Earl of Gloucester, becoming jealous of Simon de Montfort's popularity, deserted to the King, and fought against his former associates at Evesham.

—— l. 14, *une heyre*.—I suppose this refers to Guy de Montfort, Simon's second son, who was taken prisoner at Evesham, but afterwards escaped and fled to the Continent.

[P. 126](#), l. 15, *les faus ribaus*.—As this word, *ribaldus*, *ribaus*, *ribaud*, occurs frequently in our Songs, both in Latin, Anglo-Norman, and English, it may be worth while to say something about it.

It is one of those curious words of which the origin and primary signification are very doubtful. It was certainly applied to a particular class of people, and a class which seems to have been dependant on the household of the great. Giraldus Cambrensis, when telling his various troubles and persecutions (Wharton, *Anglia Sacra*, vol. iii. p. 575), speaks thus of the witnesses brought against him by his enemies:—"Archidiaconus (*i. e.* Giraldus himself) autem statim, productis testibus illis coram auditoribus ad jurandum, proposuit in singulorum personas se dicturum; in canonicos Menevenses tanquam perjuros et excommunicatos, in monachos tanquam trutannos et domorum suarum desertores, in *ribaldos* tanquam vilissimos et, sicut cæteri cuncti, mercede conductos." And again, on the next page, "Et testium multitudinem de garcionibus et *ribaldis* partis adversæ, qui omnes jurare parati fuerant et testificare ... trutannus ille vilissimus id totum faciebat; qui et *ribaldos* suos cunctos ad hoc probandum simul cum ipso mittebat.... Videns igitur archidiaconus *ribaldos* illos ad nutum *dominorum suorum* quidlibet probare paratos.... Sciens itaque si *probatio ribaldica* procederet ... *ribaldica multitudo*, etc." They seem to have been the lowest class of retainers, perhaps men without any certain appointment, who had no other mode of living than following the courts of the Barons, and who were employed on all kinds of disgraceful and wicked actions. One authority quoted by Ducange couples "parasitos atque *ribaldos*." A story quoted from a MS. at Berne, by Sinner (*Catalogus*, tom. i. p. 272), shows us that a *goliard* belonged to the class of *ribalds*: now a *goliard* seems to have been only another name for a *jongleur* (joculator), or one who attended the tables of the rich to amuse the guests by jokes, buffoonery, and mountebank tricks. An ecclesiastical statute quoted in Ducange (v. *Goliardus*) says, "item præcipimus quod clerici non sint *joculatores*, *goliardi*, seu *bufones*;" and another commands, "quod clerici *ribaldi*, maxime vero qui dicuntur *de familia goliæ*, per episcopos ... tondere præcipiantur." Matthew Paris, sub an. 1229, says, "quidam famuli, vel mancipia, vel illi quos solemus *goliardenses* appellare, versus ridiculos componebant." In this last passage we find them classed with the famuli, or household retainers. This class appears, at least in France, to have enjoyed certain popular rights or privileges. In a very curious charter of the year 1380, printed in Ducange, we find one Antony de Sagiac "*se gerens pro ribaldo*, et se dicens de ordine seu de statu *goliardorum*, seu *buffonum*," claiming a fine of five pence upon incontinent women, and accused of trying to extract money from a woman, whom he accused wrongfully, on this account, "*de talique et alio vili questu, quem sub umbra ribaldiæ, goliardiæ, seu buffoniæ ejusmodi ... vivebat*." In the household of the King of France there was a *rex ribaldorum*, whose office was to judge disputes, &c. which might occur among the retainers of his class, and who had also a jurisdiction over the public stews. As the lives of this class of men were set at a small value by their

masters, they were commonly exposed to the first brunt of battle in the wars, and the name is sometimes given to the body which is now called the *forlorn hope* in the attack of a town. The *ribaldi* who accompanied the army were also employed in plundering and destroying the country. As they were people of vile life and condition, the term *ribald* came gradually into use as a common appellation for a low and infamous person, and was used, as in the present instance, as an epithet of contempt and degradation.

[P. 128](#), l. 1, *pepulere*.—The MS. has *pepulare*.

[P. 130](#), l. 8, *Plebs devicta fremit*.—Alluding to the rising at Chesterfield, the occupation of the Isles of Axholme and Ely, and other insurrections.

— l. 11, *Urbs Londoniensis*.—The Earl of Gloucester, dissatisfied with the King's proceedings after the battle of Evesham, had taken up arms and established himself at London, the citizens of which joined his party readily, as they were themselves enraged against the King for having deprived them of their charter.

[P. 131](#), l. 2, *Francorum regis germanus rex Siculorum*.—Prince Edward left England in July, 1270, to join the King of France, Saint Louis, in his expedition to the Holy Land. Louis was persuaded by his brother, Charles, then King of Sicily, to turn aside, in order to make war on the Bey of Tunis, from whom he claimed a tribute. Louis died at Carthage of a disease produced by the climate; and when Prince Edward and his English army arrived, they found their ally dead, and the King of Sicily, who had made advantageous terms with the Bey, ready to return home. Charles, who hastened to take possession of the throne of France, refused to proceed in the crusade, and Edward, who was obliged to go alone, went over to Sicily, and wintered at Trapani. Here, on the night of December 23, the day after their arrival, occurred the terrible storm alluded to in the Poem. Early in the spring, Edward, with his small army, proceeded on their voyage, and landed at Acre.

[P. 132](#), l. 5, *Accon respirat*.—Acre was besieged by Bondocar, Sultan of Babylon, who was preparing to take the place by assault, at the moment when Edward arrived to raise the siege.

— l. 9, *Assessinus Veteris de Monte*.—On the Old Man of the Mountain, and the Assassins, or Assessins, much information will be found in a popular form, in the Marquis of Villeneuve-Trans, *Histoire de St. Louis*.

— l. 16.—This seems to be a new testimony against the truth of the story which makes Edward's Queen suck the poison from his wound. A song made on the occasion would hardly have failed to mention such a circumstance, if it had been known.

— l. 17, *Thomam de Wyta*.—This writer's name is not found in Tanner.

[P. 135](#), l. 13, *comencent*.—Probably an error of the scribe for *comencement*.

[P. 136](#), l. 4, *vironum*.—The MS. has *virronum*. *Viro* is given by Ducange as synonymous with *baro*, and is supposed to be derived from *vir*.

[P. 137](#), ll. 15, 16, *sonme ... prodhonme*.—In old manuscripts it is quite impossible to say whether the scribe meant *n* or *u*, unless we know otherwise which it ought to be, and the *n* in words of the form of those just quoted may perhaps be intended for *u*. But I am rather inclined to think such was not the case.

[P. 138](#), l. 34, *Sympringham*.—The order of Sempringham, commonly called Gilbertine canons, was founded by Sir Gilbert de Sempringham, in the first half of the twelfth century. One of its peculiarities was the establishment of monks and nuns in the same house, though their different habitations were carefully separated, and all intercourse between them strictly forbidden.

Nigellus Wireker speaks of this as a newly established order, and satirizes the near collocation of nuns and monks in a spirit similar to that of our song:—

Canonici missas tantum, reliquumque sorores
Explent; officii debita jura sui.
Corpora, non voces, murus disjungit, in unum
Psallant directe psalmitis absque metro.

And again, in describing his own order, he says, archly,—

Quid de Semplingama? quantum? vel qualia sumam?
Nescio, nam nova res me dubitare facit.
Hoc tamen ad præsens nulla ratione remittam,
Namque necem nimis fratribus esse reor;
Quod nunquam nisi clam, nullaque sciente sororum,
Cum quocunque suo fratre manere licet.

[P. 139](#), l. 61, *De Beverleye*.—The monks of Beverley were Franciscans.

[P. 140](#), l. 71, *De Hospitlers*.—The order of Knights Hospitalers, founded during the first crusades, was introduced into England about the year 1100. They were laymen, and, from an humble beginning, they became exceedingly rich and proud. In the Patent Rolls (45 Edw. III.) we find that the King “constituit Ricardum de Everton visitatorem Hospitalis S. Joannis Jerusalem in Anglia ad reprimendam religiosorum insolentiam, et ad observandam religiosorum honestatem.” See Ellis’s Dugdale, vol. vi. p. 786.

— l. 79, *De Chanoynes*.—The regular canons were a less strict order than the other monks in general, and followed the rule of St. Augustine. One of the rules of their order was expressed simply thus—“Carnem vestram domate jejuniis et abstinentia escæ quantum valetudo permittit.” They appear to have been particularly enjoined frequent abstinence from flesh. However, at the time when this song was written, they seem not to have observed their rule in this respect very strictly. Rutebeuf says of them (Jubinal’s Rutebeuf, vol. i. p. 239)—

En l’ordre des canoines qu’on dist Saint-Augustin,
Ils vivent à plenté, sans noise et sans hustin.
Je lo que leur soviègne au soir et au matin
Que la chars bien nourie porte à l’âme venin.

[P. 141](#), l. 95, *de Moyne Neirs*.—The Black Monks were the Benedictines.

[P. 142](#), l. 115, *Des Chanoygnes Seculers*.—The luxury of the secular canons is often alluded to by the early satirists. Nigellus Wireker says of them—

Illud præcipue tamen instituere, tenendum
Omnibus in tota posteritate sua,
Lex vetus ut suasit, ne quilibet absque sua sit,
Et quod quisque suas possit habere duas.
Hi sunt qui mundum cum flore cadente tenentes,
Ne sic marcescat, sæpe rigare student.
Hi sunt qui faciunt quidquid petulantia carnis
Imperat, ut vitiis sit via prona suis.

Rutebeuf (ed. Jubinal, vol. i. p. 239) says that there were many of them—

——qui ont grant signorie,
Qui poi font por amis et assés por amie.

[P. 143](#), l. 133, *Gris Moignes*.—Perhaps the Cistercians. In a poem on the Grey Monks, *De Grisis Monachis* (MS. Cotton. Vespas. A. XIX. fol. 56, r^o), which will be found among the works of Walter Mapes, they are ridiculed for the same arrangement of clothing,—

Carent femoralibus partes turpiores,
Veneris ut usibus sint paratiores,
Castitatis legibus absolutiores;
In cunctis hominibus nulli sunt pejores.

The *Albi Monachi* are similarly satirized by Nigellus Wireker for going without breeches. The Friars de Sacco wore no breeches under their robes.

[P. 144](#), l. 154, *l'Ordre de Cilence*.—Perhaps the Carthusian monks, a branch of the Benedictines, whose order, which was peculiarly strict, was introduced into England by Henry II. They were enjoined to live in separate cells, and to keep very strict silence, and have little communication with each other.

—— l. 169, *Les Frere Menours*.—The Friars Minors were better known as Franciscans, and in France as the Cordeliers. Their order enjoined, above all things, poverty and humility. They were not to ride when travelling, unless some manifest necessity or infirmity obliged them. See Dugdale, vi. 1505.

[P. 145](#), l. 188.—The MS. has *en autre*, which seems to be a mere error for *ne autre*.

[P. 146](#), l. 194, *des Prechours*.—The preaching friars were the Dominicans, called, in France, Jacobins. This order was introduced into England in 1221. Rutebeuf says that instead of adhering to their primitive humility and poverty, the Jacobins became the richest and most overbearing of all the orders. Jubinal, vol. i. pp. 152, 175-179.

[P. 148](#), l. 240, *devyns* seems to be a mere variation of *devys*, thus spelt in order to accommodate the rhyme.

[P. 149](#). SONG OF THE HUSBANDMAN.—This Song is in many parts extremely difficult to translate, from the numerous words in it which do not occur elsewhere, as well as from the abruptness of the phraseology. The same may be said of one or two other songs printed from the same manuscript.

[P. 154](#), l. 14, *halymotes*.—This word means literally *holy meetings*. It is translated *sabbath*, in the supposition that there is some allusion to the popular notion of the festive meetings of the devils and the witches.

[P. 160](#). SONG ON THE SCOTTISH WARS.—The copy of this Song preserved among the manuscripts of Clare Hall was first pointed out by Mr. Hunter, in the Appendix to the last Report of the Record Commission. I have obtained a copy of part of it by the kindness of Mr. Halliwell, who was unable from different circumstances to continue his transcript beyond the 72nd line. The Oxford MS. I only know through Mr. Halliwell's description of it: to judge by the articles contained in this MS., I should be inclined to think they were mostly copied from the Cottonian MS. Titus A. xx. In the Cottonian MS., Claudius D. vi. this poem bears the title "Commendatio Gentis Anglorum et processus guerræ inter Anglos et Scotos." In the Clare Hall MS. the Song is attributed to the "Prior de Blithe." The Prior of Blythe, in Nottinghamshire, at this time, was William Burdon. See Ellis's Dugdale, iv. 621. The MS. in the Sloane Library seems to be a transcript from a monastic register, perhaps of Alnwick, in Northumberland, for the reference in the margin is, "Regist. Prem. fol. 59, a." It is there attributed to the Prior of Alnwick. The original title seems to have been "Rithmus bonus de bello Scotiæ ad Dunbarre;" which the transcriber had first copied, and then, after erasing it, substituted the following, "Prioris Alnwicensis de Bello Scotico apud Dunbarr, tempore regis Edwardi I., dictamen sive rithmus Latinus; quo de Willielmo Wallace, Scotico illo Robin Whood, plura, sed invidiose, canit." Ritson, in his preface to Robin Hood, was misled by this latter title, and cites it as a proof that this hero was popular in the thirteenth century. In MS. Cotton. Titus A. xx. a hand of the sixteenth century ascribes this poem to Robert Baston.

It will already have been observed by the reader, that, in verse of this kind, the fourth line of each tetrastich is an hexameter (sometimes a pentameter), taken from some poet then popular, and often from a classic writer. In the MS. from which the Sloane transcript was made, the authorities for the hexameters, in the present Song, were indicated in the margin. They are as follows:—ll. 4, *Morus*.—8, *Cato*.—†8, *Cato*.—†12, *Poetria*.—†16, *Oracius*.—12, *Cato*.—16, *Doctrinale*.—20, *Doctrinale*.—24, *De proprio*.—28, *Doctrinale*.—32, *Cartul*.—36, *Urbanus*.—40, *Doctrinale*.—44, *Morus*.—48, *Theodorus*.—52, *De proprio*.—56, *Vulgat*.—60, *Pu...*.—64, *Vulgat*.—68, *Buliardus*.—72, *Oracius*.—76, *Oracius*.—80, *Oracius*.—84, *Cato*.—88, *Ovidius*.—92, *Doctrinale*.—96, *Cato*.—100, *Cato*.—104, *Ovidius*.—108, *Cato*.—112, *Cato*.—116, *Cato*. (?)—120, *Cato*.—124, *Cato*.—128, *Cato*.—132, *Doctrinale*.—136, *Cato*.—140, *Cato*.—144, *Poeta*.—148, *Poeta*.—152, *Orasius*.—156, *Virgilius*.—160, *Statius*.—†164, *Oratius*.—†168, *Teodorus*.—164, *Omerus*.—168, *Ovid*. *Omer*.—172, *Cartul*.—176, *Veritas evangelica*.—180, *De proprio*.—184, *Ovidius*.—188, *Vulgat*.—192, *Doctrinale*.—196, *Vulgat*.—200, *Doctrinale*.—204, *Idem*.—208, *Oracius*.—212, *De Vulg*.—216, *Doctrinale*.—220, *Amianus*.

In the above list of names, *Poetria* refers to the celebrated work of Galfridus de Vinesauf. *Poeta* seems to be a mere error of the scribe for *Poetria*. *Doctrinale* is here only another name for the *Parabolæ* of Alanus de Insulis. *Cato* refers to the well-known *Disticha*. *De proprio* means that the verse is of the author's own making.

[P. 164](#), l. 44, *Joannis*, John Baliol.—In the Cottonian MS. Claudius D. vi. the following lines are here inserted, which evidently do not belong to the poem:

“Exprobratio Scotorum.

Caude causantur, regnarunt, apocapantur;
Privantur caude, fas fandi, Scotia, plaude.

Responsio Anglorum.

Scotia scotabit strebæ, Scotus vix latitabit;
Anglia, jam pange, fas fandi, Scotia, plange.”

[P. 168](#), l. 102, *Johannem Warenniæ*.—This was the same John de Warenne, Earl of Surrey, who, staunch to the party of Henry III., had escaped from the battle of Lewes. He commanded the English army at the battle of Dunbar, was afterwards made Governor or Guardian of Scotland, and was again at the head of the English forces when they were defeated at Stirling.

[P. 169](#), l. 1, *Quod Trentam non transient*.—The King had carried with him to London the Scottish knights whom he most suspected, and, before he went to Flanders, he exacted from them solemn oaths that during his absence they would not repass the Trent without his permission.

[P. 170](#), l. 138, *ad Strivelyne*.—The battle of Stirling was fought on Thursday the 11th of September, 1297.

[P. 171](#), l. 141, *comes dux Anglorum*.—The Earl of Surrey (Warenne).

— l. 147, *Levenax et Ricardus Lundi*.—For an account of this reverse, and the part which the Earl of Levenax (Lennox) and Richard Lundi acted, see Knighton, in Twisden, coll. 2516, et seq.

[P. 172](#), l. 163.—This line is evidently corrupt; but, as it is only found in one MS., I have no means of correcting it.

[P. 173](#), l. 163, *Cremare Northumbriam*.—The invasion of Northumberland and the burning of Hexham and Corbridge are told by Matthew of Westminster, p. 427. See also Peter Langtoft, in the present volume, [p. 287](#); and Knighton, coll. 2520, et seq. None of them mention the damages done at Alnwick.

— l. 167, *Vesey, Morley, Somervile, Bertram*.—The poet seems to refer to members of those families who had distinguished themselves in opposing the inroads of the Scots at different periods, but who were dead at the time of this invasion.

[P. 174](#), l. 186, *Willelmo datum est militare pignus*.—On his return from the expedition into England, Wallace was solemnly installed Guardian of Scotland.

[P. 176](#), l. 205, *die Magdalenæ*.—The battle of Falkirk, so fatal to the Scots, was fought on St. Mary Magdalen's day, the 22nd of July, 1298.

— l. 211, *trutannus*.—This word is the origin of the modern word *truant*. Its primary meaning has not been accurately ascertained, but it seems to have been most generally used for a person who wandered about, and gained his living by false pretences, or passed himself under a different character to that which really belonged to him. It is applied sometimes to abbots or priors who lived

abroad and neglected their monasteries, or to monks who had quitted their houses, as in the passage of Giraldus, quoted at [p. 369](#).

[P. 178](#), l. 234, *Margaretam reginam*.—Edward married, in second nuptials, Margaret, sister of the King of France.

—— l. 243, *Comyn, Karryk, Umfraville*.—Three of the most active leaders of the Scots in their opposition to Edward. The Earl of Karrik was Robert Bruce. Gilbert de Umfraville, Earl of Angus, had been one of Edward's Commissioners for manning and fortifying the castles in Scotland.

[P. 183](#), l. 11, *collectio lanarum*.—The oppressive duty upon wool, which was the staple of English commerce at that period, was severely felt and complained of. In 1296, the King seized all the wool in the merchants' warehouses, and sold it for his own profit, paying for it, as usual, with tallies, and promises to repay them to the full. "Ministri regis omnes saccos lanæ, quinarium numerum excedentes, datis talliis, acceperunt ad opus regis, et ab unoquoque sacco, numerum quinarium non excedente, ab ipsis eorum dominis, nomine *malæ totæ*, xl. solidos extorserunt." Hemingford, p. 110.

[P. 186](#), l. 11, *de fust manger* (de fusto manducare).—In low Latin, *fustum* was a generic name for everything made of wood. It need hardly be said that it means here the plates and other utensils of the table, which among the lower classes were generally of this material. It would be more reasonable, says the writer of the song, if the court would eat out of wooden vessels, and pay for their provisions with silver, than to live sumptuously with plate, and only pay their victuals with wooden tallies.

—— l. 13, *Est vitii signum pro victu solvere lignum*.—The King's purveyors were a great grievance to the peasantry. In the curious poem of "King Edward and the Shepherd" (printed by Hartshorne from a MS. in the University Library, Cambridge), the latter personage is made to say:—

"In Wynsour was I borne;
Hit is a myle but here beforne,
The town then maist thou see.
I am so pyled with the Kyng,
That I most fle fro my wonyng,
And therefore woo is me.
I hade catell, now have I non;
Thay take my bestis, and don thaim slon,
And payen but *a stick of tre*."

And when the King, in disguise, promises to obtain redress, the Shepherd proceeds—

“Sir,” he seid, “be seynt Edmonde,
Ther is owand .iiii. pounde
And odd twa schillyng.
A stikke I have to my witnesse,
Off hasill I mene that hit is,
I ne have non other thyng.

* * * *

Thei do but gode, the kynges men,
Thei ar worse then sich ten
That bene with hym no dell.
Thei goo aboute be .viij. or nyne,
And done the husbondes mycull pyne,
That carfull is their mele.
Thei take geese, capons, and henne,
And alle that ever thei may with renne,
And reves us our catell.
Sum of them was bonde sore,
And afturwarde honget therfore,
For soth as I you say.
3et ar ther of them nyne moo;
For at my hows thei were also,
Certis, 3isturday.
Thei toke my hennes and my geese,
And my schepe with all the fleese,
And ladde them forth away.
Be my do3tur thei lay al ny3t.
To come agayne thei have me hy3t;
Of helpe I wolde yow pray.
With me thei lefte alle their thyng,
That I am sicur of their comyng,
And that me rewes sore.
I have fayre chamburs thre;
But non of them may be with me
While that thei be thore.
Into my cart-hows thei me dryfe;

Out at the dur thei put my wyfe,
For she is olde gray-hare.”

[P. 187](#). SONG ON THE FLEMISH INSURRECTION.—This Song was printed by Ritson, in his *Ancient Songs*.

[P. 188](#), l. 16, *Peter Conyng*.—Peter Coning (in English, Peter King,) was a weaver of Bruges. A brief account of this insurrection is given in Matthew of Westminster, p. 444. See, for a more complete narrative, Michelet's *Histoire de France*, vol. iii. p. 76.

[P. 189](#), l. 8, *avowerie*.—This is the low Latin *advocaria*. See Ducange, in voce.

—— l. 11, *hou*.—The MS. has *hout*.

[P. 189](#), l. 17, *to clynken huere basyns of bras*.—This circumstance occurred on the 21st March, 1302, at the beginning of the insurrection. In the towns of Flanders, as in the boroughs in England, the people were called up in an insurrection by the sound of the church bell. There was a famous distich on the bell of Roland, at Bruges—

Roelandt, Roelandt, als ick kleppe dan ist brandt,
Als ick luye, dan ist storm in Vlaenderlandt.

On the present occasion, the people dared not go to their bell, on account of their French governors, so they beat their brass basins:—*cumque ad campanam civitatis non auderent accedere, pelves suas pulsantes ... omnem multitudinem concitarent*. Meyer, *Annal.* in a. 1301, p. 90.

[P. 191](#), l. 9, *Conyng*.—This word, in English, meant a *rabbit*, and is here made the subject of a pun. In Flemish, it signified *king*.

[P. 193](#), ll. 17, 18, *Away thou zunge pope!... Thou hast lore thin cardinals*.—[P. 194](#), l. 2, *Do the forth to Rome*.—An allusion to the dissensions between the Pope and the family of the Colonnas. —“*Illis etiam diebus, dominus papa, fidei et orationum quæ erant beati Petri oblitus, assumens quæ non erant ejus, tam aurum videlicet a viduis et orphanis quam argentum, non viduis et orphanis, sed militibus bellicosis illud erogare curavit, contra schema quorundam cardinalium, eos denique degradando, et contra regem Siciliæ guerram movendo. Sed dicti regis exercitus de galeatis turmis domini papæ multa millia viriliter necaverunt.*” Matthew of Westminster, p. 432. This was the famous Pope Boniface VIII., who suffered so much from the persecutions of the King of France.

—— l. 7, *for lome*, probably means *foot-lame*, lame of foot. It occurs again in [p. 335](#) of the present volume.

[P. 195](#). A SONG ON THE TIMES.—The MS. from which this song is taken, MS. Harl. No. 913, was written in Ireland, about the year 1308, by an English monk. For a detailed description of it, see Mr. Crofton Croker's *Popular Songs of Ireland*.

[P. 196](#), l. 19, *hoblurs*.—The name *hoblurs* (*hobellarii*) was given properly to a kind of light-armed soldiers.

[P. 198](#), l. 14, *geet*.—This word should probably be translated *goats*, rather than *kids*.

[P. 199](#), l. 7, *anone*.—In the MS. this word is explained by the original scribe in the margin as “at one time.”

[P. 206](#). SONG AGAINST THE SCHOLASTIC STUDIES.—In the Cottonian MS. from which this song is taken, a hand of the 16th century has written in the margin that it was the work of Robert Baston.

The Oxford MS. was pointed out to me by Mr. Halliwell, but I have not been able to obtain a collation.

[P. 207](#), l. 2, *propere*.—The MS. has *pp̃e*, the meaning of which is not clear.

— l. 10, *Sicut servus Stichus*.—This name was given to a servant in the Roman comic writers. It is introduced here for the sake of rhyme.

[P. 208](#), l. 2, *nullus*.—The MS. has *unus*.

— l. 10, *Thebanas ... vel Trojanas cædes*.—Referring to the Thebaid of Statius, and the poem *De bello Trojano* of Joseph of Exeter, both of them at that period popular reading books.

— l. 16, *Telluris*.—The MS. has *Celurus*.

[P. 209](#), l. 4, *agro ... positus*.—The MS. has *ager* and *positus*.

[P. 212](#). SONG ON THE EXECUTION OF SIR SIMON FRASER.—This song was printed by Ritson, in his *Ancient Songs*.

[P. 213](#), l. 6, *The Waleis*.—Wallace was taken prisoner at the second battle of Dunbar, in 1305, and was executed at London on the Eve of St. Bartholomew, (Aug. 24) 1306. The places to which his quarters were sent were Newcastle, Berwick, Perth, and Aberdeen.

— l. 10, *Simond Frysel*.—This was the original form of the name of Fraser, and is the way in which it is spelt in all the English documents.

[P. 215](#), l. 14, *kyng of somere*.—Matthew of Westminster gives a popular story, that Bruce's queen had told him in derision, he was but a *summer king*, and that his kingdom would scarcely last in the winter. See Holinshed, p. 314.

[P. 215](#), l. 9, *Sire Edward of Carnarvon*.—The Prince of Wales.

[P. 216](#), l. 10, *Sir Emer de Valence*.—Aylmer de Valence, second Earl of Pembroke, a Baron who was frequently occupied in the Scottish wars, and who was appointed by Edward to be one of the guardians of his son, Edward II.

— l. 19, *the batayle of Kyrkenclyff*.—Fought, according to Holinshed, on the next Sunday after Midsummer day, 1306.

— l. 15, *Sire Thomas of Multone*.—Thomas de Multon, of Egremont, in Cumberland. He was active in the Scottish wars of this reign.

[P. 218](#), l. 17, *Sire Herbert of Morham*.—Apparently a mere error of the scribe for Norham. Matthew of Westminster relates the same anecdote.

[P. 219](#), l. 13, *oure Levedy even*.—The seventh of September, 1306.

— l. 16, *Sire Rauf of Sondwyche*.—Ralph de Sandwich was constable of the Tower of London (*constabularius turris London*).

[P. 221](#), l. 7, *a curtel of burel*.—*Burellus*, in low Latin, *bureau* or *burel* in old French, was a kind of coarse and common cloth.

[P. 222](#), l. 9, *tu-brugge*.—Perhaps this word means a drawbridge. It occurs again in Robert of Gloucester, p. 543:—

“And the castel brugge out of the med he barnde fram then ende
To the tu-brugge along, vor me ne ssolde out wende.”

Which means probably that he burnt all that part of the bridge on the meadow side up to the place where its communication with the rest was cut off by the raising of the drawbridge.

[P. 223](#), l. 6, *Erl of Asseles*.—John de Strathbogie, Earl of Athol. He also was captured and executed.

— l. 18, *Tprot, Scot, for thi strif!*—The word *tprot* appears to be a mere exclamation of contempt. In a poem on “The Propertees of the Shyres of Engeland,” printed by Hearne in the Introduction to the fifth volume of Leland’s *Itinerary*, we find it used, as here, against the Scots:—

“Northumbrelond hasty and hoot;
Westmerlond *tprut Scotte!*”

It will be found similarly used in a passage quoted in a note further on ([p. 391](#)). In Sir Thomas de la More’s *Chronicle*, it is applied to King Edward II.:—“*Tprut!* Sire King!” It seems to be taken from the French: in Jean Bodel’s *Jeu de S. Nicolas* (*Théâtre Français au Moyen-Age*, edited by MM. Monmerqué and Michel) it is put in the mouths of the common gamblers in a public-house:—

“*Tproupt! tproupt!* bevons hardiement;
Ne faisons si le coc emplat.”—(p. 183.)

And again, immediately after (p. 184):—

“*Tproupt! tproupt!* où que soit passé, Diex!”

[P. 223](#), l. 21, *with the longe shonkes*.—King Edward, still known popularly as Edward Longshanks.

[P. 224](#). SONG ON THE VENALITY OF THE JUDGES.—After this song was printed, I found another copy of it in MS. Reg. 12, c. XII. fol. 1, v^o. of reign of Edw. II., written likewise as prose, which presents the following variations:—*P. 224*, ll. 1, 2, *esuriunt | Et faciunt justitiam | et od.*—7, *exhennia*.—9, this line is omitted, and the following begins *Sed quæ*.—11, *et aure non*.—13, *Sed modo miro more*.—15, *ad peric.*—17, *ambient*.—[P. 225](#), l. 1, *hæc*.—7, *nam* is omitted.—8, *Qui sensum*.—9, *ei pure*.—14, *Quid ergo Jhesu bone*.—[P. 226](#), l. 1, *accedit*.—2, *secretius*.—7, *potest*.—ll. 12-18 are placed after l. 10 in the next page.—14, *dona*.—15, *et hoc pro l.*—17, *quamvis prius*.—19, *Si quædam pulcra nobilis | decora vel am*.—[P. 227](#), l. 2, *hoc*.—12, *ut exprimant*.—13, *vocantur*.—14, *priores*.—18, *Sed quid*.—[P. 228](#), l. 1, *quid laboras*.—2, *quid facis*.—8, *ibis Omere, foras*.—9, *De vincitibus*.—11, *enumerare*.—19, *Est salsum totum*. This MS. ends with this verse.

— *l. 7, encennia.*—This word answers as nearly as may be to the modern word *jewels*. The other MS., of which the variations are given above, reads *exennia*, i. e. *treasures*.

P. 225, l. 17, cedunt.—In the MS. the scribe has written over this word “i. re,” that is, “i. e. recedunt.”

P. 226, l. 21, cum capite cornuto.—The head dress of the ladies of rank and fashion at this period was arranged in the form of two horns.

P. 227, l. 13, relatores, “qui querelam ad iudices referunt.” Ducange.

P. 229, l. 13, transmittantur.—The MS. has *transmutantur*.

P. 229, l. 18, averia.—The term *averium* is commonly used to signify all kinds of moveable property; but more particularly to signify cattle and horses.

P. 230, l. 1, clericos.—The scribe has written above this word, in the MS. “i. pauperes.”

P. 231. THE OUTLAW’S SONG OF TRAILEBASTON.—This song also was printed by Sir Francis Palgrave in the collection mentioned in a former note. The notion that the judges were called Trailebastons on account of the hastiness of their proceedings, is quite incorrect. The term was applied not to the judges, but to the persons judged, who received this name because they carried with them long staffs. An account of the origin of the Trailebastons will be found in the extract of Peter Langtoft, at *p. 318* of the present volume. The proceedings against them led to many abuses, and were often made the means of gratifying personal revenge. The statute against the Trailebastons was continued in force through the reigns of Edward II. and Edward III.

P. 232, l. 1, souz.—In old French and Anglo-Norman, the word *sous* was not used in its present sense, but represented the Latin *solidos*.

— *l. 7, le bois de Belregard.*—Perhaps a fictitious name, invented by the poet.

P. 233, l. 3, ly Martyn ... ly Knoville.—*l. 5, Spigurnel ... Belflour.*—By the following commission, given in Rymer, we find that these Barons were the commissioners appointed to judge the Trailebastons in the western counties of England. There can be little doubt that *Belflour* in the song is meant for the name which in the commission is *Bellafagus*. This document is curious, both for the light it throws on the subject, and for the circumstance that it fixes the period at which the song was written; it bears date at Westminster, April 6, 1305.

“*De transgressionibus nominatis Trailbaston audiendis et terminandis per totum regnum.*—Rex delectis et fidelibus suis, Wilielmo Martyn, Henrico Spigurnell, Wilielmo de Knovill, Rogero de Bellafago, et Thomæ de la Hyde, salutem.—Quia quamplures malefactores, et pacis nostræ perturbatores, homicidia, deprædationes, incendia, et alia dampna quamplurima nocte dieque perpetrantes, vagantur et discurrunt in boscis, in parvis, et aliis locis diversis, tam infra libertates quam extra, in comitatibus Cornubiæ, Devonæ, Sumersetiæ, Dorsetiæ, Herefordiæ, Wygorniæ, Salopiæ, Staffordiæ, Wiltes’, et Suthamptoniæ, et ibidem receptantur, in maximum periculum tam hominum per partes illas transeuntium, quam ibidem morantium, et nostri contemptum, ac pacis nostræ læsionem manifestam, ut accepimus: Per quorum incursus poterunt pejora prioribus de facili evenire, nisi remedium super hoc citius apponatur: Nos, eorum malitiæ in hac parte obviare, et hujusmodi dampnis et periculis præcavere volentes, assignavimus vos justiciarios nostros: Ad inquirendum, per sacramentum tam militum quam aliorum proborum et legalium hominum de comitatibus prædictis, tam infra libertates quam extra, per quos rei veritas melius sciri poterit, qui sunt illi malefactores, et eorum scienter receptatores, et eis consentientes, vim et auxilium præbentes, seu dictas transgressiones fieri procurantes et præcipientes: Et etiam ad inquirendum de illis, qui pro

muneribus suis pactum fecerunt et faciunt cum malefactoribus, et pacis nostræ perturbatoribus, et eos conduxerunt et conducunt ad verberandum, vulnerandum, male tractantandum et interficiendum plures de regno nostro, in feriis, mercatis, et aliis locis, in dictis comitatibus, pro inimicitia, invidia, malitia, et etiam pro eo quod in assisis, juratis, recognitionibus, et inquisitionibus factis de feloniis, positi fuerunt, et veritatem dixerunt: unde per conductionem hujusmodi malefactorum, juratores assisarum, juratorum recognitionum, et inquisitionum illarum, præ timore dictorum malefactorum et horum minarum, sæpius veritatem dicere seu dictos malefactores indictare minime ausi fuerunt, et sunt: Et etiam ad inquirendum de illis qui hujusmodi munera dederunt et dant: et quantum et quibus: et qui hujusmodi munera receperunt et recipiunt: et a quibus, et qualiter, et quo modo: et qui hujusmodi malefactores in sua malitia foveant, nutriunt, et manutinent in comitatibus prædictis: Et etiam de illis, qui, ratione potestatis et domini sui, aliquos in eorum protectionem et advocacionem pro suo dando susceperunt, et adhuc suscipiunt: Et de illis qui pecuniam ab aliquo, per graves minas ei factas, malitiose extorserunt: Et ad felonias et transgressionem illas audiendas et terminandas secundum legem et consuetudinem regni nostri, et juxta formam ordinationis per nos et consilium nostrum super hoc factæ, et vobis in parlamento nostro liberatæ: Et etiam ad omnes felonias et transgressionem, de quibus inquisitiones coram dilectis et fidelibus nostris, Henrico de Cobeham, Thoma Paynel, Hugone de Sancto Philiberto, et Johanne Randolf, in prædictis comitatibus Wiltes' et Suthamtoniæ factæ sunt, et per vos, si necesse fuerit, faciendæ, audiendas et terminandas in forma prædicta:" etc.

[P. 235](#), l. 6, *escolage*, answers probably to a low Latin word *excollectionem*.

[P. 237](#). A SONG AGAINST THE RETINUES OF THE GREAT PEOPLE.—Half of this song is written in the original in short lines, and the other half in long lines, to suit the convenience of the MS. It contains numerous popular words and phrases, the meaning of which it is now very difficult to ascertain.

[P. 242](#), l. 9, *Le rei de Fraunce*.—Edward seems to have long cherished the design of embarking in a new crusade, which had been strongly advocated by the Pope, but he had been hindered by his continued wars and embarrassments, which the writer of the song attributes to the intrigues of the King of France.

[P. 243](#), l. 13, *A Peiters à l'Apostole*.—Pope Clement the Fifth, who was constantly in hostilities with his Italian subjects, and little more than a dependent on France, resided a great part of his pontificate at Poitiers.

[P. 245](#), ll. 5, 6, *Si Aristotle ... e Virgile*.—Aristotle and Virgil were names in great repute in the popular literature of the middle ages, and were the subject of much legend and romance.

[P. 246](#). ELEGY ON THE DEATH OF EDWARD I.—This song had been already printed in Percy's *Reliques of Ancient English Poetry*.

[P. 253](#). ON THE KING'S BREAKING HIS CONFIRMATION OF MAGNA CHARTA.—This curious poem is reprinted from an interesting little volume of early poetry, edited and printed privately by David Laing, Esq. and W. B. D. D. Turnbull, Esq. under the title of "*Owain Miles, and other Inedited Fragments of Ancient English Poetry*." 8vo. Edinburgh, 1837.

— l. 7, *the feire*.—Probably the fair of St. Bartholomew.

[P. 254](#), l. 5, *Of .iiij. wise-men*.—This was a very popular story, and found its way into the celebrated *Gesta Romanorum*. It also occurs frequently in a separate and different form in manuscripts of the fourteenth and fifteenth centuries. The sentences of the wise men were popular sayings independent of the tale, and are sometimes found separately. They varied at different periods, both as they are found separately, and as they are given in the different recensions of the story. It

would be a curious and interesting work to collect together such popular political proverbs in chronological order. I have met with this story in a MS. in the British Museum contemporary with the present song, in which, if I remember right, both the sayings and the explanations of them are given in full both in English and Latin, but I have unfortunately mislaid my reference to it. The following is taken from MS. Reg. 5 A. vi. fol. 83 r^o, of the end of the 14th or beginning of the 15th cent. A more modern copy, with rather larger commentary, will be found in MS. Harl. No. 206, fol. 38, v^o.

“Legitur quendam Regem quondam fuisse qui habuit 4^{or} Philosophos in regno suo. In quo regno multæ plagæ, multa infortunia, et multi defectus fiebant in populis. Rex autem videns se ipsum nullo peccato mortali vulneratum, mirabatur valde, et diligenter inquirebat a prædictis 4^{or} Philosophis qua de causa hæc infortunia magis agebantur in populis in tempore suo quam in tempore prædecessorum suorum.

“Primus Philosophus dixit, *Mizt is rizt*; Unde illud Ysaïæ, 69, Conversum est retrorsum iudicium, et justitia longe stetit; corruit in platea veritas, et æquitas non potuit ingredi. *Lizt is nyzt*; unde Ewang., Væ homini illi per quem scandalum venit! Per eum scandalum venit qui alios malo exemplo corrumpit. Dominus in Levetico dixit: Time, inquit, Dominum Deum tuum, ut vivere possit frater tuus apud te; hoc est, ut sic vivas quod frater tuus per tuum exemplum vitam possit habere non mortem. *Fizt is flizt*; unde Augustinus: Bene agere et illicita non prohibere consensus erroris est. Gregorius: Facientis proculdubio culpam habet qui quod potest corrigere negligit emendare.

“Secundus Philosophus dixit, *One is too*; unde Ewang.: Omne regnum in se divisum desolabitur. Ambrosius: Sicut sine via nullus pervenit quo tendit, sic sine caritate, quæ dicta est via, non ambulare possunt homines, sed errare. *Frend is foo*; hoc potest intelligi quando homines et præcipue potentes veram pacem vel justitiam aut Dei ecclesiam strangulant, quibus principaliter propter Deum militare deberent. *Weele is woo*; Gregorius: Qui bona mundi diligit, velit nolit timori et dolori bene succumbit. Seneca: Avarus nisi dum moritur nichil bene facit.

“Tertius Philosophus dixit, *Lust has leve*; unde Paulus: Si secundum carnem vixeritis, moriemini. Jeronimus: Qui post carnem ambulant, in ventrem et libidinem proni, quasi irrationalia jumenta reputantur. *Thef is refe*; unde Jeremias: Væ qui ædificant domum suam non in justitia! Robertus Lincolniensis: Væ illis qui dicunt, faciamus mala, ut veniant bona, quorum damnatio justa est! *Pride has slef*; unde in Ps.: Irritaverunt eum in adinventionibus suis, et multiplicata est in eis ruina. David autem dixit: Non habitabit in medio domus meæ qui facit superbiam.

“Quartus Philosophus dixit, *Wille is red*; unde per Psalmistam dicitur: Noluit intelligere ut bene ageret. Prover. 12: Via stulti recta in oculis ejus; qui autem sapiens est audit consilium. *Wytte is qued*; unde P.: Erit enim tempus cum sanam doctrinam non sustinebunt. Augus.: Juventuti malorum hominum venenum est quidquid virtus præcipit, esca vero quidquid diabolus suggerit. *Good is ded*; unde in psalmo: Universa vanitas omnis homo vivens, i. vivens secundum hominem, non secundum Deum. Augus.: Sicut mors corporalis separat animum a corpore, ita peccatum mortale animam a vera vita, quæ est Deus.”

In the following, which is taken from the common printed Gesta Romanorum, cap. 144, the English is translated.

“Fertur de quodam Rege cujus regnum in tam subitam devenit mutationem, quod bonum in malum, verum in falsum, forte in debile, justum in injustum est mutatum. Quam mutationem Rex admirans, a quattuor Philosophis sapientissimis causam hujus quæsivit; qui, inquam, Philosophi post sanam deliberationem ad quattuor portas civitates pergentes quilibet eorum tres causas ibi scripsit. Primus scripsit, Potentia est justitia, ideo terra sine lege; dies est nox, ideo terra sine via; fuga est in

pugna, ideo regnum sine honore. Secundus scripsit, Unum est duo, ideo regnum sine veritate; amicus est inimicus, ideo regnum sine fidelitate; malum est bonum, ideo terra sine pietate. Tertius scripsit, Ratio habet licentiam, ideo regnum sine nomine; fur est præpositus, ideo regnum sine pecunia; corabola vult esse aquila, ideo nulla discretio in patria. Quartus scripsit, Voluntas est consiliarius, ideo terra male disponitur; denarius dat sententiam, ideo terra male regitur; Deus est mortuus, ideo totum regnum peccatoribus est repletum.”

In the moralisation, these sentences are applied to the time in which it was written. In the English *Gesta Romanorum* (edited by Sir Frederick Madden for the Roxburghe Club in 1838, and which it is to be regretted is not published in a popular form), p. 397, we have the following version of the story.

“This is redde in the Cronycles of Rome, that in the tyme of Antynyane the Emperour, in the citie of Rome befille a grete pestilence of men and bestes, and grete hungre in alle the empire. The comons risene agayne her lordes, and agayne her Emperour. The Emperour desirede to wete the cause of the tribulacions and diseases, and disposede hym for to putte a remedie agayne the foresaide disease. He callede to hym .iiij. wise Philisophers, for to shew hym the cause of the grete vengeaunce; of the whiche Philisophers the first saide thus, ‘Gifte is domesman, and Gile is chapman; the grete holde no lawe, and servauntes have none awe.’ The seconde saide, ‘Witte is turnede to trechery, and love into lechery; the holy day into glotonye, and gentrie into vilanie.’ The thirde saide, ‘Wise men are but scornede, and wedowes be sore yernede; grete men are but glosede, and smale men borne downe and myslovede.’ The fourthe saide, ‘Lordes wexen blynde, and kynnesmen ben unkynde; dethe out of mynde, and trewthe may no man fynde.’”

The sentences in this last version are also found frequently in MSS. in a separate form. An imperfect copy of them will be found in the *Reliquiæ Antiquæ*, (Pickering, 1839,) p. 58. I have met recently with a much more complete copy, agreeing closely with the sentences in the above tale from the English *Gesta*, but I have also unfortunately lost the reference to it, and cannot recall it to mind at the present moment. In MS. Cotton. Vespas. E. xii. fol. 100, r^o., of the end of the fourteenth century, is given another Latin version of this story, where the scene is laid at Carthage, the King is Hannibal, and instead of the four wise men we have Virgil, and the sayings are again different from the others. This version is important both for the history of the story, and for its connexion with the fable of the legendary Virgilius.

[P. 256](#), l. 9, *god is ded*.—It will have been observed in the foregoing note that one of the versions of the story interprets *god* by *Deus*;—God is dead,—which is most probably right, and the former editors have very properly given the word with a capital.

[P. 258](#). SONGS ON THE DEATH OF PETER DE GAVESTON.—Both these songs are parodies upon hymns in the Romish ritual.

[P. 260](#), l. 1, *Vult hic comes, et non Petrus, dici*.—The favourite was, indeed, extremely angry because people persisted in calling him Peter, and obtained a Royal decree that no one should be permitted to call him otherwise than Earl of Cornwall in future.

[P. 262](#). THE BATTLE OF BANNOCKBURN.—The text of this poem is extremely corrupt. It appears, from Mr. Halliwell’s description of the MS., that there is another copy of it at Oxford, MS. Rawl. B. 214. This poem is attributed to Robert Baston, a carmelite, who, according to a popular story, was present at the battle, and was taken prisoner by the Scots. We are told that he was liberated on condition of composing a poem to celebrate the valour of the Scots: the song here printed is of quite a different character.

[P. 262](#), l. 6, *dabantur*.—*Debantur* in the MS.

—— l. 10, *præparare*.—The MS. has *portare*, with “p’p’are” written above.

[P. 263](#), l. 9, *conflictus*.—The MS. had *consultus*, which is changed into *conflictus*.

—— l. 10, *Comes heu! Gloverniæ*.—Gilbert de Clare, son of that Earl of Gloucester who was so active in the Barons’ wars of the reign of Henry III. On his death, at Bannockburn, the title became extinct.

—— l. 17, *proditorius vir Bartholomeus*.—Perhaps Bartholomew de Badlesmere, who was Steward of the King’s household, and attended the King in these wars.

[P. 264](#), l. 2, *sex seminum*.—This word evidently represents the French *semaines*.

[P. 265](#), l. 2, *nimis*.—The MS. has *nims*.

—— l. 4, *veneficos*.—The MS. has *venifices*.

—— l. 9, *multiplia*.—In middle-age Latin, the form *multiplicus* is frequently used for *multiplex*.

—— l. 14, *corruerunt*.—The scribe has written *sub* over the first syllable of this word in the MS., as though he would correct it to *subruerunt*.

[P. 266](#), l. 16, *horridus*.—The MS. has *oridus*, and just afterwards it seems to have *quievit* for *crevit*.

[P. 267](#), l. 4, *stirps radice*.—The MS. has *radix*, with *ortus* written over it; from which it may be conjectured that the original from which the scribe copied had the reading which I have given, and that the word *ortus* was written over it, or in the margin, to supply the construction—*stirps ortus radice Jessæ*.

—— l. 12, *far....*.—The MS. has *far?*.

[P. 268](#). THE OFFICE OF ST. THOMAS OF LANCASTER.—Popular heroes and patriots were frequently canonised by the people after their death. Such was the case with Simon de Montfort. See [p. 124](#) of the present volume. A very curious story of this kind will be found in William of Newbury, l. 5, cc. 20, 21. The King, in the present instance, was obliged to issue a proclamation forbidding the worship of Earl Thomas of Lancaster.

[P. 268](#), l. 2, *Thomam Cantuariæ*.—All the popular heroes were compared to St. Thomas of Canterbury. We have seen the comparison used in the case of Simon de Montfort, see [p. 125](#) of the present volume.

[P. 270](#), l. 11, *pater proles erat regia*.—Thomas Plantagenet, Earl of Lancaster, was son of Edmund, younger brother of Edward I.

—— l. 12, *matrem ... reginam Navarria*.—Blanche, daughter of Robert, Earl of Artois, and widow of Henry, King of Navarre, who was espoused in second marriage to Edmund Plantagenet.

—— l. 16, *Benedicti capitur vigilia....*, l. 17, *die tertia*.—After the battle of Boroughbridge (March 15, 1322), the Earl of Lancaster took refuge in a chapel, where he was taken on the 20th, brought to Pontefract on the 21st, tried on the 22nd, and beheaded the same day. The 20th of March was the eve of St. Benet.

[P. 271](#), l. 2, *Hoylandiæ*.—Robert de Hoyland (the father of Thomas de Holand, Earl of Kent, the first husband of Joan, Princess of Wales,) had been sent to collect forces in Lancashire, to assist the Earl of Lancaster, but when he had gotten them together, he deserted the Earl, and went over with them to the King’s party.

— *sudam* appears to be an error for some other word.

[P. 273](#). PETER LANGTOFT'S CHRONICLE.—The Cambridge MS. contains only the history of Edward I., which is given as a complete work, with the title, “Ici commence le Brut coment li bon rei Edward gaigna Escotz e Galis.” The Fairfax MS. seems also to have given the same portion of Langtoft's Chronicle. Since my text was printed, Sir Frederick Madden has kindly given me his transcripts of the English fragments as they stand in the Fairfax MS. No. 24, in the Bodleian Library, at Oxford, and in the Arundel MS. No. 14, in the College of Arms. The numerous variations in these lines, and the frequent recurrence of lines in one MS. which are omitted in another, seem clearly to prove they were fragments of popular songs interwoven into the Chronicle by its writer. I ought to say that, at the time the extracts in the present volume were printed off, it was not in my power to have the sheets collated with the original. It may also be observed, that it has not been thought proper to correct the text by the various readings, but the translation is frequently made from the latter, when the text is evidently wrong.

[P. 274](#), l. 15, *Celestine la pape*.—Pope Celestin the Fifth, who was elected in July, 1294, and abdicated in the December following.

[P. 275](#), l. 50, *suz Dover*.—An account of this attack upon Dover will be found in Matthew of Westminster, p. 424, and in Knighton, col. 2502.

[P. 278](#), l. 75, *Thomas de Turbeville*.—See, on this affair, Matthew of Westminster, p. 425, Knighton, col. 2502, Hemingford, p. 58.

— l. 83, *Cent lievre de tere*.—Robert de Brunne's version has a hundred pounds of land, i. e. lands of that yearly value.

[P. 280](#), l. 106, *Le tierz jour*.—Robert de Brunne says—

Opon the thrid day, at a toun hamelet,
Thomas was his pray, as he to mete was set.

— l. 112, *cum traitur est jugé*.—Robert of Brunne has given more details of Turbeville's trial than are found in the original.

[P. 282](#), l. 135, *Le counte de Nincole*.—Henry de Lacy, Earl of Lincoln and Salisbury.

— l. 136, *Sir Willeam de Vescy*.—William de Vescy, Lord of Alnwick, and governor of Scarborough Castle.

— l. 153, *la male rage*.—“*Male rage*: Faim extraordinaire, enragée; *mala rabies*.” Roquefort.

— l. 156, *rivelins*.—Apparently a kind of rough boots worn by the Scots, so called perhaps on account of their ragged and torn appearance.

— *la nue nage*.—*Nage* is the Latin *nates*. The Fairfax and Arundel MS. have here a line or two of the French which is not found in the other copies, with the following fragments of English—

(F.) Tprut! Skot riving,
In unseli timing
crope thu out of cage.

(A.) Tprut! Scot riving,
With mikel mistiming
crop thu ut of kage.

—— *l. 157, Robert de Ros de Werke.*—Robert de Ros was an English Baron, but, falling in love with a Scottish lady, he deserted to the Scots, for which his possessions were confiscated. See Hemingford, p. 85.

[P. 284](#), *l. 168, quatre mile.*—The English version makes it *forty thousand*—

In the non tyme felle this cas, that slayn was ilk a man,
That were in Berwik, fourti thousand and mo.

—— *l. 170, Richard de Cornewalle.*—Holinshed, p. 298, says Sir Richard Cornwall was brother to the Earl of Cornwall. See also Hemingford, p. 91.

—— *l. 171, la sale rouge.*—The Red Hall was the factory of the Flemish merchants, who carried on an extensive trade with Berwick.

[P. 285](#), *l. 175, Willeam de Douglass.*—William Douglas was captain of the garrison of Berwick. See Hemingford, *ib.*

—— *l. 176, Ricard Fresel.*—The English has *Symoun Freselle*.

—— *l. 178, li quens de la Merche, Patrik.*—Patrick, Earl of Dunbar and March, served in the English army; but his Countess, who was left in the castle of Dunbar, and who hated the English, delivered the castle to the Scots.

—— *l. 180, Gilbert de Umfravile.*—Gilbert de Umfraville, Earl of Angus, was one of the Scottish Barons who remained faithful to the English.

[P. 286](#), *l. 194, Piket him, etc.*—The Fairfax MS. has only four lines of this song:—

Piket him and diket him,
in skorn seiden he;
Nu piketh he it and diketh it,
his owen for to be.

In the Arundel MS. it stands thus:—

Pikit him and dikit him,
in hoker seiden he;
Nu pikes he it and dikes it,
his owen for to be.
Skiterende Scottes
Hodere in their hottes,
nevere thei ne the;
Rigth if I rede,
Thei tumbled in Twede,
that woned bi the se.

Robert of Brunne gives the fragment as follows, with six additional lines:—

Now dos Edward dike Berwik brode and long,
Als they bad him pike, and scorned him in ther song.

Pikit him and dikit him
on scorne said he,
He pikes and dikes
in length as him likes
how best it may be.
And thou has for thi pikyng
Mykille ille likyng,
the sothe is to se.
Without any lesyng
Alle is thi hething
fallen opon the,
For scatred er thi Scottis,
And hodred in ther hottes,
never thei ne the.
Right als I rede,
Thei tombled in Tuede,
that woned bi the se.

[P. 288](#), l. 227, *Otes de Graunt-souns*.—Otho had been sent into the East to the aid of the Christians by Edward I., who intended to follow him in person. An account of the loss of Acre, and the escape of the Christians to Cyprus, will be found in Hemingford, pp. 21-28.

[P. 289](#), l. 245, *le counte de Warwik e Huge le Despencer*.—Guy de Beauchamp, Earl of Warwick, and Hugh Despencer, who was afterwards so famous as the favourite of Edward II.

[P. 293](#), l. 299, *On grene*, &c.—In Robert of Brunne, these lines stand thus:—

Ther on that grene,
That kynrede kene
gadred als the gayte.
Right als I wene,
On som was it sene
ther the bit bayte.

[P. 294](#), l. 324, *sire Corynée*.—The fabulous hero who was said to have killed the giant Gogmagog.

[P. 295](#), l. 338, *The fote folke*, etc.—Robert of Brunne gives these lines as follows, with an introduction of his own, in which he says distinctly that they were rhymes which the English made on the Scots:—

¶ The Scottis had no grace,
To spede in ther space,
 for to mend ther misse,
Thei filed ther face,
That died in that place;
 the Inglis rymed this.
Oure fote folk
Put tham in the polk,
 and nakned ther nages,
Bi no way
Herd I never say
 of prester pages,
Purses to pike,
Robis to rike,
 and in dike tham schonne,
Thou wiffin
Scotte of Abrethin,
 kotte is thi honne.

In the Fairfax MS. they stand thus:—

Wel worthe swich a fot folk,
That drof the Skottes in the polk,
 and paiede hem here wages.
Bi wode ne bi weye,
Ne herd I nevere seien
 of prestere pages,
To pullen and to piken
The robes of the rike
 that in the feld fellen.
Fi! Skot, hu spedde ye thenne?
The devel I you bikenne,
 that ragged rit in helle!

The Arundel MS. gives them thus:—

Wel worth swich a fote folk,
That put the Scottes in the polk,
 and paied tham their wages.
Bi wode ne bi weie,
Herd I nevere seie
 of prestere pages,
To pulle and to pike
The robes of the rike
 that in the feld felle.
Hou ferd the wreches thenne?
The devel I them bikenne
 that ragged sit in helle.

In my transcript of the Cambridge MS. I had written *wages* in the third line, but, thinking it might be an error of my own, I ventured to change it to *nages*, in conformity with the readings of the other MSS. I have no doubt that *nages*, the French *nages* (see before, [p. 283](#), l. 156, and the note), the Latin *nates*, is the right word. The other reading of the line was perhaps substituted by some one who did not understand the word.

[P. 298](#), l. 380, *For Scottes, etc.*—Robert of Brunne agrees with the present text, in this song. In the Fairfax and Arundel MSS. it stands thus:—

(F.) For skiterande Skottes
Tell I for sottes,
 of wrenches unwarre.
Hem to wrothere hele
Dintes to dele
 driven to Dunbarre.

(A.) Skiterende Scottes
I telle for sottes,
 and wreches unwar.
Mikel unsele
Dintes to dele
 them drof to Dunbar.

[P. 300](#), l. 417, *Albanak*, the son of Brute, who was said to have first peopled Scotland, and given it the name of Albania.

[P. 303](#), l. 466, *For boule, etc.*—Robert of Brunne, like the Museum MSS., gives only the first six lines of this fragment.

—— l. 471, *hise tabard es tome.*—*Toom tabard* (empty tabard) was a nickname given by the Scots to their King, John Baliol, on account of his little wit. In like manner, we still vulgarly call people who possess very little sense, *empty bottles*.

[P. 304](#), l. 484, *eces*; another form of *assez*.

—— l. 486, *Henri de Perci aid Galwei.*—Henry de Percy, nephew of Warenne, was made keeper of the county of Galloway and the sheriffdom of Ayr.

[P. 305](#), l. 504, *le eveske de Duram.*—The famous Anthony Beck, Bishop of Durham, who, at the head of his knights, attended Edward in all his invasions of Scotland, and commanded one division of the army at the battle of Falkirk.

—— l. 514, *Kambynoy.*—Robert of Brunne translates this passage as follows:—

Cambinhoy
Beres him coy,
that fendes whelp,
Ther with craft
He has tham raft,
it may not help.
The Trulle the
Drenge on se,
thei lenge the fendes tueye,
The hold tham fer,
And dar no ner
than Orkeneye.
Andrew is wroth,
The wax him loth,
for ther pride.
He is tham fro,
Now salle thei go,
schame to betide.
Thou scabbed Scotte,
Thi neck, thi hotte,
the develle it breke,
It salle be hard
To here Edward
ageyn the speke.
He salle the ken
Our lond to bren,
and werre begynne
Thou getes no thing,
Bot thi rivelyng
to hang therinne.
The sete of the Scone
Is driven over done,
to London led;
I hard wele telle,
That bagelle and belle

be filchid and fled.

[P. 306](#), l. 521, *Ou il est mort | al mouster*.—The Monastery of Hexham, which the Scots had burnt, was dedicated to their patron Saint, St. Andrew. Hemingford remarks, in a similar manner, the impiety of the Scots in burning the church of their patron. This writer, in many parts of his Chronicle, seems to paraphrase and enlarge upon the narrative of Peter Langtoft.

[P. 307](#), l. 550, *Deus! cum Merlins*.—The Cambridge MS. has *Teus*, with a great T., by an error of the illuminator. Robert of Brunne, in translating this part of the Chronicle, quotes the original author, Peter Langtoft, as his authority:—

Nou tels Pers, on his maners, a grete selcouth,
He takis witnes, that it soth es, of Merlyn mouth, etc.

The MS. from which Hearne printed contained a marginal note, “De unione Scotiæ et Angliæ secundum dicta Petri et Bridlington,” meaning that Bridlington had something similar in his prophecies. Hearne, not aware that it is Peter Langtoft to whom the writer refers, alters it to Petri de Bridlington; although, if he had referred to Bale, he would have found that Bridlington’s name was John, and not Peter.

[P. 309](#), l. 582, *Jon e Thomas ... Cuthbert*.—John of Beverley, Thomas of Canterbury, and Cuthbert of Durham. These three saints are elsewhere spoken of in Peter Langtoft as Edward’s especial patrons and aiders.

[P. 310](#), l. 607, *Des biens de seint eglise*.—See, on this transaction, Matthew of Westminster, p. 428, and Hemingford, p. 107.

[P. 311](#). I suspect that the lines here inclosed in brackets, as not found in the Cambridge MS., were missed by myself in transcribing.

—— l. 613, *disime dener*.—Robert of Brunne says the twelfth penny.

[P. 315](#), l. 683, *jeo crei*.—The manner in which the writer here speaks, as well as other expressions in the course of the poem, seem to show that he wrote down the events as they happened.

[P. 316](#), l. 701, *le Sire de Canturbir*.—Robert Winchelsey, Archbishop of Canterbury, from 1294 to 1313.

[P. 317](#), l. 709, *Li sire de Nichole*.—Oliver Sutton, Bishop of Lincoln, who died in the November of 1299.

—— l. 714, *L’elyt de Everwyke*.—Henry de Newark, who succeeded to the Archbishopric in 1297, and died in 1299.

[P. 318](#), l. 720. These English verses are only found in the Cambridge MS.

[P. 320](#), l. 19, *Pur treys souz, &c*.—Robert of Brunne translates this—

Thei profere a man to bete, for tuo schilynges or thre,
With piked staves grete beten salle he be.

We learn from this writer that it was the King who gave them the name of *Trailebastons*.

[P. 321](#), l. 43, *Sire Jon de Meneteft*.—He is said to have been incited by his personal hatred of Wallace to seek out and deliver the Scottish Chieftain to his enemies. Robert de Brunne adds something to his original in this place:—

Sir Jon of Menetest sewed William so nehi,
He tok him whan he wend lest, on nyght his leman bi.
That was thorght treson of Jak Schort his man,
He was the encheson that Sir Jon so him nam.
Jak brother had he slayn, the Waleis that is said,
The more Jak was fayn to do William that braid.
Selcouthly he endis the man that is fals,
If he trest on his frendes, thei begile him als
Begiled is William, taken is and bondon.
To Ingland with him thei cam, and led him unto London.

We may take this occasion of pointing out the impropriety of quoting Robert de Brunne as Peter Langtoft. Mr. Tytler quotes this story of Jack Short upon Langtoft's authority, which involves two serious errors, first, making Langtoft say what he did not say, and, secondly, giving the story on better authority than that on which it really rests, for, in this respect, Robert de Brunne is certainly inferior to Langtoft.

[P. 323](#), l. 67, *And tus, etc.*.—Robert of Brunne has six lines of this fragment more than in the French MSS.

It is not to drede,
Traytour salle spede,
 als he is worthi,
His lif salle he tyne,
And die thorgh pyne,
 withouten merci.
Thus may men here,
A ladde for to lere
 to biggen in pays.
It fallis in his ize,
That hewes over hie,
 with the Walays.

[P. 326](#), l. 66, *nu*.—In the MS. it is written *n^ou*. Perhaps the *o* was added by somebody who thought the orthography should be *nou*.

[P. 327](#), l. 78, *serven the chapele*.—This last word, which answers to *capella* in the similar passage in the Song at the end of these notes ([p. 401](#), l. 21), means here, perhaps, a *wardrobe*.

[P. 329](#), l. 126, *amis*.—This word is added in the MS. by a later hand than that which wrote the other part.

[P. 336](#), l. 285, *turmentours that comen from clerkes plei*.—Men who have performed the part of devils, or tormentors, in the miracle plays, which were performed by the clerks.

[P. 338](#), l. 330, *Theih pleien wid the hinges silver, and breiden wod for wele*.—They use the king's silver for their own pleasures, and produce wood, or tallies, instead of contributing to the prosperity of the people.

[P. 341](#), l. 392, *a derthe*.—l. 403, *eft wele i-nouh*.—[P. 342](#), l. 409, *another sorwe*.—l. 416, *another derthe of corn*.—Our poem was probably composed in 1321. During the preceding years, the kingdom had been visited repeatedly by dearth and famine. Holinshed remarks in 1316, a great dearth and famine, insomuch that a quarter of wheat sold for forty shillings, and at the same time a murrain among the cattle; in 1317, a "pitiful famine" with a "sore mortalitie of people;" the year 1318 seems to have been free from these visitations, and may have been that in which, according to the poem, there was "eft wele i-nouh;" in 1319, again, a great murrain of cattle; and in the latter end of the following year and in 1321, broke out the "great variaunce betwixt the lords and the Spensers," which was the cause of so much bloodshed, and which seems to be the "strif" (l. 423) under which the poet represents the people as then labouring.

[P. 342](#), l. 418, *afingred*.—For other instances of the use of this form, see a note on "The Tale of the Basyn and the Frere and the Boy." (Pickering, 1836.)

[P. 344](#), l. 457, *paunter*.—The true meaning of this word seems to be a *trap*, or *snare*. An English prose treatise of counsel for hermits, probably by Hampole (MS. Trin. Coll. Cant. B. 15, 17, of the reign of Edward III.), speaking of the snares laid by the devil to deceive people, observes, "This panter leyeth owre enemy to taken us with, whan we bigynne to haten wikkednesse, and turne us to goodnesse."

[P. 345](#).—This poem is defective at the end, by the loss of the remainder of the MS., which is imperfect. The following curious Song, which was given me by Mr. Halliwell, bears a remarkable resemblance in some parts to the English poem of the Auchinleck MS. It is taken from a MS. in the University Library, Cambridge, Ee. vi. 29, of the beginning of the fifteenth century, though most, if not all, the articles it contains are compositions of a much earlier date.

Ecce dolet Anglia luctibus imbuta!
Gens tremit tristitia, sordibus polluta;
Necat pestilentia viros atque bruta.
Cur? quia flagitia regnant resoluta.

Heu! jam totus vertitur mundus in malignum.
Inter gentes quæritur ubi cor benignum.
Christus non recolitur, mortuus per lignum;
Ergo plebs perimitur in vindictæ signum.

Pax et patientia penitus orbantur;
Amor et justitia domi non morantur;
Errores et vitia gentes amplexantur;
Patrum per malitia parvuli necantur.

Pastorum pigritia greges disperguntur;
Insontes astutia mercantum falluntur;
Fraus et avaritia sorores junguntur;
Divitum nequitia pauperes plectuntur.

Simonia colitur, Simon Magus vivit;
Æquitas opprimitur, veritas abivit;
Christi grex dispergitur, lupus insanivit;
Pestisque diffunditur, agnos deglutivit.

Favor non scientia permovet rectores;
Intrudit potentia servos ob labores,
Et regum clementia quosdam per favores;
Æs et amicitia juvant pervisores.

Fortes Christi milites modo recesserunt;
Sathanæ satellites templum subverterunt;
Laceras et debiles oves prodiderunt;
Cuculi degeneres nisis successerunt.

Patres quondam nobiles pestes fugarunt,
Et in fide stabiles languidos sanarunt;
Vita venerabiles signis coruscarunt;
Actus per laudabiles Christo militarunt.

Tales erunt vestibus asperis vestiti;
Ut moderni mollibus raro sunt potiti.
Hii præclaris moribus erant insigniti;

Juvenes a sordibus sacris eruditi.
Heu! nunc mercenarii, nec veri pastores,
Rectores, vicarii, mutaverunt mores;
Ambitu denarii subeunt labores;
Tales operarii merentur mœrores:
Isti pro ciliciis utuntur pellura;
Farciunt deliciis ventres tota cura;
Dant post[ea] spurcitiis se sine mensura;
Suffulti divitiis vivunt contra jura.
Dum capella tegitur nobili vestura,
Sponsa Christi rapitur nudata tectura;
Vinea destruitur porcorum ursura,
Et vitis evellitur, carens jam cultura.
Sacerdotes Domini sunt incontinentes;
Actus suo nomini non sunt respondentes;
Sacra dantes homini forent et docentes;
Sui mores ordini non sunt congruentes.
Ista super æthera sanguine scribantur,
Ut patenti littera sæculis legantur;
Ignibus cum vetera peccata purgantur,
Sua ferant onera jam qui dominantur.
En! amor et caritas regnis refrigescunt;
Livor et severitas gentibus ardescunt;
Cleri plebis veritas et fides tepescunt;
Hinc regni nobilitas et fama quiescunt.
Feminæ fragilitas omni caret laude;
Mercantum subtilitas versatur in fraude;
Et fratrum dolositas jungit caput caudæ.
Homo, si jam veritas te gubernat, gaude!
Explicit.

[P. 14.](#) SONG ON THE TIMES.—Giraldus Cambrensis has inserted a copy of this Song in the *Speculum Ecclesiæ*, MS. Cotton. Tiberius, B. XIII. fol. 126, v^o, and attributes it to the famous Golias, which is commonly supposed to be only a fictitious name for Walter Mapes. This takes away all doubt as to its age, and the explanations given by Flacius Illyricus may be right. There is another copy in a Cottonian MS. of the thirteenth century, Vespas. A. XIX. fol. 59, r^o, where it is entitled *De veneranda*

justitia Romanæ curiæ. In Giraldus, the song commences with the 13th line, *Roma mundi caput est*, &c. In the other Cotton. MS. it begins as in our text. The variations afforded by these two MSS. are as follow:—[P. 14](#), l. 1, *Romanæ reb.*, C.—6, *profluit*, C.—9, the first *est* is omitted in C.—10, *Tegunt picem*, C.—[P. 15](#), l. 12, *ramus in sap.*, C.—15, *trahit enim*, G. and C.—17, *res et sing.*, C.—21, *In hoc consistorio*, G. and C.—27, *petunt quando petis*, G. and C.—28, *eadem et metis*, C.—[P. 16](#). The first 16 lines in this page are omitted in Giraldus.—l. 5, *nummus*, C.—6, *rot. placet, totum pl.*, C.—7, *ita pl. ... Romanos*, C.—10, *obiceret*, C.—11, *Et sanc.*, C.—12, *transeunt*, C.—13, *venit parca*, C.—15, *pro munere*, C.—[P. 17](#), l. 1, *et ... sit*, G. and C. *animanti*, C.—2, *Respondet hæc tibia*, G. and C.—6, *li mort*, C.—7, G. and C. have *Porta* at the beginning of this line, and *Papa* in the next. G. omits the words *chartula quærit*: it ought to be observed that in this MS. the song is written as prose, so that such omissions are easily explained.—8, G. and C. omit the words *cursor quærit*.—9, *omnis quærit*, G. *si des si quid uni*, G. and C.—10, *Totum mare salsum est, tota*, G. and C. except that the former has *salseum* for *salsum est*: see another example of this expression in the present volume, [p.](#)

[228](#), l. 19.—11, *Des ... des ... addas*, G.—l. 12, the extract in Giraldus ends here.—[P. 18](#), l. 4, *totum impl.*, C.—6, *habet Pluto*, C.—9, *dant divitibus*, C.

[P. 44](#), l. 3 of Song against the Bishops, *read* *fungar vice cotis*, “I will perform the part of a whetstone.”

[P. 282](#), l. 5 of translation, *for* Edward, *read* Edmund.

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TRANSCRIBER'S NOTE

Obvious punctuation errors have been corrected after careful comparison with similar occurrences within the text and consultation of external sources.

Except for those changes noted below, all misspellings in the text, and inconsistent or archaic usage, have been retained (for example, participater; agreable; Eduardus; indited).

In the Table of Contents:—

[Pg xviii](#): a final entry 'INDEX 403' has been added.

In the songs:—

[Pg 89](#): line number '250' replaced by '350'.

[Pg 271](#): 'dolose desiandatur' replaced by 'dolose defiandatur'.

In the translations:—

[Pg 78](#): 'pride and and cruelty' replaced by 'pride and cruelty'.

[Pg 131](#): 'with the Sicilans' replaced by 'with the Sicilians'.

[Pg 133](#): 'is of no but right' (a word is missing) replaced by 'is of no use; but right'.

[Pg 140](#): 'the brethen must' replaced by 'the brethren must'.

[Pg 156](#): 'all who sits there' replaced by 'all who sit there'.

[Pg 158](#): 'then so fall' replaced by 'than so fall'.

[Pg 215](#): 'come no nothing' replaced by 'come to nothing'.

In the abstracts and glossaries:—

[Pg 160](#): 'have apparently been' replaced by 'have apparently been'.

[Pg 336](#): '292. *mot-hall*' replaced by '292. *mot-halle*'.

[Pg 344](#): 'wrong.—868' replaced by 'wrong.—468'.

In the Notes:—

[Pg 349](#): ‘*P. 1, l. 14*’ replaced by ‘*P. 8, l. 14*’.

[Pg 349](#): ‘—— 15’ replaced by ‘—— *l. 15*’.

[Pg 351](#): ‘totum pl.,—7’ replaced by ‘totum pl., Fl.—7’ (the missing source reference assumed to be Fl.).

[Pg 371](#): ‘wintered at Trapeni’ replaced by ‘wintered at Trapani’.

[Pg 376](#): ‘*P. 169,*’ replaced by ‘*P. 169, l. 1,*’ (missing line number inserted).

[Pg 376](#): ‘—— *l. 186,*’ replaced by ‘*P. 174, l. 186,*’ (missing page number inserted).

[Pg 380](#): ‘The MS. has *þþe*’. The original text has one large tilde spanning ‘pp’ 

[Pg 389](#): ‘The MS. has *far?*’. The original text has an unusual symbol, similar to but not a ?  Unicode code points for these may come in the future from the Medieval Unicode Font Initiative (MUFI).

In the Index:—

Robert: ‘Geffrey’ replaced by ‘Geoffrey’,

tu-brigge: replaced by ‘tu-brugge’.

Entries Canons and London had sub-entries starting with ———. These sub-entries have been indented by two spaces instead, for consistency.

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